The Ten Wheels of Kṣitigarbha, a Great Vehicle Sūtra from the Great Collection

Daśacakrakṣitigarbha-nāma-mahāyānasūtra · Toh 239 · Derge Kangyur
འདུས་པ་ཆེན་པ་ལེས་སའི་སྙིང་པའོ་ལེགས་རང་སྐྱེ་ལ་བོད་ཡུ་ཞས་བ་བྱུ་ཐགེ་པ་ཆེན་པའོ་མད་

The Ten Wheels of Kṣitigarbha, known in Sanskrit as the Daśacakrakṣitigarbha Sūtra and in Tibetan as Sai Nyingpö Khorlo Chupa, is a Great Vehicle sūtra presented as part of the Great Collection, the vast Mahāyāna compilation of discourses. Set on Mount Khaladeya, where the Buddha dwells with great assemblies of monks and bodhisattvas, it tells how the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha arrives amid wondrous signs, and the Buddha then teaches the ten wheels, the powers and qualities by which buddhas and bodhisattvas protect beings and uphold the Dharma. Across its eight chapters it treats moral conduct, the duty to respect and protect monastics even when they are flawed, the dangers of slandering the teaching, the true marks of a field of merit, and practices such as recollection of the Buddha and meditation on emptiness, closing with the Buddha entrusting the sūtra to the bodhisattva Ākāśagarbha. It is Toh 239 in the Kangyur, where it belongs to the General Sūtra section, and its colophon records that it was translated into Tibetan from Chinese by a Chinese preceptor together with the Tibetan translator Nampar Mitok.

In the language of India: daśacakrakṣitigarbhanāmamahāyānasūtra. In the language of Tibet: From the Great Collection, the Great Vehicle Sūtra called The Ten Wheels of Kṣitigarbha.

The first fascicle.

Homage to all buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Thus did I hear at one time. The Blessed One was dwelling on the mountain called Khaladeya, the abode frequented by many sages and munis, together with an immeasurable, countless great Saṅgha of monks, all of them a great Saṅgha of śrāvakas alone. Together with him also were immeasurable, countless bodhisattva great beings, all of them a great Saṅgha of bodhisattvas alone.

Just after the teaching called Candragarbha had been given, great clouds of fragrance gathered from the southern direction, and from them a great rain of fragrance poured down. Great clouds of flowers gathered, and from them a great rain of flowers poured down. Great clouds of divine jewel ornaments

gathered, and from them a great rain of divine jewel ornaments poured down. Great clouds of divine garments gathered, and from them a great rain of divine garments poured down. Such great clouds and rains covered that mountain, the abode frequented by many sages and munis.

From those fragrances, flowers, jewel ornaments and garments there resounded hundreds of thousands of the various voices of the great Dharma, namely: the sound of going for refuge to the Jewels; the sound of upholding the bases of training; the sound of being gentle and patient; the sound of undertaking diligence; the sound of the four māras subdued; the sound of being intent upon and entering wisdom; the sound of great renown spreading widely through the three worlds; the sound of applying oneself to the special qualities of mindfulness, meditative absorption and dhāraṇī; the sound of emptiness, signlessness and wishlessness; the sound of utter weariness with desire; the sound, "Form is like a mass of foam"; the sound, "Feeling is like a water bubble"; the sound, "Perception is like a mirage"; the sound, "Formations are like a plantain tree"; the sound, "Consciousness is like a magical illusion"; the sound of impermanence; the sound of suffering; the sound of selflessness; the sound of emptiness; the sound of possessing conscience and a sense of shame; the sound of complete renunciation; the sound of the applications of mindfulness; the sound of loving-kindness, compassion, joy and equanimity; the sound of the full comprehension of all phenomena; the sound of birth in the higher realms and of passing beyond sorrow; the sound of entering the three vehicles; the sound of turning the great wheel of the Dharma; the sound of letting fall the great rain of the Dharma; the sound of bringing sentient beings to full maturity; the sound of complete liberation from the three lower realms; the sound of applying oneself to perfecting the six perfections; the sound of skill in means; the sound of entering the ten grounds; the sound of playing with the higher knowledges; the sound of delighting in the pure, unsurpassed Great Vehicle; the sound of not turning back from the grounds; the sound of acceptance that phenomena are unborn; the sound of consecration upon the crown of the head; and the sound of entering the great ocean of all the buddhas. All these resounded.

Then all those many circles of the assembly saw such clouds and rains of every kind, and heard the resounding voices of the Dharma. Each of them, according to the inclination of his own mind, saw his own body fully adorned with various fragrances, flowers, jewel ornaments and fine divine garments. They also saw that each of them held a precious wish-fulfilling jewel in the

palms of both hands, and that from each of those precious wish-fulfilling jewels various precious things fell down like rain.

Moreover, rays of light of many kinds streamed forth from those precious jewels, and by the power of those rays each of those beings also saw buddha fields as numerous as the grains of sand in the river Ganges, throughout the ten directions. By the power of those rays they also saw, in those buddha fields, each of those tathāgatas surrounded with reverence by immeasurable great assemblies.

Furthermore, by the power of that light, all sentient beings in those buddha fields who were tormented by illness were freed from the suffering of illness the moment those rays touched them. Those facing execution, and those held in prison and bound, were completely freed from these the moment those rays touched them. Those whose body, speech and mind behaved without ease, weighed down by grave negative tendencies, became utterly light and completely purified by the power of that light. Those who were hungry and thirsty became sated and satisfied. Those afflicted by execution and by punishments of every kind were freed from their suffering the moment those rays touched them. Those who were lacking and destitute of clothing, jewel ornaments, wealth and possessions came to have them in abundance, just as they wished. Sentient beings who delighted in and were inclined toward killing, and so on up to those who delighted in and were inclined toward wrong view, came to delight in and be inclined toward completely abandoning killing, and so on up to completely abandoning wrong view, the moment that light touched them. Sentient beings who suffered from failing to find what they desired in its many forms found it just as they had hoped, the moment that light touched them.

Moreover, by the power of that light, all the sentient beings in all the buddha fields who were tormented by suffering were seen to have it all pacified and to be filled with great happiness. Furthermore, because all those buddha fields were illuminated by the light, clouds, dust, mist, wind, hail, inauspicious sounds, foul smells, bad tastes such as bitterness and pungency, unpleasant textures, terrors and the many kinds of harm all ceased to be.

Moreover, those fields became entirely free of evil deeds, wrong speech, wrong intentions and wrong inclinations. They were neither too cold nor too hot, utterly peaceful and pleasant, the ground as level as the palm of the hand, and they were filled with every excellent requisite of happiness.

At that time the earth element in the bodies of each of the many members of the assembly became exceedingly heavy, so heavy that they could hardly bear it. Seeing such omens appear, they were all alarmed, and the thought arose in them, "What is the cause, what is the condition, for such omens as these?"

Then, within that circle of the assembly, Śakra, lord of the gods, called Born Stainless, who was seated not far from the Blessed One, rose from his seat, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, joined his palms toward the Blessed One, and addressed him in these verses:

You who speak the truth and see the truth,
O Sage, firmly established in the truth,
To all this great assembly gathered here
Please teach the ultimate Dharma of truth.

Many ordinary beings
Are rid of suffering and the cause of suffering.
For what reason have clouds and rains
Appeared here in this assembly?

The assembly, overjoyed,
Has conceived a mind of deep faith;
All are intent upon the Great Vehicle;
Right view has arisen and they have crossed beyond doubt.

The bodies of the many gods and humans in this assembly
Have grown so heavy in their earth element
That they cannot bear their own weight.
Through what condition has this omen arisen?

From the jewels in the palms of both hands
Rains of precious things fall, and light streams forth,
Illuminating the ten directions and clearing away evil;
Suffering is stilled and happiness is gained.
Guide, please tell us: from what condition?

Upon every circle of the assembly
Various incense and garlands
Appear as adornments on each one's body.
All the gods and humans have grown doubtful:
What is the cause, and what the condition?

Who has come here, and from where,
To display this power of miraculous ability?
Is it a buddha or a bodhisattva?
Or is it Brahmā, or a māra?
Is it Śakra? Who is it who has come?
Great Guide, please explain it.

Then the Blessed One said to Śakra Born Stainless, "You should understand it in this way. There is a bodhisattva great being called Kṣitigarbha who, throughout immeasurable, countless great eons in the past, during the times of the five degenerations, has brought sentient beings to maturity in world realms where no buddha dwells. Now, together with a retinue of eighty thousand koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, he is coming here to this world realm with his retinue in the guise of śramaṇas, in order to pay homage to me, to serve and venerate me, and moreover to look upon the circles of the assembly and give rise to rejoicing. Through the power of his higher knowledge he has displayed these miracles.

"That bodhisattva great being called Kṣitigarbha is adorned with immeasurable, countless, inconceivable special qualities, so that no śrāvaka, no pratyekabuddha, nor anyone in the world is able to fathom him. That bodhisattva is a treasury of all supreme qualities. He is a mine of the jewels of liberation. He purifies the eyes of bodhisattvas. He is a caravan leader for those who are journeying to nirvāṇa. Like a precious wish-fulfilling jewel, he rains down every kind of precious thing, and so satisfies all hopes and desires. He is like an island of jewels for many merchants. Because he makes the roots of virtue grow and increase, he is like a fertile field. Because he places beings in the happiness of liberation, he is like a vessel. Because he is a source of excellent jewels, he is like an auspicious vase of good qualities. Because he gives light to those devoted to virtue, he is like the bright sun. Because he gives light to those who have lost their way, he is like a lamp. Because he dispels the torment of the afflictions, he is cooling like the moon. For the lame he is like a conveyance. For those setting out on a long road he is like a store of provisions. For those lost in the wilderness he is like a guide. For the mad and the deranged he is like an excellent medicine. For those tormented by illness he is like meeting a skilled physician. For the old and the frail he is like a support and a staff. For the weary and exhausted he is like a bed and a seat. For crossing the four floods he is like a bridge. For going to the far shore he is

like a boat and a ship.

"He brings to ripeness the special fruits of the three roots of virtue. He brings forth the bases of the three kinds of virtue and lets them pour down continuously. His unbroken stream of giving turns like a wheel. In the firmness with which he guards moral discipline he is like Sumeru, king of mountains. His diligence, hard to destroy, is like a precious vajra. His unshakable patience is like the great earth. His profound meditative concentration is like a hidden treasure. His beauty of meditative equipoise is like an excellent garland of flowers. His wisdom, deep and vast, is like the great ocean. His freedom from attachment to anything at all is like space. His nearness to the cause of the supreme fruit is like a flower in full bloom. In taming the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) he is like a king of lions. In crushing the divine māra he is like a great nāga or elephant. In cutting down all the enemies that are the afflictions he is like a divine sword. In his weariness with much busy activity he is like a follower of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. In washing away the stains of the afflictions he is like clear water. In clearing away the filth of impurity he is like a strong wind. In cutting off the opportunities of the thorough afflictions he is like a sharp weapon. In protecting from every fear and anxiety he is like a kinsman or a friend. In defending against hostile enemies he is like a moat or a fortress. Because he frees beings from all dangers he is like a father and mother. In sheltering the weak and feeble he is like a dense forest. For those travelling a long road in summer he is like a great tree of cool shade. For those tormented by heat and thirst he is like cool water. For the hungry he is like sweet fruit. For the naked he provides clothing to wear. For those oppressed by heat he becomes a dense cloud. For the poor and destitute he becomes a precious wish-fulfilling jewel. For the fearful and frightened he becomes a refuge and a shelter. For the crops he becomes the rain.

"For turbid waters he becomes a water-clearing jewel. Because he keeps the roots of virtue of many sentient beings from being destroyed, he shows them the excellent field of practice and brings delight and satisfaction to the assembly. He urges sentient beings toward a higher conscience and sense of shame and leads them into it. He adorns those who have gathered the accumulations of merit and wisdom with the ornaments of these. In thoroughly dispelling the afflictions he is like an emetic and a purgative medicine. In gathering in the agitated mind he is like the field of practice of meditative equipoise. His unobstructed eloquence is like a turning water-wheel. His gathering of the mind upon its object is like gazing upon a beautiful form. His

steadfast patience is like Sumeru, king of mountains. His form, deep and vast, is like the great ocean. His unobstructed bases of miraculous power are like space. His thorough removal of all the habitual tendencies of the obscurations is like the warmth of the sun melting ice. Always delighting in the meditative concentrations, the formless absorptions and the true path, he is like a supreme island of the jewels of omniscient wisdom, and so, even without deliberately setting out to do so, he turns the great wheel of the Dharma.

"Noble son, such is that bodhisattva great being Kṣitigarbha, endowed with such immeasurable, countless, inconceivable special qualities. Because he and his retinue are drawing near to this place, these miracles and omens were displayed beforehand through that light."

As soon as the Blessed One had spoken of the many qualities of the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha, the bodhisattva great being Kṣitigarbha, together with a retinue of eighty hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas, appearing through the power of his miraculous ability in the guise of śramaṇas, arrived from the southern direction into the presence of the Blessed One. With the great assembly he touched his head to the Blessed One's feet in homage, circumambulated him three times, and, standing before the Tathāgata with palms joined, praised him in these verses:

Guide, supreme among two-footed beings,
With a mind of loving-kindness you protect all.
Like the great earth you are supremely patient,
And you have cleared away all thoughts of hatred and wrath.

Endowed with the supreme major and minor marks,
You adorn the fields of all the buddhas.
With true loving-kindness and compassion
You fill all the fields of the Victors.

Having cut through every net of craving,
You dwell in happiness, true and just as it is.
Forsaking the utterly pure fields,
You free sentient beings in times of degeneration.

Having made your vow in this degenerate field,
You bring to maturity beings of the lower realms.
With true and steadfast effort
You practised austerities for a very long time.

Hearing of the austerities you practised so long,
Even a mind of awe arises.
You cultivated generosity, moral discipline, patience,
Diligence, meditative concentration and wisdom.

To buddhas and to bodhisattvas
And to measureless śrāvakas you paid supreme honor.
Moreover, many beings
You rescued from death by hunger and thirst.

For the sake of other, ordinary beings
You gave up body and life many times without attachment.
To seek the true and sacred Dharma
You gave up your flesh and bones many times as well.

Giving up all your own happiness,
You hold beings lovingly in your heart.
For the sake of many ordinary beings
You strive to cut through the net of doubt.

Having fully restrained the six faculties,
You long ago abandoned every desire.
You realized that the conditioned is impermanent and suffering,
Selfless, and empty.

The cause from which
All suffering is born is desire and craving.
Therefore, first, through the six faculties,
Desire should be cut off completely.

In every realm where sentient beings dwell
You abide always with great compassion.
Even having awakened to supreme awakening,
You do not abandon any of your former aspirations.

Whenever you see sentient beings
Tormented by suffering,
With overwhelming diligence
You strive to free them from it.

Having cultivated generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence,
Meditative concentration and wisdom, all of them,
Just as a mother nurtures

Her only child with a loving mind,

So in the past too, toward every class of sentient beings,
You always gave rise to a loving mind.
Therefore, having swiftly awakened,
You free measureless assemblies.

Of all the conduct of awakening you have cultivated,
There is none you did not dedicate to the welfare of beings.
Therefore, toward all sentient beings
You do not abandon the six perfections.

Because you always accomplished unsurpassed awakening
In the evil times of the final age,
Now too, in the evil times of the final age,
You have fully awakened to unsurpassed awakening.

Gods, nāgas, humans and yakṣas
Holding evil views you have tamed, every one;
You cut through their doubts and set them in happiness
Upon the vajra-like path.

To measureless beings
You also give prophecy of supreme awakening.
Worthy of offerings, foremost among guides,
You have become the supreme field of merit.

Blessed One without equal,
With loving-kindness you protect all beings.
By your measureless, great renown
The worlds of the ten directions are pervaded.

Therefore bodhisattvas,
In order to accomplish their own aim,
Have gathered here together from every side
And come into the presence of the Great Sage.

Having heard the sacred teachings,
They give rise to minds of great joy,
And, rousing true diligence all the more,
They apply themselves to the conduct of awakening.

Through the power of the Guide's Dharma
All will attain complete awakening.
Therefore the assembly that you, Guide,
Have gathered here today is without precedent.

Some one hundred and thirty thousand yakṣas,
Who always ate flesh and drank blood,
Have all given up their evil deeds
And now incline and turn toward great awakening.

Some have gained special, supreme forms,
And patience and meditative absorption as well.
Some, all their defilements exhausted,
Have become arhats, supreme in the world.

Some cultivate the four immeasurables,
And some abide in the four means of attraction.
Some have gained the four correct knowledges,
And some abide in the patience that accords with truth.

Some have gained the heroic march absorption (śūraṃgama),
And some possess the eye of wisdom.
Some abide in acceptance of the unborn.
All of them are blessed by the Guide.

Through the power of the Blessed One's great splendor
The hosts of Māra are vanquished,
And all the ranks of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)
Of ninety-five kinds are tamed.

The streams of beings of the hells, the animals,
The pretas and the asuras are all cut off.
Made happy, sentient beings, all of them,
Have come into the presence of the Victor.

The terrors of disease and weapons
And the terror of famine too are quelled here today.
Sentient beings who were blinded and bewildered,
Who had lost the true path, are delivered.

Those drunk and deranged with the afflictions
Are all set upon the path of peace.
I too have left aside all my tasks

And come to bow at the Blessed One's feet.

The blessed ones now dwelling
In measureless fields
All have praised you in every way;
Hearing this, all have come here.

Ocean of omniscience,
Your true qualities are beyond measure.
You who act for the welfare of many beings,
With a mind of devotion I pay you homage.

Having perfected measureless merit,
I have bowed at the Blessed One's feet.
Throughout measureless eons as well
May I worship you with many offerings.

Just as the Blessed One did,
I too have made such a vow:
In this degenerate world
May I attain unsurpassed awakening.

When the bodhisattva great being Kṣitigarbha had praised the Blessed One with these excellent verses, he and his retinue further strewed over the Blessed One divine fragrances, flowers of many kinds and measureless jewel ornaments, which became a jewel parasol in the sky above. Then, in order to listen to the sacred Dharma, he sat silently before the Blessed One.

Then all the assembly gathered in that circle of the assembly, seeing the bodhisattva great being Kṣitigarbha, were filled with wonder. Each of them offered divine incense of many kinds, flowers, jewel ornaments, robes, victory banners, pennants, parasols and so on, and having made offerings to the bodhisattva great being Kṣitigarbha, they spoke these words: "We have gained a great gain. Through the blessing of the Blessed One we have seen you, great being, face to face, and have been able to make offerings to you with reverence."

Then, within that circle of the assembly, there was a bodhisattva great being called Inquiring Rightly into Doubts. He rose from his seat, arranged his robe, bared his right shoulder, bowed his head at the Blessed One's feet, set his right knee upon the ground, joined his palms toward the Blessed One, and said

to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, where has this noble son come from? How far from here is the buddha field where he dwells? With what qualities and roots of virtue is he endowed, that the Blessed One praises him with praises of many kinds, and that he in turn praises the Blessed One's inconceivable ocean of qualities? Since we have never seen him before and are filled with wonder, may the Blessed One please explain it to us."

The Blessed One said, "Enough, noble son. The extent of this great being's qualities and roots of virtue cannot be understood by the whole assembly of gods and humans together with the world. If the Tathāgata were to explain that great being's qualities and roots of virtue in full, all gods and humans together with the world would be bewildered and would not believe it."

Then the bodhisattva Inquiring Rightly into Doubts again said, "Blessed One, out of love for us, please explain it."

The Blessed One said, "Listen well and closely, and keep it in mind, and I shall explain to you just a portion of how that great being is endowed with measureless, inconceivable special qualities. Namely, he dwells at ease in the special heroic march absorption. He has thoroughly entered into understanding the domain of the tathāgatas. He has attained the special acceptance that phenomena are unborn. He has gained mastery over all the qualities of a buddha. He has attained acceptance with regard to omniscient wisdom. He has crossed to the far shore of the ocean of omniscient wisdom. He abides firmly in the absorption called Banner of the Lion's Stretch. He has climbed the mountain of omniscient wisdom. He has utterly vanquished all non-Buddhists and opponents. In order to bring all sentient beings to maturity, he dwells in every buddha field there is.

"In accordance with how that great being abides, so too do the buddha fields abide: through the absorptions he brings forth measureless special qualities, and so brings to maturity measureless sentient beings who are to be trained.

"In accordance with how that great being abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Bringing Forth Wisdom, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in that buddha field see, each in a way suited to them, the whole domain of the absorptions.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Endowed with Immeasurable Wisdom, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings

dwelling in those buddha fields, each as best they can, worship the buddha, the blessed one there, with reverence and with measureless excellent requisites of offering.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Perfection of Pure Wisdom, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields, each in a way suited to them, see the measureless faults and defects of the objects of desire, and their minds become pure.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Wisdom Endowed with Conscience and Shame, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields come to possess a higher conscience and sense of shame, are entirely parted from evil and nonvirtuous qualities, and their good intentions do not decline.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Clear Illumination Endowed with All the Vehicles, then all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields come to realize, with skill in means, the higher knowledges of miraculous power and of the divine eye, the higher knowledge recollecting former lives, the higher knowledge of death and birth, and the causes and results of this world and the world beyond.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Knowing through the Sorrowless Higher Knowledge, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields become free of all sorrow, dejection and torpor.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Endowed with Special Higher Knowledges, then all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields come to possess the higher knowledges together with skill in means.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Illuminating All the World, then through the power of that absorption all the world realms of the ten directions become free of darkness, and all who dwell in that buddha field see directly all the buddha fields of the ten directions.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Lamp of the Buddha, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields completely abandon wrong views and go for refuge to the Three Jewels.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too did the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Vajra Light, then through the power of that absorption, in those buddha fields the ring of encircling mountains, the great encircling ring, Sumeru, king of mountains, and all other mountains, the valleys, the small valleys, the ravines, gravel, potsherds, thorns, grasses and all noxious trees disappear. In that buddha field all that is reckoned as evil, poison, sorcery, savage beasts of prey, calamities, sudden accidents, epidemics, bad lands, murky skies, dust, dirt and all filth and impurity are stilled and cease to be. The ground of that buddha field becomes as level as the palm of the hand, with auspicious things of many kinds arising of themselves; it becomes pure, it becomes excellent, it becomes sublime, and it is adorned with many good signs.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Invincible Power of Wisdom, then through the power of that absorption the king of the māras dwelling in that buddha field, together with his retinue, all become terrified and go for refuge to the Three Jewels.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Lightning Rays, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields become free of fear of the world beyond and delight in the Dharma.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Endowed with the Supreme Taste, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in that buddha field are satisfied with food and drink just as they wish.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Endowed with Supreme Radiance, then through the power of that absorption there is no sentient being at all dwelling in those buddha fields who does not possess exceptional might and strength, and they become free of all the suffering of illness.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Supreme Sublime Requisites, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields, according to their inclinations, are never in want or lacking in seats and cushions, bedding, clothing, jewel ornaments, or anything whatsoever that belongs among the requisites of life, and they come to possess things utterly beautiful and exceedingly delightful.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Wisdom Free of Conflict, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields become at ease and light in body and mind, free of all hostility and all bondage, harmonious and joyful, and enthusiastic; and they come to delight in and aspire to generosity, moral discipline, patience, the undertaking of diligence, an unagitated mind, and the perfection of wisdom.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Exceptional Enthusiasm, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields come to possess a special, immeasurable supreme joy.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Light of the Worldly Path, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in that buddha field attain unobstructed wisdom and train in many kinds of pure action.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Firmly Abiding in the Vajra of the Victors, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in that buddha field possess all their faculties, their faculties do not decline, they constantly aspire to the path of true deliverance, and their minds become utterly peaceful.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Examining the Superior Banner, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields become thoroughly weary of their own sinful, nonvirtuous deeds and want no part of them; all of them guard virtue, and through the ten virtuous courses of action they are reborn as gods in the higher realms.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Endowed with Loving-kindness and Compassion, then through the power of that absorption there arise in all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields a mind of loving-kindness, a mind of compassion, a mind free of harm or violence, a mind impartial toward all, and a mind that brings benefit and happiness to one another.

"In accordance with how he abides, so too do the buddha fields become. If he enters into equipoise in the absorption called Thoroughly Gathering All Merit, then through the power of that absorption all the sentient beings dwelling in those buddha fields are completely free of strife, disputes, disease, and famine, and all unpleasant tactile objects, such as untimely wind, rain, snow, roughness, heat, and painful contact, are entirely pacified.

"Thus, if that great being enters into equipoise in the absorption called Ocean Lightning Light, then through the power of that absorption the whole great ground of those buddha fields becomes made of many kinds of jewels, completely free of every fault and defect, and it becomes adorned with immeasurable sublime requisites of life, such as trees of many kinds of jewels, clothing trees, vessel trees, ornament trees, flower trees, fruit trees, and trees of many kinds of music.

"In the same way, in short, in order to bring many sentient beings to maturity, this son of noble family every day, in the morning, enters into equipoise in absorptions as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River. Arising from those absorptions, he brings to maturity all the sentient beings to be trained in all the buddha fields of the ten directions, through whatever benefit and happiness will train each of them.

"For immeasurable, incalculable great eons in the past, this son of noble family has brought sentient beings to maturity in world systems where no tathāgata was present, during the time of the five degenerations.

"In times to come, if in some world system the danger of weapons arises and sentient beings are tormented, this son of noble family, seeing such beings, in the morning, through the power of his absorptions, quells those dangers of weapons and causes those sentient beings to cherish one another with minds of loving-kindness. If in some world system the danger of disease arises and sentient beings are afflicted, this son of noble family, seeing such beings, in the morning, through the power of his absorptions, quells the danger of disease and causes those sentient beings to attain perfect well-being. If in

some world system the danger of famine arises and sentient beings are afflicted, this son of noble family, seeing such beings, in the morning, through the power of absorption, quells the danger of famine and fully satisfies those sentient beings with food.

"Thus through the force of many absorptions this son of noble family brings relief to sentient beings with immeasurable, incalculable, inconceivable benefit and happiness of these and other kinds. Possessing in this way immeasurable, countless, inconceivable kinds of special earnest endeavor, this son of noble family strives intensely for the aim of bringing benefit and happiness to all sentient beings.

"In times past, in order to benefit, bring happiness to, and fully mature many beings, he made great inexhaustible vows in the presence of immeasurable, countless buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, and he fully generated great compassion and great diligence that cannot be taken away. Having thus generated great compassion and diligence that cannot be taken away, and having made inexhaustible vows, through the force of advancing ever higher and higher, even in a single day and night, or in a mere instant or moment, he tames immeasurable koṭis of niyutas of ordinary beings, frees them from many kinds of suffering, and fulfills the hopes of each and every one of them with whatever each of them desires.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who suffer from many kinds of desire and are tormented by longing, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, they will obtain whatever they desire and be free of suffering, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings in want of food and drink, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, they will obtain whatever they desire and have food and drink, and they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are in need and lacking in clothing, jewel ornaments, medicine for illness, bedding, seats and cushions, or the requisites of life, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the

bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, they will find whatever they desire, and they will have in abundance clothing, jewel ornaments, medicine for illness, bedding, seats, and all the requisites of life; and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are separated from those they love and have met with those who are hostile to them, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, they will meet with those they love and be parted from those who are hostile, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings tormented in body and mind by illness and much suffering, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be at ease in body and mind and free of all illness, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who fight and quarrel, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, they will be free of resentful minds; with joy toward one another, with patience, and with minds of loving-kindness toward one another, they will feel remorse and grow fond of each other, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who suffer because they have been taken captive and thrown into prison, or bound with iron fetters, shackles, and wooden stocks, or bound limb by limb, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be freed from prison, iron fetters, shackles, and chains, and will be at ease and joyful, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who have been taken captive and are beaten or flogged or subjected to harsh punishment, and who face execution, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be completely freed from captivity, beating and flogging, and harsh punishment, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are exhausted in body and mind, without might or strength, and feeble, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will become light and at ease in body and mind and will gain might and strength, and in accordance with whatever will tame them they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings whose faculties are impaired or incomplete, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, none of them will have incomplete faculties; they will possess their faculties, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are insane and mentally disturbed, or possessed by bhūta spirits and grahas, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be free of insanity and mental disturbance and will be perfectly at ease, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings whose bodies and minds are tormented by attachment, aversion, delusion, anger, jealousy, pride, wrong views, sleep, heedlessness, doubt, and the like, and who cannot rid themselves of them, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be free of attachment and the rest, will be perfectly at ease in body and mind, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up

to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are burned by fire, swept away by water, carried off by wind, or have fallen down a precipice, or fallen from a tree or a rooftop, and are terrified and cowering, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be freed from all those harmful obstructions and perils, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are seized by venomous snakes or vicious beasts of prey, or struck by many kinds of poison, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be free of all violence and harm, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are struck by bhūta spirits and grahas, and suffer from constant fever, or fever that recurs every day, every second day, every third day, or every fourth day, or who are deranged so that their bodies and minds tremble and are disturbed, their mindfulness fails, and they lose consciousness, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be completely released from fear and will be perfectly at ease in body and mind, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are threatened by yakṣas, rākṣasas, bhūtas, piśācas, pūtanas, kaṭapūtanas, kumbhāṇḍas, and vitality-eaters, and besides these, by lions, tigers, wolves, and other vicious beasts of prey; who are beset and laid open to harm by mantras, sorcery, going into battle, and many other kinds of danger, so that they are utterly terrified in body and mind, afraid of death and wishing to live, seeking happiness and not wanting suffering, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all of them will be free of every danger, will suffer no harm to body or life, and in accordance with their fortune they

will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who are afflicted and tormented by suffering because they desire great learning, or desire pure faith, or desire pure moral discipline, or desire to accomplish meditative concentration, or desire the higher knowledges, or desire wisdom, or desire liberation, or desire excellent forms, or desire pleasant sounds, or desire fragrant scents, or desire delicious tastes, or desire the finest tactile objects, or desire profit and gain, or desire fame, or desire merit, or desire to make a living by a craft, or desire flowers and fruits, or desire pleasure groves, or desire seats and cushions, or desire bedding, or desire to travel to other lands, or desire wealth and grain, or desire medicine for illness, or desire houses, or desire servants, or desire pigments, or desire rain, or desire water, or desire crops, or desire fans, or desire cool breezes, or desire fire, or desire a vehicle, or desire sons and daughters, or desire to be skilled in means, or desire to make merit, or desire warmth, or desire coolness, or desire a keen mind, or desire many other kinds of things of worldly and world-transcending aims, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, then through the force of the qualities of that son of noble family's sublime absorptions, and of his might and splendor, all of them will be free of the torment of suffering, all their hopes will be fulfilled, and in accordance with their fortune they will attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who have sown seed in fertile fields or infertile fields, whether or not they have tended them diligently, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, then through the force of the qualities of that son of noble family's sublime absorptions, and of his might and splendor, all their crops will flourish, and their fruits will ripen and be good.

"Why is that? Because for immeasurable, countless great eons in the past this son of noble family, in the presence of immeasurable, countless buddhas, blessed ones, applied himself with great diligence, and through the power of his aspirations, made with steadfast vows, in order to bring sentient beings to maturity he constantly upholds the whole great earth, constantly upholds all the multitude of seeds, and constantly enables all sentient beings to enjoy them as they wish. Through the power of that son of noble family's miraculous

abilities, all the grasses that grow from this great earth, and the roots, branches, sprouts, leaves, trunks, petals, flowers, fruits, and so on of trees, all grow abundantly; and he makes the flowers and fruits of medicinal plants, trees, crops, and so on ripen, and become full, sweet, rich, and fragrant.

"In whatever places there are sentient beings who, because their attachment, aversion, delusion, and the like are fierce and sharp, actively engage in the ten nonvirtuous courses of action: killing, taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, lying, harsh speech, divisive speech, idle chatter, covetousness, malice, and wrong view, if they single-mindedly recite the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention make offerings to him with reverence, all their afflictions will be pacified, they will be completely free of the ten nonvirtues and will possess the ten virtuous courses of action, and there will arise in them minds of loving-kindness, compassion, benefit, and happiness toward all sentient beings.

"Thus, through the force of such sublime qualities, absorption, might, and splendor, and through his absorption of intense diligence, this son of noble family goes in an instant, in a moment, to immeasurable, countless buddha fields, and in each of those buddha fields, in an instant, in a moment, he frees from suffering immeasurable, countless sentient beings who are fit vessels, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, and brings them to happiness, so that in accordance with their fortune they attain everything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa.

"Thus that son of noble family, possessing such qualities, steadfast aspirations, and inconceivable diligence of intense effort, in order to bring sentient beings to maturity, in the world systems of the ten directions, appears to some in the body of Great Brahmā, the king, and teaches sentient beings the Dharma by which they will be trained. To some he appears in the body of the god Maheśvara (Śiva). To some he appears in the body of a god of the Paranirmitavaśavartin heaven of the desire realm. To some he appears in the body of a god of the Nirmāṇarati heaven. To some he appears in the body of a god of the Tuṣita heaven. To some he appears in the body of a god of the Yāma heaven. To some he appears in the body of a god of the Heaven of the Thirty-Three. To some he appears in the body of a god of the Four Great Kings. To some he appears in the form of a buddha. To some he appears in the body of a bodhisattva. To some he appears in the body of a pratyekabuddha. To some he appears in the body of a śrāvaka. To some he appears in the body of a universal monarch. To some he appears in the body of a kṣatriya. To some

he appears in the body of a brahmin. To some he appears in the body of a śūdra. To some he appears in the body of a vaiśya. To some he appears in the body of a man. To some he appears in the body of a woman. To some he appears in the body of a youth. To some he appears in the body of a girl. To some he appears in the body of a gandharva. To some he appears in the body of an asura. To some he appears in the body of a kinnara. To some he appears in the body of a mahoraga. To some he appears in the body of a nāga. To some he appears in the body of a yakṣa. To some he appears in the body of a rākṣasa. To some he appears in the body of a kumbhāṇḍa. To some he appears in the body of a piśāca. To some he appears in the body of a preta. To some he appears in the body of a pūtana. To some he appears in the body of a kaṭapūtana. To some he appears in the body of an oppressor spirit. To some he appears in the body of a lion. To some he appears in the body of a fragrant elephant. To some he appears in the body of a horse. To some he appears in the body of a bull. To some he appears in the bodies of various beasts of prey. To some he appears in the body of Yama. To some he appears in the body of a guardian of the hells. To some he appears in the body of a hell being.

"Showing these and immeasurable, countless other kinds of bodies, and teaching the Dharma to many beings in accordance with their fortune, he establishes them on the irreversible stage of the three vehicles.

"Son of noble family, that great being thus possesses such inconceivable, distinctive qualities. He is a treasury of supreme and exceptional qualities. He is the source from which all the jewels of liberation arise. He is the perfectly pure eye of many bodhisattvas. He is the caravan leader who goes to the great city of nirvāṇa. Thus, without deliberate effort, through the great qualities explained at length above, he fully turns the great wheel of Dharma.

"It is like this, son of noble family: suppose someone, for a hundred eons, were to single-mindedly go for refuge to bodhisattva great beings as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River, such as Maitreya, Mañjuśrī, Avalokiteśvara, or Samantabhadra, recite their names, with focused attention make offerings to them with reverence and prostrate to them, and make aspirations for the sake of the hopes they desire. Compared with that, if someone, for an instant, a moment, a mere second, single-mindedly recites the name of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, and with focused attention makes offerings and prostrations to him with reverence, all the aspirations they hope for will quickly be accomplished and fulfilled.

"Why is that? Because this bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, fulfills the aspirations of sentient beings; he is like a treasury of wish-fulfilling jewels. Thus, because for a long time, in order to bring sentient beings to maturity, this great being has cultivated great and utterly steadfast aspirations, great compassion, and diligence of intense effort, he surpasses all bodhisattvas. Therefore you should make offerings to him with reverence."

Then the bodhisattva great beings who had gathered from the ten directions, and the śrāvakas, gods, humans, yakṣas, gandharvas, and all the rest of the assembly rose from their seats, and each, as best they could, scattered flowers of gold, silver, and many kinds of jewels, and incense, as an offering to the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha. Besides these, they also presented to the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, as offerings divine garments, gems, precious jewels, garlands of pearls, pearl necklaces, garlands of gold, silver, and jewels, victory banners, pennants, parasols, and so on. Furthermore, with immeasurable sweet divine music and many kinds of praises in verse, they made offerings with reverence to the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, offered those many kinds of divine offering articles in turn to the Blessed One and spoke these verses:

"The offerings of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and humans,
And of the bodhisattvas of the ten directions,
I present to the Lord of the World, of great qualities.
Please accept these supreme offerings."

Then, having spoken that verse, the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and the Blessed One spoke to him in verse as follows:

"Having developed a steadfast intellect and a pure resolve,
You quell the suffering of immeasurable sentient beings.
Like jewels, you are seen to be a source of happiness;
Like a vajra, you cut through the net of doubt.
Possessing a mind of great compassion, with diligence
You present sublime offerings to the Blessed One.
With oceanic wisdom you free beings from suffering;
Fearless, you have gone beyond existence."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, rose from his seat and said to the Blessed One, "Blessed One, there are these words of dhāraṇī, the great vidyā-mantra called Endowed with Fire and Water, Shining with Auspicious Light, Retaining What Is Heard, which bring about, for the close disciples of the Blessed One, who frees beings from the four floods, the monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, and so on, the increase of mindfulness, the increase of guarding mindfulness, the increase of livelihood, the increase of bodily ease, the increase of good health, the increase of beauty and strength, the increase of renown, the increase of the requisites of life, the increase of relatives and friends, the increase of disciples, the increase of moral discipline, the increase of learning, the increase of generosity, the increase of absorption, the increase of patience, the increase of skill in means, the increase of the factors of awakening and of the noble truths, the increase of devotion to the true path of the Great Vehicle, the increase of the lamp of Dharma, the increase of bringing sentient beings to maturity, the increase of great loving-kindness and great compassion, the increase of pure, wholesome qualities, the increase of renown throughout the three realms, the increase of the rain of Dharma in the three realms, the increase of the savor of the whole great earth, the increase of the radiance and virtuous deeds of all sentient beings, the increase of joy in the Dharma and of virtuous conduct, the increase of the light of wisdom, the increase of the six perfections, the increase of the five eyes, the attainment of consecration, rebirth among the gods, and the increase of passing into nirvāṇa. I heard these words of dhāraṇī when I served buddhas, blessed ones of the past, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River.

"Through this dhāraṇī all pure, wholesome qualities increase and arise; and the multitude of seeds, roots, sprouts, branches, trunks, leaves, petals, flowers, fruits, medicinal plants, and the flavor and fragrance of crops increase and arise; rainwater comes, and beneficial earth, water, fire, and wind increase and arise; joy and happiness increase and arise; jewels and wealth increase and arise; might and strength increase and arise; and all the requisites of life increase and arise. Moreover, through this dhāraṇī wisdom arises, and so the enemy of the afflictions is utterly vanquished. The mantra is this:

chimbho chimbho cim chimbho ākāṣa chimbho vakara chimbho amavar chimbho var chimbho vacir chimbho aroga chimbho dharma chimbho sateva chimbho satenihala chimbho vivarokaśava chimbho upaśama chimbho nāyan chimbho prajñāsamamone ratna chimbho kṣaṇa chimbho viṣemavariyā

chimbho śāsītalamava chimbho vi adrasota mahele dam veyamave cakrāse cakrāvasile kṣile phile karabha vāravarīte hasere prarāve pare carābhandāne aradāne phānra ca ca ca ca hile mile akhatathāgekhe thagkhīlo thhāre thhāre mile madhe nante kule mile aṅkucitabhe ārai gyire vara gyire kutaśamamale ton gye ton gye ton gūle hurū hurū hurū kulostomile merito merite bhandhata harakhamarema huru huru

Purifying the stains of existence is declared virtuous;
Pacifying the eon of strife is also declared virtuous.
Purifying nonvirtuous intentions is declared virtuous;
Purifying the great elements is also declared virtuous.
Purifying the lower realms is declared virtuous;
Purifying the habitual tendencies of evil is also declared virtuous.
Fulfilling hopes is declared virtuous;
Ripening the crops is also declared virtuous.
This, declared virtuous by all the buddhas,
Blessed by all the tathāgatas,
Through this declared virtue the bodhisattvas
Bestow their blessings and rejoice.

"Blessed One, I heard these words of dhāraṇī, the great vidyā-mantra Endowed with Fire and Water, Shining with Auspicious Light, Retaining What Is Heard, through serving buddhas, blessed ones of the past, as numerous as the grains of sand in the Ganges River. This dhāraṇī makes all pure, wholesome qualities increase and arise, and likewise, in full, makes everything up to all the requisites of enjoyment increase and arise.

"Venerable Blessed One, this dhāraṇī frees beings from the four floods. For the close disciples of the Blessed One, the monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, and so on, it makes their focus increase, and likewise, in full, makes everything up to all the requisites of life increase and arise. Blessed One, this dhāraṇī will cause the nectar-like noble scriptures to flourish and long endure, and it will be for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings of the three realms."

Then, when the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, spoke these words of dhāraṇī, the great vidyā-mantra Retaining What Is Heard, Mount Khalateya shook violently, and koṭis of niyutas of divine instruments sounded of themselves without being played. Divine incense, flowers, and immeasurable jewels of many kinds fell like rain, and at that moment all those many in the assembly were struck with wonder and amazement.

At that time, in that assembly, the great goddess Great Auspiciousness, the great goddess Śrī, the great goddess Song of Worship, the great goddess Dṛḍhā, the great goddess Watery One, the great goddess Great Light, and others, eighteen thousand goddesses who hold sway over the four great elements, rose from where they were seated, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One (the Buddha), joined their palms, and with reverence said this to the Blessed One:

"It is wondrous! Blessed One, it is wondrous! Sugata, although we hold sway over the four great elements, we do not know the beginning, middle, and end of the four great elements, nor their arising, their ceasing, and what is in accord with them and what is not. Yet this great being, having attained the subtle and most profound perfection of wisdom, is supremely skilled in the characteristics of the beginning, middle, and end of the four great elements, and in their arising, their ceasing, and what is in accord with them and what is not."

The Blessed One declared: "So it is, so it is. Because this son of noble family has attained the subtle and most profound perfection of wisdom, he is supremely skilled in the characteristics of the beginning, middle, and end of the four great elements, in their arising, their ceasing, and what is in accord with them and what is not. Goddesses, you should understand it in this way.

"Just as the precious wish-fulfilling jewel, endowed with many qualities, rains down precious things of every kind and gives them to many beings, so too this son of noble family rains down the precious factors of awakening of every kind and gives them to sentient beings.

"Just as an island of jewels is completely filled with precious things of every kind, so too this son of noble family is endowed with the precious factors of awakening of every kind.

"Just as the divine pāricitra tree is beautiful with fragrance and flowers, so too this son of noble family is made exceedingly beautiful by the precious qualities of the Buddha of every kind.

"Just as the king of lions is not overpowered by any wild animal and is not afraid, so too this son of noble family is not intimidated or overpowered by any being.

"Just as the bright sun dispels all the darkness of the world, so too this son of noble family dispels all the darkness of ignorance and wrong views of all

sentient beings.

"Just as the full moon, in the time of night, shows a pleasant path to all beings who have lost their way, so that they reach wherever they wish to go, so too this son of noble family, for all beings who in the night of ignorance have strayed from the three vehicles and wander in the wilderness of saṃsāra, shows the true path by means of the three vehicles, and through skillful means, in accordance with their fortune, sets them on the path of true deliverance.

"Just as the great earth is the support of all the multitudes of seeds, of plants and trees, of crops, and of all beings belonging to the element of earth, so too this son of noble family is the source from which all the distinguished qualities of the factors of awakening are taught.

"Just as Mount Meru, the great jewel king of mountains, is utterly firm, unshaken and undiminished, so too this son of noble family abides firmly in all the unshared qualities of a buddha; he does not diminish, because he never abandons any sentient being, and he is unshaken, because he dedicates all his roots of virtue.

"Just as all beings move about in space, so too all sentient beings make use of this son of noble family. Thus this son of noble family is endowed with immeasurable, incalculable qualities."

At that time the many in the assembly, hearing the praise of the immeasurable qualities of the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, were struck with wonder and amazement. They showed him honor and service, and with great joy and one-pointed mind they gazed at the bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha without blinking.

Then, to restate those points clearly, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"The true being, Kṣitigarbha,
Perfectly endowed with many qualities,
Bearing and showing forth the guise of a renunciant,
Has come to pay homage to the great Teacher.

He bestows happiness on all sentient beings,
Frees them from all the suffering of the three realms of existence,
And, raining down measureless things of every kind,
Makes offerings to the great Teacher.

Śakra (Indra), born free of stain,
Having looked about and examined all four directions,
Joined his palms with deep reverence
And extolled and praised the great Teacher:

'I see the assembly of the Blessed One:
Like the rays of light of a precious jewel,
It illuminates all the many buddha fields,
And there is nothing that is not made clear.

With the six higher knowledges he illuminates the world:
The one who has come and gathered here today
Is the most heroic Kṣitigarbha,
Who manifestly displays the conduct of one gone forth.

He is a treasure from which the seven noble riches come,
The roaring voice of the fearless Buddha,
The victory banner of many bodhisattvas,
The chief who guides many sentient beings.

He is a mine of the jewel of liberation,
An ocean of merit with steadfast diligence;
With a mind of loving-kindness he delights in compassion and tender care,
And frees many suffering beings.

He is a moat and a fortress guarding against fear,
And like the moon in a clear sky he shows the path.
Like the earth, he gives rise to all roots of virtue;
Like a vajra, he cuts through doubt completely.

He scatters the jewels of liberation to all;
Like water, he washes away all obscurations.
He becomes a parasol for those tormented by the heat of afflictions;
Like a physician, he cures every illness.

The merit of great renown obtained
By reciting the name of Kṣitigarbha for a single day
Surpasses that of reciting the names of other wise ones
Even for koṭis of niyutas of eons.

He liberates ordinary beings
And fetters all the afflictions.

He has perfected the samādhi of Heroic Progress (śūraṃgama),
And gone to the far shore of other samādhis as well.
Because the thirteen many conditions are also purified,
His wisdom is like space for all the many.

Of the measureless buddha fields
He destroys the masses of darkness of many beings.
He enters that samādhi according to each field,
And constantly enters the four meditative concentrations as well.

Having entered samādhi, he thoroughly dispels
The torment of the afflictions of sentient beings.
Ordinary beings, through their former evil deeds,
In fear of weapons, disease, and famine,
Are harmed and killed in many ways:
He sets them all completely free.

When beings whose five appropriated aggregates
Are harmed and tormented by many sufferings
Go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
All the sufferings of existence are pacified.

When beings, spinning on the wheel of suffering,
Who harm and injure one another,
Go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
They come to abide in patience and a loving mind.

When those terrified and frightened by the thirteen conditions,
And those pained by the condition of not finding what they seek,
Go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
They come to abide in happiness, without fear.

When those who delight in doing meritorious deeds, and who long for mindfulness,
Moral discipline, much learning, and wisdom,
Go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
All is fulfilled just as they hope.

When those who long for the forbearance and skill of each quality described,
And for medicines and stores of seeds,
Go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
They are endowed with all they hope for, and it is fulfilled.

When, wishing for fine crops, plants, and trees,
Or for sons and daughters, clothing, and servants,
People go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
All is fulfilled just as they hope.

Because he is endowed with all the many qualities,
He does not forsake this great earth but firmly upholds it.
Because of that, medicines and crops
Become rich, soft, and full of flavor.

When those obscured by many afflictions,
Who delight in the deeds of the ten nonvirtues,
Go for refuge to Kṣitigarbha,
All nonvirtue and affliction are pacified.

He displays bodies of every kind
And teaches the Dharma to many beings as well.
Because all the qualities of giving are perfected,
All sentient beings are cared for with compassion and made happy.

Even if for many hundreds of eons
One were to extol and praise his qualities,
It would be extremely hard to reach the end and complete them.
Therefore let all make offerings to him with reverence."

This concludes the first chapter, the Introduction, from the Great Collection, the sūtra called The Ten Wheels of the Bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha.

The second fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, rose from his seat, arranged his upper robe over one shoulder, touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One, placed his right knee on the ground, and bowing with joined palms, said this to the Blessed One:

"Ocean of measureless qualities,
I make a request of the Blessed One:
Whatever doubts and hesitations I have,
Please explain them to me at length."

The Blessed One declared: "True being, you are unobstructed in seeing all phenomena with wisdom. Nevertheless, because you wish for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings, ask the Tathāgata whatever you wish, and by the Blessed One's answer to each question I shall bring satisfaction to your

mind."

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, spoke in verse:

"In the past, for thirteen eons,
I practiced the most difficult conduct,
And for the sake of all ordinary beings
Dispelled the three fears and the five degenerations.

Having made measureless offerings
To koṭis of niyutas of buddhas,
I saw in the past this assembly of pure intention
And the gathering of this great host.

The wise, who strive with diligence,
Have all assembled and come to this gathering.
To see these utterly faultless assemblies
Is a wonder and a marvel.

Why is it that in all these buddha fields,
Where wrongdoing has caused virtue to decline,
All the evil conduct shunned by the wise
Dwells side by side?

Beings commit the evils of immediate retribution,
Denigrate the true and sacred Dharma,
Revile the noble ones, and with wrong views
Expound the treatises of eternalism and annihilation.

They commit the deeds of the ten evils,
Have no fear of the world to come,
Have long abandoned the three vehicles;
These evildoers are bent upon the lower realms.

Their eyes obscured by ignorance,
They live by attachment, envy, and deceit.
How does the Buddha turn the wheel
And liberate these sentient beings?

How are the afflictions that link to rebirth
Cut by what is like a vajra?
How are dhāraṇīs attained,
And likewise how is forbearance made certain?

How great a wonder it is
That I have seen the Guide and this great assembly!
Such a gathering of all qualities
I have not seen in other directions.

Endowed with all the many qualities
And striving intently on the path of awakening,
How is it that for assemblies of the childish
The Buddha turns the wheel?"

The Blessed One declared: "Excellent, excellent! Son of noble family, in past times too, in the fields of buddhas as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, in times of the five degenerations, you asked questions about such matters as these of blessed buddhas as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges. Because in the past you applied yourself with great earnestness to these matters you ask about, you have fully realized and understood them. Through the perfection of many excellent practices you possess a wisdom supremely skilled in means.

"It is excellent that you ask about such matters as these: in order to bring all sentient beings to full maturity and to bring them to the attainment of benefit and happiness; for the sake of the distinctive conduct by which all bodhisattvas, great beings, through skill in means, bring all sentient beings to full maturity by the six perfections beginning with giving, the treasury of noble conduct; in order to bring to completion the ocean of qualities of omniscient wisdom; in order to turn back all crowned kṣatriya kings who abide in nonvirtuous conduct from the three lower realms, so that they do not fall into them; and so that the lineage of the Three Jewels may flourish greatly and long endure in this field. Listen very well and keep it in mind, and I shall teach you."

"Blessed One, I shall do so," he replied, and listened to the Blessed One.

Then the Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha: "Son of noble family, through the force of his former aspirations the Tathāgata is endowed with the ten kinds of buddha wheels. He dwells in a buddha field of the five degenerations, a place where all the sentient beings have turned away from all purely white qualities; are bereft of the seven precious riches of the noble ones; have grown distant from the wise; are entangled in the net of annihilationism and eternalism; take pleasure and delight in the chariot that goes to the lower realms; do not regard the sufferings of the next life with fear; place their trust in dwelling in the thick black darkness of ignorance; carry to

completion the courses of action of the ten nonvirtues; commit the five acts of immediate retribution; denigrate the sacred Dharma and despoil the noble ones; and, having cast all virtuous qualities far away, carry to completion the nonvirtuous ones.

"Although he dwells in a field filled with such manifold sufferings, he dwells there in great ease. Free of timidity and free of fear and terror, he goes to the place of the great sages (ṛṣis), turns the buddha wheel, and subdues all non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) of false doctrine, together with the gods and māras. In the lineages of all ordinary beings he clears away the afflictions that are as hard as a vajra, and then establishes each of them according to their inclination. Those beings who have the power, he also makes irreversible in the three vehicles.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. Suppose that in some country there comes to be no government. All the people who live there are harassed by their own armies and by foreign armies, and they are troubled and in misery. Many of the people living there, being unhappy, fall into quarrels and disputes and countless mutual recriminations. There is lying, deceit, harsh speech, slander and strife. People become blind and dim-sighted; they are tormented by diseases of every kind, by virulent illnesses of cold and of heat, by many kinds of fevers, by madness, by wasting sickness, by indigestion, by agitation and stupor of mind; their faculties are impaired and their limbs and lesser limbs are damaged. They are destitute and bereft of clothing, of food, and of every kind of necessity for living. All their possessions are unpleasing. All the people go for refuge to non-Buddhists and to worldly gods; wrong views, wrong intentions and wrong inclinations spread everywhere; and having lost the true path, they are about to fall into the lower realms.

"At that time the elders living in that country, who are intelligent and steady of mind, learned, and of great integrity, gather and take counsel together. Assembling all the people of the countryside and the towns, they all agree in selecting one prince. He is one who in the past has given generously, kept moral discipline perfectly, applied himself with diligence, and practiced great austerities. He bears the marks of supreme merit. His faculties are complete and his limbs unimpaired; his body is well proportioned, neither too large nor too small; he is adorned with excellent major and minor marks; he has a supreme and excellent complexion. He is honored and served by all, pleasing to all the people living in that country, who long to see him. By nature he is upright and steadfast, endowed with loving-kindness and compassion, learned,

accomplished in every skill, and his mind is well adorned with gentle forbearance. He is the eldest son of the chief queen.

"They bathe his body in pure water mixed with many kinds of fine perfume, and he puts on fine garments of many kinds, adorned with jewels and scented with incense. A precious jewel is fastened in the topknot on his crown, and on his head he wears a golden diadem adorned with garlands of jewel flowers, bound with exceedingly light and soft silk. He also wears earrings, necklaces, armlets, bracelets and other ornaments made of jewels, pearls, gold, silver, and many other kinds of precious things. His feet are shod in sandals made of many kinds of precious things. Above him a canopy is spread, a parasol made of many kinds of precious things. A throne is set out that in the past all the gods and sages guarded and upheld, guarded and protected by Śakra (Indra) and all the others. In a great palace built by the most skilled craftsmen they seat him on the throne on which the former kings sat, and they make him king.

"When he has ascended the throne, the bells and the great drums guarded and upheld by the lords of the gods, the lords of the nāgas, the lords of the yakṣas, the lords of the asuras and the lords of the kumbhāṇḍas are struck, and their sound is heard throughout the whole realm. Countless people belonging to the four great castes, beginning with the kṣatriyas, bathe their bodies thoroughly, put on clean clothes, and, holding in their hands countless parasols of many kinds of jewels, victory banners, pennants, precious jewels, pearls, gold, silver, conch, crystal, coral, beryl and so on, present them to that king. In addition, all the brahmins of high and noble birth, who live a pure life, are learned and of great knowledge, praise that king with verses and with countless fine songs and melodies. They also make the aspiration, 'May he obtain every kind of good fortune!' They sprinkle many kinds of auspicious substances on the king's head.

"Learned and knowledgeable men belonging to the families of the former king's ministers, who are honest, without guile and wise, are appointed as ministers, each according to his suitability and in proper rank. By carrying out the king's work, they put an end to all the attacks by their own and foreign armies that had formerly afflicted that country, and to all rebels and bad associates. All hostile enemies and all who do harm are pacified, the whole dark side is cleared away, and the whole bright side arises and increases.

"Son of noble family, when a great crowned kṣatriya king in this way possesses that single wheel, by the power of that wheel his kingdom becomes very great,

all hostile enemies are thoroughly subdued, and his life too becomes long.

"Son of noble family, in the same way, when no buddha is present in this buddha field, the Sahā world, a world system of the five degenerations, all the sentient beings who live there are completely bound by the afflictions latent in their own minds and are harassed by inner enemies and outer enemies. Afflicted by the afflictions, blinded by delusion, and unhappy, they cling and attach themselves to eternalism and annihilationism, generate measureless attachment, and quarrel and contend with one another. Despoiling and reviling one another, they give rise to attachment, aversion and delusion; they speak with guile and deceit, and carry to completion the courses of action of the ten nonvirtues.

"Those clinging and attached people, tormented in this world system of afflictions by the many kinds of disease of the afflictions, are blind to the eye of the true Dharma. Though they are burned and agitated by aversion and anger, they do not attend in the least to the true Dharma of reality. Having completely abandoned the taste of the true Dharma, they despoil and revile those who do good. They become bereft and destitute of the ease and happiness they had before; constantly wrapped in and entangled by many kinds of nets of affliction, they go for refuge to the six non-Buddhist (tīrthika) teachers, turn away from the noble path, and become bent upon the three lower realms.

"At that time, in that field, all the bodhisattvas, the great beings, who in the past had made offerings to and served countless buddhas, who had entered the ocean of the buddhas' qualities, and who abide in the sphere of activity of the buddhas of the past, gathered and assembled, came before me, and with one voice said this: 'In past times you applied yourself earnestly to measureless giving, guarded moral discipline perfectly, and with diligence of the utmost exertion practiced what is extremely hard to practice. You have cultivated all of it to perfection.'

"Thus, adorned with such accumulations of merit and wisdom, with wisdom, skill in means, great compassion and the rest, I became a treasury of great qualities. I gained full mastery of all samādhis and dhāraṇīs, and became an ocean in which the qualities of all the grounds are complete. I was without guile or deceit; my body was very tall and perfectly endowed with the major and minor marks; I was possessed of gentle forbearance and supremely beautiful. Following no one else's lead, in cultivating the path of awakening I

brought the whole ocean of wisdom to completion. I came to possess the supreme and excellent complexion, became the great teacher of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and became the ally of all beings who are terrified of saṃsāra. I was adorned with measureless qualities such as loving-kindness and great compassion. I was the true son of the blessed ones Krakucchanda, Kanakamuni, Kāśyapa and the others, the one who attains full awakening in this Fortunate Eon, the chief among all bodhisattvas.

"Fragrant with qualities of many kinds, I had bathed in the pure water of calm abiding and insight and put on the garments of shame and modesty. I wore the pure dharmadhātu as the jewel in my topknot and wore a diadem of garlands of flowers, the vast sphere of activity of all the buddhas, bound with the thread of liberation. I was adorned besides with the jewels of qualities such as the wisdom of omniscience and the forbearance regarding the non-arising of phenomena. I wore the precious sandals of great loving-kindness, compassion, joy and equanimity. I was shaded by the parasol that brings to completion the causes of the noble state through the three kinds of conduct that cover the three realms. The seat of the vajra-like samādhi, upheld by the buddhas of the past, by the gods and by the sages, was set out. I sat upon the four applications of mindfulness, upheld with reverence by all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. Seated upon the seat spread by all the buddhas of the past, I fully awakened into unsurpassed awakening.

"Having become the wisdom of omniscience, I turned the wheel of Dharma so that the lineage of the Three Jewels would not be cut off. Beating the great drum of the Dharma, I proclaimed the sound of the Dharma throughout the three realms, and by means of the four noble truths I liberated all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, rākṣasas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, kumbhāṇḍas, bhūtas, piśācas, pūtanas, kaṭapūtanas, humans, nonhumans and the rest. The wheel of Dharma with twelve aspects, which no one in the world, whether śramaṇa or brahmin, god, māra or Brahmā, human or nonhuman, had ever turned, that wheel which no one had turned before, I turned thoroughly in three ways, so that countless gods and humans in the world might attain the great, supreme and sacred aim of benefit and happiness.

"Son of noble family, I possess such a single buddha wheel. By the power of that wheel I know directly, exactly as they truly are, this world and the world beyond, what is possible and what is impossible, and so I have attained fearlessness. I dwell at ease, and having thoroughly subdued all non-Buddhists of false doctrine, together with the gods and māras, I turn the wheel of the

great Brahmā. Because I have perfectly accomplished the conduct of the great Brahmā, in this evil world system of the five degenerations I proclaim the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly and pacify the deeds of immediate retribution of all sentient beings. In the same way, I clear away everything that belongs to the roots of nonvirtue and pacify even the streams of affliction of all beings, which are as hard as a vajra. I establish them in the sacred fruit of liberation in which all defilements are exhausted, setting each in happiness according to his inclination, and those beings who have the power I also establish in the three vehicles and make irreversible.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. As soon as a great crowned kṣatriya king first ascends the throne and takes up the rule of the kingdom, he looks closely and reflects on the laws and statutes of all the kings of the past, future and present. Having thus thoroughly understood the wheel of activity of all kings, he also knows how causes ripen into results. According to what each person is suited for, he gives them the corresponding means and sets them to work, and so he has the wise and the simple who live in that land carry out three kinds of wheel of activity. By the power of that wheel of activity, all the beings who live there enjoy for a long time many kinds of pleasing necessities of life, their happiness and well-being increase and grow, and all hostile enemies are subdued.

"What are the three kinds of wheel of activity? They are these. By establishing the wheel of activity of governing the kingdom, he has those who are skilled trained in the strategies of war and practiced in martial arts, so that they subdue hostile enemies and protect the many people. By establishing the wheel of activity of fields and dwellings, he has people build houses and carry out the work of the fields with tools, and by making them comfortable he ensures they do not lack food and drink. By establishing the wheel of activity of seeking wealth and precious things, he has people learn trade and many kinds of crafts, so that they have many kinds of necessities of life to use as they wish, and their happiness and well-being increase.

"Son of noble family, when a great crowned kṣatriya king possesses these three royal wheels, by the power of these wheels his land becomes very happy and prosperous; hostile enemies and bad associates are subdued; and because he is skilled in diligently guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

"Son of noble family, in the same way, when the Tathāgata has first fully awakened and attained unsurpassed wisdom, he reflects closely on the Dharma eye of all the buddhas of the past, future and present. Through this close examination he fully knows the causes and results of actions and of phenomena, and he establishes three kinds of wheel of activity for all the beings who are to be trained. By the power of that wheel of activity, the lineage of the Three Jewels and the Dharma eye long endure; the unsurpassed true Dharma spreads widely everywhere; all beings constantly attain great happiness, from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to passing into nirvāṇa; no non-Buddhist (tīrthika) of false doctrine can withstand it; and by means of the eye of the true Dharma all opponents are subdued in accordance with the Dharma.

"Son of noble family, what then are the three kinds of wheel of activity? They are these three: establishing the wheel of activity of cultivating samādhi, establishing the wheel of activity of becoming practiced in recitation, and establishing the wheel of activity of doing meritorious deeds.

"Son of noble family, what is the Tathāgata's wheel of activity of cultivating samādhi? There are ten kinds of samādhi. What are the ten? When this body together with its consciousness is examined exactly as it is, it is the six objects, the cause of clinging and attachment to self and mine, the field of karma, obscured by ignorance and moistened by the water of craving; it exists without autonomy, under the power of others, and so it depends on many conditions. One examines it in this way in order to stop the three streams: of karma, of affliction and of suffering.

"What is the stream of karma? It is whatever formations sentient beings actively engage in. Because becoming arises from the causes of ignorance and craving, that is called the stream of affliction. Through the power of the afflictions, from the coming together of the many causes and conditions of consciousness, name and form arise. From the coming together of the many causes and conditions of name and form, the six sense sources arise. From the coming together of the many causes and conditions of the six sense sources there arise in sequence contact, feeling, birth in a further existence, aging, death and the rest: this is called the stream of suffering. Thus these three streams arise in the field of karma through the cause of ignorance and the moisture of craving.

"So, in order to dry up these three, which arise in the field of karma through the cause of ignorance and the moisture of craving, one realizes that the five appropriated aggregates are impermanent, suffering, selfless, inert, without movement, like an illusion, like a mirage, like the moon in water, like a dream, empty, nothing whatever, signless, wishless, unmade, not come into being, unborn, formless, peaceful, isolated, and without any ground for origination or birth. By thus examining the five appropriated aggregates closely, one inclines toward the forbearance that accords with emptiness, the forbearance that accords with signlessness, and the forbearance that accords with wishlessness.

"Furthermore, in order to examine the five appropriated aggregates further, through skill in means one also observes the breath going in and out, and cultivates mindfulness of the in-breath and the out-breath. How then does one, through the power of mindfulness, observe the breath going in and out exactly as it is? Exactly as it is, one observes counting, following, calm abiding, insight, engagement and purification.

"Of these, counting performs two functions: by serving as a support, it subdues conceptual thought and analysis, and it makes one able to apprehend the characteristic of the breath going in and out. Following also performs two functions: relying on deliverance, one becomes free of conceptual thought and analysis, and one becomes skilled in the characteristic of the movement of the breath going in and out. Calm abiding also performs two functions: it manifestly shows the breath going in and out diminishing, and it makes one able to abide in the supreme samādhi.

Insight also performs two functions: it manifestly shows the breath going in and out coming to an end, and it abides in the discernment, one by one, of mind and the mental factors. Engagement also performs two functions: one becomes skilled in the practice of abandoning the aggregates of clinging, and one applies oneself to entering the noble ground. Purification also performs two functions to be accomplished: the abandoning of thorough affliction, and the complete purification of view. In this way, by cultivating the examination of the breath going in and out through these six kinds of practice, one enters into conformity with the realization of the five aggregates of clinging.

Why is that? The nature of the breath going in and out is the aggregate of clinging that is form. Taking in and experiencing the breath going in and out is the aggregate of clinging that is feeling. Apprehending the characteristic of

the breath going in and out is the aggregate of clinging that is perception. Making the breath going in and out manifest is the aggregate of clinging that is formations. Distinguishing the breath going in and out is the aggregate of clinging that is consciousness. The five aggregates of clinging, explained in this way, are individual, distinct and dissimilar; they are not new and not old; they have no location; they are not without accumulation; and they are inexpressible.

By thoroughly realizing the five aggregates of clinging in this way, one completely abandons the three kinds of formations. If one thus reaches the culmination of investigating the complete exhaustion of the three kinds of formations, one reaches the culmination of understanding the body together with consciousness, and the six objects. Clinging to self and to what is one's own, karma, ignorance, the cause of existence, the field, and the moisture that envelops it are also all exhausted. Likewise, the cultivation of the four applications of mindfulness becomes complete, and so on up to the noble eightfold path, whose cultivation also becomes complete. Likewise, up to the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, cultivation also becomes complete. Likewise, up to the wisdom of omniscience, the forbearance of the nonarising of phenomena, the samādhi of the Heroic March (śūraṃgama) and so on, cultivation becomes complete.

Likewise, one who has entered the meditative concentrations by holding to going and coming with mindfulness is called a being who abides in the true Dharma, the ultimate. This is called cultivating meditative concentration correctly, just as it is. It is called rightly honoring the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the three times. Such a one is called a child arisen from the heart of all the buddhas, born from the speech of them all, accomplished by the Dharma, and tamed by the Dharma.

Some bodhisattvas who have meditated in this way, even if they gradually fall back, become arhats whose defilements are exhausted and come to possess the six superknowledges. Some bodhisattvas who have meditated in this way rise higher and higher, perfect all good qualities, and, having become bodhisattva great beings, perfect everything up to the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha and the wisdom of omniscience; before long they will fully awaken into unsurpassed awakening.

Son of noble family, when with wisdom I examined the Dharma of the buddhas of the three times concerning so many kinds of karma, phenomena, feelings,

causes, results and karmic maturations, I established for sentient beings the ten wheels of the action of cultivating samādhi, and set them to meditation. Son of noble family, these are called the wheel of the Tathāgata's action of cultivating samādhi.

Son of noble family, what, then, is the wheel of the Tathāgata's action of training in recitation? Monks, nuns, laymen, laywomen, sons of noble family or daughters of noble family whose roots of virtue are small and thin, who abide in conventional truth, and whose faculties are not fully matured, I set to training in recitation, so that in the evening and at dawn they exert themselves with intense diligence, free of laziness. Those sentient beings who seek unsurpassed wisdom I set in the utterly pure, white Great Vehicle, so that they themselves read and cause others to read, themselves recite and cause others to recite, themselves retain and cause others to retain, themselves become trained in the Great Vehicle and cause others to become trained, and so that they strive to clear away the afflictions of themselves and others, to attain unsurpassed omniscient wisdom, to pacify the suffering of all sentient beings, and to dwell in the great city of fearlessness. Those sentient beings who aspire to the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas I set in the teaching of dependent origination and had them train in its recitation. Those sentient beings who aspire to the vehicle of the śrāvakas I had train in the recitation of the scriptures of a hundred thousand verses, the Vinaya of a hundred thousand verses, the Abhidharma and the Abhidharma discourses of a hundred thousand verses, and so on. That, son of noble family, is called the wheel of the Tathāgata's action of training in recitation.

Son of noble family, what, then, is the wheel of the Tathāgata's action of making merit? Those sentient beings who are of dull faculties, who have not developed roots of virtue, who are weak in wisdom and lazy, whose mindfulness has lapsed, who are attached and clinging to every kind of requisite for living, and who forsake their spiritual friends, I set to the work of making merit: that is, doing service for the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha, and doing service for preceptors and masters. Son of noble family, that is called the wheel of the Tathāgata's action of accomplishing merit.

Son of noble family, in this way a buddha possesses this second wheel. By the power of that wheel, with the unsurpassed wisdom of the karma of the three times, he knows correctly, just as it is, the karma, the phenomena, the feelings, the causes and the full ripening of the results of all sentient beings. Having established the three kinds of wheels of action according to whatever

will tame each one, he places all sentient beings who have become fit vessels happily in benefit, in well-being, and in fearlessness. Through fearlessness he tames all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and turns the wheel of the great Brahmā; and because the conduct of the great Brahmā is perfected, he clearly knows, correctly and just as it is, all the causes and results of sentient beings.

Son of noble family, it is like this. A great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses an intelligence skilled in means. To ascetics, brahmins, warriors, merchants, commoners and the like who have various kinds of good qualities, who are learned, heroic, skilled in crafts or of great prowess, and to any beings who are wealthy and endowed with good qualities, possessed of an intelligence skilled in means, brave and bold, steadfast, never turning back, and adorned with many kinds of merit, the great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, gives, as befits and suits what each of them possesses, jewels, wealth and riches, fields and pastures, houses, servants, laborers and so on, as is appropriate. To the people living in that land whose good qualities and knowledge are weak, and who have done little work, the great king anointed on the crown of his head into kingship also gives a share, as befits and suits them. But those living in that land who have no merit and little diligence, who are very lazy, careless, of lapsed mindfulness, without a compassionate mind, ungrateful, who do not regard with fear the sufferings of the next world, who are sunk in the mire of the household, and who commit many misdeeds, the great king punishes with various kinds of penalties, as suits and befits them. Some he rebukes and scolds with harsh words. From some he seizes their jewels, wealth, goods and the like. From some he seizes even their requisites for living. Some he flogs with the whip and throws into prison. Of some he cuts off the limbs and extremities. Of some he cuts off even the head and body. With these and various other kinds of punishment he punishes them. Son of noble family, in this way a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses this third royal wheel. By the power of that wheel his land is exceedingly happy and prosperous; he subdues all opposing enemies and bad companions, and, being skilled in the care of guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in the same way the Tathāgata too possesses a wisdom supremely skilled concerning the faculties. Those of the assembly who have grown far from the accumulations of merit and wisdom and from skillful means

and wisdom, who have completely abandoned generosity, discipline and peace, and whose minds have become disturbed because their mindfulness has lapsed, come to where I am and come to me for refuge. Because I fully know their faculties, faith, latent tendencies and inclinations, I teach them, according to whatever will tame each one, the Dharma of the means of punishment, the Vinaya and so on. Those sentient beings who have come under the sway of pride and do not uphold the many precepts, I have perform these things, so that the true Dharma of the teaching may remain for a long time. Some I punish by a pledge that serves as a reminder. Some I punish by threatening with harsh words, by reproach and by scolding. Some I punish by brief separation and by bringing them to shame. Some I punish by their not being bowed to, not being spoken to, and not sharing in gains. Some are dealt with by something like the spreading of grass, and some are punished with penalties such as expulsion. In this way, because I know fully the faculties, faith, latent tendencies and inclinations of those persons, I punish them as suits and befits them. Moreover, in order to destroy the accumulated mass of the darkness of meaninglessness, to dry up the river of the afflictions, and to attain everything from birth as a god in the higher realms up to the bliss of nirvāṇa, I have taught the Dharma of punishment, in whatever way is fitting, in order to tame persons who engage in non-virtue. In many sūtras too, the Dharma of punishing those who engage in non-virtue, in whatever way is fitting for each, is explained at length.

With supreme and sacred wisdom I also fully know those sentient beings who possess superior intention and completely pure faith and inclination. According to whatever will tame each one, I teach them the many kinds of distinctions on the side of virtue, cause them to train and become habituated, bring to completion everything up to all their roots of virtue, and lead them into the great city of fearlessness.

Son of noble family, in this way I possess this third wheel of a buddha. By the power of this wheel, because I know all the various faculties, the faith, the latent tendencies, the inclinations, the intentions, the karma and the experiences of all sentient beings, I place them happily in fearlessness, according to whatever will tame each one, by means of benefit and well-being. Through fearlessness I claim the place of the great sage, fully turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar in the midst of a great assembly.

Son of noble family, it is like this. A great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, learns of however many persons in his land have gone for refuge to worldly gods and to the various kinds of non-Buddhists, who have faith in what is false, hold false views, train in what is false, are fixated on false ascetic observances, and, attached to false omens of good and bad, have come to suffer from many kinds of pointless suffering. Having learned of them, that great king gathers them together again and again, and having taught them at length by the custom of the true Dharma of the former kings, he decrees: "Give up false views and false faith, and diligently practice the training of the Dharma customs of the former kings!" Thus all the sentient beings living in that land, of one engagement, one orientation, one intention and one aspiration, all in harmony, abide in accordance with the true Dharma of the former kings; and because they listen to his command and follow it, all who live there do in harmony whatever ought to be done. The great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, also constantly gathers with his ministers, holds feasts and enjoys himself; delighting in joyful amusement and in harmony of counsel, he carries out the affairs of the king. Son of noble family, in this way a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses this fourth royal wheel. By the power of that wheel his land is exceedingly happy and prosperous; he subdues all opposing enemies and bad companions, and, being skilled in the care of guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in just the same way the Tathāgata too possesses the wisdom that knows inclinations with supreme skill in means. The Tathāgata knows and sees that in the world those inclined in many ways toward what is false, who hold false views, have false intentions, are devoted to false teachings and engage in false actions, experience immeasurable suffering through that cause and that condition. Having known and seen this, he constantly gathers great assemblies again and again, and opens up and clearly teaches at length the Dharma of causes and results: the cause and the result of continuing the lineage of the Three Jewels of the buddhas, the blessed ones, who have passed in the past, the six perfections, the cause of the yogin, the three vows and so on; and thus he liberates the great assemblies. Those with distorted views enter right view and the right path of action of the ten virtues. Sentient beings constantly engage in the Dharma in harmony; by skillful means he guides them to practice the Dharma and sets them to

meditation, and so makes cause and result continue without interruption. Having had sentient beings, in harmony with the four assemblies, apply themselves to the distinctions of virtuous conduct, they take delight, as though at play, in the four applications of mindfulness, in samādhi, in the teaching of the wisdom of liberation, and in the limbs of the path. In order that the teaching of the noble ones may long remain, and that the lineage of the Three Jewels may not be interrupted, he lets them delight freely in the four right abandonments, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven limbs of awakening, the noble eightfold path, other samādhis besides, the teaching of the wisdom of liberation, and the many kinds of distinctions of the factors of awakening.

Son of noble family, in this way I possess this fourth wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel, because I know whatever each ordinary being is devoted to, whatever each is inclined toward, and whatever each delights in, I place them happily in fearlessness, according to whatever will tame each one, by means of benefit and well-being. Through fearlessness I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar in the midst of a great assembly." So he spoke.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. Countless sentient beings, whether living in his own land or in the land of another, are attached to wealth and forms and know no weariness of them, and are attached to and covet the wealth and forms of others. To guard against this, a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, surrounds the villages, towns, hamlets and even the royal palace with retinues and walls, and sets guards over everything down to the mynah birds and parrots, so that nothing is lost or ruined. Son of noble family, in this way a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses this fifth royal wheel. By the power of that wheel his land is exceedingly happy and prosperous; he subdues all opposing enemies and bad companions, and, being skilled in the care of guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in the same way the Tathāgata too possesses the wisdom that knows intrinsic natures with supreme skill in means. He fully knows the wicked and savage Māra, the ninety-five kinds of non-Buddhists, and besides them the hosts of Māra and the countless beings deceived by non-Buddhists. Sentient beings who are fixated on their own wealth and forms are also attached to the wealth and forms of others, and, coveting them, seek after

them. Giving rise to jealousy toward me and my assembly, in order to kill me they put poison in my alms food, spread a seat over a fire pit, hurled things down from above, let loose a maddened elephant, drew swords and pursued me, and scattered earth and filth. With many kinds of evil words they also reviled and slandered me, accusing me, saying, "He indulges in unchaste conduct," labeling me, "He is a eunuch," saying, "He is not human," and saying, "He is a conjurer." Knowing that, giving rise to jealousy toward my śrāvaka disciples too, through that cause and that condition they slander and revile them in many ways, the Tathāgata, being skilled in guarding the six faculties, abiding in the four abodes of Brahmā, and having come to possess the four discriminating knowledges, also taught the śrāvakas the Dharma sūtras that set forth the completely pure three doors of liberation.

I now know, correctly and just as it is, every nature, worldly and beyond the world. Having thus known all the many different natures of sentient beings, he acts for their benefit and well-being, according to whatever will tame each one. Son of noble family, in this way I possess this fifth wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel, with the wisdom that knows natures, worldly and beyond the world, I know individually all the immeasurable and various natures of sentient beings, and so, according to whatever will tame each one, I place them happily in fearlessness by means of benefit and well-being. Through fearlessness I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and fully roar the lion's roar in the midst of a great assembly.

Son of noble family, it is like this. In order to keep his cities, towns, hamlets and royal palace firmly guarded, a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, surrounds them with moats, and so on as in the passage before, setting guards over everything down to the mynah birds and parrots. In the palace, entirely surrounded by his retinue, his queens and daughters, he sports in the five sense pleasures and, heedless among the many kinds of enjoyments, indulges his six faculties at ease. Son of noble family, in this way that great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses this sixth royal wheel. By the power of that wheel his land is exceedingly happy and prosperous; he subdues all opposing enemies and bad companions, and, being skilled in the care of guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in just the same way the Tathāgata too, having set the bodhisattva great beings and all the great śrāvakas within the firm city of the

teaching taught by the noble ones, thereafter enters into absorption, from absorption in the supreme and sacred meditative concentration up to absorption in the four meditative concentrations; enters into absorption from the samādhi of the sphere of infinite space, and likewise at length up to the samādhi of the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception; and likewise enters into absorption up to the samādhi that is the domain of all the buddhas. Having entered those samādhis, I see countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, bhūtas, piśācas, pūtanas, kaṭapūtanas and others, who harm and injure sentient beings, who have no loving-kindness or compassion in their minds, and who have no fear of the sufferings of the next world. When they see me entered into the samādhi that is the domain of all the buddhas, they all give rise to a mind of great joy toward me, and with completely pure intention they give rise to supreme and sacred joy and faith in the Three Jewels. With reverence and with respect, struck with wonder, they confess every fault individually and vow to cut them off completely. Through that cause and that condition, in a single instant, a mere moment, all their immeasurable and incalculable obscurations of affliction, obscurations of karma and obscurations of phenomena are purified. They complete all the immeasurable and incalculable accumulations of merit and accumulations of wisdom, turn their backs on saṃsāra and turn toward nirvāṇa, and protect and uphold the unsurpassed true Dharma of the Tathāgata.

Son of noble family, in this way I too possess this sixth wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel the Tathāgata enters with completely pure wisdom into countless hundreds of thousands of meditative concentrations, samādhis, liberations, absorptions and states of equipoise, clears away the countless afflictions of sentient beings, and, according to whatever will tame each one, places them happily in fearlessness by means of benefit and well-being. Through fearlessness I claim the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar in the midst of a great assembly." So he spoke.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. A great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, together with his ministers and his fourfold army, tours and inspects all the cities, towns, hamlets, mountains, regions, valleys, side valleys, pleasure groves, fields, pastures, rivers, ponds, lakes, springs, remote pastures, forests and so on that are under his rule. In

whatever places in that land are beset by danger and doubt, or are perilous and unfit to be approached, or where enemies from outside raid and do harm, the great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, assesses them by his own experience and puts them right in every way. He applies himself to making them secure, guards them well and makes them firm, so that those regions are made even and workable, and leaves no place where foreign enemies and bad companions can watch for an opening and raid. In order to remove fear and anxiety, he protects all the sentient beings living in that land, so that they are free from the suffering of unease and are exceedingly happy and prosperous. Son of noble family, in this way a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses that seventh royal wheel. By the power of that wheel his land is exceedingly happy and prosperous; he subdues all opposing enemies and bad companions, and, being skilled in the care of guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in just the same way the Tathāgata too, with the eye of a buddha, fully knows, correctly and just as it is, whatever mentality of attachment, aversion or delusion each sentient being has. Correctly and just as it is, he also fully knows the many kinds of disorders of the afflictions.

Because the Tathāgata knows this, with immeasurable, most strenuous diligence and by the force of his skill in means, he gives, according to whatever will tame each one, the sacred medicine of accomplishing the many kinds of samādhi, and so has sentient beings apply themselves with care and diligence to curing the disease of the afflictions. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be calmed by contemplating the unattractive, he has that one cultivate the medicine of contemplating the unattractive. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be calmed by applying oneself to the abodes of Brahmā, he has that one cultivate the medicine of the abodes of Brahmā. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be cured by meditating on dependent origination, he has that one cultivate the medicine of dependent origination. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease is fit to be calmed by attending to the counting of the breath, he has that one cultivate the medicine of attending to the counting of the breath. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be calmed by meditating on the three doors of liberation, he has that one cultivate the medicine of the three doors of liberation. When there is a sentient being for

whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be calmed by cultivating meditative concentration, he has that one cultivate the medicine of meditative concentration. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be calmed by cultivating the formless meditative concentrations, he has that one cultivate the formless meditative concentrations. When there is a sentient being for whom the disease of the afflictions is fit to be calmed by cultivating up to the samādhi of the Heroic March (śūraṃgama), he has that one cultivate the medicine of the samādhi of the Heroic March.

Therefore the Tathāgata makes such a gift of the medicine of the Dharma to sentient beings. He does not let any sentient beings who have become fit vessels fall under the power of the four māras. He does not let any sentient beings who have become fit vessels turn their backs on the vehicle of gods and humans and sink toward the lower realms. He does not let the unsurpassed medicine of the Dharma of the Tathāgata and the lineage of the Three Jewels swiftly disappear. In this way the Tathāgata makes such a gift of the medicine of the Dharma to sentient beings.

Son of noble family, the Tathāgata possesses such a seventh wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel, through the conduct of unsurpassed, all-pervading wisdom, he gives many kinds of medicine of the Dharma to all sentient beings; when they are set to cultivating it, all the diseases of the afflictions are calmed, and they come to abide happily in fearlessness. Through fearlessness I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar in the midst of a great assembly.

Son of noble family, it is like this. A great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, thinks, "Let me set my mindfulness on all things, my own lineage and that of others, my first birth, the play of my youth and so on." That is, he thinks back on and recalls such things as these: the place where he was first born; being bathed; being taken onto a lap and given breast milk; the massaging of his body and limbs; playing joyfully; playing in earth and sand; playing heedlessly in many ways with his companions; training in skills; doing various other kinds of activities; traveling and going to the lands of other kings; carrying out royal duties; performing the work of a king; acting as regent; having gained the kingdom and come into power, experiencing great and happy enjoyments; and being renowned in all directions with great fame. Having recalled these, he establishes the true

Dharma customs of the former kings, sustains and cares for all the sentient beings living there, holds his own realm, and does no harm to others. Son of noble family, in this way that great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, possesses this eighth royal wheel. By the power of that wheel his land is exceedingly happy and prosperous; he subdues all opposing enemies and bad companions, and, being skilled in the care of guarding his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in just the same way the Tathāgata too, when dwelling in the midst of the assembly, recalls everything that he and others did in countless former births. That is, he recalls everything done in one birth, in two births, in three births, and so on up to countless hundreds of thousands of births. Likewise he recalls the formation of eons, and recalls too the destruction of eons. He recalls everything up to countless formations of eons and countless destructions of eons: "In past times this one lived in such-and-such a place; the family was called this, the name was this, the clan was this; this one ate this food and experienced these pleasures and pains; the life span was this long; this one lived for this long. At the end of that life, this one died in such-and-such a place and was born in these places; dying in these places, this one was born in such-and-such a place." Because he recalls all these and other immeasurable and incalculable things, he teaches the true Dharma in accordance with the individual faculties of sentient beings, and acts for their benefit and well-being.

Son of noble family, in this way I possess this eighth wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel I place countless sentient beings happily in fearlessness by means of benefit and well-being. Through fearlessness I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all who speak falsely, the non-Buddhists and others, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar in the midst of a great assembly.

Son of noble family, it is like this. A great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, just as he has in mind, thoroughly examines the family, the clan, whatever skills they have, whatever work they do, where they will be born after dying from here, and all the differing distinctions of good and bad causes and results, of the sentient beings living within his domain.

He knows which sentient beings, born into which households, are bold and heroic, and which are weak and timid; which, when trained in a craft, become

adept at it, and which do not; what work each one does; who does virtue and who does evil; who is rich and powerful and who is poor and wretched; who is beautiful and who is not beautiful, and so forth. Knowing all this, he knows everything about them right up until they pass away. He fully understands which of them die before their karma is exhausted and which die when their karma is exhausted; which are executed for breaking the king's law; which are killed by enemies; which die from being flogged with whips; which die from being thrown into prison; which die for the sake of training in a craft; which die on the battlefield against hostile foes; which die through quarrels and fighting; which die for the sake of guarding their wealth; which die under the sway of desire; which die from anger and holding grudges; which die of exhaustion; which die of hunger; which die burdened with faults and wrongdoing; which die blameless; which die worn out with old age; which die in the prime of life; which die in youth and childhood; which die having done many kinds of virtuous actions; and which die having done many kinds of non-virtuous actions. He knows which sentient beings, when they die, will be born in the higher realms because they practiced virtue, and he fully understands which sentient beings, when they pass on, will be born in the lower realms because they practiced non-virtue.

Having thus fully understood all these matters, he thinks, "I too must apply myself diligently and strive hard to practice virtue of body, virtue of speech, and virtue of mind." He thinks, "By all sorts of means I must make myself accustomed to giving, and become peaceful and disciplined, so that when I pass on I may be born in a good state and not fall into the lower realms."

So the great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, having reflected on such matters, exerts himself greatly, with diligence of the utmost effort, in practicing virtue with all three: body, speech, and mind. He constantly practices giving, namely: food, drink, clothing, oxen, horses, vehicles for riding, bedding, medicine for the sick, houses, butter lamps and lanterns, and every other necessity of life besides; servants and laborers; and further, jewels and wealth of every kind; his head, his eyes, his hands and his feet, even up to his body and his life. All of this he gives away without stinginess. He completely abandons everything from the taking of life, through taking what is not given, sexual misconduct, lying, harsh speech, idle talk, slander, attachment and aversion, up to wrong view.

Through that cause and that condition, the great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, obtains ten kinds of

distinguished qualities. What are the ten? They are these. He has great renown. He has wealth and jewels. He has excellent bodily marks. He has a large retinue. He is free of discomfort and disease. His retinue, kinsmen, and friends are all of sharp wisdom and great learning. He relies on and honors the genuine and those of genuine conduct. He is widely renowned, his fair fame spreading throughout the ten directions. He is constantly protected by gods endowed with great splendor and power. And when he passes on, he is born as a god in the higher realms and always dwells in good states, possessed of supremely blissful enjoyments.

Son of noble family, the great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, thus possesses this ninth wheel. By the power of possessing that wheel, his domain is happy and prosperous, and, having subdued all hostile foes and evil companions and being skilled in the care that protects his person, his life too becomes long.

Son of noble family, in just the same way, the Tathāgata too knows exactly as it really is everything concerning the birth, death, and passing on of all sentient beings. He fully knows, exactly as it really is, which sentient beings engage in non-virtuous conduct of body, which sentient beings engage in non-virtuous conduct of speech, and which sentient beings engage in non-virtuous conduct of mind, disparage the noble ones, and hold wrong views, and so, by the power of wrong view, fall into the lower realms when they pass on: which of them fall into the hells, which are born in the animal realm, and which are born as hungry ghosts. He fully knows which sentient beings engage in virtuous conduct of body, which engage in virtuous conduct of speech, and which engage in virtuous conduct of mind, do not disparage the noble ones, and hold right view, and so, through the condition of right view, when they pass on are born as gods in the higher realms, are born as humans, or come to the exhaustion of the defilements.

Knowing thus exactly as it really is, the Tathāgata generates loving-kindness and great compassion for those sentient beings, and with diligence of the utmost effort he displays three kinds of miracle. He turns those beings toward the Dharma and Vinaya taught by the Buddha, and establishes them in mundane and supramundane faith. What are the three? They are the miracle of the higher knowledges, the miracle of teaching the Dharma, and the miracle of knowing the minds of others. Having urged those beings on with these three kinds of miracle, he establishes them in the teaching, and having brought them to attain mundane and supramundane faith, he liberates all sentient

beings who wander in cyclic existence.

Son of noble family, I thus possess this ninth wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel, for the sake of the benefit and happiness of immeasurable sentient beings, I establish them in the happiness of fearlessness. Being fearless, I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who hold wrong views, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar in the midst of the assembly.

Son of noble family, it is like this. In order to remove the many kinds of bodily illness of the immeasurable sentient beings of the four continents, a great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, sets aside the affairs of state, washes his body with scented water, puts on clean new garments, and sits with his body upright. Bringing to mind loving-kindness, compassion, and an impartial attitude toward all sentient beings, and in order to free them from every illness, he makes offerings to all the mighty and splendid gods with flowers, incense, music of many kinds, and a great many other offering articles of every sort.

At that time all of them, from the lords of the gods and the lords of the nāgas up to the lords of the mahoragas, come to know of this and say to one another, "This great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, is endowed with good qualities. Because his splendor is great, he is worthy to be a wheel-turning monarch who rules over the four continents. Let us go to him and empower him as king over the four continents. We go so that sentient beings may be free of illness and happy." Having said this, all of them, from the lords of the gods up to the lords of the mahoragas, came and empowered that great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, as a wheel-turning monarch. He came to possess the seven precious things and to rule over the four continents, and he had a thousand sons, all of them heroic and bold, handsome and pleasing, who subdued hostile foes. In this way, throughout the great earth under his sway, from the shores of the ocean all the way to the palace, no one used weapons and everyone practiced the true Dharma, and so he made it happy and prosperous.

Son of noble family, the great king of the warrior caste, anointed on the crown of his head into kingship, thus possesses this tenth wheel. By the power of that wheel, all the sentient beings who dwell anywhere from the four great continents to the eight intermediate directions and the eighty-four thousand

minor continents abide in the ten courses of virtuous action, his own person is well protected, and his life becomes long. And when he passes on, he is born as a god in the higher realms and comes to possess excellent enjoyments.

Son of noble family, in just the same way, the Tathāgata too, long ago when he was a bodhisattva, knew that his own body and those of others suffered from immeasurable kinds of the disease of the afflictions. So he washed his body with the scented water of meditative absorption, bathed in the water of the Dharma of truth, of great loving-kindness, and of great compassion, and put on the garment of conscience and modesty. All the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the ten directions took him into their care with meditative concentration, meditative attainment, diligence, skillful means, wisdom, loving-kindness, and compassion, and all of them, speaking in unison, said this: "This great being has become a vessel adorned with the great accumulations of merit and wisdom, and so he has become a vessel for the three liberations, the four fearlessnesses, the ten powers of a tathāgata, and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha. He is the ground for attaining unsurpassed omniscient wisdom. He has perfected great loving-kindness and great compassion. He delights in working for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. He has become a merchant captain in search of the jewel of buddhahood. He frees the sentient beings who suffer in cyclic existence. He bestows on sentient beings the great bliss of nirvāṇa. We, all the buddhas, the blessed ones, by our word of truth grant him everything whatsoever that he wishes, so that he will fully awaken into perfect and complete awakening, attain the unsurpassed Dharma, and become a great king of Dharma."

At that time, relying on the accumulations of merit and wisdom, I, with exceedingly steadfast diligence, understood the four noble truths exactly as they really are, and fully awakened into unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Son of noble family, just as a wheel-turning monarch rules and holds sway over the four continents, so the Tathāgata too has gained mastery over the four meditative concentrations, the four formless absorptions, the four abodes of Brahmā, the four kinds of discriminating knowledge, the four noble truths, the four fearlessnesses, the ten powers of a tathāgata, the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, and the wisdom that knows all aspects.

Just as a wheel-turning monarch possesses the seven precious things, so the Tathāgata too possesses the seven branches of awakening.

Just as a wheel-turning monarch has a thousand sons, all heroic and bold, handsome and pleasing, who subdue all enemy foes, so the Tathāgata too has a great assembly of śrāvakas, from the first, the noble Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya, to the last, the venerable Subhadra, and others besides, who arose from the heart of the Buddha, who were born from the speech of the Blessed One, who were born from the Dharma he taught, and who have attained the qualities of a buddha. Because they have completely exhausted the defilements, they are called heroic and of great prowess. Because they possess the four abodes of Brahmā, they are called handsome and pleasing. Because they have subdued the divine māras and the non-Buddhists, they are called the subduers of hostile foes.

Just as a wheel-turning monarch tames and guides the eighty-four thousand minor continents, so the Tathāgata too has gained mastery to hold sway by his word over a hundred koṭis of Jambudvīpas, a hundred koṭis of western Godānīyas, a hundred koṭis of eastern Pūrvavidehas, a hundred koṭis of northern Uttarakurus, a hundred koṭis of great oceans, a hundred koṭis of Sumerus, a hundred koṭis of the realms of the Four Great Kings, a hundred koṭis of spheres of neither perception nor non-perception, and a hundred koṭis of great encircling mountain ranges, these having become a single, vast buddha field.

Son of noble family, I thus possess this tenth wheel of a buddha. By the power of that wheel I know, exactly as it really is, that all the defilements of my own body and of others are completely exhausted, and for the sake of the benefit and happiness of immeasurable sentient beings I establish them in the happiness of fearlessness. Being fearless, I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras, and roar the lion's roar amid a great assembly.

Son of noble family, I thus possess these ten wheels of a buddha. Through the force of my former aspirations I dwell here in this buddha field of the five degenerations, where all sentient beings have lost the pure white qualities, are bereft of the seven noble riches, and have grown far apart from the wise; where they are entangled on every side and overpowered by the net of eternalism and nihilism; where they take pleasure and delight in the chariot that goes to the lower realms; where they have no fear of suffering in the life to come; where they put their faith in dwelling in the darkness of ignorance that always covers everything; where they carry the ten courses of

non-virtuous action to completion, commit the five deeds of immediate retribution, denigrate the true Dharma and disparage the noble ones, cast all virtuous qualities far away, and bring non-virtuous qualities to completion. Dwelling here, because I possess these ten kinds of buddha wheel, I abide happily and without fear. Being fearless, I dwell in the place of the great sage, turn the wheel of a buddha, and tame all the non-Buddhists who speak falsely, together with the gods and māras. Having destroyed all the vajra-hard afflictions in the dispositions of all sentient beings, I have established all sentient beings who have become fit vessels, each according to whatever will tame them, so that they will not turn back from the three vehicles.

Then, from within that assembly, all the bodhisattva great beings who were there to be trained, the whole saṅgha of śrāvakas, and all the retinues of gods and nāgas, up to the kaṭapūtanas, humans and non-humans and the rest, the whole great assembly, rejoiced exceedingly and said with one voice, "Excellent!" They sent down a great rain of incense, a great rain of flowers, a great rain of jewels, and a great rain of garments, and this great earth, a hundred thousand of them, quaked violently.

As these ten kinds of buddha wheel were being taught in this way, in that assembly some eighty-four koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattva great beings attained acceptance of the unborn nature of phenomena. Furthermore, an immeasurable number of bodhisattva great beings attained dhāraṇīs and meditative absorptions. Furthermore, an immeasurable, countless number of sentient beings generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening and became irreversible. Furthermore, an immeasurable, countless number of sentient beings attained the fruits.

This concludes the second chapter, the chapter on the ten wheels, from the Great Collection text called The Ten Wheels of Kṣitigarbha, the bodhisattva great being.

The third fascicle.

Then, in that assembly, a great Brahmā called Devagarbha, who had fully developed the roots of virtue, had attained the ten grounds, and possessed the qualities of a bodhisattva great being, rose from his seat, joined his palms, bowed his head at the feet of the Blessed One, and spoke these verses:

To you who hold the treasury of qualities, ocean of wisdom,
I put my doubts and make my plea.
Ocean of wisdom, grant me leave out of compassion,

And clear away the doubts that trouble my thinking.
As though we were tormented by a burning thirst,
The supreme Dharma's taste, the essence of all qualities,
The taste of the Dharma of the ultimate, most excellent of all,
All of us gathered in this assembly long to hear.

The Blessed One said to the great Brahmā Devagarbha, "Ask the Tathāgata whatever you wish, and by answering each question you put, I shall satisfy your mind."

The great Brahmā replied, "Blessed One, I shall do so," and he asked in verse:

Those who have wisdom and have well cultivated absorption,
Who dwell at ease in selflessness:
Will they come to abide in the ultimate meaning,
Or will they remain wheeling round in cyclic existence?
Those who, day and night, in that supreme and sublime Dharma
Recite and train themselves and strive:
Will they cross over the lake of the afflictions,
Or will they fall into the lower realms?
Those who strive with great effort in making merit:
Will they surely turn toward nirvāṇa,
Or will they remain wheeling round in cyclic existence,
Or will they fall into the lower realms?
Those who have wisdom, empowered into kingship,
Who are endowed with the ten kinds of wheel:
Will they sink down within cyclic existence,
Or will they attain the fruit of buddhahood?
Those whose minds are seized by the afflictions,
Who are led astray by many afflictions:
How are they to cleanse their minds till they are wholly pure?
How are they to do the work of meditation and recitation?

Then the Blessed One said this to the great Brahmā Devagarbha: "Excellent! It is excellent that you have the eloquence to ask so well about these matters. You devote yourself earnestly to these teachings. You have perfected every kind of conduct. In the presence of past buddhas, blessed ones, as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, you thoroughly purified your three doors. You have spread the true Dharma. You preserve the lineage of the Three Jewels.

And now, for the sake of the benefit and happiness of immeasurable sentient beings, it is excellent that you have asked the Tathāgata about these profound matters.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. There is a teaching called the Great Instruction in Knowledge, on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced. All the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past also taught this teaching, the Great Instruction in Knowledge, on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced, in order to bring all sentient beings to maturity, to make them weary of cyclic existence, to cut off karma and the afflictions completely, and to bring the three vehicles swiftly to perfection.

All the buddhas, the blessed ones, who now dwell in the ten directions also teach abiding by this teaching, the Great Instruction in Knowledge, on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced, in order to bring all sentient beings to maturity, to make them weary of cyclic existence, to cut off karma and the afflictions completely, and to bring the three vehicles swiftly to perfection. All the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the future will also teach these ways of abiding by this teaching, the Great Instruction in Knowledge, on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced, in order to bring all sentient beings to maturity, to make them weary of cyclic existence, to cut off karma and the afflictions completely, and to bring the three vehicles swiftly to perfection. You heard in full, from the tathāgatas of the past, this way of abiding by the teaching of the Great Instruction in Knowledge, on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced, and I too shall teach this way of abiding by the teaching of the Great Instruction in Knowledge, on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced, in order to bring all sentient beings to maturity, to make them weary of cyclic existence, to cut off karma and the afflictions completely, and to bring the three vehicles swiftly to perfection. Therefore, holy being, listen well and keep it in mind, and I shall teach it."

Saying, "Blessed One, I shall do so," the great Brahmā Devagarbha listened to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One said to the great Brahmā Devagarbha, "There are ten kinds of things in which one should not abide and which one should not practice. If yogins follow even a little of this bad conduct, they will not achieve even the roots of virtue of the desire realm; and even if they had achieved them before, these will at once be lost again and decline. What need, then, to speak of their attaining the absorptions of the form and formless realms, up to the three

vehicles and the one vehicle?

"What are the ten? They are these. Some in the world wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but, being busy with the necessities of life, they are afflicted through the circumstance of having to seek them. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but their moral discipline is broken and they commit many wrongdoings. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but they hold distorted views and are attached to the good and bad omens of the world, and their bodies and minds are untamed. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but because their minds are restless and excited they do not incline toward the noble ones, and their senses are unruly. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but they delight in slander and so cause dissension. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but with harsh words they revile and disparage the noble ones. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but they engage in idle talk and tell lies. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but out of desire and jealousy they are displeased at the profit, honor, and gain of others. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but being full of aversion they give rise to malice toward sentient beings. Some wish to cultivate meditative absorption, but having wrong views they hold that there is no cause and no result.

"Great Brahmā, understand it thus: these are called the ten kinds of things in which one should not abide and which one should not practice. If those who cultivate meditative absorption follow even a little of this bad conduct, they will not achieve even the virtue of the desire realm; and even if they had achieved it before, it will at once be lost and decline. What need, then, to speak of their attaining the absorptions of the form and formless realms, and the three vehicles and the one?

"Great Brahmā, furthermore, there are ten kinds of things in which one should not abide and which one should not practice. If those who cultivate meditative absorption have any of this bad conduct, they will not achieve meditative absorption; and even if they had achieved it before, it will at once be lost and decline. What are the ten? They are these: delight in and attachment to tasks and activities; delight in and attachment to idle talk; delight in and attachment to sleep; delight in and attachment to seeking material things; delight in and attachment to beautiful forms; delight in and attachment to pleasant sounds; delight in and attachment to fragrant scents; delight in and attachment to delicious tastes; delight in and attachment to soft textures; and delight in and attachment to conceptual thought and analysis.

"Great Brahmā, understand it thus: if those who cultivate meditative absorption have any of this bad conduct, these ten kinds of things in which one should not abide and which one should not practice, they will not achieve the meditative absorptions; and even if they had achieved them before, these will at once be lost and decline.

"If meditative absorption has not been achieved, then whatever other accumulations of virtue one gathers will not become meaningful. For in order to secure one's own enjoyments and the gifts given out of faith, harmful states of mind and of mental factors will arise. Because of that, one will even break the laws of the king and the great ministers. One will insult and abuse some people, flog some with whips, and cut off or have cut off the limbs and extremities of others. By that cause and that condition one will be struck by severe illness and suffer for a long time, one's life will be short, and after death and transmigration one will be born in one or another of the three lower realms, falling as far as the hell of Unceasing Torment. Like Kudaka, Arādaka, Deśukupālaki, Devadatta, and others, one will fall away from meditative concentration, fall as far as the hell of Unceasing Torment, and experience every kind of great, unbearable suffering in immeasurable forms."

At that time the Blessed One said this to the venerable Ājñāta Kauṇḍinya: "I permit you, and the monks who dwell in remote places and cultivate meditative absorption, to stay in the best lodgings, to make use of the best bedding and the best food, and not to perform any of the work of the Saṅgha. Why is that? If those who cultivate meditative absorption become busy with the necessities of life, harmful states of mind and of mental factors will arise, they will fail to achieve any meditative absorption, and they will fall as far as the hell of Unceasing Torment and experience great, unbearable suffering in immeasurable forms.

"If those who cultivate meditative absorption are provided with the necessities of life, they will achieve the many meditative absorptions they had not achieved, and those they achieved before will not decline. By virtue of this, no non-virtuous states at all will arise in them; and in the same way, following the text at length, up to non-virtuous conceptual thought and analysis, none will arise. Then they will attain everything from birth as gods in the higher realms up to nirvāṇa.

"If those who cultivate meditative absorption have not achieved the many meditative absorptions, they should not sleep in the first and last watches of

the night, but train and meditate with diligence. They should give up busyness entirely and be of few wants and content, and not be attached to anything. They give up entirely all desire, aversion, anger, concealment, agitation, harmfulness, pride, conceit, jealousy, avarice, slander, harsh speech, lies, worldly quarrels, and heedlessness. Whoever strives in this way may accept the praise, acclaim, homage, honor, service, attendance, and so on, and even hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of gifts, from Śakra, Brahmā, the four guardians of the world, wheel-turning monarchs and the like; what need, then, to speak of accepting the offerings of the warrior caste, brahmins, the merchant caste and the rest? Even those who have not attained meditative absorption are entitled to take as their own the praise, acclaim, homage, honor, service, attendance, gifts, and offerings of these; what need, then, to speak of those who have attained meditative absorption?"

Then the Blessed One spoke in verse:

By meditating on absorption, doubts are cut away;
Nothing else apart from this is able to do so.
Therefore the cultivation of absorption is supreme,
And the wise should honor it.

Then the great Brahmā Devagarbha said this: "Venerable Blessed One, if those who have gone forth in the teaching of the Buddha are flogged or beaten with whips, staffs and the like by those of the warrior caste, by great ministers, or by officials, or if they are put in prison, reviled, mocked, have their limbs cut off, or are deprived of life and killed, is that proper, or is it not proper?"

The Blessed One said this to the great Brahmā Devagarbha: "Son of noble family, when any sentient being has gone forth in my teaching, shaved off hair and beard, and put on the saffron robe, then whether he keeps his moral discipline, or has broken his moral discipline, or even has no moral discipline at all, gods, humans, asuras and all the rest do not allow him even to be subjected to the rules that apply to householders. What need, then, to speak of subjecting him to what is contrary to the Dharma: flogging and beating his body with whips, staffs and the like, putting him in prison, insulting him, abusing him, cutting off his limbs, or depriving him of his life faculty?

"Why is that? Leave aside those who keep their moral discipline and are very learned. Even an evil monk who has gone forth in my teaching and broken his moral discipline, who by practicing non-virtuous things has become rotten within, like a worm-eaten husk filled with filth; who claims to be a renunciant

when he is no renunciant, and claims to live the pure life when he does not live the pure life; who is defeated by afflictions of every kind, ruined, and fallen headlong: even such an evil monk of broken discipline becomes a teacher and guide for all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, non-humans and the rest, and becomes a treasury of immeasurable precious qualities.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, even when those who have gone forth in my teaching have broken their moral discipline, merely by seeing their form sentient beings give rise to ten kinds of superior intention, and so they will gain ten immeasurable heaps of precious qualities. What are the ten? They are these.

"Though those who have gone forth in my teaching may have broken their moral discipline, when sentient beings see them, they recollect the Buddha and give rise to a superior intention of faith and reverence, accompanied by respect. By that cause and that condition they will never turn toward non-Buddhist teachers, their treatises, or their followers, and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa, free from fear.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting noble moral discipline. By that cause and that condition they will entirely give up taking life, entirely give up taking what is not given, entirely give up sexual misconduct, entirely give up lying, and entirely give up drinking beer and other intoxicating liquors that are a basis for heedlessness, and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa, free from fear.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting generosity. By that cause and that condition they will come to have great wealth and to make offerings to and serve the genuine and those of genuine conduct, and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa, free from fear.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting the patience of a gentle nature. By that cause and that condition they will entirely give up slander, harsh speech, idle talk, and aversion, and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa, free from fear.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting going forth and devoting oneself to diligence. By that cause and that condition they will entirely give up the household, take up the way of homelessness, and devote themselves with diligence of the utmost effort to the supreme conduct,

and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa, without fear.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting giving up the agitated mind and settling evenly in meditative concentration. By that cause and that condition they will delight in mountains, groves, and remote hermitages and, day and night, apply diligence to cultivating meditative absorption, and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa, without fear.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting wisdom.

By that cause and that condition they will delight and rejoice in hearing, reading, and reciting the sublime Dharma, and so on, up to entering the great city of complete nirvāṇa.

"Some, on seeing them, give rise to a superior intention of recollecting the roots of virtue they generated before for the sake of renunciation, and so on, up to speaking with a smile, conversing with delight, and bowing at their feet. By that cause and that condition they will be born into great and high families and into noble families, and when countless sentient beings see them they will rejoice, and so on, up to entering, free from fear, the great city of complete nirvāṇa.

"Son of good family, even when those who have gone forth in my teaching have broken their moral discipline, merely by seeing their form and their robes sentient beings give rise to these ten kinds of superior intention, and they will obtain immeasurable heaps of precious qualities. Therefore it is not right for kings, great ministers, governors, and the like to beat and strike them with whips, staves, and the like, to throw them into prison, to revile and abuse them, to cut off their limbs, to deprive them of their life faculty, and so forth.

"Moreover, great Brahmā, when those who have gone for refuge to me and gone forth break their moral discipline and practice unwholesome dharmas, I have called such a one a monk who is like a worm-ridden thing full of rot and filth; one who, not being a śramaṇa, claims to be a śramaṇa; who, not living the pure life, claims to live the pure life; defeated by afflictions of many kinds; rotten; overturned, as it were. Yet although such a monk has broken his moral discipline and practices what is unwholesome, he acts as a teacher and a guiding spiritual friend for all gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans, nonhumans, and the rest, and he becomes a treasury of immeasurable qualities. Thus, although that monk is

not a vessel for the Dharma, he has shaved his hair and beard and put on the saffron robes, and his appearance and deportment accord with those of the noble ones. Merely by seeing him, countless sentient beings will increase and generate roots of virtue of many different kinds. Furthermore, countless sentient beings will be born as gods in the higher realms and will be set upon the true path of passing into nirvāṇa. Therefore, whether those who have gone for refuge to me and gone forth keep their moral discipline, have broken their moral discipline, or have no moral discipline at all, if a universal monarch, another king, a minister, or the like is not permitted even to make them return to the state of a householder, what need is there to speak of other unlawful acts, such as beating them with whips, staves, and the like, striking them, throwing them into prison, reviling and abusing them, cutting and chopping off their limbs and extremities, depriving them of their life faculty, and so forth?

"Great Brahmā, although I have declared that such a monk who has broken his moral discipline and commits evil is like a corpse within the discipline I have taught, the remaining power of his going forth, his moral discipline, and his qualities is still present. For example, when a bull or a musk deer dies and is parted from consciousness, it is a corpse among the animals; yet because the bull has bezoar and the musk deer has musk, they become of great value for the benefit and happiness of countless, immeasurable sentient beings. In just the same way, although that monk who has broken his moral discipline is called a corpse within the discipline I have taught, through the remaining power of his going forth, his moral discipline, and his qualities he too becomes of great value for the benefit and happiness of countless, immeasurable sentient beings.

"Great Brahmā, it is like this. Merchants set out upon the great ocean and kill countless creatures of a single species and take out their eyes. If the eyeballs are combined with the fruit called Steadfast, they become a precious eye medicine. When this precious eye medicine is applied to the eyes of beings who are blind and eyeless, who came out of the womb blind from birth, they are freed from every disease of the eye, and their eyes become keen and clear. In the same way, although the monk who has broken his moral discipline is called a corpse within the discipline I have taught, because he has the deportment and the appearance of one gone forth, countless sentient beings, merely by seeing him for an instant, will obtain the utterly pure eye of wisdom; what need is there to speak of his being able to teach the sublime Dharma to others?

"Great Brahmā, it is like this. When incense is burned, although the incense itself is consumed and disappears, its fragrance lets others smell it. In the same way, that monk who has broken his moral discipline is, because he has broken it, not a fertile field of merit; burned day and night by what is given in faith, when he passes from this life he falls into the three lower realms. Yet he serves the benefit and happiness of countless, immeasurable sentient beings, causing them to be born as gods in the higher realms and to catch the fragrance of passing into nirvāṇa. Therefore, great Brahmā, I do not permit anyone to beat and strike with whips and staves, throw into prison, revile and abuse, cut off the limbs of, or deprive of the life faculty such a monk who has broken his moral discipline and commits evil, one gone forth whom all householders should honor with reverence and serve.

"Within the pure Saṅgha, such monks are to be excluded from the poṣadha, from entering the rains retreat, and from the ceremony at its close, and they have no right to make use of anything belonging to the Saṅgha of the four directions: its gains, its goods, its food, its drink, its requisites for living, and the like. It is only that they are not permitted to come into any of the Vinaya proceedings carried out by the śramaṇas; but I do not permit anyone to beat them, strike them, bind them, deprive them of the life faculty, and so forth."

Then the Blessed One spoke in verse:

"Though the campaka flower has withered,
It far surpasses every other kind of flower.
Though a monk has broken his discipline and does evil,
He is supreme above all the non-Buddhists (tīrthikas)."

"Furthermore, great Brahmā, there are five kinds of action, great misdeeds of immediate retribution.

What are the five? Deliberately killing one's father, deliberately killing one's mother, deliberately killing an arhat, causing a schism in the Saṅgha of śrāvakas through wrong view, and with malicious intent drawing blood from the body of a buddha. These five kinds are called the actions that are great misdeeds of immediate retribution. If any person has committed even one of these five, it is not permissible for him to go forth or to receive full ordination. If someone does give him the going forth or full ordination, his preceptor is at fault and is to be expelled from the Saṅgha. Even so, because such a person, once gone forth, has the deportment and appearance, I do not permit anyone to beat and strike him with whips and staves, throw him into prison, revile and

abuse him, cut off his limbs, or deprive him of his life faculty.

"Furthermore, there are four kinds of action that are close to the great misdeeds of immediate retribution. What are the four? To kill a pratyekabuddha with an unwholesome mind: among the acts of taking life this is an action of great misdeed, and it is a root offense. To engage in unchaste conduct with a nun who is an arhat: among acts of sexual misconduct this is an action of great misdeed, and so it is a root offense. To make use of the property of the Three Jewels given in faith: among acts of taking what is not given this is an action of great misdeed, and so it is a root offense. To cause a schism in a harmonious Saṅgha through evil views: among acts of false speech this is an action of great misdeed, and so it is a root offense. If any person has committed even one of these four kinds of action close to the great misdeeds of immediate retribution, I do not permit him to go forth or to receive full ordination. If someone does give him the going forth or full ordination, his preceptor is at fault and is to be expelled from my teaching. Even so, if such a person has gone forth or been fully ordained, because he possesses the deportment and appearance, I do not permit anyone to beat and strike him with whips and staves, to revile him, to abuse him, to throw him into prison, to cut off his limbs, and so on, up to depriving him of his life faculty.

"Thus there are some that are root evils but not of immediate retribution. There are some that are of immediate retribution but not root evils. There are some that are both root evils and evils of immediate retribution. And there are some that are neither root evils nor of immediate retribution.

"Now, what is it that is both a root evil and of immediate retribution? It is this: when one who has gone forth in my teaching and received full ordination deliberately kills a person who has reached the far shore of seeing the truths. This is both a root evil and of immediate retribution, and so he must quickly be expelled from the Dharma of the discipline I have taught.

"What is it that is a root evil but not of immediate retribution? It is this: when one who has gone forth in my teaching and received full ordination deliberately takes the life of another person, or, at the least, kills a being dwelling in the womb by giving poison. These are root evils but not of immediate retribution. I do not permit such a person to stay with the Saṅgha even for a night, or to make use of the goods and the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions.

"What is it that is of immediate retribution but not a root evil? It is this: when a person who has gone for refuge to the Three Jewels, or who holds the five precepts, or who holds the ten precepts, has committed even one of the five acts of immediate retribution, this is called an evil of immediate retribution but not a root evil. It is not permissible to give such a person the going forth or full ordination. If someone does give him the going forth or full ordination, his preceptor is tainted with evil and is to be expelled from my teaching.

"What is it that is neither a root evil nor of immediate retribution? It is this: when a person who has gone for refuge to the Three Jewels, or who has taken the five precepts, gives rise to a mind that doubts the Buddha, the Dharma, and the Saṅgha, goes for refuge to non-Buddhists and takes them as his teacher and master, or regards all sorts of portents as omens and follows worldly gods. And when any person disparages and misrepresents the sublime Dharma taught by the Tathāgata, the sublime Dharma connected with the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the sublime Dharma connected with the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and the sublime Dharma connected with the Great Vehicle; when he obstructs and hinders it; when, himself having no trust and no faith, he turns others away from it and hinders them; and when he cuts off and obstructs others' reading, reciting, or copying into a book even a single verse of it: this is neither a root evil nor of immediate retribution, but is called an action of great misdeed close to immediate retribution.

"Until such a person has confessed and disclosed these great evil actions of misdeed, it is not permissible for him to go forth or to receive full ordination. If anyone gives him the going forth or full ordination, that preceptor is tainted with evil and is to be expelled from my teaching. If such a person, having gone forth or been fully ordained, does not perform the act of confessing and disclosing that evil misdeed, he must quickly be expelled from the discipline I have taught. Why is that? Because these two kinds of person destroy the eye of the sublime Dharma, extinguish the lamp of the sublime Dharma, and utterly cut off the lineage of the Three Jewels. They lead gods, humans, and others to undergo suffering that is pointless and without benefit, and they make them fall into the lower realms.

These two kinds of person themselves disparage the sublime Dharma and revile the noble ones, and they also lead others to disparage the sublime Dharma and revile the noble ones. Immediately upon passing from this life they fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment and experience suffering for an eon, and they are beyond remedy.

"Moreover, great Brahmā, there are evils by prohibition that exclude one from communion and must not be done; there are evils by nature that exclude one from communion and must not be done; and among the evils by nature there are those that become root evils, which exclude one from communion and must not be done. Now, what are the root evils, the things that exclude one from communion and must not be done? They are these: when a monk commits a root evil by engaging in unchaste conduct; commits a root evil by deliberately taking the life of a human being; commits a root evil by stealing what is not the property of the Three Jewels; or commits a root evil by telling a great lie. If a monk has committed any of these four kinds of root evil, he is not included in the formal acts performed by the monks, and he has no right to make use of any goods or of the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions. Yet I do not permit anyone to do anything to him such as beating and striking him with staves and whips, throwing him into prison, abusing and reviling him, cutting off his limbs, or depriving him of his life faculty. Among the evils by nature these are the grave root evils; they are called the things that exclude one from communion and must not be done.

"Why are they called root evils? If any person commits these four kinds of deed, immediately upon passing from this life he will fall into the lower realms. Because they are the root of going to the lower realms, they are called root evils.

"Why, then, are the acts of immediate retribution, the acts close to immediate retribution, and the root evils spoken of as evil actions of great misdeed that exclude one from communion and must not be done? Son of good family, it is like this. If a lump of iron or a ball of lead is thrown up into the sky above, it does not stay there even for a moment but at once falls back to the ground. So it is with the five acts of immediate retribution, the acts close to immediate retribution, the four root evils, disparaging the sublime Dharma, doubting the Three Jewels, and the two kinds of evil person. If any person commits any of these eleven kinds of evil, immediately upon passing from this life he is without obstruction and without doubt born in the great hell of Unceasing Torment and experiences great suffering. Therefore they are called evil actions of great misdeed that exclude one from communion and must not be done. A person who has committed these evil actions of great misdeed that exclude one from communion and must not be done is certainly unable to exhaust the afflictions in this very body. He does not even accomplish meditative absorption, let alone enter and attain the unchanging certainty of

the right path. Immediately upon passing from this life he will without doubt be born in hell and experience great suffering.

"Moreover, great Brahmā, any son or daughter of good family who with pure intention has faith in my teaching and has entered the Śrāvaka Vehicle, or entered the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, or entered the Great Vehicle, and who out of faith in what I have taught has gone forth from home into homelessness and received full ordination, should hold the many points of training in great honor and respect, and should undertake great diligence, striving intensely to guard against the four root evils. Gods, humans, nonhumans, and the rest will always follow and protect such a person, and the offerings of gods, humans, and others made to him will not go to waste. In accordance with whichever of the three vehicles he delights and rejoices in, he will swiftly reach its final state. Therefore those who wish for true nirvāṇa should not let these four kinds of principle decline, for it would be easier to lose body and life.

"Why is that? Because ordinary beings attain the bliss of nirvāṇa through these three kinds of cause. What are the three? The cause that relies on the Tathāgata, the cause that relies on what the noble ones teach, and the cause that relies on my close disciples: these are the three. If ordinary beings rely on these three kinds of cause and apply themselves earnestly with diligence, they will attain the bliss of nirvāṇa.

"If any person lets these four kinds of principle decline, I am not his teacher, and he is not my śrāvaka. If any person lets these four kinds of principle decline, he goes against the prātimokṣa I have taught, which is very profound and vast, endowed with impermanence, suffering, emptiness, and selflessness, and taught for the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings. If he goes against the prātimokṣa I have taught, he becomes blind and confused with regard to all meditative concentrations and meditative absorptions and is unable to incline toward them or enter them. Entangled and overpowered by many afflictions, he is not a vessel for the Dharma of the three vehicles, and so he falls into the lower realms and experiences great suffering.

"If a son or daughter of good family has not let the four roots of the prātimokṣa I have taught decline but keeps them perfectly pure, then I am his teacher and he is my śrāvaka. He follows my words, dwells happily in my Dharma, and has brought every task to completion. Because such a person is firmly established in the aggregate of moral discipline, he is well established in all wholesome dharmas. He is established in the perfection of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He is

established in the perfection of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He is established in the perfection of the Great Vehicle.

"Why is that? Because if one guards against these four roots of evil by nature, that is established as the supreme and sublime cause of all wholesome dharmas, both those with defilements and those without defilements. Therefore guarding these four kinds of principle is called the root of all wholesome dharmas. It is like this: in dependence on the great earth all herbs and trees, crops, fruit trees, forests, and the like grow. In the same way, in dependence on guarding these four roots of moral discipline, all wholesome dharmas increase and grow.

"It is like this: in dependence on the great earth all mountains, the Cakravāla range, the Great Cakravāla range, Meru the king of mountains, and the rest abide securely. In the same way, in dependence on guarding the four roots of moral discipline, the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and the unsurpassed Great Vehicle will abide securely. It is like this: in dependence on the great earth, all the finest flavors in the world are found by seeking them. In the same way, in dependence on guarding the four roots of moral discipline, one will attain mindfulness, meditative absorption, dhāraṇī, gentle patience, the whole noble path, and so on, up to unsurpassed, perfectly complete awakening. It is like this: the great earth bears everything equally, the clean and the unclean. In the same way, if sons and daughters of good family who carefully guard the four roots of moral discipline settle their minds evenly toward those who have become vessels for the Dharma and those who have not, and do not despise them, do not revile them, do not praise themselves, are not conceited, and do not find fault, they become a ground from which all wholesome dharmas grow. It is like this: all sentient beings make use of this great earth and live happily on it. In the same way, sons and daughters of good family who carefully guard the four roots of moral discipline, with great delight in the true Dharma taught by the Tathāgata and with a supreme and sublime pure intention, gather all sentient beings equally by means of the four ways of gathering, without any perception of distinction, and so they cause all sentient beings to enjoy the delight of the Dharma and to live happily."

Then the venerable Upāli, having heard what the Blessed One had said, rose from his seat, arranged his robe, touched his head to the Blessed One's feet, placed his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, bowed with palms joined, and said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, you have said that sons and daughters of good family who carefully guard the four

roots of moral discipline settle their minds evenly toward all, those who have become vessels for the Dharma and those who have not; that they do not despise them, do not revile them, do not praise themselves, are not conceited, and do not abruptly raise charges of fault. If that is so, then at a time when you are no longer present, by what means should the Saṅgha of monks reprove and remove monks who have broken their moral discipline and engage in what is unwholesome, who, not being śramaṇas, claim to be śramaṇas, and who, not living the pure life, claim to live the pure life?"

The Blessed One said to the venerable Upāli, "I give no occasion at all for non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and householders to be permitted to raise charges against a monk's faults. If even the Saṅgha of monks is not permitted to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline in a way that is not in accord with the Dharma and without proper investigation, what need is there to speak of removing or expelling him? If they raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline, or expel him, in a way that is not in accord with the Dharma and without proper investigation, they incur the evil of a great misdeed.

"Upāli, understand it like this. Whoever raises charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline in these ten ways that are not in accord with the Dharma and without proper investigation will incur a great evil of misdeed, so the wise do not act like that. What are the ten? Without the Saṅgha's consent, to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline in the presence of the king, without proper investigation; without the Saṅgha's consent, to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before wandering ascetics; without the Saṅgha's consent, to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before ministers; without the Saṅgha's consent, to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before merchants and householders; to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before many women; to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before many men; to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before many who act improperly; to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before many monks and nuns; to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline before those who bear him a grudge; and to raise charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral

discipline before hostile enemies, without proper investigation. These are called the ten ways in which, if one raises charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline in a way that is not the Dharma and without proper investigation, one will incur a great evil of misdeed. If one is at fault even when one raises charges based on what is true and correct, what need is there to speak of raising charges based on what is untrue? One will incur a great evil of misdeed.

"Furthermore, whoever raises charges against the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline in these ten ways that are not the Dharma will incur the evil of a great misdeed, so the wise do not act like that. What are the ten? For non-Buddhists to raise charges against a monk's faults; for householders without moral discipline to raise charges against a monk's faults; for those who have committed acts of immediate retribution to raise charges against a monk's faults; for those who disparage the sublime Dharma to raise charges against a monk's faults; for those who revile the noble ones to raise charges against a monk's faults; for the foolish and mentally disturbed to raise charges against a monk's faults; for those tormented by illness to raise charges against a monk's faults; for the attendants who serve the Saṅgha of the four directions to raise charges against a monk's faults; for those who guard the orchards to raise charges against a monk's faults; and for monks under penalty to raise charges against a monk's faults. If the faults of a monk who has broken his moral discipline are charged in these ten ways that are not the Dharma, one will incur a great evil of misdeed. If one is at fault even when one raises charges based on what is true and correct, what need is there to speak of raising charges falsely? One will incur a great evil of misdeed.

"Furthermore, Upāli, if monks who have broken their moral discipline are living together with the Saṅgha within the Saṅgha of monks, then one monk among them who acts properly, who has good deportment, and who possesses the five qualities should rise from his seat, arrange his robe, and with reverence bow at the feet of the Saṅgha of monks. Then he should go before the monk who has broken his moral discipline and obtain his leave to raise a charge of fault, saying: 'Venerable one, please attend. Today I shall raise a charge regarding your fault. I raise it truthfully, not falsely; at the proper time, not letting the time pass; speaking with a smile, in words that are not harsh, with a mind of loving-kindness and without aversion; for your benefit, without harm to your happiness; and so that the Tathāgata's eye of the Dharma and lamp of the Dharma may long remain. Venerable one, I raise a charge regarding your

fault in accordance with the Dharma.' If that person permits the charge to be raised, it should be raised in accordance with the Dharma. If he does not permit it, then the monk should again bow at the feet of the elders and of the Saṅgha and with reverence say this: 'The monk named so-and-so has committed such-and-such a fault, and I wish to raise a charge on the basis of the five principles.' Then the elder monks within the Saṅgha should investigate thoroughly, questioning the accuser about what is charged and what fault was committed, and determining whether it is true or false, heavy or light; and relying on the Vinaya and the sūtras they should question and examine him with various means of admonition and drawing out the truth. By the seven methods of settling disputes, it should be settled by whichever method is appropriate in each case. If he has committed a great fault, he is to be punished with a great penalty. If he has committed a middling fault, he is to be punished with a middling penalty. If he has committed a small fault, he is to be punished with a small penalty, and he should be made to confess the fault with shame and embarrassment."

Then Upāli again said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, suppose monks who have committed evil that is a genuine fault are arrogant in the power of householders, or arrogant in the power of wealth, or arrogant in the power of great learning, the power of eloquence, or the power of disciples, and, stiff-necked with such powers, do not listen to the word of the Saṅgha; and suppose that, although the elder monks who hold the sūtras, the Vinaya, and the mātṛkā teach and correct them in accordance with the Dharma, they refuse to listen. How should such monks be punished?"

The Blessed One said, "The elder monks who hold the three baskets should ask the consent of the Saṅgha and send a messenger to the king and the great ministers to seek their power, and only then punish them in accordance with the Dharma."

Upāli again said, "Blessed One, suppose that monk who commits evil, by the power of riches, the power of great learning, the power of eloquence, and all sorts of means, so pleases the king and ministers that they all act against the Dharma and become allies of the monk who has broken his moral discipline; that they let those monks of merely bad conduct commit evil as they please, and will not even allow them to be punished in accordance with the Dharma. At such a time, what should the Saṅgha do about him?"

The Blessed One said to Upāli, "If that monk, though dwelling in an offense that excludes one from communion and must not be done, lives within the Saṅgha and his great evil is not directly evident, then for the time being the Saṅgha should leave him be. If that monk lives within the Saṅgha while his great evil that excludes one from communion and must not be done is directly evident, then the Saṅgha should ask consent, expel him in accordance with the Dharma, and cast him out of the Buddha's Dharma.

"Upāli, it is like this. Within a field of barley there grows a weed harmful to the barley. Although in its sprout, its stalk, and its joints it resembles barley, it spoils the good barley. While that weed has not yet put out its ear, the owner of the barley leaves it for a time. As soon as it puts out its ear, the owner of the barley thinks, 'It is spoiling the good barley,' pulls it out by the roots, and throws it outside the field. In the same way, that monk who has broken his moral discipline, who is in an offense that excludes one from communion and must not be done, is arrogant in householders and in many kinds of power. He lives within the Saṅgha, and although in deportment and appearance he resembles the Saṅgha, he spoils the pure Saṅgha. So long as the guardian gods have not exposed him and he lives within the Saṅgha with his great evil not directly evident, the Saṅgha should leave him be for the time being. If, urged on by the guardian gods too, his great fault becomes directly evident within the Saṅgha, then the Saṅgha should ask consent and expel him from the Buddha's Dharma. Upāli, it is like this: the great ocean does not let a corpse remain there overnight. In the same way, the disciples of the Saṅgha of my śrāvakas do not associate with a monk who has broken his moral discipline and commits evil, who is like a corpse."

Upāli again said, "Blessed One, suppose that even after the Saṅgha has asked consent and expelled that monk who has broken his moral discipline and commits evil, he so pleases the king and the great ministers by the power of precious wealth, the power of great learning, the power of eloquence, and all sorts of means that they all become allies of that man of bad conduct; and they forcibly reinstate him by their great power, so that the monk who has broken his moral discipline lives together with the Saṅgha. At such a time, what should the Saṅgha do about him?"

The Blessed One said, "At such a time, the monks within the Saṅgha who have scruples, a sense of shame, and moral discipline should, in order to guard their moral discipline, not give rise to aversion toward that monk who has broken his moral discipline, and, without bringing harm upon the king and the great

ministers, should take their leave, abandon that place, and go to another place."

The fourth fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, said this to the Blessed One:

"Venerable Blessed One, in a buddhafield marked by the five degenerations, where no tathāgata dwells, the beings who live there at that time are tormented by afflictions, practice what is unwholesome, and become dull by nature. They are extremely hard to tame: caṇḍāla kṣatriyas (rulers who behave like outcastes), caṇḍāla ministers, caṇḍāla householders, caṇḍāla merchants, caṇḍāla brahmins, and others like them. Their roots of virtue are slight, they have no faith in their minds, and they live by deceit and guile. These fools are conceited about their knowledge, have no fear of the fruit of suffering in the next world, and reject spiritual friends. For the sake of gain and profit they associate with monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil, and they become their companions in conduct contrary to the Dharma, so that all of them, without any doubt, enter and descend into the hell of Unceasing Torment. I go to those places where such beings enter and descend into the hell of Unceasing Torment, and through the Dharma of the buddhas, the blessed ones, for the benefit, happiness and relief of those beings, I teach them with skillful means the unsurpassed and sacred Dharma that is like nectar, guide them to it, and set them to practicing it. Thus I turn them back, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla brahmins, from falling into the hell of Unceasing Torment."

The Blessed One said this to the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha:

"Son of noble family, in the future, in a later time, there will be beings in this buddhafield who are thoroughly consumed by afflictions, who commit evil, and who become childish, deluded and hard to tame: caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, caṇḍāla ministers, caṇḍāla householders, caṇḍāla merchants, caṇḍāla ascetics, caṇḍāla brahmins, and others. Their roots of virtue are slight, they have no faith in their minds, and they live by deceit and guile. They are deluded and conceited about their knowledge. They reject spiritual friends. There is no truth in the words they speak. They do not follow what spiritual friends teach, but despise them and lord it over them, and they beat them down with harsh words. They doubt the sacred Dharma and hold wrong views. They have no fear of the fruit of suffering in the next world. They always delight in

associating with people of bad character. They delight in conduct ranging from killing living beings to holding wrong views. They deceive the world with deceit and guile, and they bring harm upon themselves and others. These, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla brahmins, will destroy my Dharma.

"And there will be those who, though they have gone forth in my teaching, have broken their moral discipline. They are eager to engage in the busy affairs of the world, and are honored with reverence by kṣatriyas, brahmins and others. Greedy for profit and seeking wealth, they speak mere words and do not live by them. They delight in carrying messages back and forth and delivering letters. They engage in trade and the pursuit of profit, study the treatises of the Lokāyata materialists, and delight in the work of plowing fields. They hoard and hide wealth and jewels, and look after houses, wives and children. They subjugate bhūtas with worldly mantras and mudrās, read good and bad omens, and live on the payment they receive for compounding medicines and curing illnesses. They are attached to food, drink, clothing and jeweled ornaments, and delight in doing the work of householders. They have only a semblance of moral discipline while they commit evil, and they behave like dogs at the sound of the conch. Though they are not ascetics, they claim to be ascetics, and though they do not practice pure conduct, they claim to practice pure conduct. The caṇḍāla kṣatriyas through the caṇḍāla brahmins will attend on them, make offerings to them with reverence, and listen to their words. And those who have broken their moral discipline will in turn delight in associating with the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas through the caṇḍāla brahmins, will show them honor and service, and will listen to their words.

"But if some person who has gone forth in my teaching possesses moral discipline and good qualities, whether he is one who applies himself to the stages of training and of no more training or one who has reached the culmination of the fruit, then the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas through the caṇḍāla brahmins will be jealous of him. They will not attend on him, revere him, serve him or make offerings to him, nor will they even listen to his words.

"Son of noble family, it is like this. A certain man goes to an island of jewels, and there he casts aside the jewels indranīla and mahānīla, gold, silver, pearls, rubies, beryl and many other kinds of priceless jewels, and takes glass beads instead. In just the same way, in the future, in this buddhafield, the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas through the caṇḍāla brahmins will do likewise. Having reached the jewel island of the sacred Dharma that I have taught, they will cast aside the assembly of noble ones: persons in training and beyond training who possess

moral discipline and good qualities, who delight in the ultimate, and who have scruples and a sense of shame, as well as ordinary beings endowed with virtuous qualities who strive diligently in the six perfections. Instead they will take as fields of merit the evil monks who have broken their moral discipline, who commit many evil deeds, who have no shame and no scruples, whose speech is coarse and harsh, whose bodies and minds are swollen with pride, who are devoid of pure and wholesome qualities, and who have no loving-kindness and no compassion. They will honor, serve and make offerings to them, and listen to their words. Thus these evil ones, teachers and disciples alike, will without any doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment."

"Son of noble family, there are ten kinds of wheels of evil. In the future, in this buddhafield, if caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, caṇḍāla vassal lords, caṇḍāla householders, caṇḍāla merchants, caṇḍāla ascetics and caṇḍāla brahmins possess some of these ten kinds of wheels of evil, or indeed all of them, then all the roots of virtue they accumulated in the past will be burned and become like ashes. Before long their limbs will be cut to pieces, for many days and nights their tongues will be stiff so that they cannot speak, and they will experience great and unending suffering. And when they have died, they will without any doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment.

"What are the ten? They are as follows. The kṣatriyas, the ministers and others tolerate the wicked views of monks who have thus broken their moral discipline and commit evil. But when, on the other hand, they see pure monks who dwell in the remote forest, they say this about them: 'O sirs, these monks are fools and deluded. They are hypocrites who deceive the world. Out of desire for food, drink, clothing, profit, gain and fame, they praise themselves, disparage others, and stir up discord out of jealousy. They are hungry for profit and fame and never satisfied, so they deserve to be driven out, and you should not listen to their words. These monks speak nothing but lies and are devoid of the true Dharma, so they have not attained any fruit. They are not free of desire, nor have they exhausted the defilements. It is only because they want profit, fame and offerings that they live in the remote forest and present themselves as possessing good qualities. Do not make offerings to them, nor attend on them or show them reverence. They live by deceit and guile; they are not a true field of merit, nor do they apply themselves to the path.' In this way they slander them.

"Then all of them, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla brahmins, no longer give rise to faith toward the pure monks who dwell in the remote forest.

They no longer regard them as rare, and have no wish to show them reverence. They are not inclined to make offerings to them or attend on them; however much those monks teach, they do not listen to their words, but despise and disparage them.

"To despise and disparage in this way the pure monks who dwell in the remote forest is itself to despise and disparage the eye of the Dharma and the lineage of the Three Jewels. Therefore at that time the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, deities and others who dwell in that land, whose minds are pure toward the Three Jewels and whose faith is unshakable, grow angry with all those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla brahmins. Feelings of aversion arise in them, and they say to one another: 'O sirs, look! These caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, vassal lords, householders, merchants, ascetics and caṇḍāla brahmins despise and lord it over all those who carry on the eye of the Dharma and the lineage of the Three Jewels. They have thereby destroyed their own roots of virtue, they have come under the power of unwholesome friends, and through their evil deeds they will fall into the lower realms. From this day on we will not protect them. We will not guard the dwellings, the lands, the cities, or the realm of these caṇḍāla kṣatriyas and the rest.' So saying, all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, deities and others grow weary of them, take no further interest in them, and abandon them.

"Therefore all those dwelling in the lands and cities of the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas and the rest who are vessels of the true Dharma and true fields of merit leave those lands and go away. And if some of them do remain, a wish to give them up arises, since they do not want them, and they have no thought of sheltering and protecting them. In this way the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, deities and others, and all those who are vessels of the true Dharma and fields of merit, have no thought of guarding and sheltering the caṇḍāla kṣatriya and his realm, his lands and his cities. Since they have no thought of guarding and sheltering them, at that time both internal enemies and external enemies rise up against the realm of that land. To seize the kingdom they harm and kill one another, and because of this, disease, famine and other calamities arise.

"Then all those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas through the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and all who live in that land, have no joy or gladness of heart. They are parted from everything that was once pleasing and dear to them. Relatives, companions and friends grow weary of one another and do not wish to meet. They have no loving-kindness and no compassion, but become jealous and miserly and commit many evil deeds: they engage in

everything from killing living beings to holding wrong views, and, without shame or scruple, they use and consume the wealth of stūpas and the wealth of the Saṅgha, without any remorse. That caṇḍāla kṣatriya hates the wise and the upright and favors liars and deceivers, so the ministers and the common people harm one another, nurse grudges and resentment, and fight and quarrel. And when they do battle with a foreign enemy, because those below are not of one mind, they are defeated in battle."

"All those caṇḍālas, the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins and the rest, will before long suffer the decay of their limbs, and for many days and nights their tongues will be mute. They will experience the great suffering of extremely unbearable sickness and fever, and when they have died and passed on, they will without any doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, there are caṇḍālas, caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins and others, who follow evil friends. Their roots of virtue are slight, they live by deceit and guile, they are dull and deluded and conceited about their knowledge, they have no purity of intention toward the Three Jewels, and they do not regard the fruit of suffering in the next world with fear. Among them, some have a little faith in the Śrāvaka Vehicle, yet, being utterly dull by nature, they think, 'No one is more learned or wise than I.' So they despise and disparage, deride and slander the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the Dharma of the Great Vehicle that I have taught, and they will not let other beings keep or hold, read or recite even so much as a single verse of them.

"Among them, some have gained a little faith in the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, yet, being utterly dull by nature, they think, 'No one is wiser or more learned than I.' So they despise and disparage, deride and slander the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Dharma of the Great Vehicle that I have taught, and they will not let other beings keep, hold, read or recite even so much as a single verse of them.

"Among them, some have gained just a little faith in the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, yet, being utterly dull by nature, they think, 'No one is more learned or wise than I.' So they despise and disparage, deride and slander the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle that I have taught, and they will not let other beings keep, hold, read or recite even so much as a single verse of them.

"Such persons are said to despise and slander the sacred Dharma of the buddhas, to lord it over the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the three times, to tear down all the collections of the Dharma of the buddhas of the three times, burning them and destroying them like ashes, to cut off the whole of the noble eightfold path, and to put out the eyes of countless beings.

"If those, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, conceal and obstruct the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and the Dharma of the Great Vehicle taught by the Buddha, so that not even a single verse remains, then such persons show disrespect to all who carry on the eye of the Dharma and the lineage of the Three Jewels. Through that cause and that condition, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, deities and others who protect that land, whose minds are pure toward the Three Jewels and whose faith is unshakable, become angry with all those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla brahmins, and feelings of aversion arise in them; and so on, in full as in the passage above, until: all the caṇḍālas, the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins and the rest, will before long suffer the decay of their limbs, and for many days and nights their tongues will be mute. They will experience the great suffering of extremely unbearable sickness and fever, and when they have died and passed on, they will without any doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, the caṇḍālas, the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins and others, follow monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil; and so on, in full as in the passage above, until: all in that land who are vessels of the Dharma and true fields of merit form the intention to abandon the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas and the rest, and do not shelter or protect them. Even if by chance they remain living in that land, they rely on the Dharma and do not take pleasure in householders or stay with them. They do not go again and again to the homes of patrons, and if they do go for a moment, they guard their speech and keep silent; and if they do speak, there is no falsehood in it. In front of householders they do not deride or despise those who have broken their moral discipline. They do not declare or bring up the faults of those monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil. Always relying on the field of merit, they completely avoid those who have broken their moral discipline.

"Those monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil, in turn, become angry and form feelings of aversion toward those who keep moral

discipline and possess wholesome qualities, and they despise and disparage them. In front of the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas through the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and in front of householder men and women, they tell lies with slander and all kinds of deceit, deriding and slandering those who keep moral discipline and heaping all kinds of abuse upon them. They cause all of them, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla brahmins, to feel aversion and anger toward my disciples, ascetics who have few desires and are content, who keep moral discipline, who are learned and possess eloquence; they make them deride and slander those ascetics with all kinds of harsh words, and so bring them distress of body and mind. Moreover, they have their robes, their alms bowls and their means of livelihood seized, so that they are deprived of a living. Moreover, they have the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions seized and do not allow them to use it. Some they have thrown into prison and put under the constraint of iron chains, fetters, wooden stocks and the like. Some have their limbs cut off, and some they have beheaded.

"Son of noble family, look! In this way those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, relying on monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil, commit all kinds of evil deeds of great wrongdoing such as these, and they will fall even into the hell of Unceasing Torment."

"The evil of any being who has committed the five deeds of immediate retribution, or destroyed the root precepts of moral discipline, or committed an evil close to the deeds of immediate retribution, or any evil by nature or evil by prescription, is lighter than the evil of those, from the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, who rely on those who have broken their moral discipline and act contrary to the Dharma.

"Son of noble family, although such monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil have thus committed great evil contrary to the Dharma, they nevertheless remain within my teaching. They have shaved their hair and beards and wear saffron robes, and their deportment and appearance accord with those of the noble ones. Kings, great ministers and householders are not permitted even to subject them to the laws of householders; how much less to beat them, to fine them, to put them under constraint, to throw them into prison, to abuse and revile them, to cut off their limbs, or to commit the unlawful act of severing their life faculty. If kings, ministers or householders were to do so, they would incur a great evil of wrongdoing and would without any doubt be born in the hell of Unceasing

Torment. If one is not permitted to punish even monks who have broken their moral discipline and commit evil, how much less those who possess moral discipline and practice virtue!

"Son of noble family, though a monk who has broken even one of the root precepts of moral discipline is called a monk who has broken his moral discipline and commits evil, still the vow conferred through the formal act performed by a faithful Saṅgha, as the teaching prescribes, continues unbroken in him. Even if he has given up the training and moral discipline, something of the pure Dharma still remains with him, if only in name. Therefore kings, ministers, householders and those without vows are not permitted to despise or disparage him, or to punish him.

"Such a monk is indeed not a vessel of the Dharma. Because he has fallen from the noble Dharma, he defiles the pure Saṅgha and renders unfit all the formal acts that ascetics are to perform. He has no right to make use of the possessions of the Saṅgha of the four directions. Nevertheless, since he has not given up the vow he obtained when he received full ordination from a harmonious Saṅgha, he is superior to all householders. If this is so even for one who has broken a root precept, what need is there to speak of one who has broken some other minor prescribed precept? Therefore kings, ministers and householders have no right to despise him, disparage him, or punish him.

"Why is that? Son of noble family, in times long past, in the land called Kāśi, there was a king called Brahmadatta. He commanded five caṇḍālas, saying, 'Today, near the Snowy Mountains, there is an elephant with six tusks called Upāli's Eye. Pull out its tusks and bring them to me. If you do not get them, do not hope to stay alive!'

"Then, to save their bodies and their lives, those caṇḍālas each took up a bow and arrows, put on dyed robes, disguised themselves as ascetics, and went to the place near the Snowy Mountains where the king of the elephants was. When they arrived, a female elephant saw them first. Frightened by those men carrying bows and arrows, she ran to the king of the elephants and said, 'Great lord, do you not see? Some men are approaching, carrying bows and arrows and creeping slowly along. Surely they will not bring danger to our lives?'

"The king of the elephants raised his head and looked, and when he saw men coming with shaven heads and beards, wearing dyed robes, he spoke these verses to the female elephant:

'These who wear the robe, the victory banner
Of buddhas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River,
Have completely given up all evil,
And so they surely do no harm to beings.'

"Then the female elephant also answered in verse:

'Though they make themselves look like wearers of the robe,
Since all of them carry bows and arrows in their hands,
These are pitiless and savage men,
Caṇḍālas bent on doing evil.'

"Then the king of the elephants spoke these verses:

'Since they appear wearing the patched robe,
They are the very root of loving-kindness and compassion.
Because they love and cherish all beings,
They have surely gone for refuge to the Buddha.
You should have no doubt about this,
But would do well to quickly take them to heart.
These who wear the dyed robes
Are the ones who free us from the ocean of saṃsāra.'

"Then at that moment those caṇḍālas shot a poisoned arrow at the king of the elephants, and it struck his heart, just as they had aimed. Then the female elephant let out a great cry and wept, and, her voice choked with sobs, she spoke these verses:

'Those who wear the robes,
I thought, had gone for refuge to the Buddha.
Though their appearance seemed so peaceful,
They nursed a vicious mind within.
To utterly destroy this enemy
Who shot an arrow at my lord's body,
I shall quickly trample his whole body
And sever him from his life faculty.'

"Then the king of the elephants spoke these verses:

'It is easier to be parted from the breath of life
Than it is right to give rise to an evil thought.
Though these have deceitful minds,
In appearance they are like the disciples of the Buddha.

The mind of the wise is perfectly pure;
Not for the sake of one's own life,
But in order to deliver many beings,
One always practices the conduct of awakening.'

"At that time the king of the elephants, his heart filled with tender love, said to those men, 'What do you want from me?' They said, 'We want your tusks.'"

"The king of the elephants, his heart filled with joy, pulled out his tusks, gave them to the men, and spoke this verse:

'Without any thought of anger or begrudging,
I give you these white tusks of mine.
Through the merit of this gift, may I attain perfect awakening
And bring peace to the sickness of beings' afflictions.'

"Son of noble family, look how in times past even that king of the elephants, though born in the animal realm, out of desire for unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening gave up his body and life without attachment, and, in order to serve and honor those who wore the robe, did not retaliate even though they treated him as an enemy.

"In the future, the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics and caṇḍāla brahmins, though they are utterly dull by nature, will be conceited about their slight knowledge. They will live by deceit and guile and deceive the world, and since they do not regard the fruit of suffering in the next world with fear, they will harm and injure all those who have taken refuge in my teaching and gone forth, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not. They will abuse and revile them, fine them, beat them, throw them into prison, and go so far as to sever them from their life faculty. In doing so they commit a great wrong that violates the commitment of the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future and the present, and they will without any doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment. Since they have completely burned up their roots of virtue and cut off their continuity, all the wise should shun them entirely.

"Yet even though they have committed such great evil and wrongdoing, they live by deceit and guile, and, under the sway of pride, in order to deceive the world, each of them says, 'We too aspire to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening. We shall attain full awakening through the Great Vehicle.'

"For example, it is impossible for a man who has gouged out his own eyes and become blind to climb a great mountain in order to show others the way. In the same way, in the future, at a later time, the caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics and caṇḍāla brahmins will be like that. They will harm and injure the disciples who have taken refuge in my teaching and gone forth, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not; they will abuse and revile them, beat them, throw them into prison, and go so far as to sever them from their life faculty. Because they have thereby committed a great wrong that violates the commitment of all the buddhas of the past, the future and the present, they have burned up all their roots of virtue and cut off their continuity, and they will without any doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment. Therefore the wise should shun them. Yet even though they have committed such great wrongs, they live by deceit and guile, and, under the sway of pride, in order to deceive the world, they say, 'We are seeking unsurpassed awakening. We too shall attain full awakening through the Great Vehicle.' Because they have harmed and injured those who have gone forth in this way, they will not obtain even the body of the lowest of the low, let alone the awakening of the two vehicles or the unsurpassed vehicle. Their good fortune is cut off.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, in times long past, in the land called Pañcāla, there was a king called Victor over Foes, who held power and ruled the realm of that land. There was a great charnel ground there called Khalampa, a most terrifying place, where many yakṣas and rākṣasas dwelled. Anyone who went there would be terrified, and their hair would stand on end. In that land, whenever there was a criminal to be executed, the one condemned to death by the king's law would be bound with the five bonds and taken to that great charnel ground called Khalampa, where he would be left for the rākṣasas and bhūtas to eat.

"One condemned man, to save his life, shaved his hair and beard, and tied to his neck a scrap of a monk's robe that he had found. The jailer led him away, bound him with the five bonds according to the king's law, and took him to that great charnel ground. After those who had escorted him had turned back, that night a great rākṣasī called Weapon Eye arrived at the charnel ground with a retinue of five thousand. The man saw her from afar and was terrified and afraid. Then that rākṣasī saw the man bound with the five bonds, his hair and beard shaved, with a scrap of a monk's robe tied to his neck. She circled him, keeping him to her right, bowed to him with reverence, joined her palms,

and spoke these verses:

'Sir, do not fear; remain at ease.
We will do you no harm.
Seeing you with shaven head and wearing the robe,
We have come to recollect the Buddha.'

"Then the rākṣasī's children said to their mother:

'We are so hungry and thirsty
That our bodies and minds are tormented.
To ease our bodies and minds,
Mother, please allow us to eat this man.'

"Then the rākṣasī said to her children:

'If one gives rise to unwholesome and evil thoughts
Toward one who wears the robe, the victory banner of liberation
Of buddhas as numerous as the sands of the Ganges River,
One will surely fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment.'

"Then the rākṣasī, together with her children and retinue, circled around him, bowed to him with reverence, joined her palms, and spoke these verses:

'Wearer of the dyed robe, we each confess before you.
It would be easier for us
To commit unwholesome deeds of body, speech and mind
Against our father and mother
Than ever to do you harm.'

"Then another great rākṣasī, called Donkey Tooth, arrived at the charnel ground with a retinue of five thousand. She too saw the man bound with the five bonds, his hair and beard shaved, with a scrap of a monk's robe tied to his neck. She circled him, bowed to him with reverence, joined her palms, and spoke these verses:

'Sir, I bid you, do not fear; remain at ease.
This scrap of cloth tied to your neck
Is the victory banner, the garment of the great sage.
To it we make offerings and bow.'

"Then that rākṣasī's children said to their mother:"

'Nothing is more delicious than human flesh and blood;
From it the strength of body and mind arises and grows,

Making one exceedingly brave, bold, and fearless.
Mother, we beg you, let us feast on him.'

"Then the rākṣasī said to her children:

'All the riches that gods and humans enjoy
Are obtained through those who have gone forth.
Therefore, by making offerings to this one who wears the Dharma robe,
One will attain happiness beyond measure.'

"Then the rākṣasī's children, together with their retinue, circled him, bowed to him with reverence, joined their palms, and spoke these verses:

'To this person with shaven head who wears the Dharma robe
We bow with the deepest reverence.
May we always, throughout all times to come,
See the buddhas and give rise to faith.'

"At that time another great rākṣasī, called Frowning Forelock, arrived at the charnel ground with a retinue of five thousand. She too saw the man bound with the five bonds, his hair and beard shaved, with a scrap of a monk's robe tied to his neck. She circled him to the right, bowed to him with reverence, joined her palms, and spoke these verses:

'This garment of the great sage, his victory banner,
Is highly praised and extolled by all the wise.
Whoever makes offerings to it
Will surely be freed from all the bonds of existence.'

"Then that rākṣasī's children said to their mother:

'All the flesh and blood of this man's body
The great king has dedicated to us.
Please let us eat and drink of him;
Grown strong, we will serve you, mother, as well.'

"Then the rākṣasī said to her children:

'Those who wear the Dharma robe, even one merely tied on,
Are not fit for you to eat.
If you give rise to unwholesome, evil thoughts toward him,
You will surely become vessels of great suffering.'

"Then the rākṣasī's children, together with their retinue, circled him, bowed to him with reverence, joined their palms, and spoke these verses:

'You wear the garment of the great sage
And have become a supreme field of merit.
Therefore, by our making offerings to you,
May we be freed from the bonds of existence.'

"At that time yet another great rākṣasī, called Weapon Face, arrived at the charnel ground with a retinue of five thousand. She too saw the man bound with the five bonds, his hair and beard shaved, with a scrap of a monk's robe tied to his neck. She circled him, bowed to him with reverence, joined her palms, and spoke these verses:

'Since you wear the Dharma robe tied upon you,
You are certain to attain the bliss of nirvāṇa.
So if we were to do you harm,
We fear that all the buddhas would condemn us.'

"Then that rākṣasī's children said to their mother:

'We always steal the vital luster of humans,
And likewise eat their flesh and drink their blood,
So that our form and our power may fully grow.
Please let us feast on this one as we please.'

"Then the rākṣasī said to her children:

'If you harm this one with hair and beard shaved off
Who wears the Dharma robe,
You will surely fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment
And long be a vessel of great suffering.'

"Then the rākṣasī, together with her children and retinue, circled him, bowed to him with reverence, joined their palms, and spoke these verses:

'We are terrified of the hells,
And so we will not harm your life.
We will untie these bonds and set you free;
May we be freed from all the sufferings of hell.'

"Then the rākṣasī mothers and their children, together with their retinues, gave rise to compassion, untied the man's bonds, asked his forgiveness, cheered him, and sent him back. Early the next morning the man came before

the king and reported in detail all that had happened. When King Victor over Foes and his retinue heard this, they were filled with faith and struck with wonder. He made it law and decreed to the people of his land: 'From this day forth, if anyone in my land mocks or harms a disciple of the Buddha, whether one who keeps moral discipline, one whose discipline is broken, or, at the very least, one who has no moral discipline but has shaved hair and beard and wears saffron robes, all such people shall be put to death.' By that cause and condition many people, delighting in merit, gradually turned toward the teaching, and all the people of Jambudvīpa under that king's rule took refuge in the Three Jewels with sincere intention.

"Son of noble family, so it was that in the past even rākṣasīs born in the lineage of hungry ghosts, stealers of vital luster, eaters of flesh and blood, greedy for evil and without compassion, circled such a man without moral discipline, with hair and beard shaved and a scrap of a Dharma robe tied to his neck, showed him reverence, served him, bowed to him, made offerings to him, and praised him in verse, and had no thought of harming him. Yet in times to come, caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, caṇḍāla brahmins, and others, harboring malicious minds and devoid of compassion, will commit evil worse than yakṣas and rākṣasas. Foolish and deluded, cutting off their roots of virtue, they will show no faith or respect toward disciples who have gone forth in my teaching and who, with hair and beard shaved, wear saffron robes, whether they have become vessels of the Dharma or not. Instead they will harm them, revile and beat them, threaten them harshly, cast them into prison, and go so far as to deprive them of life. Such people contravene the great prohibition taught by all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present. Having utterly burned up their roots of virtue and cut off their continuity, they will without doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment. Therefore the wise should utterly avoid this.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, long ago there was a king called Great Merit. Because that king was greatly compassionate, he did not like to execute even those whose crimes had brought them to the point of execution. At that time a wise minister said to the king:

"'Your Majesty, do not be troubled. There is a way to put that man to death by which the king will not incur the evil of taking life, and the executioner too will not have to kill him.' Having said this, the great minister placed the man condemned to death before a vicious elephant in rut. The elephant seized the

man with its trunk, lifted him up, and was about to dash him to the ground, when it saw that the man was wearing red cloth. Thinking, 'This is a Dharma robe,' it gave rise to faith with a pure mind and gently set him down on the ground. Then, regretting what it had done, it knelt to the ground, stroked the man's feet with its trunk, and with reverence gazed at him without blinking. When the great minister saw what had happened, he ran to the king and told him all of it. Hearing this, the king was startled and struck with wonder, and he decreed to all his people that from that day forth they must show reverence to the Three Jewels. By that cause and condition he also gave up taking life, and came to rule over Jambudvīpa.

"See, son of noble family: in the past even an elephant in rut, born among animals, did no evil, out of respect for the Dharma robe. Yet in times to come caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, caṇḍāla brahmins, and others, with malicious minds and no compassion, will commit evil deeds worse than that elephant in rut. Those childish fools will show no faith or respect toward those who have gone forth in my teaching, whether they have become vessels of the Dharma or not, who have shaved their hair and beard and wear saffron robes. Instead they will harm them, revile and abuse them, beat and strike them, cast them into prison, and go so far as to deprive them of life. By this they contravene the great prohibition taught by all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future, and the present. Having burned up their roots of virtue and cut off their continuity, they will without doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment. Therefore the wise should avoid this.

"If caṇḍāla kings, and so on up to caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, possess these three wheels of evil, then by that cause and condition all the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and others who protect the land, whose intention toward the Three Jewels is pure and whose faith is unshakable, will give rise to anger and hostility toward those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kings up to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and so on, as given in full in the text before. All those caṇḍālas, the caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins, and the rest, will before long have the limbs of their bodies cut to pieces, will be struck dumb for many days, and will experience the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. And when they die and pass on, they will fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, in times to come, here in this buddha field, there will be caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics,

caṇḍāla brahmins, and others who rely on evil friends, whose roots of virtue are slight and weak, and so on, as given in full before, and who do not see the suffering of the world beyond. They will seize the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions, the property of monasteries, property dedicated to monasteries, parks, property dedicated to parks, fields and pastures, and property dedicated to fields and pastures. They will seize the men and women who serve as attendants of the various monasteries; they will seize wealth and livestock, clothing and alms food, mats and seats, and medicine for the sick, and they will seize all the various other requisites of life. The property thus offered to the Saṅgha of the four directions is to be granted solely for the use of pure monks: those endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, who exert diligence, who earnestly apply themselves on the paths of training and of no more training, up to those who have attained the fruit of reaching the final state. Yet those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kings up to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, puffed up with their might and their armies, will seize it by force. They will not let pure monks endowed with moral discipline use it, but will give it to monks whose discipline is broken, who do evil, who live in households and do the work of householders. Some of them use it in common; some use it privately for themselves. And monks of broken discipline, hearing of this, likewise use it, some in common and some privately for themselves, while some give it to householders and share it with them. By that cause and condition the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and others who protect the land, whose intention toward the Three Jewels is pure and whose faith is unshakable, become angry and give rise to hostility toward those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kings up to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and so on, as given in full before. Those caṇḍālas, the caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins, and the rest, will before long have the limbs of their bodies cut to pieces, will be struck dumb for many days, and will experience the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. And when they die and pass on, they will without doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, in times to come, here in this buddha field, there will be caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, caṇḍāla brahmins, and others who rely on evil friends, whose roots of virtue are slight and weak, and so on, as given in full before, and who do not see the fruit of suffering in the world beyond. They will revile and abuse, disparage, mock, slander, oppress, and harm a Dharma preacher who has gone forth in

my teaching, who is sharp in wisdom and greatly learned, whose speech is perfect in words and meaning, who is able to teach the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, or who has realized and is able to teach the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, or who is able to teach the Dharma of the Unsurpassed Vehicle and to teach it extensively for the benefit and happiness of beings; and they will obstruct his teaching of the Dharma.

"By that cause and condition the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and others who protect the land, whose intention toward the Three Jewels is pure and whose faith is unshakable, become angry and give rise to hostility toward those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kings up to the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and so on, as given in full in the text before. All those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kings to the ministers, householders, ascetics, brahmins, and the rest, will before long have their own bodies cut to pieces, will be struck dumb for many days, and will experience the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. And when they die and pass on, they will without doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, in times to come, here in this buddha field, there will be caṇḍālas, caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins, and others, who rely on evil friends, whose roots of virtue are weak and slight, and so on, as given in full before, and who do not look with fear upon the fruit of suffering in the world beyond. They will seize the property offered to the Saṅgha of the four directions: the fields and pastures of the monasteries, wealth and livestock, jewels, flowering trees, fruit trees, trees for dyes, shade trees, fragrant trees, medicinal trees, and the like, and all the various other requisites of life. Such things are to be used only by my disciples, the pure monks endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, who exert diligence, who earnestly apply themselves on the paths of training and of no more training, up to those close to attaining the fruit of reaching the final state. Yet caṇḍāla kings, caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and others, puffed up with their might and their armies, seize these things by force, or have others seize them, or use them themselves, or let others use them. By that cause and condition the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and others who protect the land, whose intention toward the Three Jewels is pure and whose faith is unshakable, become angry and give rise to hostility toward the caṇḍāla kings, caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and the rest, and so on, as given in full before. All those caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, caṇḍāla brahmins, and the rest will before long have the limbs of their bodies cut to

pieces, will be struck dumb for many days, and will experience the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. And when they die and pass on, they will without doubt fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, in times to come, here in this buddha field, there will be caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, caṇḍāla brahmins, and others who rely on evil friends, whose roots of virtue are slight and weak, whose intentions are impure, who live by deceit and guile, who are foolish and deluded, proud of a mere smattering of knowledge, without truth in their words, who reject spiritual friends, rely on evil companions, and practice what is unwholesome, who doubt the Dharma of the noble ones, and who do not look with fear upon the fruit of suffering in the world beyond. They delight in keeping vows of evil, are drawn to everything from taking life to wrong view, are possessed by pride, and deceive worldly people. These caṇḍāla kings, caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and others, who claim, 'I abide in the vows of moral discipline,' will destroy my teaching by all sorts of means. Again and again they will rage at those who have gone forth in my teaching, revile them, abuse and disparage them, oppress them harshly, cast them into prison, cut off their limbs, and go so far as to deprive them of life. Having no faith in the Dharma I have taught, they destroy stūpas, destroy monasteries, force monks back into lay life, and obstruct people from shaving their hair and beard and putting on saffron robes; they force those who have gone forth to do all kinds of work and make them their servants. By that cause and condition the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, and others who protect the land, whose intention toward the Three Jewels is pure and whose faith is unshakable, become angry and give rise to hostility toward the caṇḍāla kings and the caṇḍāla ascetics and brahmins, and so on, as given in full before. Those caṇḍālas, the caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins, and the rest, will before long have all the limbs of their bodies cut to pieces, will be struck dumb for many days, and will experience the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. And when they die and pass on, they will without doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment.

"Son of noble family, if these caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins, and others possess even some of these ten kinds of wheels of evil that have been described, all the roots of virtue they accumulated before will be burned up like ashes and vanish. Before long the limbs of their bodies will be cut to pieces, they will be struck dumb for many days, and they will experience the great suffering of utterly unbearable

sickness and fever. And when they die, they will fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment. In times to come, it will be hard for these caṇḍāla kings, ministers, householders, merchants, ascetics, brahmins, and others even to obtain the body of the lowest and most wretched of humans, let alone to attain the awakening of the two vehicles or unsurpassed awakening; they are utterly without the fortune for it. When it is hard for such evil ones even to hear the name of the Great Vehicle, what need is there to speak of their attaining the fruit of unsurpassed, complete awakening? Because such a person has for a long time made himself unfit and has made others unfit as well, even all the buddhas are unable to protect him.

"Son of noble family, consider this: when someone works at pressing oil from seeds, each and every seed has become a living creature, and the oil comes out only when they are crushed. Look at how many beings that oil presser kills in a single day! Suppose such a seed-oil presser set up ten oil-pressing places, and in each of them pressed a thousand loads of seed every day without interruption for a full thousand years. Would that person's harmful deeds of taking life be very many?"

The bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, replied, "Very many, Blessed One, very many! Sugata, that person's killing is beyond measure and beyond reckoning, and his harmful deeds cannot be weighed, counted, numbered, or even illustrated by example. The Tathāgata alone knows them; no one else does."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, consider this: suppose some man, for the sake of wealth and profit, set up ten brothels, placed a thousand prostitutes in each of them, adorned each of those women with all kinds of ornaments, and had them entice people and engage in acts of lust without interruption for a thousand years. That person's harmful evil would be immeasurable, beyond reckoning, counting, or even illustration by example. The evil of the ten seed-oil-pressing places equals the evil of setting up a single brothel.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, consider this: suppose some person, for the sake of wealth and profit, set up ten taverns, adorned each of them lavishly with all kinds of ornaments, and in each of them, by all sorts of means, lured in a thousand people fond of liquor, plied them with drink, and made merry day and night without interruption for a thousand years. That person's evil too would be immeasurable, beyond reckoning, counting, or even illustration by

example. The evil of the ten brothels described above equals the evil of setting up a single tavern.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, consider this: suppose some person, for the sake of wealth and profit, set up ten slaughterhouses, and in each of them every day slaughtered a thousand each of cattle, sheep, camels, deer, fowl, and pigs, without interruption for a thousand years. That person's harmful evil too would be immeasurable, beyond reckoning, counting, or even illustration by example. Thus the evil of the ten taverns described before equals the evil of setting up a single slaughterhouse. And the evil of those ten slaughterhouses is equal to the harmful evil of a single day for those caṇḍālas, from the caṇḍāla kings up to the caṇḍāla ascetics, brahmins, and the rest, if they possess even some of the ten wheels of evil."

Then the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"The evil of ten oil-pressing places
Equals the evil of a single brothel.
The evil of ten brothels
Equals the evil of a single tavern.
Ten taverns
Equal the evil of a single slaughterhouse.
Ten slaughterhouses set up
Equal the evil of a single caṇḍāla king."

The fifth fascicle.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, said to the Blessed One, "Venerable Blessed One, there may be virtuous kings, virtuous ministers, virtuous householders, virtuous merchants, virtuous ascetics, and virtuous brahmins who take good care of themselves and take good care of others as well, who are wary of the world beyond, and who abide in the teaching of the Buddha. With the deepest reverence they serve and make offerings to those who have gone forth, whether they have become vessels of the Dharma or have not become vessels of the Dharma, or, at the very least, are without moral discipline but have shaved their hair and beard and wear saffron robes. Moreover, with reverence they make offerings to the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, listen to it, retain it, and honor it. They protect persons who abide in the Great Vehicle, who are endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, who exert diligence and apply themselves earnestly, up to those who

abide in the fruit, and they lend them the support of their power. They ask them questions and inquire of them, listen to them and retain what they hear, and converse and talk with them gladly. They keep far away from monks of broken discipline who do evil. They protect the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions carefully and do not let outsiders squander it. They do not themselves steal the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions or the property of stūpas, nor have others steal it; they do not themselves make use of it, nor have others make use of it. With reverence they honor preachers of the Dharma of the three vehicles and lend them the support of their power; they do not let outsiders mock, slander, or disparage them, but serve them and encourage them. Out of faith they protect and care for those who have gone forth and the Dharma of the Buddha's teaching. They do not destroy stūpas, and they carefully protect the dwellings of the Saṅgha and the monasteries. They neither despise nor disparage persons who have gone forth, who have shaved hair and beard and wear saffron robes. They themselves do not engage in the ten kinds of wheels of evil, and they keep others far away from the ten wheels of evil. They govern the kingdom according to the Dharma and customs of the kings of old; they carry on the lineage of the Three Jewels, have faith in it, and make it flourish. They always rely on spiritual friends and care for all the people with a mind of loving-kindness, and they guide and teach everyone by whatever Dharma will tame each of them.

"And they lead others to give up wrong views and apply themselves earnestly to the true Dharma. How much merit will those virtuous ones, from the virtuous kings up to the virtuous brahmins, obtain, and how much evil will they be purified of?"

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, suppose a single person of great power appeared in the world. In the morning he filled the whole of Jambudvīpa with the seven kinds of precious things and offered them to the Buddha and the Saṅgha; at noon he again filled the whole of Jambudvīpa with the seven kinds of precious things and offered them to the Buddha and the Saṅgha; and in the evening he again filled the whole of Jambudvīpa with the seven kinds of precious things and offered them to the Buddha and the Saṅgha. If he gave such gifts in this way every single day without interruption for a hundred thousand years, would that person's accumulation of merit be great?"

The bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, replied, "Exceedingly great, Blessed One, exceedingly great! Sugata, that person's accumulation of merit is

beyond measure and beyond reckoning; it cannot be expressed, reckoned, counted, or even illustrated by example. The Buddha alone knows it; no one else does."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, so it is, so it is; it is just as you have said. Yet if any of those, from the virtuous kings up to the virtuous brahmins, do not themselves engage in the ten kinds of wheels of evil and also teach others who do engage in them to give up the ten wheels of evil, their heap of merit is greater than that former heap of merit: immeasurable, beyond reckoning, and impossible to express, reckon, count, or even illustrate by example.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, consider this: suppose a single person of great power appeared in the world and, for the sake of the Saṅgha of the four directions, built monasteries and dwellings, excellent and spacious, as vast as the four continents. He furnished all those places with everything needed: seats, robes, alms food, medicine for the sick, and all the requisites of life. Then, while the Tathāgata and the whole great assembly of his close disciples, the śrāvakas and bodhisattvas, dwelled there, he made offerings and paid homage to them without interruption, diligently applying himself to all kinds of virtuous deeds, day and night without laziness, for hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of years. Would that person's heap of merit be exceedingly great?"

The bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, replied, "Exceedingly great, Blessed One, exceedingly great! Sugata, that person's heap of merit is beyond measure and beyond reckoning; it cannot be expressed, reckoned, counted, or even illustrated by example. The Buddha alone knows it; no one else does."

The Blessed One said, "So it is, so it is; it is just as you have said.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, consider this: suppose a single person of great power appeared in the world and, for the sake of the Saṅgha of the four directions, built monasteries and dwellings, excellent and spacious, as vast as ten four-continent worlds. He furnished all those places with everything needed: seats, robes, alms food, medicines, and all the requisites of life. Then, while the Tathāgata and all the close disciples of the great Saṅgha of śrāvakas and bodhisattvas dwelled there, he made offerings and paid homage to them without interruption, diligently applying himself to all kinds of virtuous deeds, day and night without laziness, for hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of years. Would that person's heap of merit be exceedingly great?"

The bodhisattva, the great being Kṣitigarbha, replied, "Exceedingly great, Blessed One, exceedingly great! Sugata, that person's heap of merit is beyond measure and beyond reckoning; it cannot be expressed, reckoned, counted, or even illustrated by example. The Buddha alone knows it; no one else does."

The Blessed One said, "Son of noble family, so it is, so it is; it is just as you have said.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, consider this: suppose a single person of great power appeared in the world and, for the Buddha's relics, built a stūpa exceedingly beautiful, lofty, and vast, as large as a great trichiliocosm, a world system of a billion worlds. The heap of merit from building a stūpa for the Buddha's relics is greater than the heap of merit from building monasteries and dwellings for the Saṅgha of the four directions, as described before. That earlier merit does not come near even a hundredth part of it, nor even a thousandth part, nor even a hundred-thousandth part, nor even a koṭi-th part, nor even a niyuta-th part. It does not come near even a fraction expressible by number, by calculation, by measure, by example, or by cause.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, consider this: suppose this great trichiliocosm were completely filled with great arhats, every one of whom had attained the perfections, possessed the eight liberations, and was absorbed in meditative concentration, packed together like rice seedlings, sesame plants, bamboo, reeds, or a grove of sugarcane. Suppose all of them had been bound with the five bonds for a hundred thousand koṭis of years, and then a single person of great power appeared in the world. Wishing for merit, he untied all their bonds, washed all those arhats with scented water, and offered them Dharma robes and alms bowls for a hundred thousand years, and also gave them, just as they wished, dwellings, seats, clothing, alms food, medicine for the sick, and all the various requisites of life. And when those arhats had passed into nirvāṇa, he made offerings to them, cremated them, gathered their relics, and placed them inside stūpas made of the seven kinds of precious things.

Furthermore, the heap of merit from building stūpas for the relics of the buddhas is greater than the heap of merit from making offerings with jeweled victory banners, flags, parasols, incense, flowers, and music of every kind. Yet compared with the merit of untying the bonds of the arhats and making offerings to them, it does not come near even a hundredth part; it does not come near even a thousandth part; it does not come near even a

hundred-thousandth part; it does not come near even a koṭi-th part; it does not come near even a niyuta-th part; and so on, until it does not come near any part that can be reckoned, counted, measured, compared, or likened.

Son of good family, if anyone, from a virtuous kṣatriya up to a virtuous brahmin, does not himself commit the ten wheels of evil and also counsels others, saying, "Do not engage in the ten wheels of evil," then his heap of merit is greater, immeasurably, incalculably, inexpressibly, than all of those earlier heaps of merit; and as much merit as arises, so much evil is also exhausted.

Son of good family, suppose there is a virtuous kṣatriya, or a virtuous minister, a householder, a merchant chief, a śramaṇa, or a virtuous brahmin who, in the future, in the last five hundred years, when the true Dharma is close to perishing, carefully guards the Dharma eye that I have taught, keeps himself well restrained, and also protects others. Mindful of the world to come, he treats the disciples who have gone forth in my teaching with great conscientiousness, whether they have become vessels of the Dharma or have not become vessels of the Dharma, and even if, in the end, they are without moral discipline: since they have shaved their hair and beards and wear saffron robes, he honors them with respect and does them no harm.

Or again, he carefully guards the true Dharma of the three vehicles, listening to it and retaining it. When he reveres the Dharma of the śrāvakas, he neither disparages nor denigrates the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and of the Great Vehicle, and he does not grow jealous of the followers of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle or of the Great Vehicle. When he serves the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, listening to it and retaining it, he neither disparages nor denigrates the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and of the Great Vehicle, and he does not grow jealous of the Śrāvaka Vehicle or of the Great Vehicle. When he serves the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, listening to it and retaining it, he neither despises nor denigrates the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he does not grow jealous of the followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle or of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle; yet he does not make the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle his own realization. He realizes the genuine Dharma of the Great Vehicle itself.

Abiding in the Great Vehicle, he constantly attends upon those persons who keep moral discipline, who possess good qualities, and who apply themselves

earnestly, from those who have begun to exert diligence up to those who abide in the fruit. He serves them, makes offerings to them, and honors them with a mind of faith, questioning them, listening to them, and retaining what they teach. He keeps far away from monks of corrupted discipline who engage in evil. He does not allow the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions, offered out of faith, to be wasted in ways contrary to the Dharma. He does not himself make free use of the property of the Saṅgha of the four directions, of the stūpas, or of the Saṅgha's own share, nor does he let others make free use of it. He venerates with great respect the persons who teach the Dharma of the three vehicles and lends them his strength, and he does not allow others to disparage, denigrate, or revile them. With deep faith he encourages those who have gone forth. He has faith in the noble word spoken by the Tathāgata and upholds it. He does not destroy stūpas. He maintains the monasteries that are the dwelling places of the Saṅgha of the ten directions. He does not oppress the disciples who have gone forth in my teaching, nor force them back into the household life. He does not himself engage in the ten kinds of wheels of evil, and he counsels others, saying, "Abandon the ten kinds of wheels of evil completely." He lives by the Dharma customs and governance of the former kings, gathering together and instructing many people of the world in the ten courses of virtuous action. He always relies on spiritual friends. He carries on the lineage of the Three Jewels and makes it flourish greatly. And he guards the Dharma eye so that it never sets.

Such people, from virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins, since they possess such qualities as these, will not see their livelihood and their enjoyments come to ruin. Gods, humans, yakṣas, pretas, kaṭapūtanas, and all the rest will rejoice in them and will protect and guard them with minds of loving-kindness. All the genuine fields of merit who have become vessels of the Dharma will also rejoice in them, and will protect and care for them with minds of compassion.

Through that cause and that condition, the land in which they dwell and all its people will become ever more prosperous and exceedingly happy. Foreign enemies will be unable to harm them; all will heed their commands and live together in harmony, undefeated. Because of this, they will strive ever more in the side of virtue, and the stream of nonvirtue will dry up completely. Because gods, humans, and others will flourish and protect them on every side, their lives will become very long. They will vanquish their own afflictions and crush the afflictions of others as well. By fully taking up the six perfections, the path

of the bodhisattvas, they will destroy every evil path of wrong view, and so turn back from their long wandering in the ocean of saṃsāra. They will abandon evil friends and always rely on spiritual friends. In every place where they are born, they will meet buddhas and bodhisattvas, attend upon them, and make offerings to them without interruption. And before long, just as they intend, in whatever buddha-field they please, they will become fully and manifestly awakened in unsurpassed, perfect, complete awakening.

Then at that time, from within that assembly, all the lords of the gods with their retinues, up to all the lords of the piśācas with their retinues, rose from their seats, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, joined their palms, and respectfully addressed the Blessed One with these words:

"Venerable Blessed One, in the time to come, in the last five hundred years, when the true Dharma in this buddha-field is close to utter destruction, suppose there are any, from virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins, who themselves completely abandon the ten wheels of evil and also counsel others, saying, 'Abandon them completely'; who are skilled in protecting themselves and others, skilled in being mindful of the world to come; who guard the true Dharma, and carry on the lineage of the Three Jewels and make it flourish without interruption; and so on, in short, just as the Blessed One has taught, those persons and the rest, who listen with respect to the Dharma of the three vehicles and retain it, and never conceal it; who carefully protect and make offerings to persons abiding in the three vehicles and do them no harm; who carefully protect the wealth and goods of the Three Jewels and do not let them be lost. To those, from virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins, we and our retinues will give protection and shelter, and we will cause these ten things also to arise and increase for them.

"What are the ten? Long life; and the arising and increase of freedom from obstacles, the arising and increase of freedom from illness, the arising and increase of a retinue, the arising and increase of wealth and jewels, the arising and increase of the requisites of life, the arising and increase of rank, the arising and increase of renown, the arising and increase of virtuous companions, and the arising and increase of wisdom. Venerable Blessed One, if those from virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins completely abandon the ten kinds of wheels of evil, counsel others too to abandon them, and possess the qualities mentioned before, then we will protect and shelter them, and these ten things too will arise and increase.

"Moreover, Blessed One, whoever, from virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins, possesses those qualities mentioned before, we and our retinues will protect and shelter, and we will make them entirely free of these ten things. What are the ten? Namely: freedom from all hostile enemies; freedom from unpleasant objects of form, sound, smell, taste, and touch; freedom from all fevers and diseases; freedom from all wrong grasping and evil views; freedom from going for refuge to what is false; freedom from all false and evil omens; freedom from all false and evil deeds; freedom from all false and evil friends; freedom from all the mire of the household life; and freedom from all sudden, untimely death. Venerable Blessed One, if any, from exceedingly virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins, possess the qualities spoken of before, we and our retinues will protect and shelter them, and we will cause them to obtain these ten things of freedom.

"Moreover, Blessed One, whoever, from virtuous kṣatriyas up to virtuous brahmins, applies himself earnestly to perfecting the qualities spoken of before, we and our retinues will strive to protect and shelter. And we will make the king with his retinue, and all the people dwelling in that land, entirely free of these ten things. What are the ten? Freedom from all enemies of foreign lands; freedom from all enemies within one's own land; freedom from all inauspicious pretas; freedom from drought; freedom from harmful rains; freedom from all untimely heat, cold, wind, violent rain, frost, and harmful hail; freedom from all planets and ill omens that have turned malign; freedom from all the harms of famine; freedom from untimely death through disease; and freedom from all wrong grasping and evil views. Venerable Blessed One, if a virtuous kṣatriya king applies himself earnestly to all those qualities spoken of before and brings them to perfection, we and our retinues will strive to protect and shelter him, and we will cause the king with his retinue, and all the people dwelling in that land, to obtain these ten things of freedom."

Then the Blessed One praised the lords of the gods with their retinues, up to the lords of the piśācas with their retinues, saying, "Excellent, excellent! These matters to which you have so pledged yourselves are right for you to do; and by that cause and that condition, they will also bring you benefit and happiness for a long time."

Then the great Brahmā Devagarbha further addressed the Blessed One with these words: "For the sake of all the virtuous kṣatriyas in this buddha-field in the time to come, I offer these dhāraṇīs, whose resolve to protect the land never turns back. Through the splendor and power of the words of this great

dhāraṇī-mantra called the Irreversible Wheel, for the full protection of the land, in the time to come in this buddha-field all virtuous kṣatriya kings will be unassailable by any hostile enemy, and all hostile enemies will be pacified and turn back of their own accord. Their actions of body, speech, and mind will be well restrained, and they will be extolled and praised by the wise. They will completely abandon evil things and always apply themselves earnestly to virtuous things. They will always abandon evil views and evil partisanship, and with steadfast diligence and great exertion they will apply themselves earnestly to the Great Vehicle. They will bring to full maturity immeasurable, countless sentient beings who have become vessels. Not depending on others for their understanding, they will become wise by nature; and by applying themselves earnestly to perfecting the precious treasury of the six perfections, they will completely abandon anger, avarice, jealousy, and all the other stains of affliction. All humans, nonhumans, and others will protect them with respect. They will not forget their duties. Delighting in the four means of gathering, they will not abandon sentient beings. And they will never be parted from the vessels of the Dharma who have become fields of merit."

Again the Blessed One spoke to Devagarbha: "For the protection of the lands of virtuous kṣatriya kings in this buddha-field in the time to come, speak the words of the great dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Irreversible Wheel. Declare how, through the power and splendor of the words of this great dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Irreversible Wheel for the full protection of the land, in the time to come in this buddha-field all virtuous kṣatriya kings will be unassailable by any hostile enemy, and so on in full, up to how they will be protected so as never to be parted from all of them, up to the buddhas and the retinues of the buddhas."

Then the great Brahmā Devagarbha spoke these words of the great dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Irreversible Wheel for the full protection of the land:

tadyathā muni mori muna garbhe muni khili dhaye muni roga bicale muni halite muni game śukla pakṣe pālala pakṣe mrila pakṣe souri sakriti toraṇa kricale pataga śakrite kukula mrile apakṣa sara odaha kiliba muni pāthaba svāhā

When the great Brahmā Devagarbha had spoken these dhāraṇīs, he further addressed the Blessed One with these words: "Blessed One, together with this great assembly, please rejoice in this great dhāraṇī that I have spoken."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent!" And all the great assembly also said, "Excellent, excellent!"

Then at that time the Blessed One spoke these words to the venerable Mahāmaudgalyāyana and to the bodhisattva, the great being Maitreya: "Son of good family, retain as a dhāraṇī these words of the great dhāraṇī called the Heart of the Irreversible Wheel for the full protection of the land, which the great Brahmā Devagarbha has offered. In the time to come, in this buddha-field, teach it in full to all the virtuous kṣatriya kings as well. Through that cause and that condition, it will bring benefit and happiness to all the virtuous kṣatriya kings with their retinues, and to all the people dwelling in their lands. They will always turn the wheel of Dharma; they will become greatly renowned and of great splendor; they will overcome evil views and establish right view; they will guard the Dharma eye and carry on the lineage of the Three Jewels without interruption; they will bring to full maturity immeasurable, numberless sentient beings; their faith in the Great Vehicle will be utterly firm; and abiding for a long time in the cultivation of the six perfections, they will cut through all obscurations and swiftly reach the final state."

Then, to recite these meanings clearly, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

At that time the great Brahmā Devagarbha
Addressed the Supreme among Two-Legged Beings thus:
"People of keen faculties
Aspire to cultivate samādhi and to make merit;
Wise kings establish the ways of the Dharma
To lift up and deliver those who wander far astray.
Among these three matters of conduct,
Which ones dispel doubt and do not turn back?"

The Blessed One spoke thus:
"If one does not abide in them, does not do them, has not done them,
Then though great of intellect and sharp in wisdom,
One will fall into the Avīci hell.
The unwise, and even the pure,
If they delight in practicing the wheel of the ten evils,
Since their roots of virtue are cut off entirely,
Will swiftly fall into the hells.

"Samādhi cuts through all afflictions;
The merit of hearing does not.
Therefore those who wish to pass into nirvāṇa
Should always rest evenly in meditative concentration.
The wise who undertake great diligence,
Who guard and uphold my true Dharma,
And have faith and respect for those who wear the saffron robe,
Will be freed from the ocean of afflictions.

"Dwelling in utterly solitary wilderness,
Keeping far away from deeds of immediate retribution,
Upholding moral discipline and cultivating samādhi,
Through faith they will cross the ocean of existence.
Those who have faith in all three vehicles
Make my true Dharma flourish;
If they make offerings to those who wear the saffron robe,
They will surely become an ocean of every kind of quality.

"Having thoroughly tamed the mind so hard to tame,
They do not speak of the faults of monks;
Content, living by the lineage of the noble ones,
They will surely become the holiest, the supreme among two-legged beings.
Abandon sinful monks,
And rely on the places of noble conduct.
Do not use or consume the property of the Saṅgha,
And you will swiftly attain great awakening.

"Whatever happiness and joy there are in all three realms,
They all arise from the Three Jewels.
Therefore, you who wish for happiness and joy,
Always make offerings to the Three Jewels.
Caṇḍāla kings and others like them,
Companions of monks who practice evil,
By committing offenses against the Three Jewels,
Will fall into the Avīci hell.

"The evil of ten oil pressers
Equals the evil of one who sells her body;
The evil of ten who sell their bodies
Equals the evil of one seller of liquor;

The evil of ten taverns
Equals the evil of one butcher;
The evil of ten slaughterhouses
Equals the evil of one king.

"But kings who are truly virtuous
Make all my true Dharma flourish;
By making offerings to all three vehicles
They will thereby become an ocean of every kind of quality.
The heap of merit gained
By filling Jambudvīpa with the seven precious things
And offering them to the Buddha and the Saṅgha
Does not match even the merit of guarding the Buddha's Dharma.

"The heap of merit gained
By building dwellings for the Buddha and the Saṅgha
Equal in extent to ten four-continent worlds
Does not match even the merit of guarding the Buddha's Dharma.
The heap of merit gained
By building stūpas for the buddhas
Equal in extent to a great trichiliocosm
Does not match even the merit of guarding the Buddha's Dharma.

"Beyond untying the bonds of the arhats
And making offerings of every kind,
The merit of placing no obstacle before the Dharma
Is more excellent than that.
Greater than whatever special insight arises
When the wise cultivate samādhi
For a thousand koṭis of eons
Is the merit of guarding the Dharma.

"Those exceedingly virtuous kings
Who abandon the wheel of the ten evils
And shelter this true Dharma of mine,
Or else protect those who wear the saffron robe,
Do not disparage or denigrate
The three vehicles I have taught, or the persons who follow them.

And listen to all of them and make offerings to them,
And act as refuge and protector to those who teach the Dharma,
And do not let the wealth of the Three Jewels go to waste,
And place no obstacle before those who wear the Dharma robes.
If they show respect to all, both the vessels and those who are not vessels,
Their merit is beyond compare.

"Just as, when the five suns have risen,
All the great oceans are dried up,
So the one who guards my Dharma
Will dry up the ocean of the afflictions.
Just as, when destruction by wind comes about,
All the mountains are destroyed,
So the one who guards my Dharma
Will vanquish every defilement.

"Just as, when destruction by water comes about,
The great earth is swept away by the water and destroyed,
So the one who guards my Dharma
Will vanquish unwanted results.
Just as the precious wish-fulfilling jewel
Fulfills all desires completely,
So the Dharma of the three vehicles
Fulfills the aspirations of all sentient beings.

"Whoever finds an excellent vase
Is parted from poverty and gains happiness and comfort;
So whoever meets the Dharma of the Buddha
Will cut through doubt and hear of awakening.
Just as the full moon on the fifteenth day
Illuminates all of space with its light,
So the person who guards the Dharma
Pervades the whole dharmadhātu with wisdom.

"Just as space is everywhere the same,
Without substance and without characteristics,
So the person who guards the Dharma
Knows all phenomena as of a single taste.
Just as the spreading light of the sun
Dispels all the darkness of the world,

So the person who guards the Dharma
Always brings happiness to the whole world."

This concludes the third chapter, on what should not be dwelt in or practiced, from the very extensive great sūtra called The Ten Wheels of Kṣitigarbha.

Then the bodhisattva, the great being called Vajragarbha, who was seated within the circle of that assembly, rose, touched his head to the feet of the Blessed One, draped his upper robe over one shoulder, set his right knee on the ground, joined his palms, bowed, and addressed him in verse:

"Those who through broken moral discipline have lost their pure qualities,
Since they are not vessels of the noble, are not your children, so you have said.
You said: 'Those who have abandoned the nature of a śramaṇa and are like ashes
Do not grace this pure assembly of mine.
Steeped in the three stains, having lost cessation and the path,
They are not fit to receive any special offering.
Of the wealth dedicated to the Saṅgha of the four directions
I have not permitted them to use even the smallest share.
Those who have broken even one of the four roots of moral discipline
Are not included in the Saṅgha, like the ocean that keeps no corpse.'
Why then, here and now, toward sinful monks,
Do you accept them with compassion and not cut them off with punishment,
And urge, 'Still, make offerings to them as to me'?

"Loving and compassionate one, you said: 'Abandoning all ill will,
If one listens with respect to the Dharma they teach...'
Yet you, who have gained the accumulations of merit and wisdom, of great compassion,
Protector of the world endowed with superknowledges, said in other sūtras:
'Have faith in the Great Vehicle,
The subtle and profound path of perfect awakening,
And abandon that path of liberation through the two vehicles.'
Why then, here and now, do you teach three vehicles,
And urge all to listen to them and to honor them?

"The faculties, the powers, the factors of awakening, and the fruits of the śramaṇa

Arise from this sūtra, and it is not said that they arise elsewhere.
Here, in the incomparable noble eightfold path,
All three vehicles alike enter that path;
If those who long for liberation rouse great diligence,
They will attain awakening, each according to their hopes.
When the Lord of all beings distinguishes these matters,
And shows that these earlier and later teachings do not conflict,
All the assemblies of gods, humans, and bodhisattvas
Will realize the genuine truth and give rise to the joy of liberation.

"Whom will the teaching of the Great Vehicle benefit,
And whom will the teaching of the Great Vehicle harm?
When the teaching of the ten liberations through the Śrāvaka Vehicle
Is heard, whom will it harm, and whom will it benefit?
Who, on hearing this Dharma, rises higher and higher?
Who, on hearing this Dharma, falls lower and lower?
How, through weariness at the faults of all conditioned things,
Will the ocean of aging and death be swiftly dried up?
Those who strive greatly in virtue day and night,
Abiding in which supreme aim, and traveling by which vehicle,
Are delivered from the four rivers so vast and deep?
Protector of the world, distinguish these, and protect all!"

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva, the great being Vajragarbha: "Excellent, excellent! Son of good family, it is excellent that, for the benefit and happiness of countless people, and for the great welfare of gods, humans, asuras, and others, you have asked the Tathāgata about these extremely profound matters. Listen very well and keep it well in mind, and I shall explain it to you in detail." When he had spoken thus, the bodhisattva Vajragarbha listened to the Blessed One.

The Blessed One said: "Son of good family, these ten kinds of persons wander in saṃsāra and find a human body extremely hard to obtain. What are the ten kinds of persons? They are these: those who do not cultivate roots of virtue; those who do not perform meritorious deeds; those who take rebirth through the defilements; those who follow evil friends; those who do not look with fear upon the suffering that ripens as a result in the world to come; those whose desire grows rampant; those whose anger grows rampant; those whose delusion grows rampant; those whose minds are intoxicated and confused;

and those who cling to the evil of wrong views. Because of these ten kinds of things that should not be dwelt in or practiced, sentient beings destroy the root of moral discipline and break their discipline, and so they fall into the lower realms.

"What are the ten kinds of things that should not be dwelt in or practiced? They are these. Among those who have gone forth in my teaching, there are some who have lapsed in higher conduct but have not lapsed in conviction. There are some who have lapsed in conviction but have not lapsed in higher conduct. There are some who have lapsed in both higher conduct and conviction. There are some who have lapsed in moral discipline but have not lapsed in view. There are some who have lapsed in view but have not lapsed in moral discipline. And there are some who have lapsed in both moral discipline and view.

"There are some who, though they have not lapsed in higher conduct, conviction, moral discipline, or view, fall under the sway of evil friends and do what should not be dwelt in or practiced. There are some who, though they have come to rely on spiritual friends, are dull by nature, mute like sheep, and cannot even distinguish one kind of deed from another; though they hear the spiritual friend teach what is virtuous and what is unvirtuous, they do not understand it, do not retain it, and do not know it, and through that cause and that condition they do what should not be dwelt in or practiced. There are some whose minds are disturbed because they search everywhere, never wearied, for wealth, jewels, and all kinds of requisites of life, and so they do what should not be dwelt in or practiced. And there are some who, afflicted and tormented by the many illnesses of conditioned existence, resort to worldly gods and practice mantras and the like, and through that cause and that condition they do what should not be dwelt in or practiced.

"In this way, because of these ten kinds of things that should not be dwelt in or practiced, sentient beings lapse from the root of moral discipline and do not become vessels of the noble ones in this very life; and because their discipline is broken, they fall into the lower realms.

"Son of good family, a person may have lapsed in higher conduct but not in conviction, and because of some one of the things that should not be dwelt in or practiced he may have broken one of the root precepts. If he is then greatly afraid and terrified at this, holds himself in check and feels shame, does nothing of the kind from then on, and abandons the evil, the Tathāgata, in

order to help him, calls him a śramaṇa who corrupts the path. Why is that? Because although he has committed so great an evil deed, he does not conceal it but confesses at once, and with scruple and shame he feels remorse. Since through his scruple and shame he confesses it individually and the evil is purified, he will cut off the stream of doing it from then on. He is not included in any of the formal acts and rites of śramaṇas; he is to be expelled, and he has no right to use any of the requisites of the śramaṇa's life. Yet that person becomes a vessel for the Dharma of the three vehicles, and therefore the Tathāgata, out of loving concern, at times teaches him the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, at times teaches him the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and at times teaches him the Dharma of the unsurpassed vehicle. And so, in two or three lifetimes, through the power of aspiration and the power of the spiritual friend, all the evil deeds he has done, all that has become evil, are purified. Then some attain the fruit of the Śrāvaka Vehicle; some pass into nirvāṇa through the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle; and some may even come to realize the meaning of the vast, unsurpassed vehicle. In the same way one should understand the case of one who has lapsed in moral discipline but not in view.

"If a person has lapsed in conviction but not in higher conduct, the Tathāgata, in order to help him, teaches the Dharma of accomplishing the four abodes of Brahmā. Such a one is a vessel of the Śrāvaka Vehicle; such a one possesses the vessel of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

"If a person has lapsed in both higher conduct and conviction, then although he does not become a vessel for the Dharma of any vehicle, the Tathāgata, in order to help him, speaks in praise of generosity.

"If a person has lapsed in view but not in moral discipline, then although he does not become a vessel for the Dharma of any vehicle, the Tathāgata, in order to help him, teaches him the Dharma of dependent origination, so that he abandons the evil of wrong views and, in this very body, realizes the Dharma of the śrāvakas or of the pratyekabuddhas; or else he causes him to enter into it and realize it in another lifetime.

"If a person has lapsed in both moral discipline and view, he is not a vessel of the Dharma of the noble ones; yet the Tathāgata, in order to help him, speaks in praise of generosity.

"If a person, though he has not lapsed in any of higher conduct, conviction, moral discipline, or view, has fallen under the sway of evil friends and relies on

them and lives with them, the Tathāgata, in order to help him, praises and teaches the ten courses of virtuous action.

"For a person who, though he has come to rely on a spiritual friend, is bad and dull by nature, mute like a sheep, and grasps nothing at all of virtue or nonvirtue, the Tathāgata, in order to help him, speaks in praise of it so that he will become habituated to recitation.

"For those persons who are tormented by the many kinds of sickness of desire and intoxicated by views about the many kinds of conditioned things, the Tathāgata, in order to help them, teaches as follows. To those who seek liberation he teaches the four noble truths of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, which bring one out of saṃsāra. To those who hold the view of annihilation he speaks in praise of the Dharma of dependent origination. To those who hold the view of permanence he teaches that, from these streams of existence in the three realms, one dies, transmigrates, and is born elsewhere, circling without interruption like a potter's wheel; and he teaches impermanence and the other teachings.

"Son of good family, nothing that the Tathāgata has taught through names, signs, letters, words, and the sounds of speech is fruitless or meaningless; there is nothing at all that he did not teach for the sake of bringing sentient beings to full maturity. Therefore, if anyone disparages or denigrates the Dharma spoken by the Tathāgata, since that is the evil of destroying the eye of the true Dharma for sentient beings, he will incur immeasurable evil misdeeds, surpassing the acts of immediate retribution or equal to the acts of immediate retribution.

"Whoever disparages or denigrates, or obstructs and hinders, the true Dharma that I have spoken for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings, whether it was spoken on the basis of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, or on the basis of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, or on the basis of the Great Vehicle, or who, at the very least, acts to conceal even a single verse of it, should be known to be denigrating the true Dharma. Because he does away with the eight limbs of the noble path and ruins the eye of the true Dharma for all sentient beings, that person in this way both engages in great ruin himself and leads others to engage in great ruin. Further, that person is said to rely on a Saṅgha without conscience or shame and to disparage and denigrate the true Dharma of the Tathāgata.

Son of good family, there are, further, four kinds of monk. What are the four? They are the monk in the ultimate sense, the conventional monk, the monk who is like a dumb sheep, and the monk without conscience or shame.

Among these, who is the monk in the ultimate sense? It is this: the buddhas, the Blessed Ones; the monks who are bodhisattva great beings, endowed with great qualities and having mastery over all phenomena; those of the awakening of a pratyekabuddha; arhats; non-returners; once-returners; and stream-enterers. These seven kinds of person are counted as monks in the ultimate sense. And as for one who lives in a household, who has not shaved off his hair and beard, who does not wear the Dharma robes, who has not received the whole moral discipline of the prātimokṣa that belongs to going forth, and who is not included in any of the formal acts, namely the motion, the act of request, the poṣadha, and all the procedural acts: because such a one possesses the noble Dharma and has attained a noble fruit, he too is counted as a monk in the ultimate sense. These are called monks in the ultimate sense.

Among these, what is the conventional monk? One who has shaved off his hair and beard, wears saffron robes, has gone forth, and possesses the moral discipline of the prātimokṣa is called a conventional monk.

Among these, what is the monk who is like a dumb sheep? He does not know whether he has broken the root offenses and the rest or has not broken them. He does not know whether they are grave or light. Though he commits subtle faults of many kinds, he does not know to regret them and confess them. He is careless about the faults he has committed, pays no heed to minor wrongdoings, and does not fear them. He does not rely on wise persons. He does not, from time to time, attend upon and serve those who are learned and endowed with wisdom. Nor does he know how to ask and inquire respectfully. Those persons who do not ask or inquire what is virtue, what is non-virtue, what is wrongdoing, what is free of wrongdoing, what is good to do and what is not good to do are counted as monks who are like dumb sheep, and are called monks who are like dumb sheep.

Among these, who is the monk without conscience or shame? It is the being who turns to my teaching and goes forth merely for the sake of a livelihood. Having gone forth, he breaks all the observances of the moral discipline of the prātimokṣa. Without conscience or shame, he pays no heed to the result of suffering in the next world and does not fear it. He is like a shellfish rotten

within and full of filth. His conduct is like that of a dog at the sound of a conch. He constantly speaks falsehood and has no words of truth. He is gripped by avarice, envy, delusion and pride. Far removed from the three supreme and sacred kinds of action, attached to gain, honor and fame, he delights in the six sense-objects, is distracted by desire, and is attached to the objects of form, sound, smell, taste and touch. Such persons are counted among those without conscience or shame who disparage and denigrate the true Dharma; such a one is called a monk without conscience or shame.

Son of good family, among those called monks in the ultimate sense, some are counted among the śramaṇas who are victors by the path. Victor by the path means one who abides in the eight limbs of the noble path, and who both frees himself from the flood of the afflictions and frees others as well. How is that? The buddhas, the Blessed Ones, the pratyekabuddhas, and the arhats: these three kinds of person are called victors by the noble path, because they are far removed from the whole cycle of the limbs of existence. Further, the Saṅgha of bodhisattvas, who do not depend on others, who see all phenomena with unobstructed wisdom, and who gather in all sentient beings for the sake of their benefit and happiness, is also counted among the śramaṇas who are victors by the path.

Some of the monks in the ultimate sense and conventional monks are counted among the monks who teach the path. The person who possesses the moral discipline of the prātimokṣa and, relying on knowledge and the power to instruct, from the genuinely virtuous ordinary person up to one who possesses worldly right view, through the power of miraculous display distinguishes, teaches and explains to others the dharmas of the noble path, is the first and lowest kind of śramaṇa who teaches the path; he is called a śramaṇa who teaches the path. The person who has attained the fruit of stream-entry is called the second. The person who has attained the fruit of once-returning is called the third. The person who has attained the fruit of non-returning is called the fourth. Further, the Saṅgha of bodhisattva great beings is called the fifth. Those who abide from the first ground up to the tenth ground, and those who abide in their final body of existence, are also counted among the śramaṇas who teach the path.

Those who possess the moral discipline of the prātimokṣa and possess pure deportment are counted among the śramaṇas who live by the path; because they sustain their life by the path, they are called śramaṇas who live by the path. Further, the bodhisattva great beings who gather in all sentient beings

for the sake of their benefit and happiness, and who apply themselves diligently to the six perfections, are also called those who live by the path.

Thus these three kinds of śramaṇa, the victors by the path, the teachers of the path, and those who live by the path, are called the genuine field of merit for the world. The śramaṇas other than these are called corrupters of the path; although they are not genuine, they too are reckoned as a field of merit. The person who dwells in and relies on a Saṅgha without restraint or shame is like a corpse within the Vinaya and Dharma that I have rightly taught. So it was said. Because he is not a vessel for the Dharma and is to be expelled from the ocean of the pure Saṅgha, I do not say of that person, "I am his teacher," and that person is not my śrāvaka.

Shameless monks who have not become vessels for the Dharma may nonetheless hold me as their teacher, have great faith in my relics and in my images, and have great faith also in my Dharma, in the Saṅgha, and in the moral discipline of the noble ones. Because of that, they do not themselves hold wrong views, nor do they cause others to cling to wrong views. They teach extensively the Dharma that I have taught, praising and extolling it highly, and they do not disparage or denigrate it. They constantly make right aspirations, and as soon as they have committed a wrongdoing they confess it again and again, regret it and give it up. If they do so, many karmic obscurations will be pacified. In this way, by the force of his faith in the Three Jewels and in the moral discipline of the noble ones, such a person surpasses the ninety-five kinds of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) by hundreds of thousands of times. Although he has not quickly arrived at the city of nirvāṇa, even a universal monarch should not denigrate him; what need, then, to speak of other people who are not such a monarch?

Therefore, because the Tathāgata knows and sees the distinct characteristics of the karma of all sentient beings and of the phenomena they experience, he has said: "Kṣatriyas and others have no right to revile, abuse or punish those who, having faith in the Dharma of my teaching, have shaved off their hair and beard and wear saffron robes." If anyone shows contempt for, reviles and abuses, or punishes any of those who have gone forth, the ripening of the fruit of that wrongdoing is just as has been explained at length.

Further, when someone goes forth from home into homelessness in my teaching, shaves off his hair and beard, and puts on saffron robes, all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future and the present hold him in

their compassion. His deportment, his appearance, and his wearing of the Dharma robes are likewise held in compassion by all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future and the present. Therefore, to show contempt for one who has gone forth, who has shaved off his hair and beard and wears saffron robes, is to show contempt for all the buddhas, the Blessed Ones, of the past, the future and the present. For this reason and on this account, the wise and intelligent, those who are weary of suffering and afraid of it, and who long for the happiness of gods and humans and for the bliss of nirvāṇa, should not show contempt for or disparage those who have gone forth from home into homelessness, shaved off their hair and beard, and put on saffron robes.

Among the shameless śramaṇas of broken moral discipline, who have not become vessels for the noble Dharma of the three vehicles, who themselves cling fervently to the evil of wrong views and cause others too to become attached to the evil of wrong views, there are those who say, "There are no virtuous kṣatriyas, no śramaṇas, brahmins, ministers, householders, merchants, vaiśyas, śūdras, men or women." There are those who say, "In the world there is no father and no mother," and so on up to, "there is no virtue and no non-virtue, no fruit of karmic maturation, and no attainment of the fruit of the noble path." There are those who say, "No phenomena arise from causes." There are those who hold that the form realm is permanent and not subject to destruction, and those who hold that the formless realm is permanent and not subject to destruction. Some hold that ultimate purity is attained through the ascetic observances of the non-Buddhists.

Some hold that ultimate purity is attained through the Śrāvaka Vehicle alone, and not through the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle or the Great Vehicle. Having faith and confidence in the Śrāvaka Vehicle, they praise and extol it, explain it and teach it, but they disparage and denigrate the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the Great Vehicle, revile them, obstruct and hinder them, and do not allow them to be taught.

Some hold that ultimate purity is attained through the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle alone, and not through the Śrāvaka Vehicle or the Great Vehicle. Having faith and confidence in the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, they extol and praise it, explain it and teach it, but they disparage and denigrate the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Great Vehicle, revile them, obstruct and hinder them, and do not allow them to be taught.

Some hold that ultimate purity is attained through the Great Vehicle alone, and not through the Śrāvaka Vehicle or the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Because they themselves have faith and confidence in the Great Vehicle, they lead others too to have faith and confidence in it. Because they themselves serve and honor it, they bring others too to serve and honor it. Because they themselves extol and praise it, they have others too extol and praise it. Because they themselves copy it into volumes, they have others too copy it into volumes. Because they themselves read and recite it, they have others too read and recite it. Because they themselves listen to it and retain it, they have others too listen to it and retain it. Because they themselves reflect on it and bring it to mind, they have others too reflect on it and bring it to mind. To all people, whether they have become vessels for the Dharma or not, they explain and teach the Great Vehicle, the ultimate, extremely profound and subtle. But they disparage and denigrate the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, revile them, obstruct and hinder them, and do not allow them to be taught. Because they themselves lack faith in them, they obstruct the arising of faith in others. Because they themselves do not serve them, they obstruct others from serving them. Because they themselves do not praise them, they obstruct others from praising them. Because they themselves do not copy them into volumes, they obstruct others from copying them into volumes. Because they themselves do not read, recite, listen to, retain, understand or bring them to mind, they obstruct others from reading, reciting, listening to, retaining, reflecting on and bringing them to mind. Thus there are also those who do not teach the Dharma of the two vehicles.

Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by practicing generosity alone, and not through moral discipline, nor through patience, and so on up to wisdom.

Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by moral discipline alone, and not through generosity, nor through patience, and so on up to wisdom. Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by patience alone, and not through generosity, nor through moral discipline, and so on up to wisdom. Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by diligence alone, and not through generosity, nor through moral discipline, and so on up to wisdom. Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by meditative concentration alone, and not through generosity, nor through moral discipline, and so on up to wisdom. Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by wisdom alone, and not through generosity, nor through moral discipline, and so on up to meditative concentration. Some hold that ultimate purity is attained by training in and knowing the many different

worldly arts and crafts. Some hold, and teach, that ultimate purity is attained through many kinds of ascetic observances, such as leaping from cliffs, leaping into smoldering embers, and fasting.

Son of noble family, in this way that monk of corrupt moral discipline, who engages in evil and is not a vessel for the Dharma, deceives with all manner of lies all those who are vessels for the true Dharma, and leads many people to embrace wrong views. Thus, through the power of their perverse and wrong views, they corrupt those of perfectly pure faith, from virtuous kṣatriyas to vaiśyas, śūdras, men, women and others, and ruin their moral discipline, their learning, their generosity and their wisdom as well. They turn them all into outcastes (caṇḍālas), from outcaste kṣatriyas to outcaste vaiśyas. These are therefore not vessels for the Dharma. The monks of corrupt moral discipline and the outcaste kṣatriyas and the rest, teacher together with disciples, sever their roots of virtue, and so they fall even as far as the hell of Unceasing Torment.

Son of noble family, a human corpse, bloated, putrid and decaying, is repugnant to all beings; its stench, the moment it reaches the nose, comes close to destroying one, and whoever is smeared with it reeks of it. In just the same way, if virtuous kṣatriyas, and so on up to virtuous śūdras, attend upon, keep company with, dwell together with, or carry out activities together with one of corrupt moral discipline, who engages in evil and is not a vessel for the Dharma, they are at once fouled with the filth and stench of wrong views. Son of noble family, just so, the virtuous kṣatriyas, and so on up to the virtuous śūdras, lose all their faith, moral discipline, learning, generosity and wisdom, and become outcastes. And so, teacher together with disciples, having severed their roots of virtue, they fall even as far as the hell of Unceasing Torment.

The sixth fascicle.

Son of noble family, see how in this way countless people, kṣatriyas and others, by relying on a monk of corrupt moral discipline, who engages in evil and is not a vessel for the Dharma, lose all virtuous qualities and fall even as far as the hell of Unceasing Torment. Therefore, those who wish for anything from rebirth as gods in the higher realms up to the bliss of nirvāṇa should attend upon, make offerings to, and show reverence to the śramaṇa who is a victor of the path, and request to hear the sūtras of the Dharma of the three vehicles. Furthermore, they should seek a śramaṇa who teaches the path and

a śramaṇa who lives by the path. If there is no śramaṇa abiding in those three paths, they should seek even a śramaṇa who corrupts the path. Although such a one's moral discipline is corrupt, if he possesses right view, faith and superior conduct, attend upon him and make offerings to him, and ask him the meaning of the three vehicles. But to one whose superior conduct, faith and view are all corrupt, one should not offer service and offerings.

As for those of corrupt moral discipline: although their moral discipline is corrupt, they do not hold wrong views, and since they possess faith, superior conduct and view, one should go wherever they are and request and listen to the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, and one should not despise or disparage them. Even though one has faith in any one of the three vehicles, makes aspirations, undertakes diligence and trains accordingly, one should not despise or disparage the other vehicles either.

Whoever despises or disparages even so much as a single verse of any one of the three vehicles, do not serve him, do not attend upon him, do not keep company with him, do not dwell together with him, and do not join with him in communal acts. Whoever serves him, attends upon him, keeps company with him, dwells together with him, or carries out activities together with him will without doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment.

Therefore, son of noble family, those who abide in any one of the three vehicles, who aspire to pass beyond saṃsāra and to supreme bliss, and who are weary of suffering, should have faith in and deeply revere all the true Dharma spoken by the Tathāgata: what was taught on the basis of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, what was taught on the basis of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and what was taught on the basis of the Great Vehicle. Do not scorn or denigrate it, and do not create hindrances or obstacles to it, not even, at the very least, an obstacle to a single verse. Always, with reverence, make a firm commitment to reading, reciting and listening, and come to understand it. If someone scorns and denigrates the Dharma of any one of the three vehicles, do not dwell together with him, not even for a single day, and do not serve him or listen to the Dharma from him. Any sentient being who scorns and denigrates even one of the three vehicles, or who relies on a person who scorns and denigrates the three vehicles, questioning him and listening to him, will by that cause and that condition fall into the great hell of Unceasing Torment and experience great suffering, and it will be extremely hard to be freed.

Why is that? Son of noble family, in times past, when I was practicing the conduct of a bodhisattva and was earnestly striving to seek unsurpassed wisdom, at times, out of longing for the true Dharma belonging to the Śrāvaka Vehicle, even for the sake of a single verse at the very least, I gave away the parts of my body: my hands, my feet, my flesh, my blood, my skin, my bones, my head, my eyes, my marrow, and even my brain. At times, out of longing for the true Dharma taught on the basis of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, even for the sake of a single verse at the very least, I gave away the parts of my body: my hands, my feet, my flesh, my blood, my skin, my bones, my head, my eyes, my marrow, and even my brain. At times, out of longing for the true Dharma taught on the basis of the Great Vehicle, even for the sake of a single verse at the very least, I gave away the parts of my body: my hands, my feet, my flesh, my blood, my skin, my bones, my head, my eyes, my marrow, and even my brain.

Practicing such austerities, whenever I found even a single verse of the three vehicles, I rejoiced greatly, and with reverence I kept it, held it in memory, and practiced it just as it had been taught, without abandoning it in the least. In this way, for countless eons, I practiced every kind of extremely difficult deed, and only then, having performed the final deed, did I attain the fruit of unsurpassed wisdom. Moreover, for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, I have taught the true Dharma of the three vehicles, distinguishing them one from another. Therefore, one should not scorn it, denigrate it, hinder it or obstruct it, nor conceal even so much as a single verse of it. Toward it, always with reverence, make a very firm commitment to reading, reciting and listening.

Son of noble family, this true Dharma of the three vehicles has been taught in harmony by all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future and the present, as numerous as the sands of the river Ganges, and all of them bless it with their blessing. It is upheld in order to rescue and deliver all sentient beings from the great suffering of saṃsāra, and to keep the lineage of the Three Jewels unbroken. Therefore everyone should have faith in the true Dharma of the three vehicles and show it reverence. One should not scorn it, denigrate it, hinder it or obstruct it. Whoever causes even a single verse of the true Dharma of the three vehicles to disappear will without doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment.

Furthermore, son of noble family, in the future, in this buddha field, there will be outcaste kṣatriyas, outcaste brahmins, outcaste ministers, outcaste householders, outcaste śramaṇas, outcaste merchants, and outcaste men or women of the vaiśya and śūdra castes. They will live by deceit and guile, foolish and deluded, puffed up with a little knowledge, by nature fierce and wrathful, impatient and harsh, not looking with fear upon the fruit of suffering in the world beyond, delighting in everything from taking life up to wrong views, avarice, envy, meanness and attachment, turning their backs on virtuous spiritual friends and relying on evil friends, not vessels for the noble Dharma of the three vehicles. Having heard a little of the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, they scorn, denigrate, revile, hinder and obstruct the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the Dharma of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle, which are upheld by all the buddhas, and they do not let them flourish. Some, having heard a little of the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, scorn, denigrate, revile, hinder and obstruct the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Dharma of the unsurpassed vehicle, which are upheld by all the buddhas, and they do not let them flourish. Some, having heard a little of the Dharma of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle, scorn, denigrate, revile, hinder and obstruct the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, which are upheld by all the buddhas, and they do not let them flourish. And for the sake of gain and fame they say, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle. As a companion of the Great Vehicle, I delight in listening to, keeping and holding in memory the Great Vehicle alone. I take no delight in the Dharma of the śrāvakas and of the followers of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. I have no wish to rely on those two vehicles."

Those who thus falsely claim to be followers of the Great Vehicle are seized by delusion about the self, and, having fallen under the sway of pride, they scorn, denigrate, hinder and obstruct the true Dharma of the three vehicles in this way, and do not let it flourish. They also scorn, denigrate and revile persons who train in the three vehicles, and render them powerless.

Son of noble family, all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future and the present, and all the bodhisattva great beings, for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, through the force of great compassion, uphold these two things. What are they? The first is what keeps the lineage of the Three Jewels unbroken: going forth from home into homelessness, shaving off hair and beard, and wearing saffron robes. The second is possessing the true Dharma that has come forth from the three

vehicles, such as the Four Noble Truths. These two things are upheld only by the buddhas, the blessed ones, and the bodhisattva great beings, and not by śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas and the like. Nor are they upheld by the great Brahmās, numbering hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas, by Śakra, lord of the gods, by universal monarchs who rule the four continents, or by any such beings.

In the future, in this buddha field, outcaste kṣatriyas will contrive to find faults and pretexts against those who have gone forth in my teaching, shaved off their hair and beards, and put on saffron robes. On all manner of grounds they will abuse and revile them, denigrate and humiliate them, beat them, strike them, throw them into prison, seize their means of livelihood, strip them of their Dharma robes, force them back into lay life and make them do all kinds of household work, press them into servitude and punish them, banish them, cut off their food and drink, and go so far as to deprive them of their life faculty. That king, the outcaste kṣatriya, having thus become foolish and deluded by nature and seized by the power of pride, reviles, humiliates, harshly punishes and otherwise mistreats the disciples who are upheld by the power of the compassion of the buddhas and bodhisattvas. He also scorns and denigrates the extremely profound Dharma that all the buddhas and bodhisattvas uphold through the force of their great compassion, and he corrupts it. He hinders and obstructs the true Dharma of the three vehicles upheld by all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the three times and by all the bodhisattvas, and does not let it flourish.

Thus those, from outcaste kṣatriyas to outcaste vaiśyas and śūdras, who are foolish and deluded by nature and seized by pride, and who claim, "We are followers of the Great Vehicle," have not become vessels even for the Śrāvaka Vehicle or the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, let alone vessels for the Dharma of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle. Out of desire for gain and fame, honor and offerings, they deceive all foolish and deluded worldly people, saying, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle," and they scorn and denigrate the true Dharma of the Tathāgata's two vehicles. Such foolish and deluded persons, living by deceit and guile, seized by pride, and driven by avarice, envy and attachment, by that cause and that condition corrupt my Dharma eye and swiftly bring it to extinction. In doing so they commit a great wrong that violates the sacred commitment of all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the three times. They commit a great wrong that violates the sacred commitment of all the bodhisattvas of the three times. They commit the evil of a great wrong that

violates the sacred commitment of all the śrāvakas of the three times, and before long all their limbs will waste away and they will be struck by many kinds of grave and virulent disease.

All these, from outcaste kṣatriyas to vaiśyas and śūdras, outcaste men or women, who commit evil deeds, have, under the sway of perverse views, severed all their roots of virtue. So even if at other times they have amassed much merit through generosity, in the future they will be born in the realm of hungry ghosts or of animals, and will not experience the happiness of wealth. With that very body they cannot generate even a small root of virtue for birth in the form and formless realms, let alone produce the seed of the roots of virtue of the śrāvakas, of the pratyekabuddhas, or of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle, the spontaneously accomplished wisdom of omniscience. Moreover, their tongues will constantly be afflicted by disease; for many days and nights their tongues will be mute and unable to speak; they will undergo the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever; and when they die and pass on, they will fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment.

Therefore, for the long-lasting benefit and happiness of those men and women, from virtuous kṣatriyas to vaiśyas, śūdras and the rest, the Tathāgata has said again and again: "Do not harm, abuse or revile, or otherwise mistreat, those who have shaved their hair and beards, put on the patched saffron robe, and gone forth in my teaching. Do not scorn, denigrate, revile, hinder or obstruct the true Dharma of the three vehicles that I have taught." If anyone deliberately contravenes what I have taught, the ripening of that evil is just as has been explained at length.

Why is that? Whoever has gone for refuge in my teaching, shaved hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and bears the appearance of one gone forth, is upheld by the blessing of the great compassion of all the buddhas, the blessed ones, of the past, the future and the present, and of all the bodhisattvas. One who has shaved hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and bears the deportment of one gone forth, is the victory banner of the liberation of the noble ones. He is the victory banner of the taste of the Dharma that all śrāvakas enjoy through liberation. He is the victory banner of the taste of the Dharma that all followers of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle enjoy through liberation. He is the victory banner of the taste of the Dharma that all followers of the Great Vehicle enjoy through liberation. He is the true Dharma of the three vehicles taught by the Tathāgata. He is upheld by the blessing of the great compassion of all the buddhas and bodhisattvas of the three times. He is

the abode of the liberation of the noble ones. He is the abode of the taste of the Dharma that all followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle enjoy through liberation. He is the abode of the taste of the Dharma that all followers of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle enjoy through liberation. He is the abode of the taste of the Dharma that all followers of the Great Vehicle enjoy through liberation.

Therefore, son of noble family, those who seek liberation should serve, make offerings to and honor any person who has gone for refuge in my teaching, shaved hair and beard, put on saffron robes, and gone forth.

In the past I had faith in the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. When I myself listened to it and held it in memory, I had others listen to it and hold it as well. When I myself read and recited it, I had others read and recite it as well.

When I myself copied it into volumes, I had others copy it into volumes as well. When I myself practiced generosity, I had others practice generosity as well. When I myself taught and explained it, I had others teach and explain it as well, bring it to mind, apply themselves to it earnestly, and spread it widely. Just so, having faith in and confidence in the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, when I myself listened to it and held it in memory, I had others listen to it and hold it as well. When I myself read and recited it, I had others read and recite it as well. When I myself copied it into volumes, I had others copy it into volumes as well. When I myself practiced generosity, I had others practice generosity as well. When I myself taught and explained it, I had others teach and explain it as well, bring it to mind, apply themselves to it earnestly, and spread it widely. In the same way, having faith in and confidence in the Great Vehicle, when I myself listened to it and held it in memory, I had others listen to it and hold it as well. When I myself read and recited it, I had others read and recite it as well. When I myself copied it into volumes, I had others copy it into volumes as well. When I myself practiced generosity, I had others practice generosity as well. When I myself taught and explained it, I had others teach and explain it as well, bring it to mind, apply themselves to it earnestly, and spread it widely. If someone has not become a vessel, then he does not listen himself and does not have others listen, and so on; the text is to be expanded just as it was explained before.

One should keep far away from all evil things, give up evil companions, rely on virtuous spiritual friends, strive earnestly in the six perfections, again and again regret and confess all non-virtuous deeds, and make genuine aspirations in keeping with one's inclination. Whoever does this may, in this very body,

become a vessel for the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and may also reach the point of not turning back from the lineage of the pratyekabuddhas, and of not turning back from the lineage of the Great Vehicle. Therefore one should train in and apply oneself earnestly to all three vehicles, and should not, out of pride, claim to be a follower of the Great Vehicle while scorning and denigrating the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. What I said before, only to those who had become vessels for the Dharma of the Great Vehicle and who practiced steadfastly, namely, "By cultivating the Great Vehicle alone one will reach the final state," does not contradict what is said here.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

"Before the great maṇḍala of the assembly,
Vajragarbha asked me:
'Why do you urge that offerings be made
To monks whose moral discipline is corrupt?

Though they have lost every quality of training,
Are foolish and hold wrong views,
Are not vessels for the Dharma and corrupt the path,
You do not permit them to be reviled or punished.

You said that whoever hears from them
The true Dharma of the three vehicles explained,
Which genuinely liberates, like excellent medicine,
Will attain the peace of nirvāṇa.

Why is it that in other sūtras
One is freed by the Great Vehicle alone,
Giving up training in the Dharma of two vehicles,
Yet here the three vehicles are taught?

O you who love all sentient beings,
Who have given up every deed of wrong view,
For the sake of benefit and happiness,
Please free us and cut through our doubt.'

For the benefit of kings of the kṣatriya caste,
For the happiness of all down to vaiśyas and śūdras,
I do not permit harm to be done to monks:
That would be the evil of a great wrong.

To shave the beard and wear saffron robes
Is the Dharma banner of the buddhas,
The eye of the path of liberation,
Blessed by all the buddhas.

Though they have wholly fallen from much of their conduct,
They have not wholly abandoned liberation.
By giving up the evil of wrong views,
They will swiftly attain nirvāṇa.

Just as the finest medicine, even when spoiled,
Still greatly helps against every illness,
So too even one whose conduct is corrupt
Can bring others' suffering to rest.

In formal acts of the Saṅgha and in the poṣadha,
I do not permit that śramaṇa to take his seat;
Yet he is entitled to teach the true Dharma to others,
And both of them will gain great merit.

One who has faith in and turns toward the Three Jewels,
And holds me to be the great Teacher,
Will give up much non-virtue and evil;
He is superior to a host of non-Buddhists (tīrthikas).

Just as the merchants wandering on the island of the rākṣasīs,
Fearful and terrified,
Each grasped a single hair of the horse,
And crossed the ocean, free from harm,

So one whose moral discipline is corrupt,
Giving up non-virtue and wrong views,
Through the power of faith as the single cause,
Will be freed from the rākṣasas of the afflictions.

If one guards the banner of liberation
Blessed by many buddhas,
And does no harm to those of corrupt discipline,
One will avoid the heavy evil of wrongdoing.

One who aspires to great merit,
Who delights in genuine liberation,
And protects vessels and non-vessels alike,

Will find liberation not hard to attain.

The fool who in his pride claims
The Great Vehicle has no power of understanding.
If he is ignorant of the Dharma of the two vehicles,
How could he come to know the Great Vehicle?

For example, if the eyeball is damaged,
One will not see the many kinds of color;
Just so, if faith has been lost and is absent,
One cannot know the Great Vehicle.

If one lacks the strength to drink even a trickle of water,
How could one drink up the great ocean?
If one cannot grow accustomed even to the two vehicles,
How could one train in the Great Vehicle?

Through having faith in the Dharma of the two vehicles,
One comes to have faith in the Great Vehicle.
Without faith in the Dharma of the Great Vehicle,
Merely speaking words does not make it real.

Inwardly holding firmly to annihilation,
They claim to belong to the Great Vehicle.
They do not guard against the three kinds of non-virtuous deeds,
And they corrupt and destroy my true Dharma.

When such persons pass from this life,
They will certainly fall into the Avīci hell.
Therefore teach those whose faculties are firm,
And not those who have not become vessels.

Those without a mind of loving-kindness, proud and arrogant,
Fierce and harsh, of feeble faculties,
Are holders of the view of annihilation:
So should the wise know them to be.

They are not vessels for the śrāvakas,
For the pratyekabuddhas,
Or for the Great Vehicle.

Because they revile and denigrate all the buddhas,
They will certainly fall into the Avīci hell.

Delighting in company, guarding moral discipline,
Relying on a master, and fearing suffering:
Let the wise understand
That this is the Śrāvaka Vehicle.

Delighting in giving, contemplating the cessation of birth,
Delighting in remote dwelling places:
Let the wise understand
That this is the vehicle of the pratyekabuddhas.

Endowed with every root of virtue,
With a mind of loving-kindness and compassion,
Always delighting in working for others' benefit:
That is the Great Vehicle.

Giving up body and life to guard moral discipline,
Neither hurting nor harming sentient beings,
Striving in the Dharma of emptiness:
Know this to be the Great Vehicle.

With a mind patient toward all phenomena,
Speaking gentle words, free of meanness,
Ever delighting and rejoicing in the Dharma:
That too is the Great Vehicle.

Toward all, vessels for the Dharma and non-vessels alike,
To work for their benefit with an even intention,
Unstained by worldly concerns:
Know that too to be the Great Vehicle.

Therefore the wise and intelligent
Should develop great faith in the three vehicles.
If they do no harm to the Saṅgha,
They will swiftly attain unsurpassed awakening.

Furthermore, son of noble family, if virtuous kṣatriyas, virtuous brahmins, virtuous ministers, virtuous householders, virtuous merchants, virtuous śramaṇas, and men or women of the vaiśya and śūdra castes and so on possess the ten wheels of abiding and practice, then in this very body they will not turn back or fall away from the lineage of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and in this very life they will become vessels for the noble Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle; but they will not become vessels for the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle or

the Great Vehicle. What are the ten? They are these. First, with faith of pure intention, being convinced that the fruits of virtuous and non-virtuous deeds exist. Second, having conscience and shame, and so completely giving up non-virtuous companions and all wrong views. Third, abiding thoroughly in the vows, and completely giving up everything from taking life up to drinking liquor that causes heedlessness. Fourth, abiding in a mind of loving-kindness, and completely giving up all hatred and anger. Fifth, abiding in a mind of compassion, and rescuing all sentient beings in distress. Sixth, dwelling happily in a mind of joy, and completely giving up the four non-virtuous deeds of speech. Seventh, abiding in a mind of equanimity, and completely giving up all attachment, avarice and envy. Eighth, turning toward what is genuine, completely giving up all deceptive omens, good and bad, and not relying on perverse non-Buddhists. Ninth, having diligence with intense exertion, and applying oneself earnestly to all virtuous qualities. Tenth, always delighting in the wilderness, and seeking the meaning of the Dharma with enthusiasm and without weariness.

Son of noble family, if those men and women, from virtuous kṣatriyas to vaiśyas, śūdras and the rest, possess these ten wheels of abiding and practice, then in this very life they will not turn back or fall away from the lineage of the followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle; in this very life the noble Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle will become manifest to them, and they will become vessels for the noble Dharma of the śrāvakas. But the noble Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and of the Great Vehicle will not become manifest to them, nor will they become vessels for the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the Great Vehicle. By the same pattern, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the Great Vehicle should also be understood. Son of noble family, these ten wheels of abiding and practice are held in common by all śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, bodhisattvas, and buddhas, the blessed ones.

Furthermore, son of noble family, there are ten wheels of abiding and practice that are not shared with the śrāvakas but are shared with pratyekabuddhas, bodhisattvas, and buddhas, the blessed ones. If men and women, from virtuous kṣatriyas to vaiśyas, śūdras and the rest, possess these ten wheels of abiding and practice, then in this very life they will not fall away or turn back from the lineage of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and in this very body they will come to know the noble Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and become vessels for the noble Dharma of the pratyekabuddhas. What are the ten? They are these: purifying the deeds of body, speech and mind; having conscience

and shame, growing weary of one's own body and developing great fear of the five appropriated aggregates; seeing that the desires of saṃsāra are exceedingly hard to cross; always delighting in solitary places and completely giving up busyness; delighting in remote wilderness and not speaking of the faults of others; restraining the senses and, with a mind always at peace, engaging in meditative absorption; being skilled in dependent origination and so examining cause and effect thoroughly; always delighting in resting evenly in meditative concentration; and being skilled in completely stopping the active afflictions.

Son of noble family, if those men and women, from virtuous kṣatriyas to vaiśyas, śūdras and the rest, possess these ten wheels of abiding and practice, then in this very life they will not turn back or fall away from the lineage of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle; in this very life the noble Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle will become manifest to them, and they will become vessels for the noble Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Son of noble family, these are called the wheels of abiding and practice of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. If all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas abide in this wheel, they will swiftly cross the ocean of the three realms of existence and arrive at the great city of nirvāṇa.

Son of noble family, as to the meaning of the words "wheel of abiding and practice": "abiding" means that which involves grasping, that which involves a basis taken as "mine," that which involves gathering together, and that which involves connecting. "Practice" means the practice of the aggregates, the practice of the elements, the practice of the sense sources, and practice that involves connection.

"Wheel" means the wheel of training and of commitment. For example, a wheel-turning monarch makes chief use of a chariot wheel, or of that wheel. In the same way, all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas rely on this wheel as they seek the path to nirvāṇa. Therefore these two kinds are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Why is that? Because they rely on a low and feeble practice, they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle.

Weary and afraid of the practice of the aggregates, which involves grasping, they seek liberation from all suffering for themselves alone, and do not strive to liberate all sentient beings; therefore they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Weary and afraid of the practice of the elements, which involves a basis, they seek liberation from all suffering for themselves, and do not strive

to liberate all sentient beings; therefore they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Weary and afraid of the practice of the sense sources, which come together as formations and involve gathering, they seek liberation from all suffering for themselves, and do not strive to liberate all sentient beings; therefore they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle.

In the practice that involves connection, they abide and rely through the force of connection, and having abided and relied, they build up abiding and reliance. They take no delight in gathering all sentient beings to themselves and lack loving-kindness and compassion; because they are bound up with connection, they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Even when they see others undergoing much suffering, they leave them be and are not stirred to weariness, seeking liberation for themselves alone; therefore they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Having cut off the head of their own afflictions, they have no zeal for cutting off the head of the afflictions of all sentient beings; therefore they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Since they do not come down to awakening by the wheel of the Great Vehicle, they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Since they do not come down to awakening by the wheel of great light, they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle. Since they delight in and strive for going alone, without companions, to the city of nirvāṇa, they are not vessels for the Great Vehicle.

Son of noble family, there are beings who have not applied themselves to the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and have not taken up diligence; their faculties are not fully ripened, their faculties are weak, and their diligence is slight. If the very profound sacred Dharma of the Great Vehicle is taught to them, both the one who explains and the one who listens incur grave wrongdoing and evil, and that is an offense against all the buddhas.

Why is that? When beings who have not applied themselves to the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, who have not taken up diligence, whose faculties are weak and whose diligence is slight, hear the very profound sacred Dharma of the Great Vehicle, such beings are truly foolish and deluded. Though they claim to understand, they fall into the extreme of annihilation and into wrong perception. They teach that there is no cause, and hold that the results of actions do not exist, and so hold that all the good that is done and all the evil that is done amount to nothing. They speak falsely about the Great Vehicle and corrupt my sacred Dharma. They declare what is not the Dharma to be the Dharma, and the Dharma to be not the

Dharma. They declare those who are not ascetics to be ascetics, and true ascetics to be no ascetics. They declare what is not the Vinaya to be the Vinaya, and the true Vinaya to be not the Vinaya. Foolish, deluded by nature, in the grip of pride, wholly given over to jealousy and avarice, they praise, protect and spread the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, yet they scorn and disparage the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and do not spread it.

Such a person, relying on the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the unsurpassed true vehicle, goes forth from home into homelessness and receives full ordination, yet does not truly understand, just as it is, what it is to become a monk, nor truly understand, just as it is, the cause that gathers all wholesome qualities. And so, toward my disciples, whether they have become vessels of the Dharma or have not, whether they are striving as those still in training or as those beyond training, or have attained the fruit of the final stage, and toward good people who keep moral discipline, whose discipline has lapsed, or who have no discipline, such people revile and abuse them in all manner of ways, do them harm, steal their robes and alms bowls, refuse them the use of the requisites of life, and even seize them and put them in bonds.

Those who thus regard all causes and results as nonexistent and proclaim annihilation, though they dwell among humans, are truly called rākṣasas. In the future, for countless great eons, it will be hard for them to obtain a human body. It is easier for a being to undergo immeasurable suffering in hell than to hold the view of annihilation among humans.

Such a foolish person, before long, will have the limbs of his body cut to pieces; for many days his tongue will be mute and he will be unable to speak; and he will undergo the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. When he dies he will without doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment, and he will revolve through all the lower realms like a wheel, taking on much suffering, with no time of release. Even for a hundred thousand eons it will be hard for him to obtain a human body.

Even if, after immeasurable and countless eons have passed, he does obtain a human body, he will be born in a world realm of the five degenerations, where no buddha dwells. He will be blind from birth, deaf, mute, or without a tongue; tormented by diseases of every kind; short of body and ugly, so that no one finds him pleasing; unskilled in speech, his words unpleasant to the ear; his

mind constantly befuddled, understanding nothing; born into a poor and destitute family, obtaining nothing at all; never meeting a spiritual friend who is virtuous; delighting in following evil companions and doing evil deeds; attached to wrong views and delighting in committing the evils of immediate retribution. Because of this he will fall once again into the hell of Unceasing Torment, and it will be very hard for him to escape from the lower realms.

Such a foolish and deluded person, who proclaims annihilation and cessation, corrupts my sacred Dharma, and then zealously punishes my disciples, whether they keep moral discipline, have let their discipline lapse, or have no discipline, and does not let them practice in peace on the side of virtue. By that cause and that condition he will fall into the lower realms for a hundred thousand eons, going from darkness into darkness, with no time of release.

The evil of that being ripens in this way because, without having applied himself to listening to the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, he strives to listen to and apply himself to the very profound sacred Dharma of the Great Vehicle. Since such a foolish and deluded person, who proclaims the view of annihilation, will find it hard to obtain even the body of the lowest and most base of humans, what need is there to speak of his becoming a vessel for the noble Dharma? Since he will not attain even the nirvāṇa of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, what need is there to speak of his attaining the very profound, unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening? The fault of that being is that he entered into the Dharma of the Great Vehicle without having trained in the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Son of noble family, it is like this. If ghee and milk are poured into an unfired clay pot, it soaks them all up, and both the vessel and its contents are spoiled. Why is that? Because the vessel is flawed. In the same way, there are beings who have not thoroughly applied themselves to the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, who have not taken up true diligence, whose faculties are not fully ripened, whose faculties are weak and whose diligence is slight. If anyone explains the very profound sacred Dharma of the Great Vehicle to them, both the one who explains and the one who listens incur grave wrongdoing and evil, and it becomes the fault of offending all the buddhas, just as was explained at length above.

Again, it is like this. If precious wealth is placed inside a worldly treasury that is leaking, crumbling and falling apart, it will be wasted and lost. In the same

way, if the Great Vehicle is explained to beings who scorn and disparage the Dharma of the two vehicles, who have no faith in it and do not train in it diligently, they will not understand it correctly, just as it is. Because of that they will commit evil, and will not know how to bring saṃsāra to its end.

It is like boarding a leaking boat, full of holes, that can be neither rowed nor steered, and setting out on the ocean. In the same way, a being who is under the sway of avarice and jealousy, and who claims, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle," without having applied himself to the Dharma of the two vehicles, holds the view of annihilation; proud, with a body that leaks with deceit and guile, he cannot enter the ocean of omniscience.

It is like this: a person who is blind is no one to whom jewels of various kinds can be shown. In the same way, one who is under the sway of pride, heedless, attached to the view of emptiness, and blind because he lacks the eye of wisdom, not having trained in the two vehicles, is no one to whom the jewel-like qualities of the unsurpassed Great Vehicle can be shown.

It is like this: a body that is foul-smelling and rotting will not become fragrant, even if it is anointed with fragrant ointments of every kind. In the same way, beings who are foolish and deluded, in the grip of pride, without faith to exert themselves in the Dharma of the two vehicles, who have not given up killing, and so on up to not having given up wrong view, cannot understand the very profound Dharma, even if they apply themselves to the unsurpassed Great Vehicle.

It is like this: even if good seed is sown in a salt marsh and great labor is spent on it, no fruit or harvest will be gained. In the same way, beings who are proud and lazy toward the Dharma of the two vehicles and do not apply themselves to it, who are attached to the five sense pleasures and feel no weariness with them, will achieve nothing at all in that very body, even if they make efforts in the family of the Great Vehicle that are very hard to carry out.

It is like this: when a little sugar is later put into a pot that was earlier used as a vessel for poison, it is unfit for use. In the same way, if the Great Vehicle is taught to a being who does not apply himself to the Dharma of the two vehicles and who teaches that there is no cause, it will not bring benefit to himself or others.

It is like this: if a little poison is later put into a pot that was earlier used as a vessel for sugar, that too is unfit for use. In the same way, if the Great Vehicle is taught to a being who has not applied himself to the Dharma of the two

vehicles, both will decline and go astray.

It is like this: just as a madman whose mind is disturbed cannot tell one sound from another, even if all kinds of music are played before him, so too, there are beings who have not thoroughly applied themselves to the Dharma of the two vehicles, whose minds are corrupted by fierce afflictions such as attachment, aversion and delusion, who hold that there is no cause, who proclaim annihilation and nonexistence, and whose faculties are unripened. Even if the Great Vehicle is explained to them for a very long time, they cannot understand or realize it.

It is like this: whoever goes to the front line of battle without armor and carrying no weapons will without doubt be wounded and suffer. In the same way, if the Great Vehicle is explained to beings who have not applied themselves to the Dharma of the two vehicles, whose wisdom is weak, and who have not become fit in faculties or as vessels, then because they will without doubt grasp it wrongly, there will be no end to the evil deeds of every kind that they commit.

Such a foolish and deluded person, before long, will have the limbs of his body cut to pieces; for many days his tongue will be mute and he will be unable to speak; and he will undergo the great suffering of utterly unbearable sickness and fever. When he dies and passes on, he will without doubt be born in the hell of Unceasing Torment and will circle and wander through the lower realms, just as was explained at length before.

Therefore, son of noble family, the wise should first examine the mind of the other person, and only then teach the Dharma. They should first give rise to a mind of loving-kindness, a mind of compassion, a mind of joy, a mind of benefit, a mind free of laziness, a mind of great patience, a mind free of pride, a mind free of jealousy, a mind free of stinginess, and a mind of samādhi in meditative equipoise, and only then teach the sacred Dharma to the other person. They should not cause the other being, having heard the Dharma, to fall into the great abyss of circling in saṃsāra.

Therefore the Tathāgata, having fully understood the characteristics of the minds of all sentient beings, teaches the sacred Dharma by the wheel of stainless practice without appropriation. The bodhisattva great beings who have donned the great armor also teach the Dharma to others in the same way. Out of loving-kindness and affection they teach the sacred Dharma in order to cut off all afflictions completely, to bring beings across the ocean of

the three realms of existence, and to lead beings into the one vehicle, whichever of the three vehicles they have faith in, and swiftly bring them to completion. Never do they cause them to fall into the great abyss of circling in saṃsāra.

Now, why is it called the wheel of stainless practice? Here, "stainless" means this: when they teach the Dharma, it is not because aggregates exist, not because sense sources exist, not because elements exist; not because the desire realm exists, not because the form realm exists, not because the formless realm exists; not because this world exists, not because the world beyond exists; not because formations exist, not because feeling exists, not because perception exists, not because conceptual thought exists, not because awareness exists, not because attention exists; not because ignorance exists, and so on up to not because aging and death exist. They do not teach the sacred Dharma to beings because there is going or because there is no going. Rather, it is with all of these, the aggregates, elements and sense sources, and so on up to going and not going, as explained at length, completely stilled, that they teach the sacred Dharma to beings. That is why it is called "stainless."

"Practice" means this: they teach the Dharma to beings in order to cut off completely dying and passing from here and being born in the beyond. Teaching the Dharma to beings in order to cut off completely, in full, the aggregates, elements and sense sources, and likewise up to going and not going, is called "practice."

"Wheel" means this: just as the light of the full moon, very cool and clear, appears unobstructed in the sky and so becomes an unobstructed field of activity everywhere, so too the deeds of the tathāgatas and bodhisattvas, done through the three wheels of complete victory, namely all their miraculous powers, their higher knowledges that reveal what is known, and their instruction in what is to be trained in, reach without obstruction throughout every world realm, for the benefit and happiness of all beings who have become vessels. Not mingled with beings going for refuge elsewhere, not mingled with any of the worldly Lokāyatas, and not mingled with any of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, they cut off all the suffering of saṃsāra for beings and bring them to attain the supremely blissful nirvāṇa of awakening. That is called "wheel." In this way, these are called the wheel of stainless practice of the buddhas and bodhisattvas.

Now, why is it called the wheel of practice without appropriation? Unobstructed with regard to all phenomena, just as the disc of the sun shines everywhere, they teach the sacred Dharma without attachment, in accordance with the faculties and the capacity as vessels of those of the three vehicles. When the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma to beings, just as space has no characteristics of distinction, so he teaches the sacred Dharma to beings without attachment, sustained by immeasurable samādhis and by the mastery and array of the liberations. The bodhisattva great beings who have donned the great armor also teach the Dharma to others in the same way. Their teaching of the Dharma is neither of existence nor of nonexistence.

Form itself is not empty; what is other than form is not empty; and so on up to consciousness itself is not empty; what is other than consciousness is not empty. The eye itself is not empty; what is other than the eye is not empty; and so on up to the mind itself is not empty; what is other than the mind is not empty. Visible form itself is not empty; what is other than visible form is not empty; and so on up to mental phenomena themselves are not empty; what is other than mental phenomena is not empty. Eye consciousness itself is not empty; what is other than eye consciousness is not empty; and so on up to mind consciousness itself is not empty; what is other than mind consciousness is not empty.

The desire realm itself is not empty; what is other than the desire realm is not empty; and so on up to the sphere of infinite space itself is not empty; what is other than the sphere of infinite space is not empty. The sphere of infinite consciousness itself is not empty; what is other than the sphere of infinite consciousness is not empty. The sphere of nothingness itself is not empty; what is other than the sphere of nothingness is not empty. The sphere of neither perception nor non-perception itself is not empty; what is other than the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception is not empty.

The four applications of mindfulness themselves are not empty; what is other than the four applications of mindfulness is not empty; and so on up to the eightfold noble path itself is not empty; what is other than the eightfold noble path is not empty.

Dependent origination itself is not empty; what is other than the phenomena of dependent origination is not empty. The three things to be guarded themselves are not empty; what is other than the three things to be guarded is not empty. The four fearlessnesses themselves are not empty; what is other

than the four fearlessnesses is not empty. The ten powers themselves are not empty; what is other than the ten powers is not empty. The eighteen unshared qualities themselves are not empty; what is other than the eighteen unshared qualities is not empty. Great loving-kindness, great compassion, great joy and great equanimity themselves are not empty; what is other than great loving-kindness, great compassion, great joy and great equanimity is not empty. Nirvāṇa itself is not empty; what is other than nirvāṇa is not empty. This is called the Middle Way application of the tathāgatas and bodhisattvas in teaching the sacred Dharma to sentient beings.

Son of noble family, in this way the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma to beings by the wheel of stainless practice, and he teaches it at length in the manner set out before, beginning with "just as the light of the full moon, very clear and cool, pervades all of space without obstruction and appears unobstructed in every field of activity." By the wheel of practice without appropriation, too, he teaches the sacred Dharma, unobstructed with regard to all phenomena: just as the light of the sun shines everywhere, he teaches the sacred Dharma without attachment, in accordance with the capacity as vessels and the faculties of those of the three vehicles. When the Tathāgata teaches the Dharma to beings, just as space has no characteristics of distinction, so, sustained by the mastery of display through immeasurable samādhis and by their array, he teaches the sacred Dharma to beings without attachment, and leads them into whichever of the three vehicles suits them.

The bodhisattva great beings who have donned the great armor also teach the Dharma to others in the same way. They cause beings to hear this supreme, sacred, very profound Dharma, and lead them into the one vehicle, whichever of the three vehicles they are inclined toward. They bring their roots of virtue to full ripeness and establish them in ease in the one vehicle. They do not let any kind of evil, nonvirtuous action increase in the abode of saṃsāra, and they make all of them utterly steadfast in nirvāṇa and irreversible.

Son of noble family, the bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma in order to cut off completely the saṃsāra of countless, immeasurable beings. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others in order to cut off their own saṃsāra alone. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others in order to bring immeasurable, countless beings across the four floods. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others in order to bring themselves across the four floods. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others in order to cure the disease of the afflictions of

immeasurable, countless beings. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others in order to cure the disease of their own afflictions. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others in order to cut off, without remainder, the continuum of the habitual tendencies of the afflictions in the aggregates of all beings. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others in order to cut off, without remainder, the continuum of the habitual tendencies of the afflictions in their own aggregates alone.

The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others with great compassion as the cause, in order to accomplish the fruit of great compassion. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do not teach the Dharma to others with great compassion as the cause for the sake of the fruit of great compassion. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others with all beings as their focus. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others without beings as their focus. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others in order to pacify the suffering of all beings. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others in order to pacify their own suffering alone. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others in order to suffuse all beings with the taste of the Dharma. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others in order to suffuse themselves alone with the taste of the Dharma. The bodhisattva great beings teach the Dharma to others so that all beings may obtain the light of the Victor's Dharma. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas teach the Dharma to others so that they themselves alone may obtain the light of the Victor's Dharma.

Son of noble family, in brief, the bodhisattva great beings, through immeasurable vows, teach the Dharma to others in order to dispel completely the great darkness of ignorance of all beings, to dispel completely every great object of fear and everything that brings harm, and so that they may obtain great radiance of light, obtain great renown, and realize correctly, just as it is, the wisdom of omniscience. The śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, through slight vows, teach the Dharma to others in order to dispel their own darkness of ignorance, obtain a little radiance of light, obtain a little renown, and realize correctly, just as it is, a little of the wisdom that comprehends the Dharma.

Son of noble family, the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas have no true focus on others. They have no true compassion for others. They have no truly uncontemptuous attitude toward others. They have no true intention to bring benefit and happiness to others. They have no true intention to untie and free others. They have no true intention to lift others up. They have no true

intention to extol and praise others. They do not truly praise others without deceit and guile. They do not truly disregard their own bodies for others and accomplish the benefit and happiness of others. Nor are their actions of body, speech and mind toward others truly free from lapse.

Son of noble family, those who abide in the Great Vehicle truly have nothing whatsoever that they take as their own, and so on, likewise at length, up to: they truly have no actions of body, speech or mind that cause harm to others.

Fascicle seven.

Son of noble family, furthermore, there are beings who are vicious by nature, harsh and rough in their speech, truly foolish, deluded by nature, conceited about their knowledge, who have not given up killing, and so on up to not having given up wrong view. When they see others obtaining gain, honor, offerings and renown, they grow jealous. They constantly seek gain, honor, offerings and renown for themselves and are never satisfied. They praise themselves and disparage others. They do not restrain their own actions of body, speech and mind, and always delight in committing every kind of evil. Their minds are vicious; they have no compassion, no scruple and no shame, and they delight in harming others. They sort fields of merit into good and bad. They delight in finding fault with those who have entered my teaching and gone forth, watching for a chance to harm them. When the slightest fault appears, without examining whether it is true or false, they scorn and disparage them, revile and abuse them. Their minds are untamed, agitated and distracted; they delight in harming those who have gone forth. They give no thought to their own faults and criticize others. When they hear the qualities and praises of the Great Vehicle, the wish arises in them to seek it out and enter it, yet they delight in committing grave misdeeds and evil, and are not at peace at all.

In order to deceive others, they make a show of listening to the Dharma of the Great Vehicle themselves and of having others listen too, a show of reading and reciting it themselves and having others read and recite it too. In order to praise themselves they disparage others. Though such a person praises the Dharma of the Great Vehicle with a show of respect, he has never trained diligently in the domain of the Great Vehicle and has not grasped its meaning. Yet he claims, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle," and, in order to seek gain, renown and his own livelihood, he gets others to take him as their refuge and to study under him. He is like a Vinaya holder whose discipline has lapsed and

who commits evil: though his own discipline has lapsed and he commits evil, for the sake of gain and renown he urges others to study the Vinaya basket.

Such beings, possessed of deceit and crookedness and cheating by nature, will find it hard to obtain even the lowest of human bodies. They will fall away from and fail to attain even the gods of the higher realms and the nirvāṇa of the two vehicles, so what need is there to speak of attaining the Great Vehicle? That is impossible. When he dies and passes on, he will fall into hell, with no time of release. Therefore the wise should not keep company with him.

Without embarrassment or shame, for the sake of gain and honor, he roars a lion's roar in the midst of a large assembly, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle," and so he associates with and befriends those who are foolish and deluded. That is like a donkey that puts on a lion's skin and declares, "I am a lion." When a man sees it from afar, he takes it to be a real lion. But then, when it gives voice, everyone knows it is a donkey, and they all spit at it, each one saying, "Look, this is just a wretched donkey that eats filth!" and they abuse it with all kinds of foul words and go away.

In the same way, the person I have described, who delights in practicing the ten paths of nonvirtuous action, has burned the seed of all gods and humans. Since he has turned back even from the Dharma of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles, what need is there to speak of his becoming a vessel for the Great Vehicle? Such a foolish and deluded person, in the grip of pride, who deceitfully tells others, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle," and gathers gain and honor, is like a foolish man without hands or feet who enters battle to overcome the enemy: he achieves nothing but his own distress. In the same way, the one who deceitfully claims to be a follower of the Great Vehicle, lacking the hands of faith and the feet of moral discipline, does not weigh his own actions and conduct, and is bent on attacking the great battle of the afflictions; it comes to nothing for him but distress.

That person, who does not restrain the three doors and commits nothing but evil, though he claims, "I am a follower of the Great Vehicle," is not a vessel for the Dharma of the three vehicles. So there is no possibility that he will conquer the deeply entrenched enemy of the afflictions of all beings, or teach the eight branches of the noble path to all beings, or establish them in the fearless city of nirvāṇa.

Why is that? Son of noble family, what is called the Great Vehicle is this: to keep excellent moral discipline in perfect purity; to be endowed with the

practice of excellent and supreme virtue; to rely on excellent embarrassment and shame; to look closely at the fruit of suffering in the next world and fear it; to give up completely all nonvirtuous phenomena and take joy in applying oneself to all virtuous phenomena; to pervade all beings with loving-kindness and compassion; to strive to bring about the benefit and happiness of all beings; to rescue and deliver all beings from the suffering of saṃsāra; and, without regard for one's own bodily comfort, to bestow benefit and happiness on all beings. These are called abiding in the Great Vehicle.

Son of noble family, if you ask what characteristics one must possess to be called of the Śrāvaka Vehicle: there are those who abide happily in right mindfulness and, because they aspire to settle evenly in meditative absorption, are always diligent; who have given up deceit and guile and have faith in the fruits of karma; who are not attached to the five sense pleasures and are not tainted by the eight worldly concerns; who are intensely diligent in virtue, as though the crown of their head were on fire; who thoroughly examine the aggregates, the elements, and the sense sources; and who always aspire to abide happily in the lineage of the noble ones. Possessing these characteristics is called the Śrāvaka Vehicle. If such a person does not become even a vessel for the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, what need is there to speak of becoming a vessel for the Great Vehicle?

Son of noble family, if you ask what characteristics one must possess to be called of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle: there are beings who possess all those qualities of the śrāvakas and, in addition, abide in repeatedly contemplating the five appropriated aggregates as impermanent, abide in repeatedly contemplating their arising and cessation, and thoroughly understand that phenomena arising in dependence are subject to cessation. Possessing these characteristics is called the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Such a being is not a vessel for the Dharma of the Great Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

If virtuous kings of the kṣatriya caste,
Down to vaiśyas and śūdras who are exceedingly virtuous,
Cultivate the ten wheels, beginning with faith,
They become vessels for the Śrāvaka Vehicle.

Those of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle are pure in their three doors,
Possess embarrassment and shame, and fear the aggregates.
Knowing the danger of wrongdoing, they delight in remote dwellings;

With mindfulness they guard their senses, and their minds are calm.
Understanding dependent origination, they cultivate meditative concentration,
And they are skilled in understanding the aggregates, elements, and sense sources.
Through these ten wheels of abiding and conduct,
One becomes a vessel of the supreme vehicle and crosses the ocean of existence.

Those who, by the wheels of two vehicles and not of three,
Strive to free only themselves from the afflictions,
Who do not give up their habitual tendencies and do not liberate beings,
Such persons are not vessels of the Great Vehicle.

The childish, of weak faculties and lazy,
Who do not apply themselves earnestly to the two vehicles,
Will never come to possess the wheels of the Great Vehicle;
They are not vessels of the vast Great Vehicle.

The childish who seek liberation for themselves alone,
Weak in understanding and in conduct, lacking a loving mind,
Attached to the view of annihilation, are headed for the lower realms.
Those who reject the true Dharma and teach what is not Dharma,
Who disparage the two vehicles and abandon their vows,
Who are fully ordained and yet lay claim to the Great Vehicle,
Destroy my Dharma and deceive all beings;
Because of this, it will be hard for them to gain a human body.

If they harm or injure the noble ones who have entered my teaching
And those who wear the saffron robe,
Or revile them, or abuse them, or rob them of their bowls and robes,
They will long be deprived of the happiness of gods and humans.

Therefore, whoever wishes to gain a human body,
To be free of the defect of muteness at the time of death,
And always wishes to meet all the buddhas,
Must at all times protect the teachings of the three vehicles.

One who, among the three vehicles, longs for the supreme vehicle
Is skilled in examining the teachings of the three vehicles;
If with joy and enthusiasm one teaches them extensively to others,
One will surely become a buddha; give up all doubt of this.

Those of corrupt discipline, stingy and proud,
Who praise themselves, disparage others, and lay claim to the Great Vehicle:
Shun them, and rely on the wise.
Then you will surely awaken and pass beyond the three realms.

In accord with whichever of the three vehicles suits each one,
Teach the Dharma of the three vehicles with love and compassion.
If you carry this through to completion, expecting nothing in return,
You will surely awaken; give up all doubt of this.

Knowing the aggregates, elements, and sense sources to be at peace,
Abiding in nothing at all, like space,
Teaching the Dharma and gathering the many beings,
One attains immeasurable wisdom and sublime intelligence.

The wicked who delight in broken discipline,
Who, having heard of the supreme qualities of the Great Vehicle,
Lay claim to the Great Vehicle for the sake of gain and fame,
Are like a donkey wearing a lion's skin.

Today, here, I declare to the entire assembly:
Whoever wishes swiftly for supreme awakening,
Apply yourselves earnestly to the ten virtuous courses of action;
Do not disparage my Dharma, but guard it well.

Formerly, in other sūtras, I said:
"Those who long for great awakening should practice the Great Vehicle;
Abandon the vehicles of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas!"
That was Dharma taught to a pure assembly.

To those people of intense diligence
Who, having made offerings to countless koṭis of buddhas,
Have abandoned wrongdoing and trained their minds in purity,
I taught a single vehicle, without a second.

This present assembly holds vessels of the three vehicles.
Some possess the qualities of the Śrāvaka Vehicle;
Those daunted by the many undertakings of action
Are not vessels for supreme awakening.
Some delight in solitude and seek awakening for themselves alone;
They too are not vessels for supreme awakening.
Some are fit to be established in supreme wisdom.

Therefore teach the three vehicles according to their inclinations.

Those who wish for liberation through the ascetic practices alone,
If they hear the Great Vehicle explained, will fall into the lower realms.
It is like making one sick with a phlegm disorder drink milk:
For that one it turns to poison and does not cure the disease.
Likewise, those of the Śrāvaka Vehicle who are not fit vessels,
If they hear the Great Vehicle explained, become bewildered,
Proclaim annihilation, and fall into the lower realms.
Therefore I teach the Dharma after examining their faculties.

This concludes the fourth chapter, on abiding and conduct, from the Great Vaipulya Sūtra The Ten Wheels of the Bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha.

When the Blessed One had spoken these verses, within that circle of the assembly there were countless hundreds of thousands of beings who, on hearing the Dharma in the past, had misunderstood it, taking it to mean mere emptiness; they had come to view cause and effect as nonexistent, had completely severed their roots of virtue, and were about to fall into the lower realms. Having heard this sūtra explained, they once again came to possess right view. Then they rose from their seats and, feeling deep shame before the Blessed One, in order to confess individually, they joined their palms, bowed, and prostrated, and said to the Blessed One, "Venerable Blessed One, in the past we generated roots of virtue in the family of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, but before even that Śrāvaka Vehicle had fully matured in us, we heard the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Being confused about that as well, and not having realized it directly, we took the view of emptiness and held that there is no cause and no effect.

For that reason and on that account, we committed countless evil, nonvirtuous actions through body, speech, and mind, and so we were bound to fall into the lower realms. But today, having heard this sūtra explained in the presence of the Blessed One, we have regained right view, and with deep embarrassment and a sense of shame we confess these individually, without concealment. May they thereby be completely purified! From this day on, we wish to guard ourselves carefully so as never to commit any actions that would become obscurations. Blessed One, out of your loving care, please accept us, so that our evil deeds may be completely purified and we may not commit them again. Out of your loving care, please protect us from experiencing the

sufferings of the lower realms in the future. We will once again practice and apply ourselves earnestly to the Śrāvaka Vehicle that we practiced before, so, Blessed One, out of your loving care, please teach us."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent! It is excellent that you confess individually in this way, with embarrassment and a sense of shame. In my teaching there are two kinds of holy beings who do not fall away. The first is one who is pure by nature and from the very beginning commits no wrongdoing. The second is one who, even though wrongdoing has been done, confesses it individually with embarrassment and a sense of shame. These two kinds of holy beings are called those whose aspiration toward my Dharma is utterly pure."

Then the Blessed One taught them the Dharma of the four noble truths in accordance with their inclinations. Among that assembly, some attained the lesser forbearance, some attained the middling forbearance, some attained the highest forbearance, some attained the supreme worldly quality, some attained the fruit of stream-entry, some attained the fruit of once-returner, and some attained the fruit of non-returner. In addition, eighty-four thousand monks exhausted all defilements, their minds were liberated, and they became arhats whose understanding was perfectly pure. Rejoicing, they bowed to the Buddha and sat down again, each on his own seat.

Again, within that circle of the assembly, there were fifty-seven hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of beings who had mistaken the Dharma they had heard before to mean mere emptiness, had come to view cause and effect as nonexistent, had completely severed their roots of virtue, and were about to fall into the lower realms. Having heard this sūtra explained, they once again found right view. They rose from their seats, touched their heads to the feet of the Blessed One, and, with deep embarrassment and a sense of shame, confessed individually in the presence of the Blessed One. Joining their palms and bowing, they said to the Blessed One:

"Venerable Blessed One, in the past we generated roots of virtue in the family of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, but before we had fully matured even as vessels for the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, we heard the Dharma of the Great Vehicle. Though faith and devotion arose in us, we were blinded by ignorance and did not understand it, so we took the view of emptiness and held that there is no cause and no effect. For that reason and on that account, we committed countless evil, nonvirtuous actions with body, speech, and mind,

and so we were bound to experience many kinds of utterly unbearable suffering for countless eons and to fall into the lower realms. But today, having heard the sūtra explained in the presence of the Blessed One, we have regained right view, and, possessed of deep embarrassment and a sense of shame, with minds that conceal nothing, we confess individually. From this day on, we wish to guard ourselves carefully so as never to commit any actions that would become obscurations. Loving Blessed One, please accept us, so that our evil deeds may be completely purified and we may not commit them again. Blessed One, through your compassion, please protect us from experiencing the sufferings of the lower realms in the future. We will once again practice and apply ourselves earnestly to the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle that we practiced before, so, loving Blessed One, please teach us."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent! Excellent, excellent! It is excellent that you confess individually in this way, with embarrassment and a sense of shame. In my teaching there are two kinds of beings who do not fall away. The first is one who is pure by nature and from the very beginning commits no wrongdoing. The second is one who, even though wrongdoing has been done, confesses it individually with embarrassment and a sense of shame. These two kinds of holy beings are called those whose aspiration toward my Dharma is utterly pure."

Then the Blessed One taught them the Dharma of dependent origination in accordance with their inclinations. All of them applied themselves earnestly to the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and all of them gradually perfected the meditative absorption called Focused on the Victory Banner. Becoming irreversible from the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, they rejoiced, bowed to the Blessed One, and sat down again, each on his own seat.

Again, within that circle of the assembly, there were some eighty hundred thousand koṭis of beings who had disparaged the Dharma of the buddhas of the past, or, at the very least, had reviled a single verse of the Buddha's teaching. For that reason and on that account they had fallen into the lower realms and experienced much suffering, and even when they regained a human body, they were mute from birth, stammering and tongue-tied, unable to speak. Having heard this sūtra explained, they found right view. They rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and, with deep embarrassment and a sense of shame, confessed individually their former evil deeds in the presence of the Blessed One. Joining their palms and bowing, they gazed at the Blessed One without blinking.

The Blessed One blessed all of them so that they were able to speak. Then the Blessed One, though he knew, said to them, "What nonvirtuous actions did you do in the past, that you have become unable to speak within this circle of the assembly?"

They said to the Blessed One, "Venerable Blessed One, in the past, during the teaching of the Tathāgata Vipaśyin, some of us disparaged the Dharma of the Great Vehicle. Some disparaged the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Some disparaged the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle.

Through disparaging it, even if only a single verse of it, by the force of those nonvirtuous actions we have wandered in saṃsāra for ninety-one eons. We were born again and again among the hell beings, in the animal realm, and in the world of the pretas, where we were mute and stammering, without tongues and unable to speak, and experienced great and utterly unbearable suffering. Only in this life did we obtain a human body, and even so we were mute, stammering, and always afflicted with diseases of the tongue. Now, through the blessing of the Blessed One, we have become able to speak, and we have come to remember every obscuration of nonvirtuous action that we committed in times past."

Among them, some said this: "Venerable Blessed One, in the past, during the teaching of the Blessed One Śikhin, some of us disparaged the Great Vehicle, and some disparaged the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle," and so on, in the same way as the earlier account, explained in full just as before.

Among them, some said this: "Venerable Blessed One, in the past, during the teaching of the Tathāgata Viśvabhū, some of us disparaged the true Dharma of the Great Vehicle," and so on, in the same way as the account explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "Venerable Blessed One, in the past, during the teaching of the Tathāgata Krakucchanda, some of us disparaged the true Dharma of the Great Vehicle," and so on, in the same way as the account explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "Venerable Blessed One, in the past, during the teaching of the Tathāgata Kanakamuni, some of us disparaged the sacred Dharma of the Great Vehicle," and so on, in the same way as the account explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "Venerable Blessed One, in the past, during the teaching of the Tathāgata Kāśyapa, some of us disparaged the sacred Dharma of the Great Vehicle. Some disparaged the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Some disparaged the Dharma of the followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, even if only a single verse of it. Through that disparagement, by the force of nonvirtuous actions, we have wandered in saṃsāra ever since. We were born again and again among the hell beings, in the animal realm, and in the world of Yama, where we were mute and stammering, without tongues and unable to communicate, and experienced great and utterly unbearable suffering. Only in this life did we obtain a human body, and even so we were mute, stammering, afflicted with diseases of the tongue, and unable to make ourselves understood. Now, through the blessing of the Blessed One, we have at last become able to speak, and we have come to remember every obscuration of nonvirtuous action that we committed in times past. Having heard this sūtra explained in the presence of the Blessed One, we have regained right view, and with deep shame, embarrassment, and minds that conceal nothing, we confess individually. From this day on, we wish to guard ourselves carefully so as never to commit any actions that would become obscurations. Loving Blessed One, please accept us, so that our evil deeds may be completely purified and we may not commit them again. Blessed One, through your compassion, please protect us from experiencing the sufferings of the lower realms in the future as well, and please teach us the sacred Dharma."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent! Excellent, excellent! It is excellent that you confess individually in this way, with embarrassment and a sense of shame. In my teaching there are two who are called holy beings who do not fall away. The first is one who is pure by nature and from the very beginning commits no wrongdoing. The second is one who, even though wrongdoing has been done, confesses it individually with embarrassment and a sense of shame. These two kinds of holy beings are called those whose aspiration toward the Dharma of my teaching is utterly pure."

Then the Blessed One taught and explained to them many kinds of sacred Dharma, in accordance with their inclinations, and led each of them to attain the happiness that delighted them. Rejoicing, they bowed to the Blessed One and sat down, each on his own seat.

At that time, within that circle of the assembly, countless hundreds of thousands of śrāvakas and countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of

bodhisattvas, having heard this sūtra explained, remembered whatever obscurations of nonvirtuous action they had committed in the past. They bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and in the presence of the Blessed One they confessed individually with deep embarrassment and a sense of shame. Joining their palms, they said to the Blessed One with reverence:

"Venerable Blessed One, in the past, within the sacred Dharma of countless buddhas, some of us spoke like this: toward attendants of those buddhas, whether they had become vessels of the Dharma or had not, we were angry and hostile; we reviled and abused them, disparaged and despised them, and mocked and denigrated them in all kinds of ways; we looked for chances to harm them, and we concealed their good qualities and proclaimed their faults. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions, we fell into the lower realms for countless eons and experienced great and utterly unbearable suffering. Later we served and made offerings to countless buddhas. Moreover, we served, made offerings to, and attended upon countless bodhisattva great beings, and before each of those buddhas and each of those bodhisattva great beings we confessed individually, with deep embarrassment and a sense of shame, our obscurations of evil action. From each of those buddhas and each of those bodhisattva great beings we also heard countless Dharma discourses, and having heard them we applied ourselves with great earnestness and practiced countless austerities that are extremely hard to practice. Yet because a remainder of karmic obscuration was left, we did not attain the perfectly blissful nirvāṇa. Nor did we attain the special gateways of meditative absorption or their qualities. Today, having heard this sūtra explained in the presence of the Blessed One, we confess individually, with ever deeper embarrassment, with minds of shame, and with minds that conceal nothing. May these be completely purified! From this day on, we wish to guard ourselves carefully so as never to commit any actions that would become obscurations.

Loving Blessed One, please accept us, so that our evil deeds may be completely purified and we may not commit them again. Blessed One, through your compassion, please protect us from experiencing the sufferings of the lower realms in the future. Through the power of the Blessed One's blessing, please let us swiftly attain the bliss of nirvāṇa in accordance with our inclinations, and attain the special qualities of the gateways of meditative absorption."

Among them, some said this: "In the past, toward attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, we caused injury and harm with all kinds of harsh and cutting words. By the force of those evil, nonvirtuous actions we fell into the lower realms for countless eons," and so on, just as was explained in full above.

Some said this: "In the past, toward attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, we caused injury and harm by beating and striking them. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions we fell into the lower realms for countless eons," and so on, just as was explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "In the past we robbed attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, of their Dharma robes and alms bowls. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions we fell into the lower realms for countless eons," and so on, just as was explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "In the past we robbed attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, of all kinds of requisites for their livelihood, seized their food and drink, and obstructed them. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions we fell into the lower realms for countless eons," and so on, just as was explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "In the past we stripped attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, of their Dharma robes, reduced them to laypeople, and made them do all kinds of work. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions we fell into the lower realms for countless eons," and so on, just as was explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "In the past, toward ordained attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, whether they had done wrong or had done no wrong, we tormented them by putting them in iron chains, fetters, and wooden stocks. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions we fell into the lower realms for countless eons," and so on, just as was explained in full above.

Among them, some said this: "In the past, toward ordained attendants of a certain Blessed One, whether they were vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, we made them miserable with a domineering mind, through

injury and all kinds of harm. By the force of those nonvirtuous actions we experienced great and utterly unbearable suffering for countless eons. Later we served, made offerings to, and pleased countless buddhas. Moreover, we also served, made offerings to, and pleased countless bodhisattva great beings, and before each of those buddhas and each of those bodhisattva great beings we confessed those nonvirtuous actions individually, with deep embarrassment. From each of those buddhas and each of those bodhisattva great beings we also heard countless Dharma discourses, and having heard them we applied ourselves earnestly with strenuous diligence. Yet even though we practiced what is extremely hard to practice, because a remainder of karmic obscuration was left, we have still not attained the bliss of perfectly blissful nirvāṇa. We have not attained the special gateways of the qualities of meditative absorption. Today, having heard this sūtra in the presence of the Blessed One, we have confessed individually, with ever deeper embarrassment and without concealment, and have become completely purified. From this day on, we wish to guard ourselves carefully so as never to commit any actions that would become obscurations. Loving Blessed One, please accept us, so that our evil deeds may be completely purified and we may not commit them again. Blessed One, through your compassion, please protect us from experiencing the sufferings of the lower realms in the future. Through the power of the Blessed One's blessing, please let us swiftly attain the bliss of nirvāṇa, and also attain the special qualities of the gateways of meditative absorption."

Then the Blessed One said to that assembly of śrāvakas and bodhisattvas, "Excellent, excellent! It is excellent that you confess individually in this way, with deep embarrassment. There are two kinds of holy beings who never fall away. The first is one who is pure by nature and from the very beginning commits no wrongdoing. The second is one who, even though wrongdoing has been done, confesses it individually with embarrassment. These two kinds of beings are called those whose aspiration toward my teaching is utterly pure.

"Son of noble family, compared with the evil of harming the ordained attendants of the Buddha's teaching in this way, the deeds of immediate retribution and the near-equivalent evils described above are mere names; they should not even be called evils. If one harms an ordained attendant of the Buddha, that evil is immeasurably, incalculably greater than the evil of the five deeds of immediate retribution described above. Why is this? Even a monk whose moral discipline is broken and who commits evil can still show countless

hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of beings the unerring path to nirvāṇa. He becomes a treasury of jewels of great qualities for many beings, and so on, just as was explained in full. What need is there to speak of one who guards moral discipline and practices virtuous dharmas? Therefore, it should be understood that whoever injures or harms a disciple ordained in the Buddha's teaching cuts off the lineage of the Three Jewels. That is to gouge out the Dharma eye of all beings.

It is to ruin the sacred Dharma that I found long ago through practicing extreme austerities. It is to do immense harm to all beings. Therefore, if one harms someone ordained in the Buddha's teaching, that evil is immeasurably, incalculably greater than the evil of the five deeds of immediate retribution described earlier.

"Therefore, because today, before me, you have confessed individually all your former obscurations of nonvirtuous action with utterly pure intention, with heightened embarrassment, and with effort, you are embraced by great compassion, and all your obscurations of evil action will gradually be purified. In this buddhafield, before every one of the thousand buddhas who will appear in the Fortunate Eon, you must likewise confess thoroughly and individually, in the presence of those tathāgatas, all your obscurations of evil action. Guard yourselves carefully against future wrongdoing as well. The last of the thousand buddhas of the Fortunate Eon is the Tathāgata called Rocana, the arhat, the perfectly complete buddha, perfect in knowledge and conduct, the Sugata, knower of the world, unsurpassed guide of beings to be tamed, teacher of gods and humans, the Buddha, the Blessed One. In his presence too you must confess thoroughly and individually all your obscurations of evil action, and then they will be completely purified, without remainder."

At that time those śrāvakas and those bodhisattvas said, "So be it, Blessed One! If, at the time of Rocana, the last of the thousand buddhas, we will thus attain right view, completely abandon wrong views, purify all obscurations of evil action without remainder, and be liberated from all suffering, then even if we are born in the hell of Unceasing Torment during this Fortunate Eon and experience all kinds of suffering, we will endure it."

The Blessed One said, "Excellent, excellent! Through your courage, through the steadfastness of your strenuous diligence, and through the power of your aspiration, at the time of the Buddha Rocana you will without doubt purify all your former karmic obscurations, and with superior intention and with

reverence you will without doubt serve him and make offerings to him. The Tathāgata Rocana will without doubt cause you to become arhats who have completely cut off all afflictions. He will without doubt cause you to attain the special qualities of the gateways of meditative absorption."

Then those śrāvakas and those bodhisattvas, rejoicing, bowed at the feet of the Blessed One and sat down again, each on his own seat.

At that time the Blessed One said to the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha, "Son of noble family, when I examine the whole world with the eye of a buddha, I see that in the future, in this buddhafield, there will be countless, incalculable hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of beings: caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, caṇḍāla brahmins, caṇḍāla ministers, caṇḍāla householders, caṇḍāla merchant chiefs, caṇḍāla śramaṇas, as well as vaiśyas, śūdras, and caṇḍālas, men or women and so on. Though they will have obtained a human body by generating a small root of virtue, they will associate with nonvirtuous friends and generate wrong views, and through evil, nonvirtuous actions they will destroy my unsurpassed, most profound sacred Dharma. They will not spread my teaching; they will do away with what has spread, and they will not generate devotion. They will mock and disparage the sacred Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle that I have taught, creating obstacles and interruptions and not spreading it. At times they will mock and disparage the sacred Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle that I have taught, creating obstacles and interruptions and not spreading it. At times they will mock and disparage the sacred Dharma of the unsurpassed vehicle that I have taught, creating obstacles and interruptions and not spreading it. At times, toward those ordained in my teaching, whether vessels of the Dharma or not vessels of the Dharma, they will give rise to hatred, revile and abuse them, disparage them, look for chances to harm them with all kinds of words, mock and denigrate them, conceal their good qualities and proclaim their faults, and likewise, with a disparaging mind, do them injury and all kinds of harm.

"Such persons, who have not become vessels for the noble Dharma, are thoroughly foolish and deluded by nature. Proud and puffed up with conceit over the little they know, as soon as they pass from this life they will fall into the three lower realms and experience great, utterly unbearable suffering for immeasurable ages. For countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons it will be hard for them to obtain a human body, and so on, just as was explained in full above.

"Son of noble family, it would be easier for such a being to dwell in the great hell of Unceasing Torment and experience great suffering than to have such an evil body, gripped by pride, following evil friends and doing nonvirtuous deeds, and so wandering in saṃsāra, extremely hard to rescue, forever tormented by suffering in saṃsāra."

At that time, within that circle of the assembly, countless, incalculable beings of great intelligence rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, and, turning toward the Blessed One with palms joined and tears streaming, said to the Blessed One:

"Venerable Blessed One, even though these beings of the world have found a human body, so very hard to obtain, they completely abandon faith. They completely abandon right aspiration. They completely abandon right devotion and right view. They completely abandon spiritual friends. They completely abandon the right time, the right place, and pure moral discipline. They completely abandon right meditative absorption and right wisdom. Although these beings have obtained a human body, so very hard to obtain, through foolishness, ignorance, and pride they commit all the grave evils described above: they mock and disparage the sacred Dharma of the Blessed One, and they injure and harm the ordained attendants of the Blessed One's teaching.

Today, in the presence of the Blessed One, with one-pointed mind we make a true vow. From this day forward, from now on as we wander in saṃsāra, until we attain liberation, we vow never to meet such evil friends, never to commit such evil deeds, never to disparage the sacred Dharma of the Buddha, never to harm persons who have gone forth, never to put out the Dharma eye of sentient beings, and never to break the lineage of the Three Jewels. Blessed One, out of compassion for us, please accept these vows that we have made.

At that time, within that assembly, countless hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of intelligent beings rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, joined their palms, bowed, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, today in the presence of the Blessed One we wish to make a vow with resolute intention. From now on, as we wander in saṃsāra, until we attain forbearance regarding the Dharma, may we not become kings. May we not become ministers. May we not become governors of a land. May we not become lords of towns, cities, or villages. May we not become lords commanding armies. May we not become guild masters. May we not become lords with authority over offerings and monasteries. May

we not become lords over guild masters, householders, and renunciants. May we not become masters or teachers. May we not take the body of a householder. May we not become those empowered to pass judgment. May we not become lords of wealth and power. If, without having attained forbearance regarding the Dharma, we were born in such a station, that very thing would be called becoming a cause of unwholesomeness for the Buddha's teaching. Because we would commit great and blameworthy evils, it would be called mocking and disparaging the sacred Dharma spoken by the Blessed One. It would be injuring and harming those who have gone forth in the Buddha's teaching. It would be putting out the Dharma eye of many sentient beings. It would be breaking the lineage of the Three Jewels. It would be doing harm and injury to countless sentient beings. Because of that we would without doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment, and there would be no time of release from wandering in the lower realms. Blessed One, out of compassion for us, please bless these aspirations."

At that time all who had gathered in that assembly, the gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, humans, nonhumans, and others, rose from their seats, bowed their heads at the feet of the Blessed One, shed tears, joined their palms, bowed, and said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, wandering in saṃsāra since beginningless time, through foolishness, ignorance, and pride we have generated every kind of unwholesome karma. Unwholesome actions of body, unwholesome actions of speech, and unwholesome actions of mind, whether we did them ourselves, had others do them, or rejoiced on seeing or hearing them done: all these evils, today in the presence of the Blessed One, with a mind of deep shame and without concealment, we confess one by one. May we guard ourselves fully so as never to do them again, and may the evils that would become obscurations in times to come be purified." In the same way they said it once, twice, and up to three times.

"From this day forward, until we reach the end of saṃsāra, may we never meet evil friends, and may we not fall under the power of unwholesomeness. Even if we do meet them, we wish to vow with resolute intention not to follow them. May we not commit any of those evil deeds. May we not experience suffering for a long time. Blessed One, out of compassion for us, please accept these aspirations."

Then the Blessed One declared to all those assembled: "Excellent, excellent! It is excellent that you, fearful of future suffering and filled with shame, have made confession one by one. It is excellent that you have made such

aspirations in order to cross over the great river of saṃsāra and to enter the fearless city of nirvāṇa.

"Son of good family, when bodhisattva great beings possess these ten qualities, they attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path. What are the ten? Son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell on the inner body, do not dwell on the outer body, do not dwell on the outer and inner body, do not dwell on the past body, do not dwell on the future body, and do not dwell on the present body. Through this first quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell on inner feeling, do not dwell on outer feeling, do not dwell on feeling that is both outer and inner, do not dwell on past feeling, do not dwell on future feeling, and do not dwell on present feeling. Through this second quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell on inner perception, do not dwell on outer perception, do not dwell on perception that is both outer and inner, do not dwell on past perception, do not dwell on future perception, and do not dwell on present perception. Through this third quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell on inner formations, do not dwell on outer formations, do not dwell on formations that are both outer and inner, do not dwell on past formations, do not dwell on future formations, and do not dwell on present formations. Through this fourth quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell on inner consciousness, do not dwell on outer consciousness, do not dwell on consciousness that is both outer and inner, do not dwell on past consciousness, do not dwell on future consciousness, and do not dwell on present consciousness. Through this fifth quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell in this world. Through this sixth quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance

regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell in this world. Through this seventh quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell in the desire realm. Through this eighth quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell in the form realm. Through this ninth quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path.

"Furthermore, son of good family, bodhisattva great beings do not dwell in the formless realm. Through this tenth quality, bodhisattva great beings attain forbearance regarding the Dharma of the true and faultless path."

When the Blessed One taught this Dharma discourse, within that assembly some seventy-two hundred thousand koṭis of bodhisattva great beings attained forbearance regarding the unborn nature of phenomena. Some eighty-four hundred thousand koṭis of niyutas of bodhisattvas attained the forbearance that accords with the Dharma. Some hundreds of thousands of countless śrāvakas attained everything from the complete severing of all afflictions up to arhatship. Some hundreds of thousands of niyutas of sentient beings generated the mind set on unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening, which they had not generated before, and came to abide on the stage of irreversibility from the wisdom of the Tathāgata. Countless, immeasurable sentient beings generated the mind of a pratyekabuddha, which they had not generated before. And countless, immeasurable sentient beings generated the mind of a śrāvaka, which they had not generated before.

Then again the Blessed One declared to the great assembly: "A sentient being who has attained forbearance regarding the Dharma I permit to take up the position of a kṣatriya king consecrated on the crown of the head, to enjoy precious wealth of every kind, and to enjoy a position of great eminence; but no other sentient being."

The bodhisattva Vajragarbha again said this to the Blessed One: "Blessed One, do you then definitely not permit a sentient being who has not attained forbearance regarding the Dharma to occupy the position of a kṣatriya king consecrated on the crown of the head, to enjoy precious wealth of every kind,

and to occupy a position of great eminence? Or is there also an occasion when you permit it?"

The Blessed One declared: "If a sentient being, even though he has not attained forbearance regarding the Dharma, practices the ten courses of wholesome action and also causes other sentient beings to train in them, then I permit him too to dwell in the position of a kṣatriya king consecrated on the crown of the head and to enjoy precious wealth of every kind and other positions of great eminence. But some sentient beings have not attained forbearance regarding the Dharma, do not practice the ten courses of wholesome action, and do not establish other sentient beings in training either, yet by great force and coercion they become kings consecrated on the crown of the head and enjoy precious wealth of every kind and positions of great eminence. These are called caṇḍāla kṣatriyas, caṇḍāla lords who enjoy other positions of great eminence as well. Foolish, deluded, and seized by pride, they destroy my most profound sacred Dharma. They cut off the lineage of the Three Jewels and leave the lamp of the sacred Dharma extinguished. They inflict many kinds of harm and injury on those who have gone forth in my teaching: they beat them, revile them, and punish them; they rob them of their robes, their alms bowls, and their means of livelihood; they strip them of their robes, reduce them to householders, and force them to do all sorts of labor; they bind them and imprison them, and even deprive them of life. They mock and disparage the sacred Dharma of my teaching, obstruct it, hinder it, and do not let it flourish, and they seize the property of stūpas and of the Saṅgha. Such a person will without doubt fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment, experience great suffering, and wander in the lower realms with no time of release."

Then the bodhisattva Vajragarbha asked further: "Blessed One, there are sentient beings who have not attained forbearance regarding the Dharma, do not practice the ten courses of wholesome action, and do not encourage other sentient beings to practice them either, yet by great force and coercion become kings in the position of one consecrated on the crown of the head, and dwell amid precious wealth of every kind and other positions of great eminence. Is there any other cause or any other means by which they may be brought out of the hell of Unceasing Torment and also freed from the suffering of the other lower realms?"

The Blessed One declared: "There is another cause and another means by which they can be brought out."

"Suppose a sentient being who has assumed kingship, consecrated on the crown of the head, and enjoys many kinds of wealth, has not attained forbearance regarding the Dharma and does not possess the ten courses of wholesome action either, yet possesses the power of faith. He serves and honors the Three Jewels. He does not mock or disparage, interrupt, or obstruct the sacred Dharma of the Buddha's teaching, which comprises the three vehicles, not even so much as a single verse. He does not harm, injure, revile, beat, or punish any of the ordained attendants of the Buddha's teaching, whether they keep moral discipline, have broken their moral discipline, or have no moral discipline at all, provided they have shaved their hair and beards and wear saffron robes. He does not rob them of their robes, their alms bowls, or their means of livelihood; he does not strip them of their robes, reduce them to householders, and put them to labor; he does not throw them into prison, nor go so far as to deprive them of life. He does not seize the property of stūpas or of the Saṅgha. He does not incite base and wicked people to harm and injure those who have gone forth, nor incite them to seize and make use of the property of the Three Jewels. With respect he listens to the sacred Dharma of the Buddha's teaching, which comprises the three vehicles, and retains it; and having listened and retained it, he strives with diligence and earnestness to follow the Dharma just as it has been taught. With respect he makes offerings to, honors, and serves the noble attendants of the three vehicles that I have taught. He makes a firm commitment to the Great Vehicle and gives rise to no doubt and no thought of turning back. And he leads other sentient beings as well to have faith in and trust the Great Vehicle, to retain it, and to apply themselves earnestly to training in it. If so, then this caṇḍāla kṣatriya, and other caṇḍālas of great eminence, were permitted even by the buddhas of the past to be consecrated to kingship and to enjoy many kinds of wealth. Even though they enjoy villages, cities, and all riches, they will not fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment, nor will they fall into any of the other lower realms. Such a one I too permit to be consecrated to kingship and to enjoy many kinds of wealth. Thus, even though such beings enjoy villages and cities, they will not fall into the hell of Unceasing Torment, nor will they fall into the other lower realms.

"Any sentient being who wishes to purify all the obscurations of evil karma, without exception, should earnestly train in this Dharma discourse that I have taught and retain it. Whoever, in this way, in the presence of the Saṅgha, confesses his evil deeds one by one with a mind of deep shame and remorse,

will have all the evil deeds committed in former times purified completely, without exception."

The eighth fascicle.

At that time the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha again said this to the Blessed One: "Venerable Blessed One, how is a bodhisattva great being free of error regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle? How is he free of error regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle? How is he free of error regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle? How is he free of error regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle? How is he free of error regarding the Great Vehicle? How is he free of error regarding persons of the Great Vehicle? How does he make the lineage of the Three Jewels flourish continually? How is he free of error regarding all who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels for the Dharma or not, even those who merely wear a scrap of robe and have shaved their hair and beards? How does he advance ever higher in the Dharma of the Great Vehicle and become irreversible? How do keen wisdom and special merit continually arise and increase in him? How does he gain mastery of the meditative absorptions, the dhāraṇīs, the forbearances, and the grounds, and become irreversible in them? How does he always meet spiritual friends and live in harmony with them? How is he never parted from seeing all the buddhas, never parted from bodhisattvas and from the śrāvaka attendants, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings to and honoring the Saṅgha? How, striving earnestly in all roots of virtue, is his mind never satiated? How is his mind never satiated with the many kinds of conduct of awakening?"

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha: "Son of good family, there are ten kinds of wheels of the bodhisattva great being. A bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten wheels will be free of error regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will be free of error regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will be free of error regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will be free of error regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will be free of error regarding the Great Vehicle. He will be free of error regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. He will make the lineage of the Three Jewels flourish continually. He will be free of error regarding all who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels for the Dharma or not, even those who merely wear a scrap of robe and have shaved their hair and beards.

He will advance ever higher in the Dharma of the Great Vehicle and be irreversible. Keen wisdom and special merit will continually arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery of all the meditative absorptions, the dhāraṇīs, the forbearances, and the grounds, and be irreversible in them. He will always meet spiritual friends and follow them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and pratyekabuddha attendants, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings to and honoring the Saṅgha. Striving in all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satiated, and his mind will never be satiated with the conduct of awakening and with aspirations of many kinds. Whatever evil, unwholesome deeds he committed in the past will all be destroyed without remainder by the noble wisdom of the Dharma, hard and sharp like a vajra, so that he will not experience their fruit in ripening. He will commit no new evil, unwholesome deeds at all. With a mind free of weariness and discouragement he will turn the unsurpassed wheel of Dharma. His mind will be free of weariness and discouragement in applying himself to the seven precious limbs of awakening. And with a mind free of weariness and discouragement in subduing the diseases of affliction of all sentient beings, he will become the support and refuge of all sentient beings and sustain them.

"Son of good family, it is like this. Wherever a universal monarch possessed of the seven precious things goes, the precious wheel goes first, and the other precious things follow behind it. It travels throughout the four continents, clearing away all turbidity of body and mind of all sentient beings, and causing the happiness of body and mind of all sentient beings to arise and increase. In the same way, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten wheels will attain everything from being free of error regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle up to becoming the support and refuge of all sentient beings and sustaining them.

"Son of good family, it is like this. A great chariot has four wheels; many people sit within it and travel along a great road. Whatever is on that road, whether clods of earth, potsherds, gravel, grass, wood, leaves, branches, flowers, or fruits, all of it passes under the wheels of that chariot and is crushed and broken, so that none of it is of any use. In the same way, a bodhisattva great being who possesses the ten kinds of wheels completely destroys all obscurations of affliction, obscurations of sentient beings, and obscurations of phenomena, so that he does not take on their ripening.

"Son of good family, it is like this. A sharp discus, hurled for an instant, cuts off the head and limbs of an opposing enemy and leaves him powerless to act. In

the same way, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten kinds of wheels overcomes all the great suffering of wandering through the five destinies and completely cuts off all afflictions and evil deeds, so that he does not take on their ripening.

"Son of good family, it is like this. When the aeon of fire comes, five suns rise at once, and there is no moisture belonging to the water element, whether in the rivers, lakes, or streams of the four continents, that is not dried up. In the same way, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten kinds of wheels completely dries up the four currents, the obscurations of affliction, the obscurations of sentient beings, the obscurations of phenomena, and everything that ripens into the roots of suffering.

"Son of good family, it is like this. When the aeon of wind comes, great winds arise from the four directions at once, and every world system, with its mountains great and small and all its great lands, is destroyed and scattered. In the same way, when a bodhisattva great being possesses these ten kinds of wheels, there is nothing among the four worldly distortions and all the mountains of pride that is not shattered, and all the obscurations of affliction, obscurations of sentient beings, and obscurations of phenomena of all sentient beings, and all the roots of the painful ripening of suffering, are destroyed and scattered.

"Son of good family, it is like this. When the maned king of lions lets out his roar for a single instant, all wild beasts take flight, and all creatures are terrified and unable to move. In the same way, when a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten kinds of wheels proclaims the sound of the Dharma for a single instant, all non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and all evil friends who teach wrongly are seized with fear and terror, their words become confused, and they are unable to question or dispute.

"Son of good family, it is like this. When Śakra, lord of the gods, battles the asuras, and he enters the fray surrounded by the army of the gods and holding a vajra in his hand, all the asuras turn back in fear. In the same way, before a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten kinds of wheels, all non-Buddhists of wrong view and all evil friends who teach wrongly flee in fear.

"Son of good family, it is like this. When a precious wish-fulfilling jewel is fastened to the top of a victory banner, precious things of every kind fall like rain, providing for all poor and destitute beings. In the same way, a

bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten kinds of wheels and stands on the victory banner of pure moral discipline pours down the great rain of the Dharma, and so provides for all sentient beings without measure.

"Son of good family, it is like this. At nighttime, when the whole world has become dark and people are bewildered and have lost their way, the full moon rises, dispels all the darkness, and shows the way to those who have lost it. In the same way, when a bodhisattva great being possesses these ten kinds of wheels, he teaches the sacred Dharma to sentient beings who are blinded by the darkness of ignorance and have lost the noble eightfold path. He dispels all the darkness of ignorance, and because the light of the Dharma has dawned for them, the noble eightfold path becomes manifest, so that they cut off all defilements and bring suffering to an end.

"Son of good family, it is like this. When the great disk of the sun rises in the world, all crops grow and increase; all flowers, crops, and leaves flourish; all stench and filth are cleared away; the grain of the crops and the fruits of medicinal plants all ripen; and all the snow mountains melt, so that all the streams roar and gradually flow down into the great ocean. In the same way, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten kinds of wheels abides in superior generosity, and the qualities of disciplined moral conduct, gentle patience, diligence, meditative concentration, wisdom, skillful means, loving-kindness, compassion, and eloquence flourish fully in him, and he teaches the sacred Dharma to all sentient beings. By the splendor of the light of that Dharma, the roots of virtue of all sentient beings, the many kinds of superior crops, grow and increase; the sacred flowers and the many kinds of leaves of superior conduct flourish fully; all the bad deeds of affliction are completely cleared away; the fruits of the higher realms and of nirvāṇa fully ripen; all the mountains of wrong view and pride melt and flow down, so that the waters of true faith, moral discipline, learning, generosity, wisdom, and meditative absorption gradually flow down and fill the ocean of nirvāṇa; and all sentient beings, just as they wish, enter the fearless city of nirvāṇa.

"Son of good family, what then are the ten wheels of the bodhisattva great being? Son of good family, it should be understood that what are called the ten wheels are not to be ascribed to any other dharma: they are the ten courses of wholesome action themselves. It is because he possesses these ten kinds of wheels that one is called a bodhisattva great being. He is fully liberated from all evil, he perfects all wholesome qualities just as he wishes, he swiftly fills the ocean of great nirvāṇa, and by the light of the wisdom of great skill in means

he brings all beings to full maturity, benefits them all, and leads them to attain happiness. Why is that? Son of good family, all the buddhas, the blessed ones of the past, also attained the fruit by completely abandoning the ten courses of unwholesome action and wholeheartedly extolling these ten courses of wholesome action. Therefore, whoever guards even some of these ten courses of wholesome action that have been taught, without lapse for as long as he lives, will attain every supreme and exceptional fruit, just as has been taught.

"Furthermore, son of good family, when a bodhisattva great being completely abandons killing for as long as he lives, that itself is the gift of fearlessness to all sentient beings. Because he does not cause sentient beings fear and anxiety, he does not produce for them the suffering of fear, and by virtue of this all his roots of virtue are swiftly brought to completion. From beginningless time, sunk in the ocean of wandering through the five destinies, by virtue of killing he has committed evil, unwholesome deeds with body, speech, and mind, has had others commit them, and has rejoiced in them on seeing and hearing of them, and he has thus been obscured by the obscurations of affliction, the obscurations of sentient beings, the obscurations of phenomena, and the obscurations of life. Now the wheel of completely abandoning killing destroys and crushes all of these without remainder, so that he does not experience their fruit in ripening.

"Even in this very body, gods, humans, and all others will be delighted with him and find him pleasing, no suspicion will arise toward him, he will be thoroughly happy in body and mind, and he will live long. And when the time of death and transmigration comes, his body and mind will not be tormented by suffering; surrounded by beloved children, wife, and all his household as he passes away, he will not see the most terrifying messengers of Yama. Moreover, he will meet beloved spiritual friends, tamed by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, true fields of merit; he will be filled with joy in body and mind, and with reverence for them, deep faith will arise in him. And after he passes from that life he will be reborn again among humans, with all his faculties complete and all his limbs intact. Wherever he is born he will be free of illness, long-lived, handsome, upright of mind, and thoroughly happy and content. Moreover, he will meet beloved spiritual friends, tamed by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, true fields of merit. Following their training, he will completely abandon killing, completely cut off all evil, unwholesome qualities, perfect all exceptional wholesome qualities, and seek out all the Dharma discourses of

the Great Vehicle. Gradually devoting himself to all the aspirations and practices of the bodhisattvas, he will enter the vast ocean of wisdom and go on until he attains unsurpassed awakening.

"In his buddha field there will be no weapons, and the very words 'enemy' and 'harm' will not be heard. Sentient beings will be born in a field free of every fear, thoroughly happy and content, free of illness, and long-lived. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma in whatever way will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the first wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of taking life. If a bodhisattva great being possesses that wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the full flourishing of the lineage of the Three Jewels, nor regarding the disciples who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not, down to the least of them, who merely wear a patch of monastic robe and have shaved off hair and beard.

"In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise higher and higher and be irreversible. Sharp wisdom and a special merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience, and grounds, and will be irreversible. He will always meet spiritual friends and follow them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka disciples, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings and paying homage to the Saṅgha. Diligent in seeking all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satisfied, and his mind will never have its fill of the conduct of awakening and of aspirations of every kind. The other results he attains are as has been explained in detail.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, when a bodhisattva great being completely abandons taking what is not given for as long as he lives, that very abstention is the gift of fearlessness to all sentient beings. Because he dwells without

tormenting anyone and without harming anyone, content with wealth he has himself obtained properly, and without hope for wealth or profit gained contrary to the Dharma, by the power of this all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion.

"Beings have circled through the five destinies from beginningless time and sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra, and this too is because, through the power of taking what is not given, they have themselves committed the unwholesome paths of body, speech, and mind, have urged others to commit them, and have rejoiced at what they saw and heard. They have been veiled by the obscurations that arise from this: the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration regarding sentient beings, the obscuration regarding the Dharma, and the obscuration regarding jewels and wealth. Since the wheel of completely abandoning taking what is not given destroys all of these without remainder, he does not experience their ripened result.

"In this very life, gods, humans, and others all delight in him and find him pleasing, so no suspicion arises toward him. His body and mind are thoroughly at ease, and he comes to possess all wealth and jewels. When the time of his death and passing comes, his body and mind are not tormented by suffering. Surrounded by beloved sons, wife, and all his household, he will not see, at the time of death and passing, the most terrifying messengers of Yama. Moreover, he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit, and with body and mind filled with joy, he will develop faith toward him, together with reverence.

"After passing from that life he is born once again among humans, with faculties complete and limbs whole. Wherever he is born, he possesses great wealth, is fair of form, is upright of mind, and is thoroughly happy and at ease, and his wealth does not become something shared with the five dangers. Again he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, possessed of merit and good qualities, a true field of merit. Training under him, he will completely abandon taking what is not given, cut off completely all evil and unwholesome phenomena, perfect all the special wholesome phenomena, seek out all the Dharma discourses of the Great Vehicle, and gradually devote himself to all the aspirations and conduct of bodhisattvas, and he will enter the vast ocean of wisdom and go on until he attains unsurpassed awakening.

"Moreover, sentient beings will be born in his buddha field, a field adorned with jewels of many kinds, filled with jewel trees, jewel pools, jewel palaces, and the like, free of grasping at I and mine, and arrayed with every ornament. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma in whatever way will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the second wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of taking what is not given. If a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle.

He will make no mistake regarding the full flourishing of the lineage of the Three Jewels, nor regarding the disciples who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not, down to the least of them, who merely wear a patch of monastic robe and have shaved off hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise higher and higher and be irreversible. Sharp wisdom and a special merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience, and grounds, and will be irreversible. He will always meet spiritual friends and follow them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka disciples, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings and paying homage to the Saṅgha. Diligent in seeking all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satisfied, and his mind will never have its fill of the conduct of awakening and of aspirations of every kind. The results he attains are also as has been explained.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, when a bodhisattva great being completely abandons sexual misconduct for as long as he lives, that very abstention is a gift to all sentient beings: freedom from the fear of being distracted by the winds of desire, freedom from jealousy, freedom from harm, freedom from torment, and freedom from strife. Because he is content with his own wife and has no longing for the wives of others, by the power of this all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion.

"Beings have circled through the five destinies from beginningless time and sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra, and this too is because, through the power of sexual misconduct, they have themselves committed unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, have urged others to commit them, and have rejoiced at what they saw and heard. They have been veiled by the obscurations that arise from this: the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration regarding sentient beings, the obscuration regarding the Dharma, and the obscuration regarding wives. Since the wheel of completely abandoning sexual misconduct destroys all of these without remainder, he does not take on their ripened result.

"In this very life, gods, humans, and others all delight in him and find him pleasing, so no suspicion arises toward him. His body and mind are thoroughly at ease, and his wife will not be unfaithful. When the time of his death and passing comes, his body and mind are not tormented by suffering. He passes away surrounded by beloved sons, wife, and all his household, and he will not see the most terrifying messengers of Yama. Moreover, he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit, and with body and mind filled with joy, and with reverence toward him, he will develop deep faith in him.

"After passing from that life he is born once again among humans, with faculties complete and limbs whole. Wherever he is born, he has an excellent household, is fair of form, is upright of mind, and is thoroughly happy and at ease. Again he will meet a most pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. Training under him, he will completely abandon sexual misconduct, completely abandon all evil and unwholesome phenomena, perfect all the special wholesome phenomena, seek out all the Dharma discourses of the Great Vehicle, and gradually devote himself to all the aspirations and conduct of bodhisattvas, and he will enter the vast ocean of wisdom and go on until he attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will have no women. Sentient beings free of attachment and lust, endowed with supreme celibate conduct, will be born in that field, and all of them will be born miraculously, not from an impure womb. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma to sentient beings in whatever way will tame them. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and

happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the third wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of sexual misconduct. If a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the full flourishing of the lineage of the Three Jewels, nor regarding the disciples who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not, down to the least of them, who merely wear a patch of monastic robe and have shaved off hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise higher and higher and be irreversible. Sharp wisdom and a special merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience, and grounds, and will be irreversible. He will always meet spiritual friends and be in harmony with them. He will never be parted from seeing the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka disciples, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings and paying homage to the Saṅgha. Diligent in seeking all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satisfied, and his mind will never have its fill of the conduct of awakening and of aspirations of every kind. The other results he attains are as has been explained.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, when a bodhisattva great being completely abandons lying for as long as he lives, he will always be honored by all sentient beings. The words he sets down will be taken as authoritative, everyone will listen to his words with respect, and no doubt about them will arise. By the power of this his roots of virtue will be brought to completion.

"Beings have circled through the five destinies from beginningless time and sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra, and this too is because, through the power of lying, they have themselves committed evil and unwholesome actions with body, speech, and mind, have urged others to commit them, and have rejoiced at what they saw and heard. They become veiled by the obscurations that arise from this: the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration regarding sentient beings, the obscuration regarding the Dharma, and the obscuration regarding authoritative speech. Since the wheel of completely abandoning

lying destroys all of these without remainder, he will not take on their ripened result.

"In this very life, gods, humans, and others all delight in him and find him pleasing, no suspicion arises toward him, his body and mind are thoroughly at ease, and others trust and listen to everything he says. When the time of his death and passing comes, his body and mind are not tormented by suffering. He passes away surrounded by beloved sons, wife, and all his household, and he will not see the most terrifying messengers of Yama. Moreover, he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit, and with body and mind filled with joy, and with reverence toward him, he will develop deep faith.

"After passing from that life he is born once again in a human body, with faculties complete and limbs whole. Wherever he is born, his words carry authority, he is fair of form, upright of mind, and thoroughly happy and at ease. He meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. Training under him, he completely abandons lying, cuts off completely all evil and unwholesome phenomena, perfects all the special wholesome phenomena, seeks out all the Dharma discourses of the Great Vehicle, and gradually devotes himself to all the aspirations and conduct of bodhisattvas, and he will enter the vast ocean of wisdom and go on until he attains unsurpassed awakening.

"In his buddha field, everyone speaks the truth. Sentient beings free of deceit, adorned with divine speech, never misleading, upright in the workings of their minds, engaged solely in the pure white dharmas of right conduct, wearing fragrant divine garments, and arrayed with jewel ornaments, will be born in that field. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the Dharma in whatever way will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the fourth wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of lying. If a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake

regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding bringing about the full flourishing of the lineage of the Three Jewels, nor regarding the disciples who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not, down to the least of them, who merely wear a patch of monastic robe and have shaved off hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise higher and higher and become irreversible. Sharp wisdom and a special merit will always increase and arise in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience, and grounds, and will be irreversible. He will always meet spiritual friends and follow them. He will never be parted from seeing the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka disciples, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings and paying homage to the Saṅgha. Diligent in seeking out all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satisfied, and his mind will never have its fill of the conduct of awakening and of aspirations of every kind. The other results he attains are as has been explained.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, when a bodhisattva great being completely abandons divisive speech for as long as he lives, he will always be honored and held in high esteem by all sentient beings. Others will listen to everything he says, they will be reconciled, and no suspicion will arise. By the power of this his roots of virtue will be brought to completion.

"Beings have circled through the five destinies from beginningless time and sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra, and this too is because, through the power of having engaged in divisive speech, they have themselves committed unwholesome actions with body, speech, and mind, have urged others to commit them, and have rejoiced at what they saw and heard. They become veiled by the obscurations that arise from this: the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration regarding sentient beings, the obscuration regarding the Dharma, and the obscuration regarding reconciliation. Since the wheel of completely abandoning divisive words destroys all of these without remainder, he does not take on their ripened result.

"In this very life, gods, humans, and others all delight in him and find him pleasing, no suspicion arises toward him, his body and mind are thoroughly at ease, and people listen to everything he says and are reconciled. When the time of his death and passing comes, his body and mind are not tormented by suffering. He passes away surrounded by beloved sons, wife, and all his household, and he will not see the most terrifying messengers of Yama.

"He meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit, and with body and mind filled with joy, and with reverence toward him, he will develop deep faith. After passing from that life he is born once again among humans, with faculties complete and limbs whole. Wherever he is born, the words he speaks are gentle and reconciling, he is fair of form, upright of mind, and thoroughly happy and at ease. Again he meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. Training under him and entirely free of divisive words, he cuts off completely all evil and unwholesome phenomena, perfects all the special wholesome phenomena, seeks out all the Dharma discourses of the Great Vehicle, and gradually devotes himself to all the aspirations and conduct of bodhisattvas, and he will enter the ocean of wisdom and go on until he attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will be utterly stable, solid, and indestructible, and fully adorned with fine divine substances. Sentient beings who live in harmony, without dispute, thoroughly gentle and reconciled, and who seek wholesome dharmas will be born in that field. They will always listen to the sacred Dharma in concord and with respect. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma by whatever means will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the fifth wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of divisive speech. If a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the full flourishing of the lineage of the Three Jewels, nor regarding the disciples who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not, down to the least of them, who merely wear a patch of monastic robe and have shaved off hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise higher and higher and be irreversible. Sharp wisdom and a special merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over

all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience, and grounds, and will be irreversible. He will always meet spiritual friends and follow them. He will never be parted from seeing the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka disciples, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings and paying homage to the Saṅgha. Diligent in seeking all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satisfied, and his mind will never have its fill of the conduct of awakening and of aspirations of every kind. The other results he attains are as has been explained.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, when a bodhisattva great being completely abandons all harsh words for as long as he lives, he will be honored and held in high esteem by all sentient beings. Whatever he says, others will all delight in it and listen, and they will have no suspicion. By the power of this all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion.

"Beings have circled through the five destinies from beginningless time and sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra, and this too is because, through the power of harsh words, they have themselves committed unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, have urged others to commit them, and have rejoiced at what they saw and heard. They have been veiled by the obscurations that arise from this: the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration regarding sentient beings, the obscuration regarding the Dharma, and the obscuration regarding gentleness. Since the wheel of completely abandoning harsh words destroys all of these without remainder, by its power he does not take on their ripened result at all.

"In this very life, gods, humans, and others all delight in him, so no suspicion arises toward him. His body and mind are thoroughly at ease, and everything he says is pleasing and sweet to others. When the time of his death and passing comes, his body and mind are not tormented by suffering, and he is not afflicted. He passes away surrounded by beloved sons, wife, and all his household, and he will not see the most terrifying messengers of Yama. He meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit, and with body and mind filled with joy, and with reverence toward him, he will develop deep faith.

"After passing from that life, when he is born once again among humans, he has faculties complete and limbs whole. Wherever he is born, he speaks gentle words, is fair of form, upright of mind, and thoroughly happy and at ease. Again he meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma,

possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. Training under him, he completely abandons harsh words, cuts off completely all evil and unwholesome phenomena, perfects all the special wholesome phenomena, seeks out all the Dharma discourses of the Great Vehicle, and gradually devotes himself to all the aspirations and conduct of bodhisattvas, and he enters the vast ocean of wisdom and goes on until he attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will be free of every unpleasant sound, and that field will be filled with pleasing, melodious sounds of many kinds and with the sound of the Dharma. Sentient beings endowed with mindfulness and intelligence, having the voice of Brahmā, and thoroughly gentle, will be born in that field, and they will always encourage one another with gentle words. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the Dharma in whatever way will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the sixth wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of harsh words. Because a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the full flourishing of the lineage of the Three Jewels, nor regarding the disciples who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, whether they are vessels of the Dharma or not, down to the least of them, who merely wear a patch of monastic robe and have shaved off hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise higher and higher and be irreversible. Sharp wisdom and a special merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience, and grounds, and will be irreversible. He will always meet spiritual friends and come to follow them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka disciples, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings and paying homage to the Saṅgha. Diligent in seeking all roots of virtue, his mind will never be satisfied, and his mind will never have its fill of the conduct of awakening and of aspirations of

every kind. The other results he attains are as has been explained.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, because a bodhisattva great being completely abandons idle talk for as long as he lives, he will be honored and held in high esteem by all sentient beings. Everything he says will be meaningful, and those who hear his words will listen with respect and have no suspicion. By the power of this all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion.

"Beings have circled through the five destinies from beginningless time and sunk into the ocean of saṃsāra, and this too is because, through the power of idle talk, they have themselves committed unwholesome actions of body, speech, and mind, have urged others to commit them, and have rejoiced at what they saw and heard. They have been veiled by the obscurations that arise from this: the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration regarding sentient beings, the obscuration regarding the Dharma, and the obscuration regarding meaningful speech. Since the wheel of completely abandoning idle talk destroys all of these without remainder, he does not take on their ripened result.

"In this very life, gods, humans, and others all delight in him and find him pleasing, so there is no suspicion toward him. His body and mind are thoroughly at ease, and everything he says is meaningful. When the time of his death and passing comes, his body and mind are not tormented by suffering. He passes away surrounded by beloved sons, wife, and household, and he will not see the most terrifying messengers of Yama. He meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit, and with body and mind filled with joy, and with reverence toward him, he will develop deep faith.

"After passing from that life he is born once again among humans, with faculties complete and limbs whole. Wherever he is born, he speaks words that are beneficial and meaningful, is fair of form, upright of mind, and thoroughly happy and at ease. Again he meets a pleasing spiritual friend, one tamed by the Dharma, possessed of moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. Training under him, he completely abandons idle talk, cuts off completely all evil and unwholesome phenomena, perfects all the special wholesome phenomena, seeks out all the Dharma discourses of the Great Vehicle, and gradually devotes himself to all the aspirations and conduct of bodhisattvas, and he will enter the vast ocean of wisdom and go on until he

attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will be free of all meaningless words, and that field will be pervaded by many kinds of supreme and sublime sounds of the great Dharma belonging to the Bodhisattva Piṭaka. Sentient beings who, through immeasurable aspirations and perfect sublime wisdom, are skilled at explaining the meaning of the Dharma in its many aspects will be born in that field. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma in whatever way will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the seventh wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of idle talk. Because a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. The lineage of the Three Jewels will flourish fully, and he will make no mistake regarding those who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, the disciples, whether they are vessels for the Dharma or not vessels for the Dharma, down to those who merely wear a scrap of Dharma robe and have shaved their hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise ever higher and higher and will not turn back. Sharp wisdom and an exceptional merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience and grounds, and will not turn back. He will always meet spiritual friends and follow them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never be parted from seeing the bodhisattvas and the disciples who are śrāvakas, never be parted from hearing the Dharma, and never be parted from making offerings to and serving the Saṅgha. His mind will never be sated in striving to seek out all roots of virtue, and his mind will never be sated with the conduct of awakening and with aspirations of every kind. The other results he will obtain are as has already been explained.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, if a bodhisattva great being completely abandons covetousness for as long as he lives, all sentient beings will honor him and regard him as venerable. His mind will be pure and free of turbidity,

and by its power all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion. From beginningless time he has wandered in saṃsāra through the five destinies and sunk in the ocean of saṃsāra; under the power of covetousness he has himself committed evil, nonvirtuous actions of body, speech and mind, has urged others to commit them, and has rejoiced on seeing and hearing them done. From this arise the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration concerning sentient beings and the obscuration concerning phenomena, and he is obscured by an obscuration that prevents freedom from covetousness. Yet because the wheel of completely abandoning covetousness destroys all of this utterly, without remainder, he will not undergo its result in karmic maturation. Even in this very body, gods, humans and others will all delight in him and find him pleasing. He will be free of anxiety, his body and mind will be thoroughly at ease, and his mind will be pure and free of turbidity. When the time comes for him to die and pass on, he will not be tormented by suffering in body or mind. He will die and pass on surrounded by beloved children, wife and retinue, and he will not see the terrifying messengers of Yama. He will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one disciplined by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. His body and mind will be filled with joy, and with reverence for that friend he will give rise to deep faith.

"When he has passed on from that life, he will be reborn again among humans, with his faculties complete and his limbs whole. Wherever he is born, his mind will be pure and without turbidity; he will be handsome in appearance, upright in mind, and supremely happy and content. Once again he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one disciplined by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. He will train by following him, completely abandon covetousness, entirely cut off nonvirtuous qualities, bring all the exceptional virtuous qualities to completion, and seek out all the Dharma teachings of the Great Vehicle. He will gradually devote himself to all the aspirations and conduct of a bodhisattva and enter the ocean of vast wisdom, until he finally attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will be level like the palm of a hand and filled with many kinds of jewels. It will be thick with jewel trees of every variety, and filled with jewel garments, jewel ornaments and adornments, jewel victory banners, flags and parasols, nets of gold, silver and pearls, trees and the like. Sentient beings will be born in that field who are most pleasing and beautiful to behold, who have entirely abandoned pride, who are exceedingly handsome in appearance, whose faculties are unimpaired, and whose minds are impartial, and it will be

adorned with the perfect quality of freedom from covetousness. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma according to whatever will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the eighth wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of covetousness. Because a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. The lineage of the Three Jewels will flourish fully, and he will make no mistake regarding those who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, the disciples, whether they are vessels for the Dharma or not vessels for the Dharma, down to those who merely wear a scrap of Dharma robe and have shaved their hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise ever higher and higher and will not turn back. Sharp wisdom and an exceptional merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience and grounds, and will not turn back. He will always meet spiritual friends and be in harmony with them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never be parted from seeing the bodhisattvas and the disciples who are śrāvakas, never be parted from hearing the Dharma, and never be parted from making offerings to and serving the Saṅgha. He will never be sated in striving to seek out all roots of virtue, and his mind will never be sated with the conduct of awakening and with aspirations of every kind. The other results he will obtain are as has already been explained."

The ninth section.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, if a bodhisattva great being completely abandons malice for as long as he lives, all sentient beings will honor him and hold him in high esteem. His mind will be pure and free of stain, and by its power all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion. From beginningless time he has wandered in saṃsāra through the five destinies and sunk in the ocean of saṃsāra; under the power of malice he has himself committed evil, nonvirtuous actions of body, speech and mind, has urged others to commit them, and has rejoiced on seeing and hearing them done. From this arise the

obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration concerning sentient beings and the obscuration concerning phenomena, and he has been obscured by an obscuration consisting in acts of malice. Yet because the wheel of completely abandoning malice destroys all of this utterly, without remainder, he will not undergo its result in karmic maturation. Even in this very body, gods, humans and others will all delight in him and find him pleasing. He will not be anxious, and his mind will be pure and free of stain. When the time comes for him to die and pass on, he will not be tormented by suffering in body or mind. He will die and pass on surrounded by beloved children, wife and all his retinue, and he will not see the terrifying messengers of Yama. He will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one disciplined by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. His body and mind will be filled with joy, and with reverence for that friend he will give rise to deep faith.

"When he has passed on from that life, he will be reborn again among humans, with his faculties complete and his limbs whole. Wherever he is born, his mind will be pure and free of stain; he will be handsome in appearance, upright in mind, and supremely happy and content. Once again he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one disciplined by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. He will train in harmony with him, completely abandon malice, entirely cut off all evil and nonvirtuous qualities, bring all the exceptional virtuous qualities to completion, and seek out all the Dharma teachings of the Great Vehicle. He will gradually devote himself to all the aspirations and conduct of a bodhisattva and enter the ocean of vast wisdom, until he finally attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will be free of all turbidity, blemishes, clouds, mist, dust, dirt, unpleasantness and unsightliness. It will be beautifully adorned with many jewels and delightful. Sentient beings will be born in that field who are free of pride, lovely and beautiful in form, whose faculties are unimpaired, and whose minds are always at peace, and it will be adorned with loving-kindness, compassion and perfect qualities. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the sacred Dharma according to whatever will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time and bring benefit and happiness to countless sentient beings.

"Son of noble family, this is the ninth wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of malice. Because a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle,

and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. The lineage of the Three Jewels will flourish fully, and he will make no mistake regarding those who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, the disciples, whether they are vessels for the Dharma or not vessels for the Dharma, down to those who merely wear a scrap of Dharma robe and have shaved their hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise ever higher and higher and will not turn back. Sharp wisdom and an exceptional merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience and grounds, and will not turn back. He will always meet spiritual friends and train under them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never be parted from seeing the bodhisattvas and the disciples who are śrāvakas, never be parted from hearing the Dharma, and never be parted from making offerings to and serving the Saṅgha. His mind will never be sated in striving to seek out all roots of virtue, and his mind will never be sated with the conduct of awakening and with aspirations of every kind. The other results he will obtain are as has already been taught.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, if a bodhisattva great being completely abandons wrong view for as long as he lives, all sentient beings will honor him and hold him in high esteem. His mind will be pure and free of wrong conceptions, and by its power all his roots of virtue will be brought to completion. From beginningless time he has wandered in saṃsāra through the five destinies and sunk in the ocean of saṃsāra; under the power of wrong view he has himself committed evil, nonvirtuous actions of body, speech and mind, has urged others to commit them, and has rejoiced on seeing and hearing them done. From this arise the obscuration of the afflictions, the obscuration concerning sentient beings and the obscuration concerning phenomena, and he has been obscured by an obscuration to right view. Yet because the wheel of completely abandoning wrong view destroys all of this without remainder, he will not undergo its result in karmic maturation. Even in this very body, gods, humans and others will all delight in him and find him pleasing. He will be free of anxiety, his body and mind will be thoroughly at ease, and his mind will be pure and free of wrong view. When the time comes for him to die and pass on, he will not be tormented by suffering in body or

mind. He will die and pass on surrounded by beloved children, wife and all his retinue, and he will not see the terrifying messengers of Yama. He will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one disciplined by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. His body and mind will be filled with joy, and with reverence he will give rise to deep faith.

"When he has passed on from that life, he will be reborn again among humans, with his faculties complete and his limbs whole. Wherever he is born, his mind will be pure and free of wrong view; he will be handsome in appearance, upright in mind, and supremely happy and content. Once again he will meet a pleasing spiritual friend, one disciplined by the Dharma, endowed with moral discipline and good qualities, a true field of merit. He will train in harmony with him, completely abandon the doctrines of wrong view, entirely cut off all evil and nonvirtuous qualities, bring all the exceptional virtuous qualities to completion, and seek out all the Dharma teachings of the Great Vehicle. He will gradually devote himself to all the aspirations and conduct of a bodhisattva and enter the ocean of vast wisdom, until he finally attains unsurpassed awakening.

"His buddha field will be free of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles, free of all the retinues of Māra of the gods, and free of all the retinues of the non-Buddhists. It will be adorned with jewels of every kind and exceedingly beautiful. Sentient beings will be born in that field who possess right view and have completely abandoned all belief in marvels and auspicious omens, all the various corrupt views, the eternalist view, the nihilist view, and every view of a self and of what belongs to a self. They will be very long-lived and will enjoy the single taste of the Great Vehicle. The lifespan of that tathāgata will be immeasurable, and he will teach the Dharma according to whatever will tame sentient beings. Even after his complete nirvāṇa, the sacred Dharma will remain for a long time, and for the benefit and happiness of countless sentient beings, the teaching of the Dharma of a single taste will spread fully without dispute, and there will be no obstructing spirits and no hindrances.

"Son of noble family, this is the tenth wheel of the bodhisattva great being: the complete abandonment of wrong view. Because a bodhisattva great being possesses these ten wheels, he will make no mistake regarding the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and he will make no mistake regarding persons of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. He will make no mistake regarding the Great Vehicle, and he will make no mistake

regarding persons of the Great Vehicle. The lineage of the Three Jewels will flourish fully, and he will make no mistake regarding those who have gone forth in the teaching of the Tathāgata, the disciples, whether they are vessels for the Dharma or not vessels for the Dharma, down to those who merely wear a scrap of Dharma robe and have shaved their hair and beard. In the Dharma of the Great Vehicle he will rise ever higher and higher and will not turn back. Sharp wisdom and an exceptional merit will always arise and increase in him. He will gain mastery over all meditative absorptions, dhāraṇīs, forms of patience and grounds, and will not turn back. He will always meet spiritual friends and train under them. He will never be parted from seeing all the buddhas, never be parted from seeing the bodhisattvas and the disciples who are śrāvakas, never be parted from hearing the Dharma, and never be parted from making offerings to and serving the Saṅgha. His mind will never be sated in striving to seek out all roots of virtue, and his mind will never be sated with the conduct of awakening, with aspirations, and with the six perfections. The other results he will obtain are as has already been explained.

"Son of noble family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses these ten wheels will swiftly attain manifest, complete awakening in unsurpassed, perfect awakening. Why is that? Because all the tathāgatas, arhats, perfectly complete buddhas of the past likewise completely abandoned the ten nonvirtuous actions, and all of them praised and extolled the result of the path of the ten virtuous actions. For the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, to make the path of awakening arise and grow, to remove without remainder the suffering of karma and afflictions of all sentient beings, to dry up the three lower realms, to sustain the lineage of the Three Jewels, to cut off existence in the three realms entirely, to cut off the aggregates, the elements and the sense sources, and to lead all beings swiftly into the city of fearless nirvāṇa, they completely abandoned the results of the ten nonvirtuous actions, just as has been explained.

"Therefore, son of noble family, suppose someone has not accomplished this path of the ten virtuous actions as it truly is, or at the very least does not guard even a few of the paths of the ten virtuous actions as they truly are, and yet says, 'I will attain manifest awakening,' or 'I truly practice the Great Vehicle,' or 'I am accomplishing unsurpassed, perfect awakening.' That person is a great liar. In the presence of the buddhas, the blessed ones of the ten directions, he deceives the world. Without scruple and without shame, he talks of emptiness while holding a nihilist view. He is a fool, ignorant, and a

deceiver. Know that when he passes on from that life he will fall into the lower realms.

"Son of noble family, if merely saying the words, or merely hearing them, were enough, and awakening and nirvāṇa could be attained without needing to cultivate the path of the ten virtuous actions or to apply oneself diligently, then within a single eon, in a single instant, all sentient beings, as numerous as the atoms of the earth in all the buddha fields of the ten directions, would attain manifest awakening and pass into nirvāṇa. But no such thing is possible. Why is that? Because the path of the ten virtuous actions is the root of the Great Vehicle. It is the cause of awakening, and it is like a staircase to nirvāṇa.

"Son of noble family, if merely generating the resolve or merely making aspirations were enough, and awakening and complete nirvāṇa could be attained without needing to apply oneself diligently to becoming habituated to the path of the ten virtuous actions, then within a single eon, in a single instant, sentient beings as numerous as the atoms of the earth in all the buddha fields of the ten directions would attain manifest awakening in perfect awakening and pass into nirvāṇa. But no such thing is possible. Why is that? Because the path of the ten virtuous actions is the cause of the distinctive results and qualities, both worldly and beyond the world.

"Son of noble family, if one does not apply oneself diligently to the path of the ten virtuous actions, then even if for eons as numerous as the atoms in all the buddha fields of the ten directions one says, 'We are followers of the Great Vehicle,' and teaches, or listens, or generates the resolve, or makes aspirations, one will not attain awakening and nirvāṇa, nor will one be able to bring others out of the suffering of saṃsāra.

"Son of noble family, it is through diligence in the path of the ten virtuous actions that there come to be in the world the great families of kṣatriyas, brahmins and the like, and all states from the gods of the Four Great Kings up to the summit, the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception; and likewise the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and everything up to unsurpassed, perfect awakening. All of these come about through the distinctions and differences in how intensely one applies oneself to the path of the ten virtuous actions.

"Therefore, son of noble family, whoever wishes to attain unsurpassed, perfect awakening swiftly should be adorned with the ornament of diligence in the path of the ten virtuous actions; if he does not remain committed to the ten

nonvirtues, he will attain manifest awakening in unsurpassed, perfect awakening. Whoever wishes swiftly to enter the domain of the Great Vehicle's practice, or wishes swiftly to attain unsurpassed, perfect awakening, or wishes swiftly to bring all virtuous qualities to completion, should first guard the path of the ten virtuous actions with great care. Why is that? Because the path of the ten virtuous actions is the cause that brings about all virtuous qualities, the ground on which good qualities are established, and the attainment of the supreme results, both worldly and beyond the world. Therefore, apply yourself with great diligence to the path of the ten virtuous actions."

Then, to set out these points clearly once again, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

"Those who wish to cut off all the suffering of existence
And to attain great awakening
Should not be lazy in their diligence in the wheels of the ten virtues,
But should exert themselves in it.

Toward the sacred Dharma of the three vehicles,
Toward persons of the three vehicles,
And toward all who have gone forth,
They will come to be free of mistakes.

With faith and devotion for the practice of the Great Vehicle,
And realizing the supreme Dharma
That brings relief to the whole assembly,
They swiftly attain great awakening in that pure field.

If one completely abandons killing,
All will honor one and hold one in high esteem;
One will always be free of illness and long-lived,
Happy and content, and free of harm.

In every place where one is born,
One will be devoted to the path that is the buddhas' domain,
One will see the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
And swiftly attain unsurpassed awakening.

If one completely abandons taking what is not given,
The wise will honor one and hold one in high esteem;
Every path by which desire arises will be stilled,
And freedom from desire will arise.

In all one's births one will be endowed with wealth
And will become a great patron,
And one will also attain a lovely buddha field
Adorned with many jewels.

If one completely abandons sexual misconduct,
The stains of the afflictions will be stilled,
The ocean of existence that is desire will dry up,
And one will swiftly attain a pure buddha field.

Many kinds of sentient beings, too,
One will draw out of the mire of desire;
Having firmly established them in the Great Vehicle,
One will set them to practice pure conduct.

If one completely abandons speaking falsehood,
One attains the faculties and wisdom of the noble ones;
One always delights in speaking the truth
And crushes the suffering that comes from falsehood.

Because one's single word is held as reliable,
One sees the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha;
By cultivating the refusal to speak falsehood,
One swiftly attains great awakening.

If one completely abandons divisive speech,
One becomes a vessel for virtuous qualities;
One sees the Buddha, the Dharma and the Saṅgha,
And never falls into the nihilist view.

One attains the noble ones' joy free of attachment
And the dhāraṇī of the treasury of jewels;
One understands the ocean of the profound Dharma
And swiftly attains unsurpassed awakening.

If one abandons cutting words
And speaks gentle and tender words,
All sentient beings will honor one,
And even one's former nonvirtuous karma will be stilled.

One's assembly will always rejoice,
And one will become a teacher of bodhisattvas;
One will know the domain of many buddhas

And will even pass beyond the ten grounds.

If one completely abandons idle talk,
The wise will honor one and hold one in high esteem;
All the words one speaks to others
Will come to have five qualities.

Always listening to the words of the noble ones,
One will delight in seeking the noble path;
Fulfilling the ocean of the buddhas' qualities,
One will swiftly attain omniscience.

If one completely abandons covetousness,
Does not disparage the noble ones,
And honors those who wear the saffron robe,
One accomplishes the awakening of the three vehicles.

One is always born in pure fields
And comes to abide in the station of a teacher;
Mounted on the unsurpassed vehicle,
One swiftly attains the wisdom of the Victor.

If one completely abandons malice
And single-mindedly cultivates a mind of loving-kindness,
One will swiftly attain meditative equipoise
And will be devoted to the domain of the noble ones.

One will be born in a pure buddha field,
Free from every fault and defect;
Abiding there, one attains awakening.
So all malice should be abandoned.

If one completely abandons wrong view
And cultivates a mind of pure faith,
One will be devoted to the teaching of the three vehicles
And will make offerings to all the buddhas.

Completely freed from the three lower realms,
One will meet the noble Saṅgha,
Will possess the qualities of a bodhisattva,
And will attain supreme wisdom as well.

It is said that through the paths of the ten virtuous actions
Supreme awakening is attained,
And the meditative attainments, the dhāraṇīs,
The grounds and the forms of patience arise.

Through this wheel of great nature
All the lower realms are utterly conquered,
All the obscurations of evil are destroyed,
And great awakening is swiftly attained."

This concludes the sixth chapter, called "The Path of the Ten Virtuous Actions," from the noble great extensive sūtra called The Ten Wheels of Kṣitigarbha.

"Furthermore, son of noble family, the bodhisattva great being has ten wheels, the great armor of the giving of material things. A bodhisattva great being who possesses those wheels has, from his very first generation of the resolve, cleared away the five sense pleasures. He far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

"What are the ten? They are as follows. He gives food of every kind, drink, clothing, jewel ornaments, oxen, horses, chariots, the limbs of his body, his feet, hands, ears, nose, head, eyes, marrow, brain, skin, bones, flesh and blood, his land, his kingdom, his children, his wife, his male and female servants, his house, his fields and pastures, and so on. When he makes each of these gifts, he has no regard for his body or his life. He does not generate the resolve and give out of a wish for the worldly or supramundane happiness of himself alone. Rather, he generates the resolve to give gifts in order to make the sprout of great loving-kindness and great compassion grow toward all sentient beings. He generates the resolve to give gifts in order to develop skill in means and supreme wisdom. He generates the resolve to give gifts out of great loving-kindness toward all sentient beings, for the sake of their benefit and happiness. He generates the resolve to give gifts in order to remove the suffering of all sentient beings. He gives gifts with a mind free of the thought of being above others, a mind free of harshness, a mind free of jealousy, and a mind free of miserliness and reluctance. Whatever the thing given may be, large or small, even if he gives no more than a single handful of food, he generates the resolve to give gifts without hoping for a result in karmic maturation. He generates the resolve to give gifts without hoping for the result

of the Śrāvaka Vehicle. He generates the resolve to give gifts without hoping for the result of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. Whatever the thing given may be, large or small, even if he gives no more than a single handful of food, he generates the resolve to give gifts while dedicating it to the wisdom of omniscience.

"Son of noble family, if a bodhisattva great being possesses these ten wheels, the great armor of the giving of material things, then because he has cleared away the five sense pleasures at his first generation of the resolve, he far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, served and fully protected by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles. Why is that? When śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas generate the resolve to give gifts, they have no mind of loving-kindness and great compassion; they give gifts in order to be rid of their own poverty, to free themselves from suffering, to gain happiness for themselves, and to bring themselves to nirvāṇa. They do not give for the sake of all sentient beings. When a bodhisattva great being gives gifts, he gives with a mind of loving-kindness and great compassion, in order to remove the poverty and want of all sentient beings, to bring all sentient beings out of suffering, to bring all sentient beings to happiness, and to lead all sentient beings to nirvāṇa. He does not practice giving for his own sake alone. For this reason he far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, served and fully protected by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

"When a bodhisattva great being practices the perfection of the giving of material things, his mind is not attached to the finest of the five sense pleasures. He gives to all sentient beings every comfort that is his own to give. He gives while abiding in a mind that gathers in all sentient beings, a mind of patience that pays no heed to any suffering of his own, a mind intent on stilling the suffering of all sentient beings, a mind that gives happiness to all sentient beings, and a mind intent on leading all sentient beings to nirvāṇa. Therefore he far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, served and protected by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

"Son of noble family, if one's mind is not attached to the five sense pleasures and one gives with loving-kindness and great compassion, one is called a

bodhisattva great being, and one is called a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. But if one gives without having abandoned the five worldly sense pleasures and without loving-kindness and great compassion, then even if one gives away immeasurable, countless, incalculable things, one is not called a bodhisattva great being, nor is one a true field of merit for śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, for such giving does not bear the seal of the noble ones. Therefore one should give having abandoned the five worldly sense pleasures and possessing loving-kindness and great compassion. If one gives without having abandoned the five worldly sense pleasures and without loving-kindness and great compassion, one is not even called a bodhisattva, nor is one a true field of merit.

Son of good family, if one gives while attached to the five kinds of sense pleasure, not even a small part of the suffering of one's own body will be allayed, so what need is there to speak of removing the immeasurable suffering of all sentient beings?

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

The wise who possess the wheel of material giving,
With the conviction of a pure intention,
Abandon the five kinds of sense pleasure
And bring benefit and happiness to all sentient beings.

It is for the happiness of all sentient beings,
Not in hope of a ripened fruit.
Though the gift they give be small,
They become a true field of merit.

Though one makes many gifts,
If one dwells in the five kinds of sense pleasure,
One is not sealed with the seal of the noble ones,
And one remains within the indeterminate group.

Though the gift one gives be small,
One who does not dwell in the five sense pleasures
Becomes a true field of merit
For śrāvakas and solitary victors.

Therefore, abandoning the five kinds of sense pleasure,
Always giving with complete purity,
And bringing happiness to all sentient beings,

One becomes a true field of merit.

Furthermore, son of good family, the bodhisattva great being has a tenfold wheel of the great armor of the gift of the Dharma. When a bodhisattva great being possesses that wheel, then from the first generation of the mind of awakening, because the five kinds of sense pleasure have been entirely cleared away, he swiftly attains the meditative absorption called Light of the Sun Lamp. He far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

What are the ten? They are these: the true Dharma taught by the tathāgatas, namely the true Dharma connected with the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the true Dharma connected with the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, the true Dharma connected with the Great Vehicle, worldly dharmas, world-transcending dharmas, dharmas with defilements, dharmas in which the defilements are exhausted, conditioned dharmas, unconditioned dharmas, and nondual dharmas. The bodhisattva great being has faith in and respect for these ten kinds of Dharma, and retains as much as he is able of what he has heard and keeps it in mind. He examines it thoroughly. In the end he comes to understand it, and he teaches it to others as is fitting.

Whenever he teaches the Dharma, he should do so with a mind free of jealousy, a mind free of stinginess, a mind free of pride, a mind that does not hope for gain, a mind that does not disparage others, a mind that does not praise itself, a mind full of reverence, a mind of benefit, a mind of great loving-kindness, and a mind of great compassion.

To a person of the Śrāvaka Vehicle he teaches and explains the Dharma of the śrāvakas, and not the Dharma of the pratyekabuddhas or the Dharma of the Great Vehicle. To a person of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle he teaches the Dharma of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and not the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle or the Dharma of the Great Vehicle. To a person of the Great Vehicle he teaches the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, and not the Dharma of those of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles. He teaches the true Dharma in accordance with the faculties and the capacity of sentient beings, and does not teach the Dharma to those whose faculties are not suited and who are not vessels for it.

He does not urge beings of the Great Vehicle to practice the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle or to practice the Śrāvaka Vehicle. There are occasions when he urges beings of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, saying, "Devote yourselves to the practice of the Great Vehicle," and there are also occasions when he urges beings of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, saying, "Devote yourselves to the practice of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and to the practice of the Great Vehicle."

Toward even the smallest portion of the true Dharma of the Tathāgata's teaching, even a single verse or just half a verse, he has deep faith and shows reverence, and he does not deride it, denigrate it, obstruct it or hinder it. He regards the teacher of the Dharma as like the Buddha, regards the assembly listening to the Dharma as like the sick, and regards the Dharma being explained as like excellent medicine; and having entirely cut off the five kinds of sense pleasure, he teaches the true Dharma without expectation.

Son of good family, these are called the tenfold wheel of the great armor of the gift of the Dharma of the bodhisattva great being. The bodhisattva great being who possesses that wheel clears away the five sense pleasures entirely, swiftly attains the meditative absorption called Light of the Sun Lamp, far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

The wise who practice the giving of the Dharma
Teach the Dharma of the three vehicles according to the vessel.
They do not teach them the other vehicles,
So that, having heard, they do not come to deride and denigrate them.

They teach the true Dharma according to faculties and vessel,
And not to those whose faculties are not vessels.
Just as each one inclines toward whatever it may be,
They teach that very Dharma and so bring delight.

To a person who practices the Great Vehicle,
They do not teach the Dharma of the two other vehicles.
To persons of the two vehicles below,
They teach the Dharma of the middle and the highest vehicle.

With deep faith and respect one should listen to the Dharma,
And should not deride or denigrate it.

Those who make offerings to one who speaks the Dharma
Should regard him as like the Buddha.
To clear away the sickness of the afflictions,
They urge others to listen to the medicine of the true Dharma.
Keeping profit and fame far away,
One should teach and explain the true Dharma.

Furthermore, son of good family, the bodhisattva great being has a wheel of the great armor of pure moral discipline. The bodhisattva great being who possesses that wheel, from the first generation of the mind of awakening, entirely clears away the five sense pleasures, far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of pure moral discipline? Son of good family, the pure moral discipline of a bodhisattva is of two kinds: the common and the uncommon.

What, then, is the common wheel of a bodhisattva's pure moral discipline? It is when someone living in the household takes the vows of moral discipline of a layman or a laywoman, or else, having gone forth, receives full ordination through the moral discipline of the prātimokṣa. These vows and this moral discipline of the prātimokṣa are the common wheel of a bodhisattva's pure moral discipline; they are shared with all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. By virtue of this pure wheel of a bodhisattva's moral discipline, the afflictions of all sentient beings are not cut off, their wrong views are not dispelled, and they are not freed from the obscuration of karma and from saṃsāra. So it is not called the wheel of great armor, nor is one called a bodhisattva great being, for one is not a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

What, then, is the uncommon wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's pure moral discipline? It is that bodhisattvas guard pure moral discipline with a mind of equality, a mind free of harm and a mind free of resentment toward all sentient beings of the ten directions. They guard moral discipline completely with a mind that makes no distinctions and a perception that sees no difference among all, whether superior, middling or inferior: those with moral discipline and those of bad discipline, the generous and the stingy, the loving and the hateful, the diligent and the lazy. They guard moral discipline completely free of aversion, free of anger and free of wrongdoing toward all

sentient beings of the three realms. They guard moral discipline completely without conceptualizing the aggregates, elements and sense sources of the three kinds of existence. They guard moral discipline without dwelling in the desire realm. They guard moral discipline without dwelling in the form realm. They guard moral discipline without dwelling in the formless realm. They guard moral discipline without dwelling in any of the ripened fruits of existence. They guard moral discipline without dwelling in gain or loss. They guard moral discipline without dwelling in formations. These are called the uncommon wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's pure moral discipline.

Son of good family, the bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel of the great armor of pure moral discipline, from the first generation of the mind of awakening, entirely clears away the five sense pleasures and is called a bodhisattva great being. He far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

Taking vows while living in the household,
And the prātimokṣa discipline of those gone forth,
Are shared with the two vehicles,
And are not called the great awakening.

The wise who meditate on the Dharma of emptiness
Do not rely on or dwell in any world.
Without dwelling in any existence,
They guard pure moral discipline.

The moral discipline that abandons signs
Is free of attachment and free of all defilements.
Those who guard moral discipline such as this
Are called a true field of merit.

Furthermore, son of good family, the bodhisattva great being has what is called the wheel of the great armor of patience. The bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first generation of the mind of awakening, entirely clears away the five sense pleasures, far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of patience? Son of good family, a bodhisattva's patience has two characteristics. What are they? The worldly and the world-transcending.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's worldly patience? It is patience with defilements: one is patient while taking sentient beings as the object, with grasping, with signs, relying on the ripened fruit, and relying on meritorious action. Further, one is patient in dependence on one's own forms, sounds, smells, tastes and objects of touch. Patience bound up with involvement, patience that is not free of being troubled, patience of weak strength, patience that abandons sentient beings, patience accompanied by deceit and guile, patience that beguiles others, and patience that does not work for the benefit and happiness of sentient beings: these are called a bodhisattva's worldly patience. This patience is not called the wheel of great armor that is not shared with the śrāvakas, the pratyekabuddhas and the rest. How so? Such a one is not a bodhisattva great being, nor is he called a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's world-transcending patience? It is undefiled patience. Through the great light of the Dharma of all the noble ones, for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all sentient beings, one practices a patience free of attachment, and a patience based on the sense source in which all objects of action, all verbal expression, causes, signs, letters, and all sounds and speech are completely cut off. By cultivating this patience, the three kinds of total affliction, the three kinds of eon, the three characteristics, the three times, the three existences, the three kinds of formations, the three roots of nonvirtue, the four floods, the four knots, the four kinds of grasping, the four bodily ties and the rest are completely cut off; and so, when one cultivates this patience, body and mind become utterly peaceful. This is called the patience of the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva that transcends the world.

Son of good family, the bodhisattva great being who possesses that patience of the wheel of great armor is called a bodhisattva great being because from the first generation of the mind of awakening he has entirely cleared away the five sense pleasures. He far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

Patience is of two kinds:
With signs and without signs.
Patience with signs involves attachment;
The wise do not praise it.

Cultivating patience that relies on
The three kinds of formations, the aggregates, the elements and the sense sources,
Is patience with defilements,
And is not that of a great bodhisattva.

Having cleared away the four inversions,
One cultivates patience free of attachment.
When the three kinds of formations are pacified,
All will come to praise this patience.

All formations utterly pacified,
All conceptions entirely abandoned,
The mind even like the sky:
All will come to praise this patience.

All dharmas agreeing in a single taste,
Empty, signless and at peace,
The mind dwelling in nothing and clinging to nothing:
This patience becomes of great benefit.

Furthermore, son of good family, the bodhisattva great being has a wheel of the great armor of diligence. The bodhisattva great being who possesses that wheel, from the first generation of the mind of awakening, entirely clears away the five sense pleasures, far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of diligence? Son of good family, a bodhisattva's diligence is of two kinds: worldly and world-transcending.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's worldly diligence? With diligence of intense effort, bodhisattvas devote themselves to the three worldly bases of meritorious action. What is merit? It is this: the meritorious action of giving, the action of making merit by guarding moral discipline, and the action of

making merit through meditation. Performing these actions is called the three kinds of diligence. These three kinds of diligence take sentient beings as their object, are accompanied by defilements, are accompanied by grasping, rely on the ripened fruit and rely on meritorious action. This is called a bodhisattva's worldly diligence. This diligence is shared with the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle and the rest, and so it is not called the wheel of great armor, nor is one called a bodhisattva great being, for one is not a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's world-transcending diligence? Bodhisattvas, with diligence of intense effort and a mind of equality toward all sentient beings, clear away all afflicted action and suffering. This diligence is praised by all the noble ones; it is undefiled, free of grasping, without support and without abode. With a mind that makes no distinctions and a perception that sees no difference among all, whether superior, middling or inferior beings, the diligent and the lazy, the generous and the stingy, those with moral discipline and those of bad discipline, the loving and the hateful, they undertake diligence of intense effort. Toward all sentient beings of the three realms, they do the work to be done with equality and without an object, and with a mind that does not dwell in any ground of speech, conception or analysis they undertake diligence of intense effort. Without conceptualizing the aggregates, elements and sense sources of the three kinds of existence, they undertake diligence of intense effort: the diligent effort that does not dwell in the desire realm, the diligent effort that does not dwell in the form realm, the diligent effort that does not dwell in the formless realm, the diligent effort that does not conceptualize any of the ripened fruits of existence, the diligent effort that does not dwell in gain or loss, the diligent effort that does not dwell in formations, the diligent effort that does not dwell in the three worldly bases of meritorious action, and intense diligence undertaken in the three bases of meritorious action that are bound up with what transcends the world. This is called the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's world-transcending diligence.

Son of good family, the bodhisattva great being who possesses that wheel of the great armor of diligence, having entirely cleared away the five kinds of sense pleasure from the first generation of the mind of awakening, is called a bodhisattva great being. He far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the

Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

Fools deeply attached to the six faculties
Are carried away by the five rivers.
Though they undertake diligence of intense effort,
The wise will find fault with it.

If one undertakes diligence that takes beings as its object,
That is accompanied by defilements
And accompanied by grasping,
One is not a true field of merit,
And not a great bodhisattva.

The wise who undertake diligence
Have cast far away all attachment;
Their minds dwell in nothing and cling to nothing.
They are called a true field of merit.

Free of attachment to name and form,
Having abandoned the aggregates, elements and sense sources,
One who becomes the support of the whole assembly
Is a great bodhisattva.

Though moving in the world, he is like the moon in water;
He has perfected the undertaking of diligent effort.
By this wheel are utterly destroyed
The bonds of affliction that bind all people.

Furthermore, son of good family, the bodhisattva great being has a wheel of the great armor of meditative concentration. The bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first generation of the mind of awakening, entirely clears away the five sense pleasures, far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of meditative concentration? Son of good family, a bodhisattva's meditative concentration is of two kinds: worldly and world-transcending.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's worldly meditative concentration? It is that bodhisattvas cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the

aggregates, cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the elements, and cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the sense sources. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the desire realm, while dwelling in the form realm, and while dwelling in the formless realm. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the three vows, while dwelling in the three liberations, while dwelling in the four applications of mindfulness, while dwelling in the four right efforts, while dwelling in the four bases of miraculous power, while dwelling in the five faculties, while dwelling in the five powers, while dwelling in the seven branches of awakening, and while dwelling in the noble eightfold path. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the earth element, while dwelling in the water element, while dwelling in the fire element, while dwelling in the wind element, while dwelling in the space element, and while dwelling in the consciousness element. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in pleasant feeling, while dwelling in painful feeling, and while dwelling in feeling that is neither pleasant nor painful. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in the sphere of infinite space, while dwelling in the sphere of infinite consciousness, while dwelling in the sphere of nothingness, and while dwelling in the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in this world and while dwelling in the world beyond. They cultivate meditative concentration while dwelling in limited perception, while dwelling in vast perception, and while dwelling in immeasurable perception. These meditative concentrations are accompanied by defilements, accompanied by grasping and accompanied by attachment; this is called a bodhisattva's worldly meditative concentration. This meditative concentration is said to be shared with the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle. It is not the wheel of great armor, and one is not called a bodhisattva great being, for one is not a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's world-transcending meditative concentration? It is this: bodhisattvas cultivate meditative concentration free of the aggregates, cultivate meditative concentration free of the elements, and cultivate meditative concentration free of the sense sources. They cultivate meditative concentration free of the desire realm, free of the form realm, and free of the formless realm. They cultivate meditative concentration free of the three vows, free of the three liberations, free of the four applications of mindfulness, free of the four right efforts, free of the four bases of miraculous power, free of

the five faculties, free of the five powers, free of the seven branches of awakening, and free of the noble eightfold path. They cultivate meditative concentration free of the earth element, free of the water element, free of the fire element, free of the wind element, free of the space element, and free of the consciousness element. They cultivate meditative concentration free of pleasant feeling, free of painful feeling, and free of feeling that is neither painful nor pleasant. They cultivate meditative concentration free of the sphere of infinite space, free of the sphere of infinite consciousness, free of the sphere of nothingness, and free of the sphere of neither perception nor non-perception. They cultivate meditative concentration free of this world and free of the world beyond. They cultivate meditative concentration free of limited perception, free of vast perception, and free of immeasurable perception. This meditative concentration gives rise to the great light of the noble ones; it is undefiled, free of grasping and free of attachment. This is called the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's world-transcending meditative concentration.

Son of good family, the bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel of the great armor of meditative concentration, having entirely cleared away the five sense pleasures from the first generation of the mind of awakening, is called a bodhisattva great being. He far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

To cast off one's own heavy burden,
One cultivates absorption that has an object,
Wishing to cut off one's own afflictions:
This is not the mark of the truly wise.

Relying on a support and accompanied by conception,
Though one cultivates absorption, wishing for liberation,
If one dwells at the edge of this shore or the far shore,
One does not work for the benefit of beings.

For the benefit and happiness of all beings
One cultivates absorption and casts off the heavy burden,
Clearing away all the afflictions:
That is the mark of the truly wise.

To bring refreshment to all beings,
One cultivates the absorption that does not abide,
Cutting off all existence in the realm of desire:
Such a one is called a person of great intelligence.

To free all who are bound by existence
And bring them into the city of fearlessness,
One cultivates utterly peaceful absorption:
Such a one is a great bodhisattva.

The tenth and final fascicle.

Furthermore, son of good family, the bodhisattva great being has what is called the wheel of the great armor of wisdom. The bodhisattva great being who possesses that wheel, from the first generation of the mind of awakening, entirely clears away the five sense pleasures, far surpasses all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all who follow the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of wisdom? Son of good family, a bodhisattva's wisdom is of two kinds: worldly and world-transcending.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's worldly wisdom? It is this: bodhisattvas rely solely on reading the true Dharma of the three vehicles, reciting it, copying it into books, listening to it, and teaching and explaining it to others. Wishing to dispel the darkness of ignorance of all sentient beings, and so that the lamp of wisdom may arise for all sentient beings, with diligence of intense effort they read, recite, listen to, copy into books, and teach and explain extensively to others the Dharma connected with the Śrāvaka Vehicle taught by the Tathāgata, and devote themselves to it with true diligence. They read, recite, listen to, copy into books, and teach and explain extensively to others the Dharma connected with the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle taught by the Tathāgata, and practice it devotedly with true diligence. With diligence they read, recite, listen to, copy into books, and teach and explain extensively to others as well the Dharma connected with the Great Vehicle taught by the Tathāgata, and devote themselves to it with true diligence. Yet they do not seek the branches of the undefiled noble path, do not seek the noble path, do not seek the liberation that belongs to the noble path, and do not devote themselves to the utterly peaceful true wisdom; rather, they always devote themselves to a wisdom that is accompanied by views and accompanied by the notion of

wisdom. Such wisdom, accompanied by grasping and accompanied by attachment, is called a bodhisattva's worldly wisdom. That wisdom is shared with all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and so it is not called the wheel of great armor, nor is such a one called a bodhisattva great being, for he is not a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's transcendent wisdom? It is this. Bodhisattvas who apply themselves with diligence to the path of awakening read, recite and listen to the true Dharma of the three vehicles as far as they are able, copy it into volumes, and teach and explain it extensively to others; yet they abide in a practice that does not take it as an object. They are accomplished with a mind that is unmoving, nonconceptual and without essential nature, a mind like space, a mind utterly at peace, a wisdom without increase or decrease, a mind without attachment, a mind without arising and cessation, an irreversible mind, a mind of the equality of all phenomena, a mind of suchness, a mind of the limit of reality, a mind of the realm of phenomena, a mind of selflessness, a mind free of conceptualization, utterly peaceful and patient, free of conceptual thought. Through supreme skillful means they dwell at ease on the ground of fearlessness, and through skillful means they dwell at ease on the ground of the supreme and sublime intelligence that neither abides nor clings. Because this wisdom is without grasping and without attachment, it is called the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's transcendent wisdom.

Son of good family, when a bodhisattva great being possesses this wheel of the great armor of wisdom, then, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, because he has eliminated the five sense pleasures he is called a bodhisattva great being. He passes far beyond the grounds of the śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is one to be worshiped, protected and served by all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

Furthermore, son of good family, there is the bodhisattva great being's wheel of the great armor of skillful means. A bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, eliminates the five sense pleasures, passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas; all followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle will worship, protect and serve him.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of skillful means? Son of good family, a bodhisattva's skillful means is of two kinds: worldly and transcendent.

What is a bodhisattva's worldly skillful means? It is this. For their own benefit, for the benefit of others, or for the benefit of both, bodhisattvas think in terms of self and other, and, in order to accomplish fully the benefit of self and others through many kinds of crafts and arts, they make offerings to and serve the buddhas, the blessed ones, bodhisattvas, pratyekabuddhas and śrāvakas, and their fathers and mothers. When they see the sick, the destitute, those without protector or refuge, and those suffering from many harms, they rescue them with supreme skillful means and bring beings to full maturity through the means of attraction.

That bodhisattva, himself abiding in the Great Vehicle, teaches the very subtle and profound true Dharma to followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle and followers of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas who are not vessels for the Great Vehicle and whose faculties are not fully matured; he sets them to train and has them devote themselves to the meditative concentrations of the noble ones. Furthermore, he teaches them the ultimate truth and has them devote themselves to it; he turns them back from the four distortions and has them understand the characteristics of the phenomena by which one does not fall; he has them apply themselves to the four kinds of discriminating knowledge; and further, through the wisdom that is skilled in leading them into the four applications of mindfulness, the four correct exertions, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven factors of awakening, the noble eightfold path, and the path with remainder and without remainder, up to the fruits of the path, he brings them to full maturity.

Beings who are attached to gain, fame and wealth, whose faculties are restless, and whose roots of virtue are not fully matured, he brings to full maturity by having them read and recite the sūtras, the Vinaya and the Mātṛkā, and by having them read and recite treatises other than those the Buddha taught that accord with liberation. Beings who have no inclination to give, he brings to full maturity by urging them to give away jewels and wealth and riches of many kinds. Beings who are fierce and of unstable nature he urges to train in the four abodes of Brahmā; beings full of anger he urges to train in patience; lazy beings he urges to train in diligence; beings whose minds are distracted he urges to cultivate meditative concentration; and beings whose wisdom is corrupt he brings to full maturity with skillful means,

teaching them the true Dharma, instructing them and conferring scriptural transmission on them. Beings who have no faith in the Three Jewels and neither abide in nor practice them, he brings to full maturity by having them go for refuge to the Three Jewels, have faith in the Three Jewels, train in the vow of a layman, and train in the vow of the one-day fast. Furthermore, he brings them to full maturity by having them learn and practice the various fields of crafts and arts.

The forms of such supremely skillful worldly wisdom of a bodhisattva great being are more numerous than the grains of sand in the river Ganges. Thus, to subdue all non-Buddhists (tīrthikas) and all who follow other teachers through superior conduct, diligence, and the wisdom of skillful means in every field of writing, treatises, crafts and arts: that is a bodhisattva's worldly skillful means.

This skillful means is shared with all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. It has become the cause on which all the qualities of a buddha rest and the ground for the practice of skillful means; being supremely skillful in means and spontaneously accomplished, it is free of conceptual thought, and so it has become a quality that does not turn back.

Furthermore, son of good family, if a bodhisattva, relying neither on a learned teacher nor looking to a spiritual friend, applies himself to worldly skillful means, that bodhisattva is deluded by worldly skillful means and will fall into the lower realms. He is unable to apply himself to and abide in the wisdom of transcendent, supreme skillful means, and he is not a true field of merit for anyone. Lacking supreme skill in means, he does not know the differences in the faculties and conduct of beings; and being deluded about supreme skillful means, he teaches the Great Vehicle to those who are not vessels for the Śrāvaka Vehicle, the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle or the Great Vehicle, and to those whose faculties are not matured for the Great Vehicle, and he has them train in it and devote themselves to it. To beings who have become vessels for the Dharma of the Great Vehicle, he teaches the Dharma of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles, and has them train in and devote themselves to the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles. To beings who have become vessels for the Dharma of the Buddha Vehicle, he teaches the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, and has them train in and devote themselves to the Śrāvaka Vehicle. To beings who have become vessels for the Dharma of the Śrāvaka Vehicle, he presents the things of saṃsāra as happiness and joy, and does not teach them so as to produce weariness with the things of saṃsāra.

Furthermore, being deluded about supreme skillful means, to beings who delight in killing, and so on up to those inclined to wrong views, he teaches the very profound Dharma of the Great Vehicle; he does not teach them weariness and fear at dying and passing from this round of existence, being born in the next, and experiencing the ripened fruit of suffering, nor does he teach them to give up sinful, nonvirtuous things. Furthermore, being deluded about supreme skillful means, he has beings who are inclined to keep moral discipline practice generosity. To beings inclined to cultivate patience he teaches the abandonment of patience and has them keep moral discipline. To beings inclined to cultivate diligence he teaches the abandonment of diligence and has them practice patience. To beings inclined to cultivate meditative concentration he teaches the abandonment of meditative concentration and has them devote themselves to diligence. To beings inclined to cultivate wisdom he teaches the abandonment of wisdom and has them cultivate meditative concentration.

Thus a bodhisattva deluded about worldly skillful means is unable to work for the benefit and happiness of beings correctly, just as things are, and becomes an evil friend to all beings. This skillful means is accompanied by objectification and accompanied by attachment; it is called a bodhisattva's worldly skillful means. Thus this worldly skillful means is shared with the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles. It is not the wheel of great armor, nor is such a one called a bodhisattva great being, for he is not a true field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas.

What, then, is a bodhisattva's transcendent, supreme skillful means? It is this. Bodhisattvas give up their own benefit and make the benefit of others their chief concern; in order to bring beings to maturity by displaying many kinds of crafts and arts, they serve and make offerings to the buddhas, the blessed ones, bodhisattvas, śrāvakas, pratyekabuddhas, and their fathers and mothers. Those who are sick, in want, destitute, without protector or refuge, and tormented by many kinds of intense suffering, they rescue through skillful means, and they bring beings to full maturity through the four means of attraction. They teach the true Dharma to beings according to their inclinations, their faculties and their capacity as vessels.

Furthermore, step by step, they urge followers of the Śrāvaka Vehicle to train in and devote themselves to the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, and urge followers of the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle to train in and devote themselves to the Great Vehicle. If there are those whose faculties are not matured for the Śrāvaka or

Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, they teach them weariness through the painful nature of saṃsāra, and urge them to grow weary of saṃsāra and to seek nirvāṇa. To beings who are inclined to killing, and so on up to those attached to wrong views, they teach, in accordance with their faculties and nature, how one circles in saṃsāra; they teach that one is born from this world into the next and experiences in the next the fruit of suffering, and so teach fear of and weariness with sinful, nonvirtuous things. To some they teach the Dharma connected with the Śrāvaka Vehicle; to some they teach the Dharma connected with the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle; to some they fully reveal the Dharma of the unsurpassed vehicle and lead them gradually to train in it. To beings who are inclined to generosity they teach the keeping of supreme, perfectly pure moral discipline; and so on in full, likewise, to beings inclined to meditative concentration they teach what is comprised by the supreme undefiled path of the noble ones and unsurpassed wisdom, and have them devote themselves to it.

This supreme skillful means is without objectification and without attachment; it is called the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's transcendent skillful means. Son of good family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel of the great armor of supreme skillful means, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, because he has eliminated the five kinds of sense pleasure, is called a bodhisattva great being. He passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is one to be worshiped, protected and served by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

"Devotion to wisdom is of two kinds,
Worldly and beyond the world.
That with attachment is worldly;
That without attachment is beyond the world.

Devotion to supreme skillful means
Abides in two distinct kinds:
That with an object is worldly;
That without an object is beyond the world.

Whoever teaches a single vehicle
Does not teach the Dharma well.
If one is not fully matured oneself,

How could one act for the sake of others?

If to beings wholly given to nonvirtue
One teaches the Dharma of the three vehicles,
That is delusion and bewilderment;
It does not belong to great awakening.

If to those eager to enter the three vehicles,
Who long for the true Dharma,
One teaches a Dharma that delights in saṃsāra,
That is not the nature of the wise.

Examining well with one-pointed mind,
One teaches according to wish and inclination.
Because this is supreme skillful means,
The wise praise it.

When beings who engage in evil deeds
Become vessels for the three vehicles,
One teaches Dharma suited to their faculties as vessels
And frees them from every evil."

Furthermore, son of good family, there is the bodhisattva great being's wheel of the great armor of great loving-kindness. A bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, eliminates the five kinds of sense pleasure; because he passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, he becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and will be worshiped, protected and served by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

What, then, is the wheel of the great armor of great loving-kindness? Son of good family, a bodhisattva's loving-kindness is of two kinds: loving-kindness focused on phenomena and loving-kindness focused on beings. Loving-kindness focused on phenomena is called the wheel of the great armor of great loving-kindness. Loving-kindness focused on beings is not called the great armor of great loving-kindness. Why is that? Loving-kindness focused on beings is shared with the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles. Śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas devote themselves to a patience focused on beings for the sake of their own benefit and happiness. Śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas do so for their own peace, their own nirvāṇa, the removal of their own obscurations, and the cutting off of their own afflictions; they do not devote themselves

diligently, through loving-kindness focused on beings, for the sake of all beings. Therefore this loving-kindness is not called great loving-kindness, and it is not the great armor.

Loving-kindness focused on phenomena is not shared with followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles; only bodhisattva great beings are able to devote themselves to it. Bodhisattva great beings devote themselves to this loving-kindness focused on phenomena through the application of diligence, for the benefit and happiness of all beings. Bodhisattva great beings devote themselves to loving-kindness focused on phenomena with intensely striving diligence, in order to bring all beings fully to nirvāṇa and to cut off their afflictions completely. Therefore this loving-kindness is called the great armor of great loving-kindness.

Furthermore, a bodhisattva who devotes himself to loving-kindness focused on phenomena does not abide in the aggregates, does not abide in the sense sources, does not abide in the elements; he does not abide in the applications of mindfulness, and so on up to the limbs of the path of awakening. He does not abide in the desire realm, does not abide in the form realm, does not abide in the formless realm. He does not abide in this world, does not abide in the world beyond; he does not abide on the near shore, does not abide on the far shore; he does not abide in an object, and does not abide in the absence of an object. Thus, by devoting himself to loving-kindness focused on phenomena, a bodhisattva passes far beyond the grounds of the vehicles of all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas. That is called the wheel of the great armor of a bodhisattva's great loving-kindness focused on phenomena.

Son of good family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel of the great armor of great loving-kindness, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, eliminates the five kinds of sense pleasure, passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and will be worshiped, protected and served by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

"Śrāvakas and solitary victors,
Cultivating love focused on beings,
Carry thirteen faults in their minds
And strive for their own benefit.

Bodhisattvas of great renown,
For the sake of each and every being,
Cultivate the unshared great love
And abandon the thirteen faults of mind.

Having thoroughly abandoned the thirteen stains,
They direct themselves toward great awakening.
If one cultivates love focused on phenomena,
Becoming a field of merit is not far off.

If one dwells at ease in the thirteen powers,
One far surpasses all beings,
Just as the king of lions
Surpasses all other beasts.

Having utterly subdued the thirteen foes,
And abandoned clinging to the extremes of permanence and annihilation,
If the mind is stained by nothing whatsoever,
One swiftly attains great awakening."

Furthermore, son of good family, there is the bodhisattva great being's wheel of the great armor of great compassion. A bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, eliminates the five kinds of sense pleasure; because he passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, he becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and will be worshiped, protected and served by all followers of all the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles. How is that? All followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles practice compassion for the sake of their own benefit and happiness; they do not generate great compassion for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all beings.

Bodhisattva great beings do not generate great compassion for the sake of their own benefit and happiness alone; they generate great compassion for the sake of the benefit and happiness of all beings. Therefore, because a bodhisattva possesses the wheel of the great armor of great compassion, he passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and will be worshiped, protected and served by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

For the sake of the benefit and happiness of all beings, bodhisattva great beings bring beings to full maturity through the four means of attraction.

Gathering all beings through generosity, out of great compassion and for the sake of their happiness, is as follows. They are without avarice in giving away jewels, wealth, riches, vehicles, servants, laborers, lands, kingdoms, sons, wives, and even their bodies and lives. Because they apply themselves to a practice without objectification, they do not see that there are beings to be trained; they do not see a giver, they do not see a recipient, they do not see things of wealth, they do not see the practice of giving, they do not see a fruit of having given, and so on, up to not seeing even nonobjectification. Such is the great compassion they generate.

For the sake of the benefit and happiness of all beings, with pleasant speech, with acting for their benefit, and with conduct consistent with that benefit, they teach and explain extensively through whatever means will train each one, up to not seeing even nonobjectification. Thus, at all times, with a supremely disciplined mind, a mind utterly at peace, an immeasurable mind, a mind that does not form anything regarding the aggregates, elements and sense sources, wherever they are born, bodhisattva great beings are unwavering; and with this wheel of the great armor of great compassion that does not abide, they never grow weary of bringing to full maturity all beings who have become vessels. Such is what is called a bodhisattva's wheel of the great armor of great compassion, and it is not shared with any śrāvakas or pratyekabuddhas.

Son of good family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel of the great armor of great compassion, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, eliminates the five sense pleasures, and so is called a bodhisattva great being. He passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles will worship, protect and serve him.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke in verse:

"The very profound and sublime Dharma
Becomes the basis of great compassion.
It is utterly unfathomable, like space;
It has no abiding place and has no form.

The great diligence of the bodhisattva
Is endowed with great qualities;
Through the Victor's wisdom and great compassion

That hero thereby passes beyond the world.

Beings without protector or refuge,
Bound by the turbid suffering of saṃsāra,
Are washed by the water of great compassion,
And so those beings are set free.

By the compassion that bodhisattvas generate
The ocean of saṃsāra is dried up;
It is not done by the assemblies of the Śrāvaka Vehicle,
Nor by those who practice the Vehicle of Solitary Victors.

Beings of desire, anger and delusion,
Who are bound to fall into the lower realms,
Are washed by the water of great compassion
And set free from every suffering."

Furthermore, son of good family, there is the bodhisattva great being's wheel of the great armor of great and very steadfast patience, endowed with the analytical knowledge of language, equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, endless and exceedingly vast, and with all the qualities of a buddha whatsoever, namely the samādhis and the dhāraṇīs. A bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first moment he generates the mind of awakening, eliminates the five kinds of sense pleasure, passes far beyond all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a great field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles will worship, protect and serve him.

What, then, is the bodhisattva great being's wheel of the great armor of great steadfastness, endowed with the analytical knowledge of language, equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, endless and exceedingly vast, and with all the qualities of a buddha whatsoever, namely the samādhis and the dhāraṇīs? It is this. When bodhisattvas thoroughly examine all phenomena, then, just as the light of the moon's disk pervades the whole of space, their minds have become equanimous; in all the doors of samādhi that are signless, without support, without abiding and without stain, and in all the doors of dhāraṇī, there is no activity of mind. Free of the mind's clinging to the eye, to forms, to eye consciousness and to eye contact, and with no activity of mind, when the three kinds of inner feeling arise on the condition of eye contact, namely pleasant, painful, and neither pleasant nor painful, the mind is utterly

at peace and without attachment toward those feelings.

In the same way, with the ear, sounds, ear consciousness and ear contact; the nose, odors, nose consciousness and nose contact; the tongue, tastes, tongue consciousness and tongue contact; the body, tangibles, body consciousness and body contact; and so on up to the mind, mental phenomena, mind consciousness and mind contact, the passage is to be expanded in the same way: all mind, mentation and consciousness is always at peace and without attachment. Toward the three kinds of feeling that arise from mind, mentation and consciousness, namely pleasant, painful, and neither pleasant nor painful, the mind is always at peace and without attachment.

Toward every aspect of the aggregates, elements and sense sources of the three times, there is no grasping and no activity of mind. Toward all the three realms, the three formations, the three tangibles, the three feelings, the three faculties, the three vehicles, the three vows and the three liberations, toward all such aspects, the mind abides in equality, utterly at peace, without abiding place, without signs and without grasping. Toward all generosity, moral discipline, patience, diligence, meditative concentration and wisdom, and all the perfections, it abides utterly at peace, with no activity of mind. In the same way, toward the four applications of mindfulness, the four correct exertions, the four bases of miraculous power, the five faculties, the five powers, the seven factors of awakening and the noble eightfold path, it likewise abides utterly at peace, with no activity of mind. Toward all the nine successive meditative attainments, too, it abides utterly at peace, with no activity of mind.

Furthermore, toward the three kinds of formative activity, the wisdom unobstructed regarding phenomena, the limbs of the path, and what leads to the nature of the path, there is likewise no grasping and no activity of mind. Toward every aspect of the all-base consciousness and what is not the all-base consciousness, of what is with appropriation and without appropriation, with defilement and without defilement, the near shore and the far shore, the small, the great and the immeasurable, doing and not doing, the virtuous, the nonvirtuous and the indeterminate, it abides utterly at peace, without grasping and with no activity of mind. Toward every aspect of all phenomena, from great loving-kindness, great compassion and the bringing of beings to full maturity through skillful means, up to the three things that need not be guarded, the four fearlessnesses and the eighteen unshared qualities of a buddha, it abides utterly at peace, without grasping and with no activity of

mind.

By the power of this wheel, bodhisattva great beings eliminate the faults of the three kinds of feeling, completely pacify all conceptual thought, and completely abandon all phenomena that are signs. Furthermore, it also brings forth the wheel of the great armor of skillful means in all the samādhis of the Eye of Space and of the Crown, and in the dhāraṇīs. Because a bodhisattva abides in that wheel, whatever remainder of sinful, nonvirtuous karma from times past would lead him to the lower realms and the Avīci hell, and all the karma of circling among the other states of existence and destinies, he eliminates entirely, without remainder, so that he does not experience its ripened fruit.

Furthermore, son of good family, it is like this. When black darkness covers the whole sky, the sun rises and dispels all the darkness. In the same way, a bodhisattva too, because he possesses the analytical knowledge of language that is equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, endless, broad and vast, accomplishes and brings forth all the qualities of a buddha whatsoever, namely the samādhis and the dhāraṇīs, and also the wheel of the great armor of very steadfast patience. Furthermore, abiding in the wheel of the great armor of skillful means in the samādhis of the Eye of Space and of the Crown and in the dhāraṇīs, with the sun of immeasurable, spacelike wisdom he completely dispels the darkness of the four distortions. Whatever remainder of sinful, nonvirtuous karma from times past would lead him to the lower realms and the Avīci hell, and all the karma of circling in saṃsāra among the other states of existence and destinies, he dispels entirely, without remainder, and does not experience its ripened fruit.

Furthermore, by its power he gains mastery over the qualities of a buddha and becomes irreversible. He does not fall under the power of evil friends or follow them; he is never parted from seeing the buddhas, never parted from seeing bodhisattvas and śrāvaka attendants, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings to and serving the Saṅgha. His mind is never satisfied with any of the good qualities, and so on without interruption until awakening; he is never parted from the recollection of the Buddha, and at the very least it continues without interruption even in his dreams.

Son of good family, how does a bodhisattva great being, because he possesses the analytical knowledge of language that is equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, endless, broad and vast, bring forth all the qualities of a

buddha whatsoever, namely the samādhis and the dhāraṇīs, and the wheel of the great armor of very steadfast patience? It is this. When bodhisattvas abide in this samādhi of entering the absorptions from the first meditative concentration up to the fourth, entering the absorptions from the sphere of infinite space up to the sphere of neither perception nor nonperception, and entering the samādhi of the cessation of perception and feeling, they cut off the three kinds of feeling and the three formations; without formative activity and without wavering activity of mind, they cut off feeling, perception, volition, awareness, attention and all the rest. Abiding in this samādhi, they partake of the food of meditative concentration for one day, or for up to seven days. Even when they rise from that samādhi, the mind is utterly at peace and without grasping, and they abide in calm stillness.

Furthermore, they settle evenly in the samādhi of emptiness that reaches the limit of the ultimate. When they abide in that samādhi, because the mind is utterly even, it is without attachment like space, and from every pore of the body drops of sweet dew like stars come forth, dispelling all the torment bound up with the afflictions. When they rise from that samādhi, they attain right mindfulness, and the body is pervaded by a special joy. Just as a son of the gods and Maheśvara (Śiva), entering all the samādhis of bliss, experience utter bliss in every pore of the body, so that bodhisattva, his body touched by bliss, comes to recollect the Buddha. Through recollecting the Buddha he sees the Buddha, and sees no other sign than that.

At that time, if that bodhisattva brings a single buddha to mind, he sees a single buddha. If he brings many buddhas to mind, he sees many buddhas. If he brings the Buddha's body to mind as small, he sees the Buddha's body as small. If he brings the Buddha's body to mind as large, he sees the Buddha's body as large. If he brings the Buddha's body to mind as immeasurable, he sees the Buddha's body as immeasurable. If he brings to mind his own body as possessing the marks of the Buddha's body, he sees that body of his own as perfect in the marks, just like the Buddha's body. If he brings to mind the bodies of others as the Buddha's body, he sees the bodies of others as perfect in the marks, just like the Buddha's body. If he brings to mind sentient beings, things that are not sentient beings, and everything whatsoever that belongs to form as the Buddha's body possessing the marks, he sees sentient beings, things that are not sentient beings, and everything whatsoever that belongs to form as perfect in the marks, just like the Buddha's body, and he does not see form in any other way.

At that time the bodhisattva further thinks: "All phenomena and all forms are like an illusion. Since they are not real, I shall completely cut off all phenomena without remainder, such as the three kinds of feeling and the three formations." Thinking this, he enters into the samādhi of cessation. Abiding in that samādhi, he cuts off everything completely, just as he had resolved beforehand, and lives on the food of the taste of samādhi. He remains for as long as he is able, whether seven days, or two weeks of seven days, or three, or four, or five, or six, or seven, or eight, or even for immeasurable hundreds of thousands of koṭis of niyutas of eons, eating the food of samādhi. When he rises from that samādhi, his mind is utterly at peace, he is attached to nothing, and he dwells in bliss. If he enters the samādhi that reaches the limit of the ultimate, then, just as explained before, he again comprehends everything from bringing to mind the Buddha's body possessing the marks up to seeing that all phenomena and all forms are like an illusion and unreal.

Son of noble family, this is called the wheel of the great armor of the bodhisattva great being's analytical knowledge of language (niruktipratisaṃvid), which is equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, limitless, vast and extensive, and is all the qualities of a buddha whatsoever: all the samādhis, all the dhāraṇīs, and utterly firm patience. Bodhisattva great beings who possess this wheel are supremely skilled in means with regard to the Eye of Space, the samādhis of the Crown, and the dhāraṇīs; they abandon everything without remainder and do not take on the fruit of karmic maturation.

Furthermore, son of noble family, it is like this. When destruction by fire is about to occur in a world-system, five suns rise all at once, and the waters of the ponds, great ponds, rivers, great rivers, lakes and great lakes in the world-system all dry up without remainder. In the same way, the bodhisattva too, possessing the analytical knowledge of language that is equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, limitless, vast and extensive, brings forth all the qualities of a buddha: the samādhis, the dhāraṇīs, and the wheel of the great armor of utterly firm patience. Furthermore, he abides in and brings forth the wheel of the great armor of skill in means with regard to the Eye of Space, the samādhis of the Crown, and the dhāraṇīs. All the karma, driven by the residue of the sinful, unwholesome actions of past times, by which one circles in saṃsāra in the lower realms such as Avīci and in other states of existence and destinies, he dries up completely without remainder, and he does not take on the fruit of karmic maturation.

Furthermore, son of noble family, it is like this. When destruction by water occurs in the world, in the great trichiliocosm world-system the four great continents of this small world, the eight subcontinents, Meru, king of mountains, and all the lesser mountains are washed away by the water and are destroyed and consumed without remainder. In the same way, the bodhisattva too, possessing the analytical knowledge of language that is equal to the expanse of space, immeasurable, limitless, vast and extensive, accomplishes and brings forth all the qualities of a buddha whatsoever: the samādhis, the dhāraṇīs, and the wheel of the great armor of utterly firm patience. Because he abides in and brings forth the wheel of the great armor of skill in means with regard to the Eye of Space, the samādhis of the Crown, and the dhāraṇīs, he also abides in the wheel of the great armor of skill with regard to the karma, driven by the residue of the sinful, unwholesome actions of past times, by which one circles in saṃsāra in the lower realms such as Avīci and in other states of existence and destinies.

By abiding in this wheel, the sun of immeasurable, space-like wisdom arises, and he completely dispels the four inversions in his own body and all the darkness of ignorance. All the karma, driven by the residue of the sinful, unwholesome actions of past times, by which one circles in saṃsāra in the lower realms such as Avīci and in other states of existence and destinies, he also dispels completely without remainder, and he does not experience the fruit of karmic maturation either.

Son of noble family, a bodhisattva great being who possesses this wheel, from the first generation of the mind of awakening onward, eliminates the five kinds of desire, utterly transcends all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, becomes a field of merit for all śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, and is honored, protected and served by all followers of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles.

Through the power of this wheel, he gains mastery over all the qualities of a buddha, becomes irreversible, and does not fall under the power of evil friends. He is never parted from seeing all the buddhas, never parted from seeing the bodhisattvas and the śrāvaka attendants, never parted from hearing the Dharma, and never parted from making offerings to the Saṅgha and serving it. His mind is never sated with any good qualities, and this continues unbroken until his full awakening. As for never being parted from the constant recollection of the Buddha, he is not parted from it even in the slightest degree, not even in a dream. In this way that bodhisattva swiftly completes the accumulations of merit and wisdom, and before long he fully

awakens to unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening in a pure buddhafield. In that buddhafield all sentient beings are born miraculously; their marks and forms resemble those of the buddhas, the blessed ones; their afflictions are thin and slight; and every one of them dwells happily in the Great Vehicle.

Then, in order to restate these points clearly, the Blessed One spoke these verses:

Those who wish to become vessels for the Dharma
Should completely cut off all the afflictions.
If one is absorbed in genuine emptiness,
There is nothing at all that is hard to do.

In order to cut all the bonds of existence,
Strive earnestly to enter meditative absorption.
Because one possesses the qualities of samādhi,
One will without doubt gain wisdom hard to fathom.

If one thoroughly cultivates the formless dhyānas
And examines the samādhi of cessation and emptiness,
The supreme understanding that recollects the Buddha arises,
And all one's misdeeds will be completely exhausted.

All phenomena, existent and nonexistent,
Are overcome by examining them as genuine emptiness.
Having completely cleared away the courses to the lower realms,
One will always come to see many buddhas.

Having thoroughly cultivated genuine emptiness,
One should strive in all other wholesome qualities.
If one makes offerings to each and every buddha,
One will swiftly attain the fruit of buddhahood.

If one acts as a spiritual friend to all sentient beings
And clears away the sickness of the afflictions,
One will swiftly be born in a pure buddhafield,
Fully awaken, and attain great awakening.

Sentient beings who possess the marks of a buddha
Will completely fill that buddhafield.
All of them will aspire to the vehicle of the buddhas,
And will entirely abandon the vehicles of the śrāvakas and solitary victors.

This concludes the seventh chapter, called "The Characteristics of a Field of Merit," from the noble, extensive great sūtra, The Ten Wheels of the Bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha.

When the Blessed One taught this discourse of the Great Vehicle, there were in that assembly bodhisattva great beings, as numerous as the grains of sand of the river Ganges, who in times past had trained in the recollection of the Buddha. Now, having heard the Blessed One explain the practice of applying oneself earnestly to the recollection of the Buddha, they attained every gateway to the samādhi of recollecting the Buddha.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard this Dharma, attained every gateway of the dhāraṇī called "The Flower Garland That Lives on Samādhi."

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, attained every gateway of the dhāraṇī called "The Heroic March That Relies on the Light of Lightning."

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, attained every kind of conforming patience, the patience that turns toward the Dharma and rests upon its shining light.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, became free of dust and stain; the pure Dharma eye regarding phenomena arose in them, and they attained the fruit of stream-entry.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, attained the fruit of once-returning.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, attained the fruit of non-returning.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, attained the supreme fruit of arhatship.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, set about escaping from the prison of the three realms; relying on the Blessed One, they went forth and entered the true Dharma.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, dwelling happily in the ten paths of wholesome action for as long as they lived, generated the resolve

for the Śrāvaka Vehicle and became irreversible.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, dwelt happily in the ten paths of wholesome action for as long as they lived, and became irreversible from the resolve they had generated for the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, dwelt happily in the ten paths of wholesome action for as long as they lived, generated the resolve for the Great Vehicle, and became irreversible from unsurpassed, perfect and complete awakening.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, attained the worldly right view. Through the power of that right view, the causes of going to the lower realms, the karma of thorough affliction, and all the afflictions were purified, and the causes of going to the higher realms, genuine aspirations, and all wholesome actions arose in them and increased.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, went for refuge to the Three Jewels and took the vows of a layman. They became eager to make offerings to the Buddha, delighted in hearing the Dharma, and devoted to serving the Saṅgha, and their resolve to exert themselves diligently day and night became boundless.

Furthermore, immeasurable, countless sentient beings, having heard the Blessed One's teaching, completely abandoned all that inclines toward wrong ways, all that leans toward wrong ways, all bad understanding and all bad actions. Gaining unshakable faith in the Dharma of the Buddha, they completely abandoned the household life and went forth in purity.

Then the Blessed One spoke these words to the bodhisattva great being Ākāśagarbha:

"Son of noble family, I entrust into your hands this gateway of the Dharma, the great exposition called The Ten Wheels of the Bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha. Retain it, and spread it far and wide. Whatever sentient beings read this Dharma discourse, recite it, bring it to mind, explain it at length to others, or abide in genuine conduct, you must protect them by means of these ten things and enable them to attain benefit and happiness for a long time. What are the ten? They are as follows. Guarding their means of livelihood and all the wealth they possess, so that it does not decline; guarding them from all harm, so that they

are free of harm; guarding them from wrong views and wrong leanings, so that they abandon the ten paths of unwholesome action; guarding them from all harm to their body and speech, so that there is none; guarding them from all blame and slander, so that there is none; guarding them so that none of their moral discipline and conduct declines; guarding them so that all nonhuman beings, disturbances of the great elements, untimely illnesses, and everything unwholesome are cleared away from them; guarding them so that no untimely or improper happenings, ill omens, or epidemics befall them; guarding them so that even when the time of death comes they see all the buddhas; and fully guarding them so that, after passing from that life, they are born in the happy realms and attain benefit and happiness. Son of noble family, whatever sentient beings read this Dharma discourse, recite it, bring its meaning to mind, explain it at length to others, or abide in genuine conduct, you must thoroughly protect them by means of these ten things, bless them, and through these ten things bring them benefit and happiness for a long time."

Then the bodhisattva great being Ākāśagarbha said this to the Blessed One: "So it is. Blessed One, I will retain this Dharma discourse and spread it far and wide. Whatever sentient beings read this Dharma discourse, recite it, bring its meaning to mind, teach it at length to others, and abide in genuine conduct, I will thoroughly protect them by means of these ten things and bring them benefit and happiness for a long time."

When the Blessed One had spoken this sūtra, the bodhisattva great being Ākāśagarbha, the bodhisattva great being Kṣitigarbha, the bodhisattva great being Vajragarbha, and the bodhisattva great being Questioner of Doubts by Reasoning, who were present in that assembly, together with the great Brahmā Devagarbha and the whole great assembly of gods, nāgas, yakṣas, gandharvas, asuras, garuḍas, kinnaras, mahoragas, humans and nonhumans, rejoiced at what the Blessed One had said.

This concludes the eighth chapter, called "The Entrustment for Attaining Happiness," from The Ten Wheels of the Bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha in the Great Collection.

This completes the Great Vehicle sūtra from the Great Collection called The Ten Wheels of the Bodhisattva Kṣitigarbha.

It was translated, edited and finalized by the Chinese preceptor Hwashang Zabmo and others, together with the chief editor-translator, the monk Nampar Mitok.

Translator's Notes

• The mountain's name is given as the Tibetan transcribes it (Khaladeya); its Sanskrit form is uncertain (the Chinese version suggests Khalatiya). "The teaching called Candragarbha" refers to the preceding section of the Great Collection (Mahāsaṃnipāta), the Candragarbha Sūtra, here named as a text rather than as the bodhisattva.
• The epithet of Śakra here, "Born Stainless," is translated from the Tibetan; its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. "Eighty thousand koṭis of niyutas" renders the stock vast number given in the Tibetan.
• "His form, deep and vast" follows the Tibetan as written (gzugs); a reading gzungs, "his dhāraṇī," would also fit the simile, but the text has been kept as it stands.
• The name of the bodhisattva rendered "Inquiring Rightly into Doubts" is translated from its Tibetan meaning; its Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. In the verse line about sentient beings coming before the Victor, the Tibetan has "true" (bden pa), which makes little sense; the evident reading "happy" (bde ba) has been followed.
• The names of the absorptions are translated from the Tibetan; their Sanskrit forms are not attested with confidence here.
• The names of the absorptions are rendered literally from the Tibetan; their Sanskrit forms are not attested with confidence. "Wisdom Free of Conflict" likely reflects araṇā-jñāna. The text shifts from present to future time ("in times to come") while keeping present-tense verbs; this is rendered as it stands.
• "Feeble" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as an evident slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("those who are feeble"), which matches the parallel clauses. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("do not shift") in the list of afflictions is taken as being unable to be rid of them; its exact sense is uncertain.
• □□□□□□□, □□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□ are taken as the standard renderings of pūtana, kaṭapūtana, and ojohāra ("vitality-eaters"). In the list of worldly wishes, □□□□□ is read as a conveyance, though it could also mean a spiritual vehicle.
• □□□□□□□□□ is taken as this text's name for the Yāma heaven, since it stands in the place of Yāma between Tuṣita and the Thirty-Three. □□□□□□□ ("oppressor") is a class of spirit I cannot identify with confidence, so it is rendered literally. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("fragrant ox") is taken as the gandhahastin, the fragrant elephant, which the usual parallels list here.
• The mountain's name, transcribed in Tibetan as Khalateya, is given as the Tibetan spells it; it is the setting of this sūtra, known elsewhere as Khalatika or Khadiraka. In the second summary the text reads "focus" (□□□□□□□) where the first list had "mindfulness" (□□□□□); it is translated as written.
• Of the six goddesses named at the start, only Śrī (dpal ldan lha mo) and Dṛḍhā (brtan pa, the earth goddess) are identified with confidence; the others (bkra shis chen mo, mchod dbyangs, chu can, 'od chen) are translated by meaning as Great Auspiciousness, Song of Worship, Watery One and Great Light. The verse section introduces Śakra's praise but its close falls outside this piece, so the opening quotation mark of his speech is left open.
• "The thirteen many conditions" and "the thirteen conditions" in the opening verses are rendered as written; the text does not enumerate them here. "What is like a vajra" in Kṣitigarbha's question presumably refers to the vajra-like samādhi that severs the last afflictions.
• The final paragraph of the simile continues into the next piece, so the closing quotation mark is not yet given.
• Where the bodhisattvas' speech ends is not marked in the Tibetan; the description that follows (with honorific verbs) parallels the enthronement of the prince in the preceding simile and is rendered in the Buddha's first person, since he is the speaker and the one so enthroned. "Hard as a vajra" reads sra bdag as sra ba dag.

• The list of attributes of the five aggregates of clinging is terse; "they are not without accumulation" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally, a double negative that sits oddly among the other negations and may reflect a difficulty in the source or its translation. In "the cause of existence, the field, and the moisture that envelops it", the imagery is of karma as field and craving as moisture.
• "By something like the spreading of grass" renders □□□□□□□□□ (read as □□□□□□□□□□), evidently the Vinaya procedure of "covering over with grass" (tṛṇaprastāraka) for settling disputes. "Brief separation and bringing them to shame" renders the terse □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, apparently temporary exclusion and public censure. In "rebukes and scolds", □□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□ "to revile".
• "Mynah birds" renders □□□□□□, taken as a transcription of Skt. śārikā, often paired with parrots; the identification is not certain. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("So he spoke") closes the Buddha's account of the fourth wheel within the narrative and is kept as written. "Let them delight freely" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□.
• The first sentence switches from "I" to "he" as in the Tibetan, where the Buddha speaks of the Tathāgata in the third person and of himself in the first. "And so on as in the passage before" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, an abbreviation that refers back to the fuller description of the fifth royal wheel.
• "The counting of the breath" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, the counting practice of breath meditation described earlier in the text.
• The "ninth wheel" is the ninth of the ten wheels after which the sūtra is named; in the closing paragraph the Tibetan adds a plural marker (literally "these ninth wheels of a buddha"), but the sense, matching the king's "this ninth wheel" above, is the single ninth wheel. Attachment and aversion in the list of the ten non-virtues stand for covetousness and malice.
• After the name Subhadra the Tibetan has the syllables "rab de" before "and others"; they do not yield a clear name, and I have read them as part of the closing "and others besides" rather than invent a further disciple. The western continent is spelled "ban glang spyod" for the usual "ba glang spyod" (Godānīya), an evident copyist's slip. The king's "tenth wheel" is literally plural ("these tenth wheels"), but the sense is the single tenth of the ten wheels.
• "This great earth, a hundred thousand of them" renders the unusual "brgya stong sa chen po"; it probably refers to the great earths of the vast buddha field described just before. The name of the teaching, literally "the great instruction in knowledge, abiding, and what is not to be practiced," corresponds to the next chapter's title, "abiding and conduct"; I have kept the negative as written.
• The phrase rendered earlier as "on what to abide in and what is not to be practiced" is shown by this passage to mean things "not to be abided in or practiced," the negative governing both verbs; the teaching's title has been kept as before for continuity, and the lists here are rendered by the clearer sense. Kudaka, Arādaka and Deśukupālaki are given as the Tibetan spells them; the first two may be the meditation teachers Udraka and Ārāḍa, who in Buddhist legend fell away from their absorptions, but this is not certain, and the third I cannot identify.
• Two words are uncertain. In Devagarbha's list of punishments, "brgyad" is rendered "mocked" tentatively; it does not give a clear sense as written. The simile for the corrupt monk, "srin kwa lwa," is obscure; "a worm-eaten husk filled with filth" follows the likely sense (srin, "worm") and the familiar image of a monk "rotten within."
• □□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is rendered as "a worm-ridden thing" on the reading □□□□ (worm, vermin), and the exact object of comparison is uncertain. The fruit called □□□□ ("Steadfast") could not be identified with confidence and is translated literally. □□□□□□□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□□□□□ are taken as entering the rains retreat and its concluding ceremony (pravāraṇā). The closing □□□□□□□□□□ here refers to the deeds of immediate retribution

(ānantarya), not the hell.
• In "among acts of taking what is not given," the text reads □□□□□, taken as a copyist's slip for □□□□ ("among"). In "follows worldly gods," the text has □□□□ ("forget"), which makes little sense here; it is read as □□□□ ("follow"). Here □□□□□□□□□□ refers to the deeds of immediate retribution (ānantarya), not the hell.
• The recurring phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "that exclude one from communion and must not be done," taking □□□□□□□□ as "not dwelling together" with the Saṅgha, the consequence of a pārājika offense. The distinction between evils by prohibition (prajñapti-avadya) and evils by nature (prakṛti-avadya) is the standard Vinaya one.
• Upāli asks how the Saṅgha should act "at a time when [the Buddha] is no longer present" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□), taken to refer to the period after the Buddha's passing. □□□ is taken as the monastery attendants (kalpikāra) who make things allowable for the Saṅgha.
• Here □□□□ refers to the mātṛkā, the doctrinal matrices of the Abhidharma, held alongside the sūtras and Vinaya; it is not the class of goddesses. "The seven methods of settling disputes" are the adhikaraṇa-śamatha of the Vinaya. The weed in the barley field (□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "what harms the barley") is not named.
• "They have only a semblance of moral discipline" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose wording is awkward; it may be a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("they have broken their moral discipline"). The phrase "behave like dogs at the sound of the conch" is literal; the conch summoned monks to meals, so it likely pictures greedy monks running to food like dogs. The term rendered "caṇḍāla" (□□□□□□□□□) describes people who act like outcastes, not their actual caste.
• The forest-dwelling monks are described with □□□□□□□□□□□□, "dwelling in the remote borderlands," i.e. hermits of the wilderness. Three readings follow evident copyist slips: □□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□, "they praise themselves"; □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as "stir up discord", since the negative makes no sense in a list of accusations; and □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "weary of profit and fame", is read as craving them, as the following "never satisfied" requires. In the list of protectors, □□ appears twice ("gods ... and deities"); the second may stand for another class of spirits.
• The phrase rendered "and so on, in full as in the passage above, until" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) is the sūtra's own abbreviation, telling the reader to supply the earlier passage in full. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "householder men", since it is paired with "women". □□□□□□□□□ is taken as "put out the eyes".
• "Something of the pure Dharma still remains with him, if only in name" renders a phrase that literally reads "there is merely the speech of the pure Dharma"; the sense seems to be that some trace of his ordained status remains. The elephant's name □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "Upāli's Eye", following the name list; the element □□□□□□□ may instead stand for utpala (blue lotus), giving "Lotus Eye".
• Several names here could not be identified with confidence, so their meanings are given in English: the king □□□□□□□□□□□ ("Victor over Foes", perhaps Skt. Śatrujit), and the rākṣasīs □□□□□□□□□□□□ ("Weapon Eye") and □□□□□□□□□ ("Donkey Tooth"). The name of the charnel ground, □□□□□□, has no clear meaning and is given in phonetics as "Khalampa". The verse Weapon Eye's retinue speaks has five lines in the Tibetan.
• The names of the two rākṣasīs (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, reading □□□□ as □□□□ "forehead", and □□□□□□□□□□□□□) and of King □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with Sanskrit originals with confidence, so their meanings are translated, as with Donkey Tooth earlier. "Caṇḍāla kings" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, kṣatriyas who behave like outcastes.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "elephant in rut" (musth). The "three wheels of evil" evidently refers to a set defined earlier in the sūtra. The phrase "the fruit of reaching the final state"

renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, apparently the final fruit of arhatship. In the first list, □□□□□ is read as □□□□ "weak", as in the parallel later in the passage.
• The clause □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ reads literally "there is no lack of fortune," which contradicts the sense of the passage; it is translated by the evident meaning, "they are utterly without the fortune for it," the second negative apparently being a scribal slip or emphatic. "Vows of evil" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the commitments to harmful livelihoods (Skt. asaṃvara or pāpa-saṃvara).
• "The fifth fascicle" renders the division marker □□□□□□□□□□ in the Tibetan text. Kṣitigarbha's question continues into the next piece, where the main clause (how much merit such virtuous rulers and others obtain) is given.
• The opening comparison is syntactically compressed: the instrumental "by the merit of untying the bonds of the arhats" is read as the standard of comparison, so that the offerings and stūpa-building just mentioned fall far short of the merit of freeing and serving the arhats described in the preceding passage; the final series renders the stock formula of incomparability (saṃkhyā, gaṇanā, upamā, upaniṣad). Khrag khrig is taken as niyuta, consistent with the house glossary. "Does not make the Dharma of the Śrāvaka and Pratyekabuddha Vehicles his own realization" renders mngon du mi byed, meaning he does not adopt their goal as his own, while still not disparaging them.
• "Whose resolve to protect the land never turns back" renders sems phyir mi ldog pa, describing the dhāraṇīs offered; the dhāraṇī's own name, the Irreversible Wheel, echoes this. The dhāraṇī text itself presumably follows in the next piece. In the first list of ten, the first item, long life, is phrased without the "arising and increase" formula that the other nine carry, and this is kept as written.
• The dhāraṇī is given syllable for syllable as the Tibetan spells it. In the verses, mtshams med sems can dmyal ba is taken as the Avīci hell, the hell of uninterrupted torment. The line mkhas pa ma yin yang dag pa dag is obscure; it is read as "the unwise, and even the pure," taking yang as "even"; an alternative is "the unwise and the untrue." The question closing Devagarbha's verse (gang dag the tsom sel cing mi ldog) is kept as a question, as gang dag suggests; its sense is compressed. "Thereby" in "they will thereby become an ocean" reads des as written, though it may be a slip for nges, "surely," as in the parallel line above. The final verse continues into the next piece.
• The opening lines complete a verse begun in the previous piece. In Vajragarbha's verses, the lines in the first person ("this pure assembly of mine", "I have not permitted") are read as his quotation of the Buddha's earlier words, so they are set within the quotation; "like the ocean that keeps no corpse" renders "like the taste of the ocean," evoking the stock image of the ocean that does not tolerate a corpse, which is uncertain. The line "Still, make offerings to them as to me" interprets the compressed phyir yang nga la mchod pa byos. The couplet beginning "Loving and compassionate one" is elliptical and its construction is uncertain. "The ten liberations through the Śrāvaka Vehicle" renders rnam par grol ba bcu po literally; the ten may instead refer to ten kinds of persons. "Higher conduct" (lhag pa'i spyod pa) and "conviction" (mos pa) render the Tibetan literally.
• "Resort to worldly gods" renders lha rjed pa; rjed ("forget") does not fit, and the sense of worshipping or propitiating worldly gods is taken from context, possibly reading a similar verb such as mchod. The ten things not to be dwelt in are completed here by dividing the long sentence about seeking wealth and about illness into the ninth and tenth items, which the parallel with the following explanations does not fully confirm. "A śramaṇa who corrupts the path" renders lam sun 'byin pa'i dge sbyong (mārgadūṣin), the last of the four classical types of śramaṇa. In "is not a vessel of the Dharma of the noble ones; yet the Tathāgata," the particle nam is read as a connective, and in "destroying the eye of the true Dharma" the verb bcar is read in the sense of ruining or gouging out.

• □□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□ (poṣadha), the evident reading in a list of formal monastic acts. □□□□□□□□□ is rendered "procedural acts"; it may stand for a specific rite such as the pravāraṇā. The two similes for the shameless monk (□□□□□□□□□, some shellfish or snail, "rotten within and full of filth"; and "the conduct of a dog at the sound of a conch") are rendered literally; their exact sense is uncertain. "The three supreme and sacred kinds of action" is not further specified in the text. □□□ for the first-listed path-teaching śramaṇa is taken as "lowest" in the graded list of five.
• The list "there are no virtuous kṣatriyas, no śramaṇas ..." follows the Tibetan word order, in which "virtuous" (□□□□□) qualifies kṣatriyas; the sense is a nihilistic denial of the social classes and their merit. □□□□□□□□ may also be rendered "guild masters".
• The four kinds of śramaṇa here correspond to the well-known Indian classification: the victor of the path (mārgajina), the teacher of the path (mārgadeśaka), one who lives by the path (mārgajīvin), and one who corrupts the path (mārgadūṣin). "The sixth fascicle" renders the bam po division marker in the Tibetan. In the corpse simile, the clause beginning □□□□□□ is taken as "whoever is smeared with it reeks of it."
• □□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "delusion about the self" (ātmamoha), the root of the pride mentioned next. In the passage on those who have heard only the Pratyekabuddha Vehicle, the Tibetan reads "the unsurpassed vehicle" without "great," and this is kept.
• □□□□□□□□□□ is rendered "wrong" (Skt. avadya, a reprehensible act) and □□□□□□ "sacred commitment." The closing first-person sentences, opened by "in the past" (□□□), are taken as the Buddha recounting his own former conduct, which continues in the next piece.
• In the verse on formal acts, □□□□□□□□□ is taken as the Saṅgha's formal acts carried out by motion. The verse of the merchants alludes to the well-known tale of merchants rescued from an island of rākṣasīs by clinging to a wondrous horse. In this piece □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ ("great merit") and □□□□□□ ("loving-kindness") are ordinary words, not the names Great Merit and Maitreya. The final quoted verses continue into the next piece, so the closing quotation mark is left open.
• The verse line □□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "conceal the master," is taken as "relying on a master," since "conceal" makes no sense here; this reading is uncertain. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is understood as the active afflictions (Skt. paryavasthāna). The second list of ten as written yields nine clearly separate items, and is translated as it stands. The definitions of "abiding" and "practice" at the end are terse and are rendered literally.
• In "little diligence" the text reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□; this is taken as a slip for □□□□□□□□□□ ("to those of little diligence"), as the parallel sentence that follows confirms. The phrase "come down to awakening" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ literally (flowing or descending into awakening). The sentence comparing hell with the annihilationist view is terse in the Tibetan; it is rendered as stressing that the annihilationist view among humans is worse than hellish suffering.
• "Proclaims annihilation and cessation" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, here in the pejorative sense of a nihilist teaching that things are cut off and cease. In □□□□□□□□□□ the same word □□□□ means "punishment", so it is rendered "punishes". The phrase "from not having given up killing up to wrong view" refers in brief to the ten nonvirtuous actions.
• The opening sentences repeat, almost word for word, a passage that appears earlier in the source; they are translated again because they stand again in the Tibetan here. "Practice without appropriation" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, practice that does not take up or grasp anything. The "three wheels of complete victory" correspond to the three miracles of a buddha: miraculous power, revealing what is in others' minds, and instruction. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as a variant spelling of the term for the Lokāyata materialists (□□□□□□□□□□□). The repeated formula "X itself is not empty; what is other than X is not empty" is rendered literally

as it stands.
• "The three things to be guarded" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as it stands; in lists of a buddha's qualities this item usually appears as the three things that need no guarding (arakṣya), which may be what is meant here.
• "Fascicle seven" renders the section marker □□□□□□□□□□□□, which marks the start of the seventh fascicle of the Tibetan text. "Has burned the seed of all gods and humans" means he has destroyed the karmic seed for rebirth as a god or a human.
• "Restate" renders □□□□□□ here in its ordinary sense of repeating or recapitulating, not mantra recitation. "Ascetic practices" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (dhūtaguṇa). The line "One becomes a vessel of the supreme vehicle" closes the pratyekabuddha stanza as the Tibetan stands; its referent is somewhat ambiguous. The assembly's speech continues into the next piece.
• The four stages named here (lesser, middling and highest forbearance, and the supreme worldly quality) follow the text's own list. The name of the absorption □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is translated literally as "Focused on the Victory Banner", since a Sanskrit form could not be identified with confidence. The assembly's speech continues into the next piece.
• "Some of us spoke like this" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which loosely introduces the list of offenses that follows. The speech continues into the next piece.
• □□□□□□□□□□ here refers to the deeds of immediate retribution (ānantarya), the five gravest crimes, not to the hell of that name used earlier; it is translated accordingly. The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ is read as a comparison ("compared with the evil of ..."), which the sense of the following sentences supports.
• □□□□□□□, the last of the thousand buddhas of the Fortunate Eon, is rendered Rocana, the name usually given to that buddha. In the phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, □□□□ is read as a slip for □□□□ ("confess"), which the context requires; likewise □□□□□□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□□□□□ ("conceal their good qualities"), as in the parallel lists earlier. The sentence beginning "it would be easier" reads the final negation as a comparison: dwelling in that hell is preferable to the evil rebirth described.
• "Forbearance regarding the Dharma" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (Skt. dharmakṣānti), the acceptance of the nature of phenomena attained on the path. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "the time that is not," is taken as the future (times not yet come), matching the parallel resolve "never to do them again."
• The sixth and seventh qualities are worded identically in this Tibetan ("do not dwell in this world"); they are translated as they stand. In Vajragarbha's second question, □□□□□□□□□□ is read as "do not encourage" (as if □□□□□), matching the Buddha's parallel "do not establish others in training"; read literally it would be "without disparaging." "The ten courses of wholesome action" renders the daśakuśalakarmapatha.
• "Free of error" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "without confusion or mistake," i.e. not misjudging or wrongly treating each vehicle and its practitioners. "The eighth fascicle" marks the start of the eighth bampo (division of the Tibetan text).
• "The four currents" renders □□□□□□□□□□, literally "four flowings"; it most likely denotes the four floods (ogha) or the four outflows (āsrava), but the text does not specify. "The four worldly distortions" are the four inverted views (viparyāsa): taking the impermanent as permanent, suffering as happiness, the impure as pure, and what is without self as a self. In the opening list this piece reads "pratyekabuddha attendants" where Vajragarbha's question had "śrāvaka attendants"; it is translated as it stands.
• "The obscurations of life" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□, an obscuration bearing on lifespan, which fits the context of killing; the text does not define it further.
• "Make no mistake regarding" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□, that is, he will not err in his attitude toward these vehicles and their followers (and so will not disparage them). "The five destinies" renders □□□□□□□□, the five realms of rebirth. "Shared with the five dangers" refers to the

traditional five threats to wealth, such as kings, thieves, fire, water, and unloved heirs. In "training under him," the written □□□□□□ is read as □□□□□□□.
• "His wife will not be unfaithful" interprets □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, literally "his wife will not be slack," that is, lax in fidelity. "Supreme celibate conduct" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (brahmacarya), the pure conduct of chastity, not the god Brahmā.
• "Wherever he is born" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□ as the stock phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□ found in the parallel sections. "Reconciliation" renders □□□□□□, the healing of discord that divisive speech destroys.
• "Having the voice of Brahmā" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, the melodious Brahmā-like voice, here an attribute of the beings, not the goddess Sarasvatī.
• "Idle talk" renders □□□□□□□□□, frivolous or senseless speech, the seventh of the ten unwholesome actions.
• The text reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, evidently a slip for □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "for as long as he lives," which is the reading in the parallel sentence that follows; translated accordingly. □□□□□□□□ and □□□□□□□□□ here name the eighth of the ten nonvirtues, covetousness (Skt. abhidhyā), so they are rendered "covetousness" rather than "attachment." □□□□□□□□ is the five destinies (gati) of saṃsāra, not "tantra." □□□□□□ (upasthāyaka or antevāsin) is rendered "disciples," referring to monastic pupils and attendants; "the disciples who are śrāvakas" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□. The closing benefits of the eighth wheel repeat, almost word for word, those already given at the start of this piece for the seventh wheel; both are translated as they stand.
• □□□□□□□□□ is malice (Skt. vyāpāda), and □□□□□□□□□□□ wrong view (mithyādṛṣṭi), the ninth and tenth of the ten nonvirtues. In this piece □□□□□□ means loving-kindness, listed beside compassion as an adornment of the buddha field; it is not the name Maitreya. □□□□□□□□□□□ marks the beginning of the ninth section (bampo) of the Tibetan text.
• □□□□□□□□□, rendered "Māra of the gods," is the divine Māra (devaputramāra), one of the four māras. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, rendered "belief in marvels and auspicious omens," appears to reflect the Sanskrit pair kautūhala and maṅgala, superstitious reliance on wonders and lucky signs. In the passage on the false claimant, "I will attain manifest awakening" supplies the sense of the first clause, which, like the two quoted claims, is governed by "says" (□□□□□). □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is taken as "to sustain the lineage of the Three Jewels."
• The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ appears to be a copyist's slip; it is read as □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "for eons ... 'We are followers of the Great Vehicle,'" which fits the sentence. □□ is taken as "if he does not remain committed to the ten nonvirtues," reflecting the Abhidharma notion of a binding commitment to wrongdoing. In the line introducing the verses, □□□□□□ means "to restate," not mantra recitation. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is pure conduct (brahmacarya), not a reference to the god Brahmā, and □□□□□□ in the verses is loving-kindness, not Maitreya.
• □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ in the chapter colophon reflects Sanskrit mahāvaipulya, "great extensive [sūtra]." □□□ in the list of things given is marrow, not legs. □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ is obscure; it is taken as the thought of being above others, that is, condescension toward the recipient, which fits the series of attitudes free of harshness, jealousy and miserliness. Though announced as ten, the wheels are not numbered in the text; they appear to correspond to the series of motives and attitudes in giving rather than to the list of things given.
• "The indeterminate group" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□ (aniyata-rāśi), the class of beings not yet fixed in either the right or the wrong direction, one of the three groups of beings. The line rendered "To persons of the two vehicles below" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, whose wording is unclear; the sense, given the prose above, is that śrāvaka and pratyekabuddha practitioners may be taught the middle and highest vehicles. The name of the absorption, □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, is translated literally as "Light of the Sun Lamp" since no Sanskrit form

could be confirmed. In this passage □□□□□□ means "restate" and □□□□□ means "obstruct" in their ordinary senses, not ritual ones.
• The list of kinds of worldly patience is terse and some items are hard to construe; "patience that is not free of being troubled" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, and "patience of weak strength" and "patience that abandons sentient beings" divide the run □□ into two items. The sentence ending this piece is introduced by □□□□□□□□□□□□□ and is rendered as a brief question followed by its answer.
• "The three kinds of eon" renders □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ as it stands; in this list of afflictive factors it may stand for three kinds of conceptualization (vikalpa), but the text has been followed. The three bases of meritorious action (puṇyakriyāvastu) are giving, moral discipline and meditation.
• In the first verse □□□□□ is read as □□□□□□, "fools" (literally "the childish"), since □□□□□ makes no sense here.
• "The tenth and final fascicle" renders the section marker □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, which marks the start of the last fascicle (bam po) of the Tibetan translation. In the verses, "absorption" renders □□□□□□□□ (samādhi). The phrase □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, "wisdom accompanied by the notion of wisdom", is terse; it seems to mean wisdom that still grasps at wisdom as an object.
• Here □□□□, listed after the sūtras and the Vinaya, is mātṛkā in its sense of the Abhidharma matrices (the third basket), not the class of goddesses. The phrase "bring beings to full maturity through the means of attraction" reads □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□, where □□□ appears to stand for □□□□; translated accordingly. The phrase □□ is awkward; it is taken as "treatises other than those the Buddha taught" that nevertheless accord with liberation.
• The opening sentence says the worldly skillful means is shared with śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas, yet goes on to describe it as the cause on which the buddha qualities rest and as irreversible; the Tibetan gives no negative or contrast, so it is translated as it stands, though the second half may be meant to contrast with the shared kind.
• Throughout this piece □□□□□□ is the virtue of loving-kindness, not the name Maitreya. In the prose explanation the Tibetan says śrāvakas and pratyekabuddhas devote themselves to "patience" (□□□□□□) focused on beings, where the argument leads one to expect "loving-kindness"; it is translated as written. "Solitary victors" renders □□□□□□□, a verse form for pratyekabuddhas.
• The second statement of the wheel's name reads "great steadfastness" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□) where the first reads "very steadfast great patience" (□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□

• The bodhisattva named □□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□□ could not be identified with a known Sanskrit name and is translated by meaning. The Chinese preceptor's name is given in Tibetan phonetics, as the Tibetan records it.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.